

Screen Tourismus am Wilden Kaiser

From protocinema to the social media
communication of screen locations

Dissertation

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Abstract

The dissertation explores the dynamic interplay between media and tourism, focusing on screen tourism through the TV show "Der Bergdoktor" set in Wilder Kaiser (Austria). It analyzes social media communication by different tourism stakeholders, addressing connections, differences and similarities in Instagram posts, the relationship between the show and tourism/media development, and the benefits of screen tourism and social network communication for production.

The case study reveals the screen product's significant influence on motives and locations on Instagram. While Screen Tourists, Destination and Production accounts differ in photo success, composition and description, they share similarities like the Influencer aesthetic. The theoretical findings highlight media's impact on tourism, emphasizing post-tourism, where tourists enjoy staged authenticity of screen tourism despite knowing their experiences are artificial.

Methodologically, the study uses both quantitative and qualitative data, analyzing Instagram metrics and conducting account interviews to create thick data. It contrasts the TV show's presentation of Wilder Kaiser with social media depictions and ties the findings to the historical tourism-media nexus, showing postmodern screen tourism as its current form and front-runner.

Keywords: Screen tourism, post tourist, post modernism, social media, Instagram, medialisaton, mediatisation staged authenticity, screen, destination, production, de-differentiation, ZDF, Bergdoktor, Wilder Kaiser

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List of abbreviations

- WK -> Wilder Kaiser
- BD -> Bergdokter (engl. Mountain Doctor)
- ST -> Screen Tourist or Screen Tourism
- DMO -> Destination Marketing Organisation
- (More information about them on page 15 in chapter 2.1)
- UGC -> User Generated Content
- RQ -> Research Question

Chapter 1

Introduction to screen tourism

Lynne Kirby's book "Parallel Tracks" (Kirby, 1997) inspired this work, exploring the intertwined history of railroads and silent cinema. My initial exposure to Kirby's theories in a Los Angeles library in 2018 led me to ponder about the relationship of media and tourism. This dissertation examines the co-evolution of media and tourism and extends Kirby's findings to the digital age. It designates screen tourism as a modern manifestation of the tourism-media nexus. This journey from a book in the USA to a dissertation in Germany underscores the underling forces at work.

The co-evolution of tourism and media The connection between travel and cinema began before movies existed in the protocinema phase. Railways enabled in the 19th century the development of mass tourism and modern cinema. Both evolved over the centuries and continue to exist today, within new forms. For a long time it was mostly the railway, traveling and tourism that impacted the cinema and media. But since the late 20th century, screen products have increasingly influenced tourism, channeling tourists to exotic destinations worldwide. Screen tourism represents a postmodern connection between induced travel and media consumption. This work aims to describe the history of tourism and media's co-evolution and connect it to contemporary phenomena.

Screen tourism as latest phenomenon Screen tourism significantly influences masses to visit specific locations. With most knowledge about the world now coming from media, its unconscious impact on all aspects of life is undeniable. Fans undertake pilgrimages to connect with their heroes and fictional worlds. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 37) Initially, railways established the cinema dispositive and influenced early movie stories. Now, the powerful screen affects travel and tourism, altering tourists' perceptions and the physical landscape of destinations. The screen tourist is a key figure of post tourism and central to this work's theories.

Learning from post tourism Post tourism challenges traditional tourism by aiming to move beyond mass tourism into *non-touristic tourism* (Jansson, 2018, p. 102)

Post tourists negotiate new boundaries, focusing on sustainability or celebrating fictional places like Kings Landing from "Game of Thrones" (Creators: Benioff and Weiss, 2019). (cf. Jansson, 2018, p. 102; Reijnders, 2016, p. 108; Böcher and Paster-nak, 2018) What we can learn as researchers lies in the very definition of post tourism: "We may grasp the socio-cultural mechanisms through which the boundaries of tourism are challenged and re-negotiated (Jansson, 2018, p. 104)". Post tourism confronta-tions are our answers to the new relationship between media and tourism, which can answer the research questions.

The primary research questions This dissertation addresses in a first research ques-tion how screen tourism communication appears on social networks, specifically In-stagram, using the TV show "Der Bergdoktor" (eng. mountain doctor) as a case study. It investigates the impact of screen productions on tourism and social media patterns, highlighting the evolving influence of digital and social media on tourism, which is underexplored in current literature. The study examines in a following re-search question the co-evolution of media and tourism, offering insights into screen tourism's impact on tourist behavior, destination marketing and screen productions. Practical conclusions in the third research question aim to uncover benefits of screen tourism on social networks for production. These questions guide the study in exam-ining the multifaceted interactions of historical path dependencies, real world con-sequences and theoretical possibilities.

Contribution to academia The significance of this approach lies in its contribution to the academic understanding of screen tourism by situating it within the broader context of media and tourism evolution. It expands on existing theories and provides a new theoretical base line for a new relationship in the digital post modern era. The method of using qualitative data to enrich quantitative data ads to the robustness of the findings. The choice for social media as primary data source for the content analysis offers insights into the everyday and by that often overlooked aspects.

The overlooked knowledg of social media Sociologist Jean-Claude Kaufmann stud-ies the complexity of everyday life, emphasizing the importance of the banal, like family meals at home. (cf. Korsmeier, 2007, p. 1) Kaufmann states: "[...], there is no commonplace that does not deserve to be thought about. The peculiarity of banality is that everyone knows it and ignores it at the same time, only wants to know about it what they already know, that is, quite little. (Ibid., p. 2)" Researchers must avoid this oversight. Cultural geography and sociology should analyze everyday social media posts, as not to discredit it as banality. The knowledge of social media could tell us something we simple overlooked until we discovered it.

Tourism as a lifestyle fuelled by media In the Western world, most people travel regularly, as seen in the abundance of travel content on social networks. It is more

common to find someone who travels twice a year than someone who never travels. Tourism is meticulously planned, fitting into routines alongside work and leisure. It is so integral to our life today and has a long developed history since the 19th century, that it reveals much about postmodern life. Travel has become an end in itself, driven by the question, "Where to go next?" (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 70 + 230) In desperation (figure 1.1) you turn to media for inspiration. Especially networks like Instagram, play a crucial role in inspiring to and informing about destinations, with 65 percent of people (Google, 2014, p. 5) starting their search without a set destination. People in the global north often turn to social media to facilitate the pressure to find the next paradise. This work aims to highlight and explore these pressures and dynamics of tourism influenced by (social) media.

Demarcation and scientific approach This work uses a case study approach in film tourism research as many other works in the field but framed by historical developments and current societal contexts. The case study supports the deducted theories derived from the tourism media co-evolution. Inspired by Kirby, Lukinbeal, Zimmermann, Escher and Adams (chapter 2.3), it integrates multiple approaches and considers practical research aspects beyond academia.

Structure and organization The dissertation is divided into six chapters: The first is outlining the background of this work and its significance to the field. The second chapter provides historical context and definitions for the encounter of different phenomenon. The third chapter describes the research methods used to collect the data. In chapter four, the case study is divided into three groups of agents to analyze their Instagram communication about the mountain doctor. In chapter five, the results of the case study and the implications for the current state of media and tourism development are evaluated and discussed. The final chapter six concludes the thesis by summarizing what the findings mean for current and future developments. The long appendix has sources, original material from the study, detailed information and additional visuals.



Figure 1.1: The lifestyle is exhausted at some point (source: front page Groebner, 2020).

Chapter 2

From protocinema to the post tourist

2.1 Terms and definitions

Definition of screen tourism

Distinction from other forms of tourism Screen tourism, part of cultural tourism, is like pilgrimage tourism. Screen tourism is offering a unique view of spaces unlike regular tourism as it offers an additional layer only visible for tourists who have seen the show. It differs from social, sports, business and political tourism, sharing traits with leisure tourism but is culturally focused. (cf. Bakk, 2010, p. 30) This paper focuses on on-location screen tourism, where sites are preserved and visitable, unlike off-locations like Bergdoktor Fanfest, which don't fit the narrow definition of screen tourism. (cf. Karpovich, 2010, p. 10; Beeton, 2016, p. 173ff)

Definition of screen tourism and film-induced tourism Film tourism has many names, both in academic and everyday language, although this is probably the most common. Other terms include "cinema tourism" (Karpovich, 2010), "television-induced tourism" (Riley et al., 1998; Connell, 2005), "movie-induced tourism" (Kim and Richardson, 2003; Im and Chon, 2008; Jewell and McKinnon, 2008), "film-motivated tourism" (Karpovich, 2010), "film-induced tourism" (Frost et al., 2009; Macionis and Sparks, 2009; Ward and O'Regan, 2009; Beeton, 2016) or "screen tourism" (Connell and Meyer, 2009; Kim et al., 2009; Kim, 2010; Kim and O'Connor, 2011) and the generic term "media-induced tourism" (Iwashita, 2003) and the related term "Celebrity induced tourism" (Lee et al., 2008). In German-language paper "Auf den Spuren von Sternenkriegern und Seepiraten" (Escher et al., 2008) Escher, Riempp and Wüst write in 2011 about "fan-tourism". Many people use the terms synonymously, but film tourism should be distinguished from "film-induced tourism", as Croy wrote (Croy, 2011). Film tourism describes the actual visit to film locations, while "film-induced tourism" attempts to explain the influence of film and television on the motivation of

tourists to travel. This study is primarily concerned with the former phenomenon. (cf. Rittichainuwat and Rattanaphinanchai, 2015, p. 137; Busby and Klug, 2001, p. 316)

The change in film to screen tourism "Screen tourism" broadens the concept beyond "film tourism" to include all media viewed on screens, like TV shows, series and internet content. It acknowledges changing viewing habits and technologies, extending beyond cinema to content consumed on smartphones and other devices, reflecting the modern, continuous media landscape. The definition of screen tourism includes different media genres, possible new dispositive and versatile carrier mediums. (Journalistic) documentaries were also not clearly covered by the old term but are included within screen tourism. At the heart of this new reorientation of film tourism research is the screen, on which the series, films or excerpts from them induce screen tourism.¹ The importance of screens has grown, transitioning from isolated events like cinema visits to a networked, continuous experience accessible via smartphones and social networks. Screen tourism, encompassing series and TV tourism, goes beyond film tourism, reflecting a shift towards visual media's dominant role in shaping tourism in general. "[T]he significance of visuality in contemporary culture far outweighs that of other types of perception, giving the [moving image] representation a primary role in shaping the modern tourist's expectations and perceptions of sights [...] (Karpovich, 2010, p. 9)." It's part of the broader "popular media-induced tourism (Ibid., p. 9; Iwashita, 2006, p. 60)", distinct from literary tourism and potentially include game tourism, highlighting the evolution of tourist attractions in the digital age.

Baseline definition of screen tourism The different definitions were analyzed using the word cloud method, which ranks different words according to their frequency of occurrence:

1. Scottish Tourist Board DMO, 2022 on page 1
2. Riley et al., 1998 on page 920
3. Tooke and Baker, 1996 on page 87
4. Jewell and McKinnon, 2008 on page 153
5. Plagens, 2017 on page 11 till 16
6. Siehl, 2010 on page 92
7. Connell, 2012 on page 1009 till 1016
8. Buchmann, 2010 on page 233

¹Screen tourism isn't defined by the length of a film but by how it's distributed. Nowadays, films are often known through clips, trailers and mashups on social media, not just their full length. These snippets, along with social media paratext, can inspire screen tourism.

- [illegible]

The most used words can be seen in the figure 2.1 and will be the basis for the proposed definition of screen tourism. "Film" and "tourism" are the most dominant. "induced", "television", "location", "screen", "cultural", "tourists", "destination" and "cinema" are among the most used. Film tourism can now be defined as cultural tourism that is induced by cinema, television and the screen to experience the locations of the inducing product in the destination. The target group of screen tourism is congruent with the target group of a film or series. (David, 2017, p. 5).

The screen The screen has a broader definition and includes all types of displays in the world, that can show third party content. A screen could be everything from a

smartphone to a cinema projection, from a home TV to a public advertising display, as well as the screen of an in-flight entertainment system (page 231) or wearable devices such as smartwatches. With its ubiquitous presence (see page 212), the screen itself, not just the content it displays, increasingly influences and drives tourism.²

Screen product A screen product, created by actors, production teams and broadcasters in a screen production, includes all moving image media displayed on screen devices. Viewers consume these products, leading some to become screen tourists. Post-production, all parties may engage as prosumers, interacting with the content on social media and at screen locations. The initial interaction with the screen product triggers travel to screen locations, linking tourists to the production and destinations.

Screen location The screen location is a specific, recognizable site where a screen production occurred. It is often a building or distinct area linked to the narrative and characters of the screen product. It serves as the origin of the production and the destination for screen tourists who visit after experiencing the medialised version in the screen product. This place unites various groups involved³, as a shared point of reference and visitation.



Figure 2.2: Percentage of the books with mentions of the terms "film tourism" and "screen tourism" from 1889 till 2019 (source: Screenshot from Google Books Ngram Viewer). In 2017, the number of mentions of both terms peaked.

Sharpening the definition is part of the change This definition of "screen tourism" marks the initial step of this work in exploring the interplay between media and travel, highlighting the postmodern shift in reality perception and to (digital) media advancements. Film tourism changed since it was first systematically described around the turn of the millennia in 2000 and the term screen tourism is starting to take off in the mid 2010s (figure 2.2). Originally focused on film, the tourist today in-

²Chapter 5.2 will explore the influences of the screen further on page 47 and 178 and following.

³As described on page 13

teracts with screens ubiquitously, expanding the scope to screen tourism. This evolution reflects broader historical shifts from early cinema to the digital era, addressing changes in the triangle how people, space and media interact.⁴

Tourism

To define tourism, we should use the UNWTO definitions of tourism and tourists: Tourism is a social, cultural and economic phenomenon that refers to the movement of people to countries or places outside their normal environment for personal or professional reasons. The people who travel in this way are called tourists: A tourist is a person who, with the motives described above, moves away from his or her usual environment in his or her free time with the intention of returning to it. (UNWTO (2008), quoted in Aschenbrand, 2017 p. 57)

Post tourism definition Urry defines them as tourists who "take pleasure in the variety of tourist games" (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 13). The post tourist enjoys the variety of tourist experiences, recognizing them as staged rather than authentic. (cf. Ibid., p. 13ff) This awareness of inauthenticity is crucial in the era of post tourism. Lush and Urry framed this development in 1994 (Lash and Urry, 2002) as 'the end of tourism'. The staged authenticity of the destination is now an important part of tourism: "One in which the traveler (typically a middle-class Western consumer) was reflexively aware of the staged nature of mass tourism and deliberately performed tourism according to media imageries rather than searching for authentic places (Jansson, 2018, p. 101)." post tourism is understood by André Jansson as "a generalized social condition that entails de-differentiation⁵ between tourism and other social realms as well as a complex set of reactions against this predominant trend (Ibid., p. 101)". post tourism as a condition in which tourism merges with other social realms also reflects a broader critique of its commercialized nature.

Social networks

Social media is anything that has a profile page for each user. You must also be able to connect with other people and these connections must be publicly visible on your profile. The network must have a function to interact with other people in a public place. One of the first networks were Facebook and Youtube, Instagram and Twitter (now called X) came in a second wave and in the latest one BeReal and TikTok⁶ to

⁴This is already part of the expected outcome for the discussion of the developments described later in section 2.2 and contextualized in section 5.2.

⁵Marshall McLuhan also coined the more positive term "global village" for the age of electronic media that will unite cultures around the world (cf. Adams, 1992, p. 120) or again more negatively in Meyrowitz's concept of "No Sense of Place" (Wasburn and Meyrowitz, 1988).

⁶The Chinese name for the app that is its own instance is called Doujin

name just a few of the most relevant.

Interaction metrics The interactions are a central KPI to this thesis's data analysis. For Instagram, interactions consist of likes and comments but excludes private metrics like saves and direct messages. Likes are often dominating over comments in this metric due to their higher frequency. Likes, symbolized by a heart on Instagram, heavily influence the total interaction count.

Medialisation vs. mediatisation

In this paper, the terms "medialisation" and "mediatisation" are used distinctly, though often seen as synonyms⁷. *Medialisation* refers to the integration of mass media into various societal sectors, influencing our perception and creating a media-shaped worldview, as outlined by Hepp (Hepp et al., 2015, p. 324ff). *Mediatisation* describes cultural and societal changes prompted by media developments, such as the advent of printing or electrification, detailing a transformation where elements adapt to media logic. (cf. Peissl, 2022, p. 1) The distinction helps understand screen tourism: (Screen) tourists approach destinations with a media-shaped view (medialisation), encountering locations presented under the influence of media (mediatisation). This dual process transforms how tourists perceive and document these places. (cf. Couldry and Hepp, 2013) Leszczynski's (Leszczynski, 2015, p. 731) argument further blurs the lines between 'virtual' and 'real,' emphasizing media's role in shaping reality itself. It claims "the material conditions of reality within which the practices and spaces of everyday life are produced at the moments or sites of multiple conjunctions of code, content, social relations, technologies and space/place (Ibid., p. 732)". So to speak medialisation is reality or becomes reality through mediatisation.

Sceentourists, Destination and Production accounts

screen tourist All the context in the paragraph 2.1 is given for the definition of the screen tourism group of Instagram accounts. They had to be at the WK at some point and post about screen tourism communication on Instagram. The content of fan sites is not considered part of the screen tourism group.⁸ Specific example accounts are not listed to avoid focusing on specific privately owned and operated accounts.

Destination Destination accounts are defined by all stakeholders who work directly for the tourism sector or who benefit secondarily from tourists coming to the Wilder Kaiser. The direct accounts are accounts like the DMOs of @wilder.kaiser or @visittirol, hotels like @hotel_garni_tirol or @jodlhof or attractions like @hex-

⁷As in this web article

⁸But this could be an interesting topic for future studies to look at this cluster of accounts as well.

enwasser or @skiweltwilderkaiserbrixental. Players that benefit from tourism are restaurants like @auwirt_aurach or @cafe_beim_schuster and various accounts like @zefi.immobilien or @memoryellmau. This group of accounts does not include local residents who do not have a commercial product to sell to tourists.

Production Production accounts are all the people who are directly or indirectly involved in the screen production of the BD TV show. From the broadcaster @zdfmediathek or @orf to the actors like for example @andreagerhard_tall_area or @sigl_hans as well as their agencies like @schlag_agentur and the crew behind the camera like @supagraf or @brkhrd.kln. Other media covering the BD and WK issues are not part of the Production group.

Screen tourism communication

Screen tourism communication encompasses basically any post identified by a boolean search in Crowd Tangle that includes keywords related to the screen product Mountain Doctor and the destination Wilder Kaiser. Posts irrelevant to this focus, such as those mistakenly including the english word "going" for the town of Going or referring to Hans Gruber as villain from "Die Hard" (John McTiernan, 1988) and not the brother of the mountain doctor, were filtered out. This definition also covers posts using relevant hashtags for visibility without a genuine connection to the content or the region. Geographic location of the screen tourism communication was considered secondary, as the boolean search terms of the Wilder Kaiser already targeted the destination. Posts not directly related to the study were further sifted out during a detailed geographic analysis of the Wilder Kaiser region to avoid contaminating the sample data.

Motive and Photographer

The photographer's place, defined by where the camera is when the photo is taken, is often different from the geolocation tagged on Instagram, which is less precise and often predefined. This study distinguishes the point of the photographer from the point of the subject or motive. The proximity between the two depends on the chosen subject; close objects, such as the travel companion, result in smaller geolocation differences compared to distant subjects, such as landscapes. Defining the subject is much more difficult because it could be considered a qualitative question: Determining the position of the subject means identifying the last clear part (in terms of distance) in the (upper) centre of the photo (figure 2.3). Challenges arise with drones or high viewpoint photos where only the position of the photographer or subject may be discernible. A SoSciSurvey was used to accurately map the points of both photographers and motives based on input from individuals familiar with the

destination.



Figure 2.3: Determining points for a motive and a photographer place with a photo example from the Hintersteiner Lake at the WK (source: own photo)

Fandom and fans

"Fandom is more than simply being a fan, its a hole culture created by a community of people to share their love of the same thing (Beth, 2023, min. 00:01:00)." Fandom goes beyond mere admiration, forming a culture with other fans who share their enthusiasm. Fans participate in activities beyond the original media, often through social media. Here, direct interactions with celebrities and accounts of the screen product are possible, fostering community building between the screen product, my self and other fans. "It taps into that ancient human impulse to belong to a group of like minded people (Beth, 2023, min. 00:02:00)." Screen tourism, the activity of organizing holidays around favorite shows or films, is a prime example of fandom. This form of tourism allows fans to connect physically at specific locations and resembles aspects of fan conventions with elements such as cosplay and socializing. Sometimes these fan conventions even take place in the locations seen on screen.

Abbrevations: BD, WK, ST, DMO

The abbreviation **BD** usually stands for *Bergdokter* (Mountain doctor)⁹, which normally means either the name of the tv show, the main character and his function in the show or as synonym for the actor of the BD Hans Sigl. **WK** is the *Wilder Kaiser* as municipality and region in the state of Tirol in the Austrian alps.¹⁰. **ST** of course stands for *screen tourism* or *screen tourist* and is further explained in this paragraph.

⁹More infos in chapter 3.4 on page 85

¹⁰More Infos on chapter 3.5 on page 91

DMO is the abbreviation for *destination marketing organization* and this is for example the WK tourism organization in distinction to the other profiles named in the definition of the Destination accounts (page 13).

2.2 History of the connection between Tourism and Media

Tourism destination archetypes The concept of the "lonely tropical beach" as an ideal tourist destination emerged during the European explorations of the 15th and 16th centuries. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 19 + 44) It was further romanticized in the 18th century by travelers who saw landscapes as if they were paintings. These historic perceptions have persisted, making such scenes highly "Instagrammable" today (figure 2.4). Even a survey of Swiss people in 2017 found that for 18 percent, home meant the ocean beach - family for 70 percent and mountains for 60 percent. The appeal of the ocean and tropical beaches reflects a deep-seated desire in Western culture, seen in the popularity of travel-related hashtags and the global success of travel brands like Lonely Planet¹¹. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 159; Groebner, 2020, p. 19 + 44) The ethnologist Marc Augé sees the beach as a space where the poor and the rich can exist simultaneously as the greatest common denominator, and where we

¹¹#lonelyplanet is a hashtag used twelve million times and #lonelybeach is used more than 60 thousand times on instagram. "Lonely Planet" itself is a global brand of bestselling travel guides and will celebrate its 50th anniversary in 2024. The success of the brand and the company speaks to the commercial value of people's desire for the "lonely" travel experience.

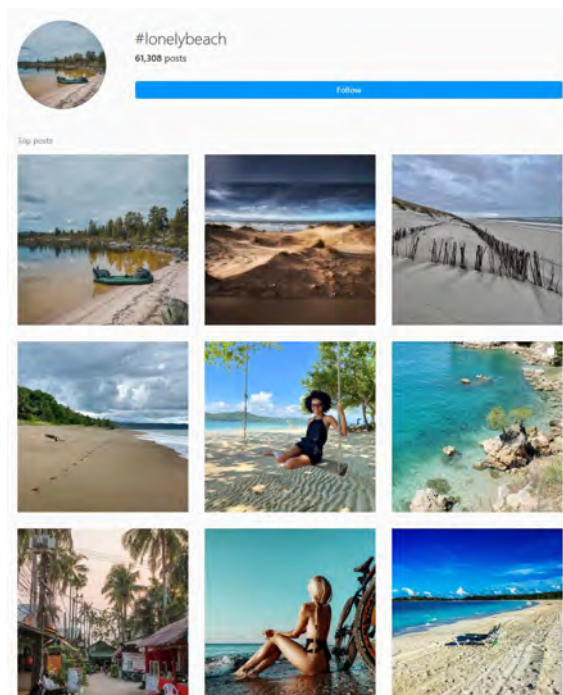


Figure 2.4: Instagram hashtag #lonelybeach.

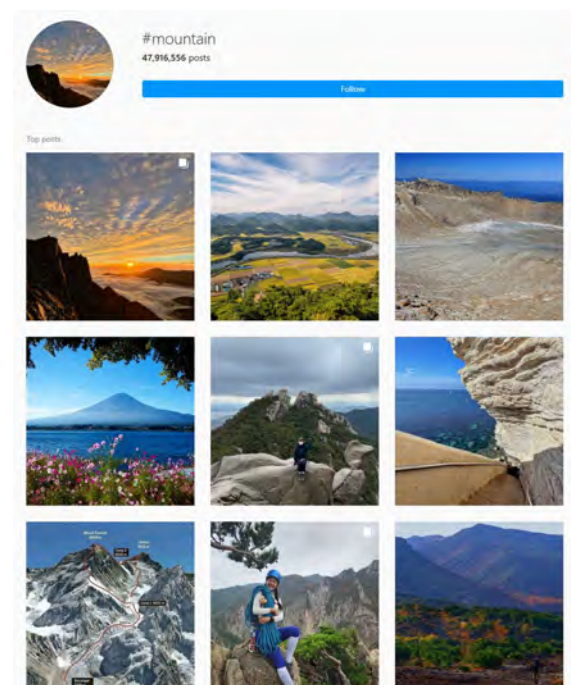


Figure 2.5: Instagram hashtag #mountain (Source for both: Screenshot from Instagram (06.10.2022)).

can act out our own archaic tribal rituals. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 23) The beach is a universal gathering place! Conversely, other archetypes of destinations, such as mountains, are also very important as the supposed other side of the landscape spectrum. They have significant cultural and sometimes religious significance, as the results of the Swiss survey and the popularity of mountain hashtags show. 46 million posts under the hashtag #mountain in figure 2.5. The allure of these landscapes has even attracted Bollywood film productions to regions like Tirol, coining the term "Tirollywood" from the regional film commission. This has attracted STs from this untapped nation to these picturesque settings with religious values. (cf. Cine Tirol Film Commission, 2017)

2.2.1 Protocinema

Paintings and early art

The proto-gaze of paintings Since the 18th century, the viewing habits of early tourists¹², were shaped by the artistic norms of their era. It required landscapes to resemble the idealized scenes depicted in paintings. This "proto-gaze" influenced how landscapes were perceived, much like Casper David Friedrich's "Wanderer über dem Nebelmeer" (1817) which epitomizes the romantic gaze. It's a lone hiker, not just in nature but triumphant in solitude, symbolizing man's stance not against nature, but as a counter to early industrialization. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 49 + 110 - 111) As landscapes transitioned from wild to exalted through the 19th century. Art and technology helped reshape perceptions, instilling a mix of fear and admiration that spurred tourists to seek direct experiences with nature. By 1865, the aesthetic of an exalted nature had been democratized, broadening the access of these experiences to the masses. Tourism thus not only changed perceptions of nature but became intertwined with it, highlighting a mutual evolution of both nature and tourism as interconnected entities. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 49 - 51 + 66)

Painting movement As cinema emerged as a new medium, painting also attempted to capture movement, exemplified by Gustave Caillebotte's works like "Linge séchant au bord de la Seine" (1892) and "Pont de l'Europe" (1876-1877, figure 2.6). These artworks reflected the fascination with depicting dynamic scenes, a motive also prevalent in early films which frequently showcased natural elements such as smoke, clouds, lightning and turbulent seas. While paintings like those of Caillebotte hinted at movement, it was cinema that truly succeeded in not only capturing but displaying motion, fulfilling the artistic obsession of the era with dynamic representation. (cf. Des Cars, 2021, p. 5 - 6)

¹²At this time primarily the upper-class elite (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 49).

Photography

The age of the world as a photo

Photography, once a privilege of artists, became a commonplace means of capturing reality. It evolved into a medium of communication and social expression by the early 20th century. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 204) By 1910, over one-third of American households owned a portable camera (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 170), integrating photography into everyday life. Judging by its dominance over the last few centuries, it



Figure 2.6: Painting of a bridge, people and train tracks in Paris by Gustave Caillebotte (Source: Own photo from Musée d'Orsay (Paris)).

certainly looks like photography is a typical postmodern trait, as it seems to be for tourism. Émile Zola captured this sentiment, suggesting one hasn't truly seen something until it's photographed. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 204; Scott, 2018) Heidegger described modernity as "the age of the world as a picture (quoted in Urry and Larsen, 2011, p.166)", emphasizing the profound shift photography brought to the representation of reality: "From the infinitely large to the infinitely small, from the depths of the sea to the deepest recesses of the human body, from the perpetual motion of celestial bodies to the seething movement of microorganisms [...]" (Des Cars, 2021, p. 5)."

The act of photographing The primary motivation behind photography has shifted from merely documenting events to the process of documentation itself, engaging with the technology and crafting a narrative through editing. In modern experience culture, photography has become an experiential act, where the technical ease of taking photos allows more focus on post-production and storytelling. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 105 and 106) This transformation empowers every individual to shape their own stories, effectively "become their own director or screenwriter [...]" (Löfgren, 2019, p. 74). Photography's appeal now lies even more so in the creative process of interpreting and transforming them through (digital) enhancements, making the efforts after shooting a photo an integral part of the modern tourist experience.

Change of perception Photography, from its early days, was captivating for its ability to quickly produce photos as vivid and real as the observed environment itself, a phenomenon described by Walter Benjamin (Benjamin, 1993, p. 51). He

highlighted the intrinsic relationship between the photographer and their camera, a dynamic that extends to tourists who use cameras to capture and shape their perceptions of the world. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 56). This connection also parallels how other technologies, like transport and cinema, influence our view of the world. Just as the cinema screen and train window extend our visual reach,¹³ the camera is illustrating how technology mediates our experience of reality.

Places began to travel In the 1880s, the advent of photography allowed places to "travel" as tourists captured and shared images far more easily than they could through painting. Unlike the costly and time-consuming process of landscape painting, photographs could be quickly produced and widely distributed, making distant places accessible and connecting them in new economic and visual relationships. This shift transformed photography from a mere reflective tool (like painting was) into an active technology of world-making. In Walter Benjamin's view, the mechanical reproduction of photos catered to a modern desire to bridge distances and bring the world closer together. This was turning photographs into instruments of place-making rather than mere representations of reality. Photos are not statements about the world but part of it. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 166 - 168)

Capturing the past Photography, as a representational technology, inherently ties itself to specific objects and places, facilitating the repeated capture of iconic motives. Valentin Groebner in his book "Ferienmüde" (Groebner, 2020, p. 77). notes a limited range of subjects that have dominated tourist photography for 150 years, including mountains, scenic vistas, lakes, luxury hotels and cultural icons from snake charmers to ancient temples. This consistency underscores photography's role in capturing the unchanging aspects of the world and their dissemination results in de-differentiation of motives. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 75 - 77) Groebner suggests that while we cannot normally stop time, holidays offer a unique opportunity to try, as tourists seek to escape their daily routines and slow down the passage of time. Yet, it is photography that truly achieves this, acting as a simulacrum that freezes moments and creates enduring memories. Concurrently but not by chance, the erection of monuments and memorials around the same time serves a similar purpose. Both techniques aiming to organize and permanently display the past, thereby leaving a lasting imprint on our collective memory. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 78 - 79)

Images as place In his book "TV as a Gathering Place", Adams argues that images actually lack a sense of place because they cannot inherit time. The moving image is in the process of changing this. What images lack in time, they make up for in reproduction: A place cannot be reproduced as seamlessly as a photographic image.

¹³The similar dispositive of the two is picked up later in this chapter in page 46.

It can be argued that reproduction itself offers images a fourth dimension, as they can exist through time.¹⁴ (cf. Adams, 1992, p. 124)

The Cinématograph as evolutionary process

The notion that the Lumière brothers' Cinématograph of 1895 first introduced "living images" (Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 89) is a simplification. Instead, this development was the result of many technological evolutions, from paintings and camera obscura to photography and dioramas. Each step brought increased realism to visual media, building upon and refining the achievements of previous proto-cinematic techniques. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 89 - 95) Notably, the diorama, a popular 19th-century invention, functioned as a direct precursor to cinema. These large installations, which toured cities and could encompass the viewer in a 360-degree panoramic experience. They portrayed landscapes, urban scenes or war depictions, offering an immersive experience that was unparalleled at the time. (cf. Kirby, 1997, p. 45; Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 94)

History of hiking

hiking into modernity At the dawn of the twentieth century, walking transitioned from a perilous necessity to a leisurely and cultural activity, influenced by changing perceptions of nature. Francesco Petrarca, who climbed Mount Ventoux (Provence, France) in the 13th century, epitomized this shift. Previously seen as dangerous or utilitarian, walking became a form of recreation when Petrarca climbed the mountain not out of necessity but for pleasure. This act not only marked the beginning of recreational hiking but also symbolized the transformative view of nature from adversary to ally and a source of enjoyment. (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020a, p. 2) „And people go to marvel at the heights of the mountains, the immense tides of the sea, the broadly flowing streams, the vastness of the ocean and the paths of the stars and forget about themselves (Translated from German by deep1.com).“ as quote from a letter from Petrarca to Dionysius (Confessiones X, eight).¹⁵ Petrarca's journey was revolutionary, introducing the concept of traveling for pleasure long before the formal establishment of tourism. His reflections emphasized the marvels of natural landscapes and set a precedent for the values cherished in tourism today. Cited as the father of mountain tourism (Alpinism) and a precursor to modernity, Petrarca's influence extends beyond his time, with his actions laying foundational

¹⁴Social media further strengthens this argument with its culture of recontextualisation, editing and redistribution.

¹⁵(Found in a NZZ article about Francesco Petrarca and whether he was really on the mountain or not.)

elements for future perceptions of travel, leisure and the archetype of mountain destinations. His ascent of Mount Ventoux is also regarded as an early form of media tourism, linking physical travel with the consumption and creation of media narratives. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 76 + 115; Petrarca, 2014, p. 43; Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020a, p. 2; Reijnders, 2021, p. 2) This connection between mountains and tourism has evolved into what Enzensberger describes as the "incitement of tourism (Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 113 + 114)", particularly alpinism, which continues to thrive today. Following in Petrarca's footsteps, the Romantics further developed walking as a lifestyle, now integral to holidays in mountainous regions like the Alps. Today it serves also as both a personal and cultural critique.¹⁶ (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 46 + 66 + 113 + 114; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 22)

Hiking infrastructure In the early 19th century, European Alps tourist guides evolved into specialized mountain guides, establishing a profession that persists today. Alpine clubs promoted hiking and mountain exploration with a cultural critique as a way to achieve freedom and a good life. They were part of the cultural change that led to a new dimension of tourist infrastructure in the Alps, in mountain regions and ultimately in tourism as a whole. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 51 + 78; Hachtmann, 2007, p. 87) By the 1830s, this development led to significant infrastructure projects, including guesthouses and mountain railways, to cater to growing tourist demand, marking the Alps as a hub for mass tourism by the 1870s. Hiking and the mountains became part of the zeitgeist of modernity. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 119 - 121)

The art of landscape Even in the early tourist rush to the Alps, artists like Lugardon romanticized the region, depicting idyllic landscapes free of people or infrastructure — found again in today's social media. Despite the presence of hikers, they were absent from artistic representations until the era of selfies. Nowadays, discussions about hiking are intrinsically linked to descriptions of the landscape. The Instagram hashtag #hiking (figure 2.7) features predominantly panoramic views or self-portraits against spectacular natural backdrops. Nature is present in the absolute majority of photos, people in more than half nowadays. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017 119 + 121)

Establishing of the exalted nature

The Beauty and the exalted Beast Hiking offers a physically demanding experience, rewarded by panoramic views at the summit, though mountain railways can ease the journey. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 120) With height comes a better view and a stronger sense of transcendence. The higher you go, the more you can touch

¹⁶Which is discussed in a later section on page 194.



#hiking

84,085,514
posts

Follow

Top posts



Figure 2.7: Instagram hashtag #hiking (Source: Instagram screenshot (30.11.2023)).

paradise. The top of a mountain is seen as the point of contact between heaven and earth. The mountains take on a context beyond their original meaning and become exalted! The sea is also sometimes marked as exalted, but only the tourist experience in alpine landscapes has been consistently linked to this aesthetic. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 113 + 114 + 243) The aesthetic of the "picturesque" in Alpine landscapes with the sublime mountain peaks with serene valleys and green forests contrasts the exalted visual of the mountain peaks.¹⁷ Already in the paintings of the 19th century, mountains are shown in contrast to something beautiful. This stylistic dialectic enhances the exalted nature of the mountains, a theme evident and popular today, as in figure 2.7. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 117 + 118)

Retro desire for the exalted alps in a time of acceleration The Alps are often viewed through a lens of nostalgia¹⁸ and the allure of a mythic past, a sentiment intensified in our rapidly accelerating times. These mountain landscapes, with their rugged terrain and picturesque townscapes, serve as canvases for retro-inspired sentiments. If we look at the spaces of the Alps, we find hills that are little used for agriculture, old buildings, a dominance of natural influences, a fragmented infrastructure and so on. In this setting, each element — from untamed hills to aged buildings — helps reconstruct and narrate tales of a bygone era. This is making the Alps not just a destination but a storyteller of historical myths. For tourists, they evoke nostalgia for a time that is more myth than reality. The tourist listens in awe to these stories at the destination that brought him there in the first place. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 80 + 81) This quest for the past is preserved and perpetuated in tourists' photographs, capturing a scene of nostalgia that will soon itself be a thing of the past. The acceleration of our world has supported not its development but the existence of the exalted nature of the Alps¹⁹

Developments in society from the city to the invention of leisure time

Age of inventions The 19th century was an era of major technological advances that continue to influence our lives today, such as the invention of the light bulb, the telegraph, the telephone, the power grid and modern rail transport.²⁰ (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020b, min. 00:02:40ff) Increased automation and streamlined, interconnected processes gave workers more leisure time. These innovations coincided

¹⁷As seen in the BD case study: Beautiful townscapes and the mysterious rocks of the WK, or the happy family life against the life-threatening unusual illness of patience. (Source: ten season of the BD tv show)

¹⁸Feelings of nostalgia can have different sources, as explained in another paragraph on page 186.

¹⁹This is also supported by the theories of Baudrillard and the simulation on page 203.

²⁰Passenger rail travel began in 1825 and today 2.6 billion people use the German rail system (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020b, min. 0:04:00 and 00:15:00).

with the rise of wealth in the global North and laid the groundwork for modern tourism. Without leisure, tourism would not be possible because no one would have time for it, which soon became the antithesis of the organized and structured working day. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 55) As leisure emerged as a break from the structured working day, it also fostered the growth of mass media consumption, which in itself offered new ways to spend leisure time. These new mass media also took on the role of a dialectical medium of what to do with this time. (cf. Rowe, 2006, p. 317 - 331)

The changing space-time of the railway Since its inception in 1835, the railway has been pivotal in transforming German society, accelerating industrialization and fostering national unity. For many, train travel was their first venture beyond their hometown, discovering that their language extended across regions. (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020b, p. 1) The fast pace, the connections and seeing new landscapes through the windows of the train did something profound to people and to the world. Holger Glockner describes it in this podcast: "The railway was an exceptional innovation because it put the world at reach. The trains made the industrializing of the space and time possible. It made the world available for the humanity (Translated by deepl.com; cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020b, min. 00:27:50)." The train annihilated space and gave travelers a sense of the vastness, scale and omnipresence of landscapes. By the end of the 19th century, travelers had a sense of space and time for the first time.²¹ (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020b, min. 00:28:10; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 163)

Capturing changing society Photography - a the technology for the imaginary suspension of time - was not only chronologically but also substantially linked to the great mobilizations thrusts. In the 19th and early 20th centuries came the steamship, the railway and the automobile. The acceleration of the world in all spheres of society made life fleeting, work transitory and family cohesion fading. Everything seemed to be available for shorter and shorter periods of time. But the instinct was to grab it before it was gone. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 68 + 75 - 77) Everyday life was every day, but in the 20th century travel and holidays were even more singular events, creating unique experiences worth capturing and preserving. Social development created moments made for the camera!

The compression of space-time

The effects of an accelerating world Technological acceleration was the driving force

²¹This development took its next evolutionary step at the beginning of the 21st century with the internet and smart devices. The train made space and time available, but digital technologies make the world available anywhere, anytime. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 163)

behind the shrinking of the world in the 19th century. With the fast trains and the expanding railway network, as well as new communication technologies in the following centuries such as telegraphy, radio and telephone, the compression of time and space made modernity possible. As knowledge about the world has a rapidly decreasing half-life, it becomes less worth knowing, harder to verify realities and less important to tell the truth. And if you have less factual, applicable knowledge about the world, you have "shrinking presence", as Hermann Lübbe defined it. (cf. Rosa, 2016, p. 232 - 234; Harvey, 1989, p. 260ff + 284ff) This is a world where fiction can exist on a level playing field with reality, as evidenced by the ST phenomenon in its destinations.

Domination of nature and control of the forces of the world

The age of reason vs. romanticism The Age of Reason and the Enlightenment valued reason over imagination, viewing the latter as a source of human weakness and a barrier to true insight. However, the Romantic era sought to revive the importance of imagination, like Petrarca who is seeking something beyond reason²². Philosophers like Rousseau and artists such as William Blake championed imagination as essential, akin to a "sixth sense" (van Es et al., 2021, p. 4). The ideals and interpretations of the Age of Reason are still relevant today because of their dominant influence on Western societies. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 109; van Es et al., 2021, p. 4) Despite Modernism's focus on reason and control the 21st century showed us the true (destructive) power of the Anthropocene age - a humanity with *too much* control! In the post-modern era, imagination is increasingly recognized for its role in shaping perspectives, even as it contends with reason in debates over critical issues like climate change. Post-truth is just the latest (corrupted) state of this development. They are literally fighting reason and logic (figure 2.8) with the possible result of losing more and more control over the forces of the world.²³ (cf. Edwards, 2015, p. 1; van Es et al., 2021, p. 4 - 5)

Tourism safety Tourists often seek both safety and adventure²⁴, a contradiction that DMOs need to balance. Something as simple as interacting with locals in a foreign language can be seen as an adventure compared to routine tasks at home. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 246 - 247) Pre-travel information and emotional connections facilitated by the media can enhance a sense of security while maintaining the thrill of adventure. A role that could be filled by a screen product. Fictional screen products in particular can help here, with their strong emotional impact on the fan, pro-

²²More on this on page 21.

²³Probably visible in the fight against climate catastrophe and the corona crisis.

²⁴Part of the perfect tourist type you can read about later in this chapter on page 187.

viding more than just information about the destination. "The foreign unknown is harmless in the world of tourism, and shocks are coming in the 'package deal' with predictability (Bauman, 2011, p. 29 + 30)." The growth of outdoor brands and shops offering safety and outdoor equipment promotes the idea of consuming wilderness safely. In the end they are just a service provider for the consumption of wilderness as a demonstrative anti-consumption. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 130) Security allows consumption, but it is never an adventure, and security is often a medialised feeling.

The gaze as a feature of control Almost

everything is beautiful through the tourist gaze, because the industry hides itself. Tourism industry has transformed destinations often by overriding local preferences in the pursuit of creating the perfect tourist experience. The tourist gaze, empowered through photography and videos, not only shapes but also controls perceptions of a place. This visual documentation gives tourists a sense of control over their experience, with user-generated content now strongly influencing the image of a destination through its rapid reproduction. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 60 - 69)

Markers and history

History as off-sight marker History and stories play an important role in the appropriation of landscapes when travelling. History is a learned cultural practice and a natural part of tourist habits at a destination. It can be said that history is nothing more than a narrative about our past, a life that has become a story to be told in the future. This relationship between history and travel dates back to Pausanias' account of his travels in ancient Greece. Tourist sites are often not just appreciated for their aesthetics but for the historical and mythological narratives they embody. These stories charge the artifacts with relevance and meaning in a discursive and dialectical mode (through the media). The fabric of a place must inherit something greater than the combined pieces of itself: "A pile of appropriately textured sand is nothing until it is turned into a sandcastle (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 119)," as Urry writes. This (narrative) information be-



Figure 2.8: The lack of understanding beyond the facts featured by climate activist Luisa Neubauer's tweet (Source: Twitter screenshot (06.10.2022)).

comes a marker or sign for places and objects of interest, with media playing a key role in broadcasting these stories to a wider audience. History functions, as MacCannell shows, as an off-sight marker. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 102ff; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 119 + 120)



Figure 2.9: Typical british humor in form of a plaque posted on Pinterest (Source: Pinterest screenshot from a photo from Elisabeth Rozanski (30.11.2023)).

Identifying on-sight markers When visiting the WK destination, the on-sight marker, like the sign of the old doctor in front of the fictional practice²⁵, directly indicates a location's relevance and doubles as a prop in the show. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 103; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 119) On-sight markers are typically confined to their physical places like street signs, while off-sight markers come from external sources and are often sourced from media or historical contexts. They both guide tourists by signifying points of interest, one physically and the other mentally. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 104; Böcher, 2018b)

Same marker, different interpretation

Tourist markers are interpreted based on the knowledge and engagement level of the visitor. For instance, someone un-

familiar with "Game of Thrones" (Creators: Benioff and Weiss, 2019) might simply admire the historical architecture of Dubrovnik, whereas a fan recognizes it as King's Landing from the series. Die-hard fans may even feel a deeper connection, visualizing the characters and retracing their steps along the storied city walls. This layered understanding²⁶ — from general appreciation to profound fan engagement — enhances the significance of the location, turning a simple visit into a richer, more memorable experience. Knowledge of the associated screen product adds depth to the visit, making it more valuable to those who recognize and appreciate these nuances. The marker of the screen location can be interpreted in different ways, depending on your personal involvement into inducing screen product. (Böcher, 2018b)

²⁵This was actually stolen so many times that they replaced the sign of the new famous BD main character with his fictional predecessor in the series.

²⁶which we will explore in more detail later in this chapter on page 205.

Proto screen tourists and pilgrimage

Imagination needs places The imagination in your head needs places to materialize.²⁷ This could be explained by a theory of separate worlds: You live in an empirical, measurable world, but there is also the world of imagination, of stories out there and fantasies in your mind. They are usually separate, but when they come together in one place, they create meaningful human experiences. For Caughey this means: "The quotidian becomes unusual, while at the same time the strange and unknown is made usual (Reijnders, 2016, p. 15)."²⁸ (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 15)

Pilgrimage as proto (screen) tourism Tourism, which evolved from early pilgrimages, continues to include the obligatory visit to churches and participation in spiritual rituals well into the 21st century. Pilgrimage and tourism are both practices of searching: They reflect an eternal quest for self-discovery and connection. (cf. AMIROU (2012), cited in Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 54 + 55; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 79) Originally established by religions, sacred sites served as tangible anchors for intangible beliefs. In secular terms: Religions were the ones who started creating places for fiction. These sacred destinations, central to every religion through the ages, also function as repositories of collective memory; in effect, these places seem to freeze time and thus shape memory. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 13-16)

New forms of spirituality Tourism might indeed be seen as a new form of religion for the postmodern era, with travel influencers acting as its new priests and travel guides akin to sacred texts. "Moving around and experiencing the absolute here elsewhere seems to be postmodernism's way of salvation," wrote Wöhler 2013. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 54 - 55) As traditional religious influence diminishes, tourism offers a new way to find meaning and transcendence. Similar to how landscapes in art before, like those by Caspar David Friedrich, shows the compensation of religion in a new kind of relationship with the landscape and have taken on a nearly divine significance. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 11) This shift reflects a broader societal change where the narrative told about a place often becomes more important than the place itself, echoing the doctrinal influence historically wielded by religions like the Catholic Church. "The fame of the object becomes its meaning (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 149)." (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 149ff)

From pilgrimage to screen tourism Pilgrimage is a precursor of standard tourism, but it has even more in common with ST. The need to place one's imagination, either a god or a fictional narrative (sometimes indistinguishable), is a strong similarity. While historically pilgrimages blended religious devotion with cultural and

²⁷As discussed in the section about 5.2 on page 224.

²⁸Problematic here is the binary division between imagination and reality, which cannot be maintained in postmodernity. More on this critique on page 5.2.

leisure experiences, ST does similarly with fandom, transforming viewers' adoration for fictional content into physical journeys. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 13 + 14; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 5) Reijnders suggests that both forms of tourism are responses to the need to externalize desires for something transcendent, underscoring how modernity's push to make the immaterial tangible has only intensified with the rise of digital media. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 105) As we continue to digitalize and dematerialize experiences, tangible interactions with places depicted in media become even more significant, not as a contradiction but as a natural consequence of our medialised worldview. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 14ff and 105ff; van Es et al., 2021, p. 289; Reijnders, 2021, p. 3)

From foot to train

It is not a journey, but a departure and arrival Previously, travel on foot meant engaging deeply with the journey itself, epitomized by the German saying, "the way is the goal". The appropriation of the landscape changed from walking paths to the train carriage. Traveling by train introduced a focus on the beginning and end, home and destination, reducing the journey to merely the means to an end. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 77) This shift allowed more people to travel further and faster, not emphasizing the experience of travel itself. "The train takes the tourist directly to the destination and the journey is only an arrival (Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 77)." The train, much like later mountain railways and gondolas, brought tourists directly to their destinations, prioritizing efficiency over experiential depth, thus reshaping the relationship between travelers and the landscape as well as prioritizing the destination in modern travel.

Pictorial exploration at the destination As early as the 19th century, the destination of a railway line had to be an exceptional place. Landscape was no longer experienced traveling physically, but rather pictorially at the train destination. As Burckhardt puts it: "The guest of the 19 hundreds goes into his hotel room, opens the curtains and looks out of the window [...] to find the ideal mountainscape of the alps [...]; ideally the framed view out of the hotel window is the same as the traveler saw before arriving in the brochure (Translated by deep1.com; Ritter and Burckhardt, 2006, p. 268)." (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 77 - 78) Continuing the development of the construction of houses with picturesque views, hotels were also built in the same way from this age on. Sitting safely and comfortably on your hotel balcony overlooking spectacular urban and natural landscapes. This was already recognized at the time as the "spectacle-isation [sic] of fishing villages (Drachmann (1881), p. 62 found in Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 159)". Thus, tourism evolved from a physical journey into a visual consumption of scenery. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 159 +

Information of the world

Imagined future realities Imagination powerfully shapes both our memories of the past²⁹ and our visions for the future, making it a crucial element in conceptualizing time and space. This influence is evident in how narratives and places intermingle in our minds; for instance, the concept of "America" existed in the European imagination before its actual discovery. The imaginative groundwork often drives us to seek out the real locations tied to the stories we hold dear. A screen product can inspire our imagination and it can then inspire the exploration and physical engagement with places previously only envisioned. (cf. Reijnders, 2021, p. 3)

Real present change In Petrarca's time, the experience of the world tended increasingly towards the real present world, away from the metaphysical religious establishment. Stories of European expansion and scientific expeditions that were disseminated through emerging forms of media, introducing new knowledge and sometimes stereotypes about exotic locales. Scientific advancements further solidified this cultural transformation. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 77) The onset of modernity brought accelerated information exchange and for the first time intra-generational changes, expanding the space of experience and altering the horizon of expectations: For the first time, people began to view their future as fundamentally different from their past, fostering a collective imagination towards a better future. (cf. Rosa, 2016, p. 210)

The absent present David Hume's 18th-century theory of the "absent present" suggests that imagination is essential to the creation of ideas. Imagination is stemming from sensory perception and forms ideas that evolve into a mental framework in which "old experiences could be ranked and new experiences interpreted (van Es et al., 2021, p. 5)". Imagination initially filled world's information gaps, a concept furthered by Kant, who believed that "a coherent experience of the world is simply impossible" and therefore the imagination does not come after experience but precedes it. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p.5ff) This later concept relates to ST, where fictional narratives feeds the imagination and fills in the gaps about the destination.

Confirmation in the real world Imagination is inherently linked to sensory experiences. For even "the wildest fantasies spring from something recognizable (Reijnders, 2016, p. 15)". We can only imagine as far as our knowledge allows: What you do not know, you cannot imagine, where there are no words, you cannot describe.³⁰

²⁹More on this on page 182.

³⁰This was also touched upon slightly after page 74. Outside of this work, the theories around *Neusprech* and the *Major Consensive Narrative* discuss this phenomenon.

Every imagined concept, whether personal or depicted in media, was inspired by the physical world. The imagined narratives are variations or mirrors of your world. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 15; van Es et al., 2021, p. 6) Completing the cycle where reality inspires imagination, which we then seek to see reflected back in the world.

The history of tourism and the screen

Screen inspiration The DMO of Arles in France still supports the idea that landscapes are more attractive when they are first seen in a depiction by a great artist. Media as a source of inspiration. Motivating and inducing people to become tourists through artistic representations has always and everywhere been part of tourism and travel. The knowledge of the existence of these factors is common sense in the study of geography, but not well researched in detail and without incorporating theoretical concepts.³¹ (cf. de Botton, 2003, p. 226; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 237)

A defining characteristic of modern masses Modernity has shifted from documentary literature to a variety of media, changing how we view tourism and travel. Now, not only are different travel forms more accessible, but the exotic unknown has become more available. Fictional stories now influence distant places more than factual information. Tourism as cultural technique has evolved and became prominent with industrialization, now a key aspect of modern life. Media has consistently played a role in shaping the significance of the tourism development. (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 5; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 237)

2.2.2 The birth of cinema and modern worlds

The development of city and rural

Empty mountains vs. packed cities Media often depict stereotypical landscapes, leading to skewed perceptions of places: mountains appear isolated and cities overcrowded (figure 2.10). This portrayal shapes tourist expectations and reinforces the idea of the countryside as an ideal retreat for city dwellers. Historically, as cities grew denser in the 19th and 20th centuries, urban architecture may have made residents feel confined in what Benjamin calls the "Kerkerwelt" (engl. Dungeon). footnote. And this is exactly the narrative of the pilot episode of the BD series. In paragraph 3.4 on page 85 the plot is explained in more detail. The new medium of films, breaking this perception with rapid cuts and diverse visuals, offered new perspectives and ways to mentally traverse these spaces. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 35)

Primordial space as counter-world Rural mountain landscapes are experienced as primordial spaces where you are free and can experience yourself in contact with

³¹A gap that this work will try to close a little.

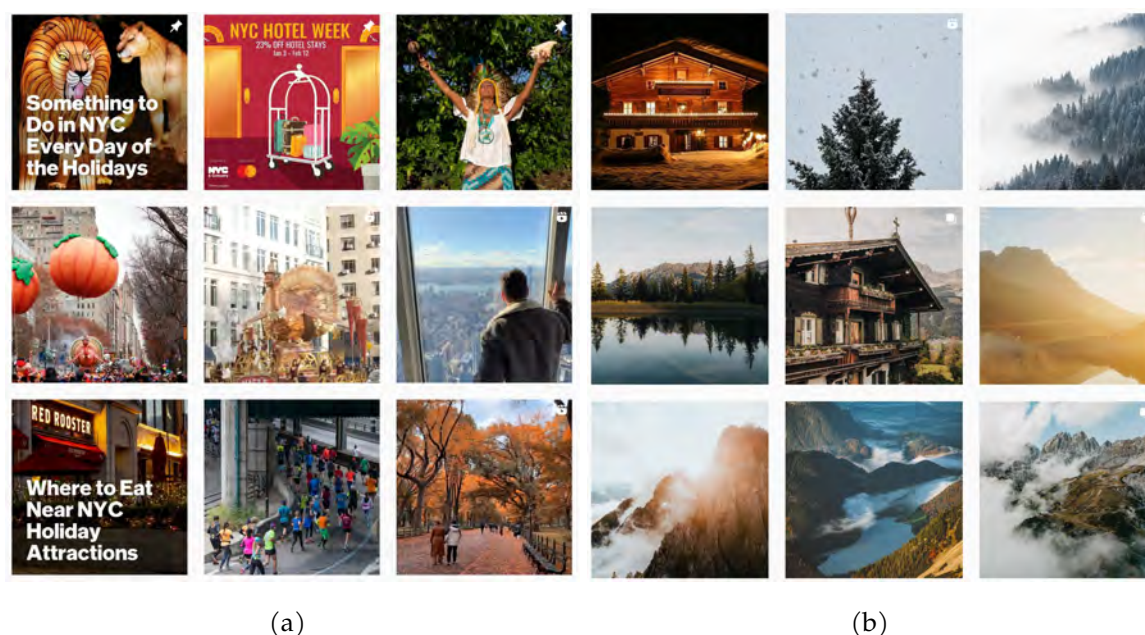


Figure 2.10: (a) Instagram page of New York (USA) DMO. (b) In contrast the Wilder Kaiser (Austria) DMO (Source for (a) and (b): Instagram Screenshot (25.11.2022)).

nature with calculated risks³². It remains in contrast to the schizophrenic feeling in the city of a life on rails with unpredictable dangers. (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020a, min. 00:17:00 - 00:39:00; Bauman, 2011, p. 29 + 30) Ali Auffermann describes his work as a photographer in the Alps in a podcast: "A fascinating counter-world to overdeveloped regions" and "The mountains offer the photographer lot of motives because of the contrast of colors, the wilderness and the size (Translated by deep1.com; Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020a, min. 00:28:06)". To find the exalted, all you have to do is point to the nearest mountaintop - in real life in the destination, but also in a hashtag like #alpinism on Instagram.

The invention of leisure time

The invention of gazing In the Christian pilgrimage tradition, the landscape was initially unimportant and went largely unremarked due to limited opportunities to look and means to talk about their impressions. However, as the modern age ushered in leisure time and Romantic thinkers pioneered ways to appreciate and discuss landscapes, gazing at landscapes developed into a deliberate activity. Gazing at landscapes was an invention. This also helped the cinema, which is based on a similar view. Travel evolved from a scholastic pursuit to an end in itself, focusing more on the experience and visual enjoyment, evidenced by the proliferation of

³²If these risks are really that calculable stays in question: In 2011, 2,000 people were injured or lost their lives in the Austrian mountains. (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020a, min. 00:17:30 + 00:34:00)

travel guides at the time. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 76; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 6)

The development of tourism out of leisure time In order to develop an urge to travel to a destination, one must first know that it exists. In a discursive social dialogue, a place has to gain relevance in order to be considered as a holiday destination. Leisure time made it possible to travel, but the media made people want to go to certain places. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 242) With disposable leisure time, it became possible for people to use their lifetime for more than just family and work. But first they had to use their time to consume media, such as newspapers, books and the first films, in order to be induced to visit the places they had discovered. Leisure time made media consumption and tourism possible, but the influx of people to travel came from the media and especially the moving pictures, (Kirby, 1997, p. 134ff + 146ff)

The flaneur In the 1880s, new technologies of representation began to proliferate. These included dioramas³³ but also postcards³⁴, guidebooks³⁵, photographs³⁶, but also arcades and cafés³⁷, and simpler mirrors and stained glass windows. The *flaneur* emerged as a key figure, engaging with these spaces through leisurely exploration. He uses these spaces, walks through them and gazes at things as he goes. Similarly, the perspectives of train passengers, car drivers and plane passengers were transformed by their modes of transport, illustrating Urry's point that "The arrival changes the nature of vision (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 162)." This evolution highlights how transportation technologies influence our perception of space. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 162)

Consumption as post religion Today, our rituals around shopping, ordering and communicating are not dedicated to gods or emperors but are geared towards consumption, a cornerstone of post-religious modernity. This shift has transformed places like motorway service areas, railway stations and especially airports into modern temples of consumption filled with supermarkets, luxury shops and entertainment facilities. We are never bored by ourselves, but always entertained by others. Entertainment pervades our lives, with even holidays becoming stages for "participatory games and theatrical fictions (Groebner, 2020, p. 129)", glossing over the decline of true leisure time. This feel-good industry, subtly pervasive, uses screen products and themed locations to sustain the consumer culture, effectively masking its own industrial nature and the broader transformations of society under capital-

³³More on this on page 21.

³⁴Mentioned on page 48.

³⁵The link with leisure on page 34.

³⁶Detailed on page 19.

³⁷What today is sometimes seen as derogatory café behavior was actually part of its appeal at the time of its creation.

ism and industrialization. The feel-good industry (which tries not to look like an industry at all) is very sensitive to reality. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 128 - 129)

The story of cinema and railway

The conjoined development of cinema and the railway The link between cinema and transport technologies (especially the railways) is deeply rooted in the development of the two apparatuses. This is not only because the two technologies began to spread throughout the world in the same century, but the relationship between them was already established when it started - in the protocinema phase: (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 24) "[...] the railroad was, first of all, a social, perceptual and ideological paradigm providing early film spectators with a familiar experience and familiar stories, with an established mode of perception that assisted in instituting the new medium and in constituting its public and its subject (Kirby, 1997, p. 2 + 3)." The prefixes cine- or kino- signify movement as one of the key components of cinema, as Lukinbeal explains. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 89)

The train as cultural image When cinema was established, the perceptual and social paradigms of modern mobile urban societies in the West were already deeply ingrained. Railways, having set the stage for cinema's evolution, became a potent cultural symbol within film history, exemplified by the famous Lumière brothers' 1895 film "The Arrival of the Train at La Ciotat Station" (Lumière and Lumière, 1896). This early connection is further highlighted by the world's first tracking shot, filmed from an electric railway by a Lumière cameraman in 1897 (Promio, 1897). (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018,



Figure 2.11: Buster Keaton in the front of the train like the cameras of the early genre of train movies. Photo from the production of the all-time great silent (train) film "The General" (Bruckmann and Keaton, 1926) (Source: Filmdienst.de (30.11.2023)).

p. 24 - 27; Geddes and Gregory, 2014, p. 144) Early cinema's close relationship with railways is underscored by continues works from iconic filmmakers like George

Méliès, Edwin S. Porter³⁸, D.W. Griffith, Dziga Vertov, Buster Keaton and John Ford, who prominently featured trains in their films and narratives. Buster Keaton, director, screenwriter, stuntman and actor, was aware of the emerging film history (30 years) and reacted to it as early as 1926 in his film "The General" (Bruckmann and Keaton, 1926). The film is about a train being brought home through enemy lines. It shows Keaton at the front of the train, sitting on the train's battering ram (figure 2.11), like the film cameras of the first train movies at the very beginning of cinema at the end of the 19th century. The railways made cinema possible and continued on parallel tracks with a cross-pollination of ideas, images and people. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 24-27)

Cinema venue In the beginning, the Lumières often showed their films in cafés and restaurants.³⁹ This changed in the early years of the 20th century, when films entered their first specialised venue. Phantom Rides (also known as Hale's Tours) showed their films in old or replica railway carriages. They actually simulated a train journey by showing films filmed from moving trains⁴⁰. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 90)

The great melting pot Cinema played a crucial role in the homogenization of Western society, drawing diverse audiences together into theaters where class distinctions and daily concerns were set aside. Like the train, cinema transported people across continents, particularly in America, fostering the great melting pot of society. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 29) The two machines represent the turbulence of modern societies and are symbols of progress and innovation. They not only changed our perception of the world but also actively participated in that change. They show what they represent, reflecting their essence and influence the change. They basically look inside themselves and in doing so influence our view of the world out there. (cf. Kirby, 1997, p. 12 - 20)

Places of the visual media

Visual media were always connected to spaces:

1. The drawings of the great masters had the aura of being unique in a place and

³⁸Read more in the section on editing and the film "The Great Train Robbery" (Porter, 1903) on page 40.

³⁹These were and are everyday places for people. This symbolisms that the movies have completed the circle of the hole as they began their consumption in everyday places, moved away with cinemas and TV living rooms, only to return to everyday places with the smartphone and its ubiquitous screen. The environment of modern video consumption on social networks could also be described as public town halls, and these digital spaces became part of our everyday lives.

⁴⁰. You can find similar films today if you look at the phenomenal success of Norwegian Slow TV or the late night programmes of various German public broadcasters. More on this on page 52

time⁴¹.

2. The panorama and diorama, where large installations that were built into specially constructed buildings (figure 2.12). (cf. Kirby, 1997, p. 43)
3. Cinemas required stationary equipment and established specialised venues to present moving images. (cf. Köln im Film e.V., na, p.1)
4. The television became a more personal space, connecting visual media to the individual living room.

The different media formats always had very specific dispositive spaces attached to them. You could or did use them only in that specific space.

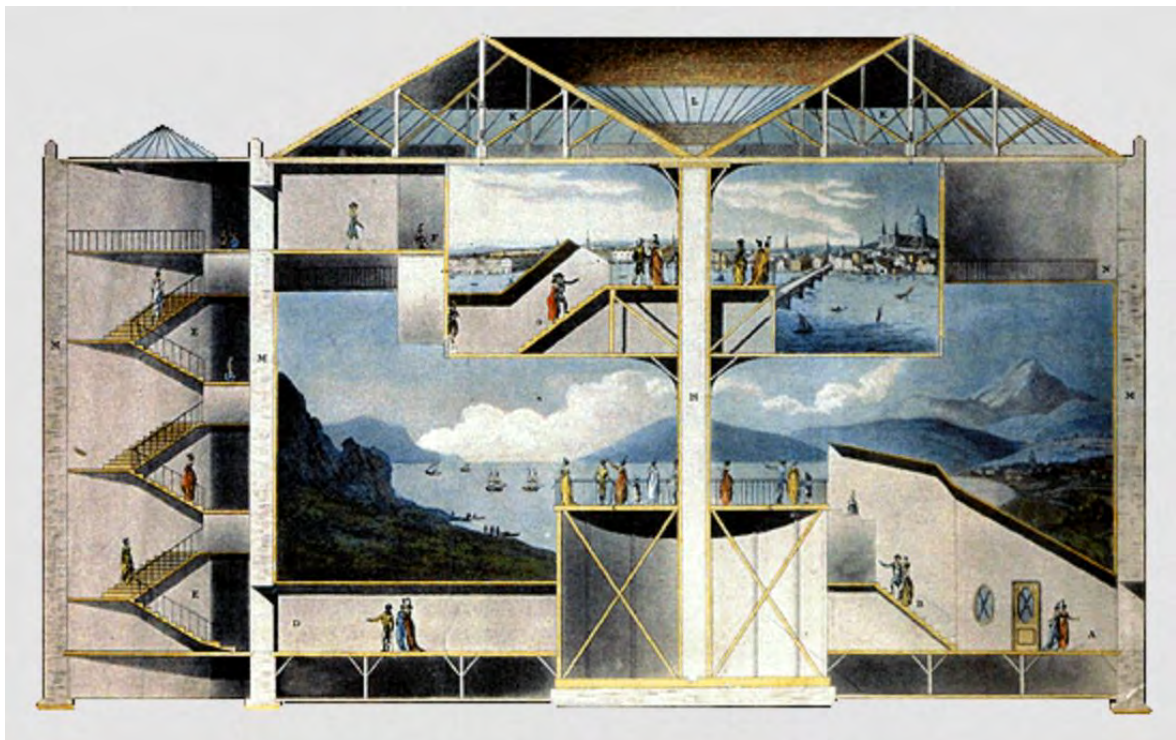


Figure 2.12: Innsbruck's Giant Panoramic Painting Building with "The Battle of Bergisel 1809" (Source: Panorama Innsbruck).

Early Genres

Train movie genre The realm of travel was one of the earliest focuses in film, presenting exotic and distant worlds from a Western perspective. One of the first public film screenings, "The Arrival of the Train at Le Ciotat Station" (Lumière and Lumière, 1896), was the beginning of a progression to more complex travel films. The first reactions at the screening showed the power of real things filmed through the apparatus of cinema: "true-to-life situations filmed in actual locations had an undeniable

⁴¹(For example, Michelangelo's "Creation of Adam" as part of the ceiling in the Sistine Chapel in Rome)

impact on the audience (Maier, 1994, p. 1)". Early films used natural landscapes and exotic locations as backdrops, captivating audiences who had limited access to such places. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 51) One of the earliest genres to establish a canon was the train film, featuring cameras mounted on trains traversing exotic locales. This is paralleling the tourist experience of viewing panoramic scenes through a window or from a scenic viewpoint. Film used the tourism perspective like the panorama and the floating view from a train to excite the audience.

Freedom of the western genre The Western genre, exemplified by "The Great Train Robbery" in 1903 (Porter, 1903), was one of the first popular genres. Westerns uniquely benefited from the freedom to shoot on location, offering financial and creative independence similar to the liberated mindset of tourists. Far from the constraints of everyday settings, they could fully unleash their creativity. Hollywood stars and crews also relished the privacy afforded away from the "prying eyes of Hollywood" (Frost, 2006, p. 5)". Privileged members of the production crew often treating these shoots as a holiday, engaging in leisure activities (figure 2.13) like hunting or fishing. (cf. Dickinson, 1973, p. 85; McBride, 2001, p. 419; Rothel, 1990, p. 63 + 69)



Figure 2.13: The actor playing the main BD character is promoting the destination, playing golf and enjoying the view while shooting in the region (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id 8VdK6YAagz).

Spatial techniques of film and the cinema

Narratives as containers Narratives can include the contingent, the unpredictable and the ironic in history and culture, as well as its spaces and times. Spaces become places as a product of humanity's attempt to represent and preserve meaningful experiences. They do this through language, art and ritual. Places are created as much by tangible experience as by the imagination within narratives. (cf. Weller, 2013, p. 32) This is why the spatial techniques of screen products are important, and cinema in particular has established a strong grip on these place-making narratives.

Vistas and establishing shots



Figure 2.14: The most famous cut in cinema history: "Kubrick's transcendent match cut, millions of years in 1/24th of a second, from the film '2001: A Space Odyssey' (Kubrick, 1968) (Source: figure from Lindner, 2016)"

Cinema and its proto-cinematic predecessors are highly charged spatial media⁴². They often employ panoramic shots that mirror the sweeping views typical at tourist destinations vistas. These panoramas are used to establish a sense of place and are called establishing shots and are often the first of a specific scene. However, cinema can also present fantastical, otherworldly views inaccessible in reality. Techniques like aerial views and intricate camera movements can create a hyper-realistic cartography that distinguishes film topography from actual places, offering perspectives that transcend normal human experience. (cf. Geddes and Gregory, 2014, p. 149 - 150)

Visual movement Early cinema audiences were captivated by the detailed movement in films — something that prior moving media like stroboscopes⁴³ and dioramas couldn't fully capture. The fascination with moving water, leaves and clouds in film reflected a deep-seated longing for dynamic representation stemming from a broader societal acceleration. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 90 + 94) Artists of the 19th century also tried to encapsulate in their paintings but film, as a new medium, was uniquely positioned to satisfy this craving with precision. The pioneer filmmaker Hepworth noted that even the simplest movements, like trains and buses in motion, satisfied audiences because "it was a miracle to see moving photographs (Hepworth (1917), quoted in Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 91)", fulfilling the public's desire for motion in a way that had never been possible before. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 91 + 92; Des Cars, 2021)

From Cinema of attraction to continuity editing Early movies primarily showcased simple scenes with intricate movements or impressive landscapes, such as the Lumière brothers' film "Départ de Jérusalem en chemin de fer" (Lumière et al., 1897). These films, reflecting a tourist-like perspective, gave au-

⁴²More on this in the section on the spatial turn on page 188.

⁴³Or also called thaumatrope or praxinoscope etc. as demonstrated here Praxinoscope-The Movie on YouTube.

diences the instinctive pleasures that are now summarized under the term *cinema of attraction*. It took decades for films to evolve into narrative spaces, because despite some early pioneers, it was the concept of *continuity editing* that finally made it successful. Earlier attempts with dioramas and thaumatropes to capture real movement fell short. The true cinematic breakthrough came from manipulating time and space between cuts, which distinguished modern film. It was only by leaving out space and time that the film found its final form. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 93 + 95)

Jumping through space-time The establishment of standard time in 1883 introduced a paradigm of synchronicity and simultaneity that was reflected in film through the advent of parallel editing. First used in "The Great Train Robbery" (Porter, 1903), editing in film allowed for simultaneous action and rapid scene transitions, eliminating transitional spaces, much like a train journey that skips across the countryside. This editing technique not only condensed space and time, but also led to the loss of local nuances, leaving only space for the spectacle. The disintegration of space-time through editing can mean a loss of local autonomy, or as Benjamin would put it, the loss of the aura. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 25) This manipulation gave films a new role, from "referential medium, bound to the real, to become a *simulacra* [emphasis in original] medium, free to fabricate a reality-effect (Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 96)". Editing alone can transform film from a medium that reflects reality to one that constructs it (figure 2.14). If the original parts of the material were more closely tied to reality, a film once edited "does not re-present a world that preexisted it (Doel and Clarke, 2007, p. 897)".

Manipulate space-time The advent of film editing marked a crucial shift, allowing cinema to transcend the limitations of space-time and to structure itself into a "uniquely linguistic reality (Baudrillard, 2001, p. 1)", where it no longer merely represented the real world, but reconstructed it. This shifted film to a simulation, but with the "reality effect" (Doel and Clarke, 2007, p. 897) it still maintained a close but transformed relationship with reality. The elements within the frame remained real, but the hyperreal emerged from what happened between the cuts - what was potentially there but not shown. What defined the hyperreal was noticeably absent.⁴⁴ Editing transformed cinema into a simulacrum, an apparatus that could manipulate and manufacture reality. Beyond mere editing, cinema employed other techniques such as stop-motion and speed magnification, collectively known as *montage*⁴⁵, to further manipulate cinematic space and time. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008,

⁴⁴Discussed at length in Deleuze's "Logic of Sense" (Deleuze et al., 1969) and "Difference and Repetition" (Deleuze and Patton, 2001).

⁴⁵curiously borrowed from the surreal world of paper-play. (cf. Ibid., p. 96)

p. 96) These techniques allowed filmmakers to craft configurations that challenged traditional configurations of life for the viewer. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 96; Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 4; Baudrillard, 2001, p. 1) As cinema evolved, it increasingly sought to smooth over these manipulative montages, but its core function remained the manipulation of these fundamental dimensions. The point here is that most films omit space by cutting through landscapes, and in doing so reshape our understanding of reality. A simulation by omission, negating space and time.

Recognizable landscapes Every screen product uses landscape to some extent. Some of them closer to reality ("Once Upon a Time in the West" Leone, 1968) and some of them far away ("Blade Runner" Scott, 1982) or completely generated ("Avatar" Cameron, 2009). And it does not even matter if it is all CGI, as Escher writes in his article "Naturaneignung in Hollywood?" in 2012 Escher, 2012. In order for the audience to locate the narrative, you need a recognizable environment to which you can attribute a real place. The landscape does not have to be real, it just has to resemble a real counterpart, so that the fiction is "grafted onto existing landscapes (Reijnders, 2016, p. 111)". (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 111)

Virtual travel Early cinema techniques "[...] enables audiences to travel virtually, to experience the filmed locations at a distance [...] (Tzanelli, 2007, p. 3)", enhancing the immersion to the point where distinguishing real from virtual becomes increasingly difficult. As audiences engage with these cinematic representations, they feel compelled to visit the actual places, blending imagination with the visual journey initiated by the screen product. (cf. Tzanelli, 2007, p. 3) Virtual travel has long been a reality, and it continues to evolve with technology. It is just that the level of immersion is getting higher, congruent with an increasingly impossible task to separate the real from the virtual.

Film as a revolutionary medium

Visual dominance Film has elevated the visual sense in Western culture, exemplified by ST. For instance, JRR Tolkien's books didn't mention New Zealand, but Peter Jackson's "The Lord of the Rings" film trilogy (Jackson, 2003) linked it to Middle-earth. New Zealand became Middle-earth despite being a fictional continent in a high fantasy setting. Even with a subtle blend of real and artificial visuals in the movies, this association shows the overwhelming influence visuals can have, even dominating other senses and media types. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 18; New Zealand Institute of Economic Research, 2002; Li et al., 2017)

The effectiveness of film People are captivated by cinema not for its stars or special effects, but for the immersive experience it offers: Did the viewer lose track of

time and space, did the film touch on their own hopes and dreams, was it an experience that superseded everyday life? This immersion offers an insight into the effectiveness of films. Films that linger in the mind may prompt multiple viewings and inspire significant personal reflections, or simply stir a desire to visit the portrayed screen locations. (cf. Blothner, 2003, p. 30 - 36)

The blurred lines of cinema Movies uniquely blend myth and reality, creating an intermediate world where anything is possible. This "world in between (Blothner, 2003, p.51)" has blurred the lines between fiction and reality. In modernity, fiction and reality have come closer together. Films and cinema are one of the places of transition. Films often focus on everyday details so effectively that they often feel more real than reality itself. In contrast to cyberspace, which remains distinct⁴⁶, film is deeply integrated into our lives and culture, making the distinction between real and fictional worlds less clear and less necessary. In a medialised and mediatised world, it is no longer possible or tempting to separate reality from fiction. (cf. Ibid., p. 50 - 52 + 210) This integration has made cinema a dominant form of entertainment since the early 20th century, contributing to phenomena such as ST: London's famous Baker Street, made familiar through Sherlock Holmes, is "more real by far to tourists than are the hotels they temporarily occupy (Tuan, 1991, p. 690-691)".

The Age of Mechanical Reproduction

The art transformed the world through reproduction Art's transformation of the visible world has progressed notably since the invention of Gutenberg's printing press, evolving through photography and culminating in the cinema. Walter Benjamin noted that film has been the most potent agent of this transformation, for better or worse, significantly altering our sensory perception of the world. The technical reproduction of moving images via film has not only changed landscapes from coastlines to mountain ranges but also fundamentally altered our concepts of matter, space and time. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 14) Benjamin write in the 1960s: "Neither the matter, nor the space, nor the time are since twenty years what they have always been (Translated by deep1.com; Ibid., p. 8)." This shift is rooted in the newfound ease of reproducing images for mass consumption, a stark contrast to the earlier, more labor-intensive methods of art reproduction. (cf. Ibid., p. 8 - 10)

Media of technical reproduction Cinema evolved from earlier technologies like dioramas and photography but also as Kirby described (page 35) from trains and the railway system. First static photos learned to move and then came the addition of sound in 1927 with "The Jazz Singer" (Crosland, 1927). This integration made cin-

⁴⁶in recent years, cyberspace has become more and more part of your life with mobile technologies, digital life and augmented reality.

media finally as vital as utilities like gas or water. As art forms became predominantly technologically reproduced, this reproduction itself became a medium.⁴⁷ However, this shift towards democratized, widely accessible media means the uniqueness of art being tied to a specific time and place has diminished. (cf. Ibid., p. 10 - 11)

Screen tourism against the mechanical reproduction ST can be seen as a reaction to the loss of uniqueness in reproduced art, as tourists seek out the real places they've seen on screen.⁴⁸ (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 110) Reproduction can only bring it into a hyperreal situation, it cannot replicate the here and now of the original: "Under the close-up the space stretches and with slow-motion the movement [of time, D.B.] (Translated by deep1.com; Benjamin, 1993, p. 35)." It is a different nature that is visible to the apparatus of the camera than to the human eye. Before, most spaces were discovered consciously and directly, but with the new media it is now a mostly indirect access to spaces. For example, the photo of this glacier is now visible to everyone on Instagram in the palm of their hand on the way to work. (cf. Ibid., p. 13 + 35 + 50) Reproductions transform specific moments into anytime, anywhere experiences, democratizing access but diluting the *aura*. The aura is the unique character found only in physical proximity, like looking at a mountain range on a clear Sunday, as Benjamin explains. (cf. Ibid., p. 13 - 15 + 36) ST visit these real places to connect with the aura lost in reproduction.

L'art pur l'art Art, deeply rooted in tradition: The culture around it evolves yet retains its era's heritage, making each piece uniquely tied to its origin. (cf. Ibid., p. 16) However, with the advent of technical reproduction, the concept of "l'art pour l'art" emerged, valuing art solely for its intrinsic and autotelic qualities, independent of tradition. (cf. Ibid. 16 + 17; Britannica, 2023, p. 1) This mirrors changes in travel: as it became accessible for everyone, the idea of "le voyageur pour le voyageur" evolved, promoting travel as an end in itself. You do not choose a destination to have a holiday as it is fixed in modern culture, but you have a holiday and you need a space to express it. Traveling as an end in itself. (cf. Grob and Klein, 2006, p. 16ff) Screen products further this by offering diverse locales that inspire and induce, not tourism or travel, but to experience a particular destination.

From elitist to the masses Technical reproduction in the 20th century transformed the uniqueness of art into a standard, favoring continuous updates over tradition. Previously, art was elitist and symbolized power, but it became more accessible, losing its unique character — a cost of its democratization. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 13 -

⁴⁷Digital networks are the latest addition to the media of technical reproduction. The case study in the chapter 4 and following starting on page 97 are about this.

⁴⁸. But the question remains whether they are really looking for the 'real' place, and whether destinations such as WK can offer this. This thesis will try to answer this in the case study on page 97.



Figure 2.15: Bergdoktor-Meme from social media (Source: Twitter post (30.11.2023))



Figure 2.16: Characters with the same name in "Die Hard" (John McTiernan, 1988) and BD (Source: Unknown internet source).

15) This shift mirrored changes in tourism, evolving from the exclusive Grand Tours for the elite to mass tourism facilitated by trains.

The reality of the masses Reality has been reshaped for mass consumption, leading to delayed consequences that alter perception and thought. (cf. Ibid., p. 16) Walter Benjamin noted these trends well before the advent of the internet or social media.⁴⁹ Benjamin's insights reveal that this shift towards mass-centric reality began in the 19th century and was amplified by cinema by the late 20th century. (cf. Ibid.)

Reproduction as ritual Technical reproduction emancipated art from tradition and cult. (cf. Ibid., p. 17) Over time, the reproduction of art and media became part of every corner of society. Reproduction became just another process in the globalized world. You can almost state that technical reproduction is a post modern tradition. It is a ritual amongst other and found its pop-cultural expression in the visual culture of the Internet. Reproduction is part of the DNA of the Internet and people have become habitual in making memes (figure 2.15 and 2.16). (cf. Hiro, 2011, p. 1)

Exhibition through reproduction With advancements in reproduction techniques since photography, art's exhibition factor has risen, while its cult value has diminished. Benjamin highlights that "in the fleeting expression of a human face, the aura beckons from the early photographs for the last time (Translated by deep1.com; Benjamin, 1993, p. 21)". But as this aura fades, exhibition value predominates. In

⁴⁹Today, with social media and media politics, the influence of the masses is more pronounced than ever. Is social media the end of this, or are the populists taking advantage of this system and establishing an even more dominant role for the masses.

tourism, the representation of people persists and has adapted to the digital age, where selfies have become a common form of expression through mobile cameras on social networks. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 20 + 21; Eberle, 2017, p. 13ff) Is the selfie really the last resort of the cult in post modernity?

Producers and consumers As reproduction technology evolved, the subjects of photography shifted from elite portraits to include everyday people, democratizing media representation. This change, amplified by the affordability of photographic equipment, transformed individuals into both audience and contributors, particularly evident in the rise photography⁵⁰ accessible to the masses. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 29) Today, we see a culture of *prosumers* who simultaneously experience and create content. In tourism, this is clear as travelers consume tourism experiences and produce content. The tourist's consumed experience becomes the content.⁵¹ Content like sending postcards, writing reviews or posting photos online becomes the consumed content of others - possible future tourists. The line between consumer and creator has blurred, a trend that began with early media but has been greatly accelerated by the internet. (cf. Ibid., p. 29; Yoo et al., 2011, p. 611; Neuhofer et al., 2012, p. 7)

A medium of controll Technical reproduction changes not only the medium, but also the relationship between the medium and the consuming masses. A mass that had just been created with the newly established mass medium of cinema. In films, like all technically reproduced media, typically "the conventional is enjoyed uncritically, the truly new is criticized with reluctance (Translated by deep1 . com; Benjamin, 1993, p. 33)." Going to the cinema is not an isolated, singular reception of art, like reading a book or looking at a painting, as you always experience it together with others.⁵² With technical reproduction the collective reaction often influences individual responses. Similarly, on social media, posting is shaped by communal expectations. (cf. Ibid., p. 33) Thus, consuming and sharing photos of travel engages with broader social control mechanisms inherent in media reproduction.

The cinema dispositive (and its similarities to railway travel)

Cinemas unmatched dispositive Cinema continues to enchant, with people spending money and queuing up despite the availability of TV, pay TV and streaming services. Cinema offers a unique experience, a special dispositive that other mediums

⁵⁰and later with the combined use of smartphones and social media.

⁵¹Within social media, you use travel content to get to know the destination and add your own perception of the destination to the content already available.

⁵²Just as Coppola said with experiences of film festivals.

can not match.⁵³ (cf. Blothner, 2003, p. 26) This trade-off of money and effort for an irreplaceable experience mirrors tourism, where the true value lies in being physically present at the destination.

Basic dispositive Choosing a train or a destination mirrors choosing a film: you buy a ticket and the conductor, like cinema staff, verifies it. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 31) Watching landscapes pass from a train window offers a "panoramic perception (Schievelbusch, quoted in Kirby, 1997, p. 7)" similar to cinema's moving images. A concept that Nietzsche's comments with "Everyone is like the traveler who gets to know a land and its people from a railway carriage (Thrift, 1996, p. 286)." This could be taken as a critique of the dispositive and what it means for understanding the world. This highlights how dispositives shape our understanding of the world, important in contexts where consumption could occur anywhere. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 163)

Other worldly dispositive The cinema dispositive transforms ordinary life into a shared, otherworldly experience, creating a fantastic reality for 100 minutes. A diverse audiences watch dramatic stories unfold in the darkened theater. (cf. Blothner, 2003, p. 29; Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 31 + 32) Kirby (Kirby, 1997, p. 2) likens this to the paradox of the railway experience, where motion (of the train) and stillness (of the passenger in the seat) coexist, concluding in an illusion of movement (in the diageitic frame) to the cinema spectator (sitting still and focused in his seat).⁵⁴ (cf. Kirby, 1997, p. 2) "Spectators are not motionless subject chained to identification with the camera's gaze; rather, they are engaged in a "kinetic affair" that exceeds the representation presented. This kinetic affair links the pleasures of spectatorship to the feeling of dynamic motion, which is generated by the camera's wandering eye. (Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 15)" The viewer sits still in the cinema chair, but is not passive as a voyeur, but "explores the presentation as a tourist (Ibid., p. 15)". When we watch a film in the cinema, it is the kinetic energy of the moving gaze that transforms the world of the screen into an extension of our physical world. (cf. Ibid., p. 15)

The end of the show The conclusion of a film in the cinema or the arrival of a train marks a return to reality, signaled by a familiar sequence that cues the audience to reengage with their surroundings. Everyday life disappears for the duration, until it returns at the end. In the cinema when the lights dim (and then brighten), the boundary between fiction and reality blurs, leaving lasting impressions, such as the eerie aftereffect when going home after a horror film. (cf. Blothner, 2003, p. 34-35) Similarly, the end of a train journey signifies a return to the real world, transitioning

⁵³The dispositive of cinema is discussed in more detail by Blothner Blothner, 2003 in 2003 and by Böcher (Böcher, 2018b) in 2018.

⁵⁴You can connect this paradox to Hartmut Rosas "Rasender Stillstand" Meyer, 2013.

from the temporary escape of travel.

Changing and interconnecting dispositive The cinema's dispositive has largely remained unchanged despite the rise of television and streaming services, which have not significantly altered its fundamental nature. However, the dispositive of train travel has evolved with the incorporation of screens, making films a part of the journey. Previously, travelers read a book, but now, mobile phones provide access to a global library of films, integrating entertainment into the fabric of rail travel. Especially in urban areas where the crowd's mechanical nature fosters a dispositive of distraction - Creating smombie-like⁵⁵ movements through the city. This distraction persists until the journey's end, when passengers snap back to the reality of their immediate surroundings. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 35; Kirby, 1997, p. 141ff)

Genres of movement: Road movies and Western

Rooted in the changing landscapes of the nineteenth century, the road movie genre, as Grob notes, is more concerned with departure and the search for new beginnings than with action and complex conflicts. It shows ordinary protagonists traveling to find inspiration and escape routine, reflecting social unease with the current world and suggesting travel as a response. (cf. Grob and Klein, 2006, p. 9 - 18 + 40) Common to all films in this genre is "the will to set out, to perceive the outside in a new way, so that the inside also changes (translated by deep1.com; Ibid., p. 18)". The focus of the genre is not on reaching a destination, but *traveling for the sake of traveling*⁵⁶, as a constant movement against the monotony of everyday life. (cf. EBD, p. 9 - 18 + 40) In contrast to the Western genre, which focuses on the establishment of civilization, road movies depict a society that is already bound by the rules of civilization. The freedom of road movies is found in the constant movement symbolized by personal vehicles such as cars and motorbikes, which offer more autonomy than scheduled public transport. Bernd Kiefer, in Grob's book "Road Movies" (EBD, p. 44), offers the perspective that in the context of American culture, the car, seen as a medium according to Marshall McLuhann, offers a highly accelerated and modern experience, which corresponds to the fragmented and cinematic perspectives of the road movie genre. "With the automobile, the American experience becomes fully modern, i.e. highly accelerated, at the same time fragmentary, staccato to hysterical (translated from deep1.com; Ibid., p. 45)". The experience of the world from a car is different from what came before, but similar to what cinema and other screen products have to offer. (cf. Ibid., p. 9 - 18 + 44 - 45)

⁵⁵Smombie is a combination of the word smartphone and zombie.

⁵⁶This refers back to the paragraph on "L'art pur l'art" on page 43

The stream as mode of modernity

The stream was established with modernity and the introduction of newspapers, which allowed everyone to experience the same stories. Today it is more elaborate, but basically the same, as it still brings together the past, present and future of the users. The stream allowed multiple temporalities to coexist and interact. The change of pace and temporality "enabled us to imagine ourselves as members of the same sociological reality (Hochman, 2014, p. 3)". The stream shows us the lives and spaces of others more than other forms of society before modernity. (cf. Ibid., p. 3- 4).

2.2.3 Parallel development of tourism, media and technology

Communication of tourists

From postcards to mobile photos Postcards, the original medium for travel communication, featured aesthetics similar to those sold today, such as temples and landscapes, largely ignoring industrial scenes at the destination.⁵⁷ (cf. Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 52; Groebner, 2020, p. 73 + 74) Dubbed 'the new postcard' (Munar and Jacobsen, 2013, p. 52), photos and videos shared via smartphones and social media represent modern tourism communication but haven't eclipsed traditional postcards, which still hold relevance and popularity in new social contexts. These communication mediums coexist, with postcards providing a tangible, emotional connection and social media offering instant communication blurring the lines between home and destination. Communication about tourism destinations is what made tourism possible in the first place - communication preceded tourism. Both forms serve to showcase holidays as status symbols and affirm the traveler's presence at the destination, maintaining the tradition of tourism as a form of social communication. In a social competition won with the proof of being there, photos of the loneliest beach or the highest mountains are shown on smartphones, social media networks and postcards. (cf. Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 52; Groebner, 2020, p. 49 + 50).

Tourism is communication Tourism acts as a form of communication, showcasing social status to peers and the host country alike, driven by the need to match or exceed the perceived status of colleagues, friends and family. As Urry notes, not all travel impacts social status; it's primarily those experiences characterized by significant movement and the exploration of new destinations that elevate one's standing. High-status indicators include fast cars, private planes, luxurious accommodations and exotic places, all meant to be seen and admired by both local onlookers and peers back home. (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 233 + 234)

⁵⁷ A wonderful source of old and new postcards can be found at Bartko Reher Antiques (cf. Bartko and Reher, na).

Globalisation: From the studio system to international attractions

On location vs the studio system Starting in the 1920s and during the 1930s and 1940s, the Hollywood studio system centralized film production in large hubs like Los Angeles and in sound stages of the big studios, marking the "Golden Age of Hollywood". (cf. Bordwell et al., 1985) Early film production, while mostly confined to studios, occasionally ventured into real locations for spectacular effects, exemplified by Buster Keaton's "The General" (Bruckmann and Keaton, 1926), which featured a real train and explosive bridge scene filmed in Oregon (USA)⁵⁸. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 51 + 52; Maier, 1994, p. 2) However, advancements in camera technology and global incentives have since made screen production as mobile as tourism, with cities like (Vancouver, Canada), regions like (Tirol, Austria) and governments like (Korea) vying for both film projects and tourists. (cf. Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 6 - 7; Vancouver Film Commission, 2023; cine.Tirol, na; Council, 2011) The attraction to a few selected global places is strong and even visible in the case study of the BD, as the global city of Munich is just around the corner (only 1.5 h) from the location of the WK. A quote from ZDF for the production of the Mountain Doctor supports this, as the proximity to Munich (attractive metropolis, airport and the Bavaria Film Studios) was a decisive factor in the choice of WK screen locations. (cf. Böcher, 2018a) A location to the big hubs and studios still matter but mostly personally now, for the people involved and not decisive by the screen production overall.

The importance of locations Today's film industry combines digital techniques like green screens, CGI and motion capturing with actual on-location shoots. While digital productions dominate mainstream cinema, on-location shoots remain crucial for culturally significant and critically acclaimed films, as real locations often contribute to a film's aesthetic and critical success.⁵⁹ Filmmakers value real-world locations for their irreplaceable authenticity and atmosphere, as noted by Sony's Jeff Cooper regarding LA Union Station: "You couldn't build a soundstage like this (Strauss, 2014, p. 1)". Both digital and real-world settings are used to enhance storytelling, providing a balance of visual effects and tangible settings that reflect a production's ambition and budget, often leading filmmakers on a global search for

⁵⁸The location at IMDB.com.

⁵⁹This cultural discourse is perfectly illustrated by the debate surrounding the Star Wars franchise: George Lucas used more CGI in the original trilogy (episodes four to six), which was filmed on location in Tunisia in the 70s and 80s, even after the CGI effects in the second trilogy (episodes one to three) were criticized. The latest trilogy (episodes seven to nine) went back to its roots and offered reasonable CGI effects, on location shooting (Dubrovnik for example) and natural looking sets and props. (cf. Eidiger and Natalie, 2015, p. 1)

unique locations to captivate audiences.⁶⁰ (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 51 + 52; Maier, 1994, p. 1 - 7; Hain and David, 2023, min. 00:07:23ff)

From sets to wonderlands Throughout the evolution of tourism, movies have always accompanied it. For example, after filming "The Alamo" (Wayne, 1960), a Texas farmer bought the sets on his land and transformed the film set into a theme park named "Alamo Village". Similarly, the set of "Arizona" (Ruggles, 1940) became a major tourist attraction, described as a "Cowboyland version of Disneyland (Frost, 2006, p. 6)". Disneyland itself originated as a way to entertain visitors so they are distracted from being STs at the many California film ranches, with Walt Disney creating a theme park near the studios. These theme parks, have become today significant (tourist) attractions in their own right, embodying a shift towards simulated environments in tourism.⁶¹ (cf. Frost, 2006, p. 6)

The romantic and collective tourist gaze

The shift of world forms the tourist gaze The concept of the tourist gaze, as defined by Urry, emerged around 1840, sparked by the coinciding advent of collective travel, tourism desire and photographic technology. This period marked a significant shift where technology and social change melded to shape a new cultural zeitgeist.⁶² (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 14) Gazing only became a thing when the apparatus allowed us to reproduce it. The ability to reproduce and share our gaze through photography was integral from the start, fundamentally changing how relationships and perceptions were formed. Urry notes, 1840 "is one of those remarkable moments when the world seems to shift and new patterns of relationship become irreversibly established (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 14)". Photography advanced the development of the tourist gaze, as "they are not separate processes but each derives from and enhances the other, as an 'ensemble' (Ibid., p. 186)." (cf. Ibid., p. 14+186)

Gaze definition Urry's theory of the (romantic) gaze is social constructivism. It deconstructs the notion of the 'innocent eye'. The gaze is a discursively consolidated expectation of a landscape, its interpretation and appropriation. This gaze is not merely an observation but a socially constructed way of seeing, enriched by our knowledge of the relationships between things. Urry emphasizes that seeing is embodied, affecting how spaces are experienced based on societal stereotypes about what or who should inhabit those spaces. (cf. Ibid., p. 1-2; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 245; van Es et al., 2021, p. 285; Crouch, 2000; Crouch, 2001). Finding these stereo-

⁶⁰This balance and ambition is perfectly shown in Gareth Edwards film "The Creator" (Edwards, 2023).

⁶¹What exactly it distracts from is written on page 205.

⁶²Urry and Larson describe in their book "The tourist gaze 3.0" (Urry and Larsen, 2011) on page 14 all the unfolding and defining events that happened in a period of just three years around 1840.

types in the condensed setting of tourism makes the gaze a "good way of getting at what is happening in 'normal society' (Ibid., p. 3)". Moreover, the influence of screen products on our visual expectations significantly shapes this modern gaze, as tourists seek out landscapes that match predefined visual signifiers (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 16).

The (romantic) gaze The technology of the smartphone, the internet and social networks has influenced and empowered the visual gaze in modern tourism. (cf. Ibid., p. 2) The gaze is not an invention of the (modern) tourism industry, but was already present in the paintings of the Romantics and was subsequently developed between different stakeholders. The romantic gaze presents an idealized image of tourism that often remains unfulfilled, as advertisements create expectations they cannot meet. Consequently, tourists may find themselves disappointed upon encountering a crowded destination, contrary to the solitary romantic scenes promised. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 246; Groebner, 2020, p. 44)

Seeing other tourists In the tourism ecosystem, backpackers are viewed as the apex tourists⁶³, seeing themselves above the plentiful *regular* tourists. (cf. Ibid. 50 + 105; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 202) In Goathland, UK, tourists attracted by the "Heartbeat" TV series (?), differ from other visitors: They engage superficially due to the screen-induced collective gaze and view their visit as *snackable content*, contrasting with walkers and ramblers who immerse themselves for longer periods and less intrusively. This distinction even leads to complaints among tourist groups about each other, echoing the sentiment in Jarvis Cocker's song "Common People", where he sings, "You know that everybody hates a tourist (Found in Groebner, 2020, p. 103)". This situation illustrates the varying perceptions of the 'correct' way to experience and gaze upon a landscape, suggesting a hierarchy of visual engagement deemed appropriate for different settings. (cf. Mordue, 2009, p. 338 + 342)

The illusion of the anonymous flaneur Tourists are under constant surveillance, both observing and being observed, as noted by gaze theorist Urry, who describes them as "subject to the most intrusive surveillance [...]" (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 221)". This scrutiny is a trade-off for accessing destination paradises, now intensified by digital lifestyle that make it possible to track activities covertly and extensively⁶⁴. The anonymity once possible for the flaneur is lost now as tourism is mass phenomenon around the globe, are observed by security, states and the tourism industry as well as actively engage themselves with public social media while using hashtags and posts that invite further observation, altering the private nature of travel into a

⁶³More on this on page 186.

⁶⁴This very work benefits from the openly available tourism data on Instagram to answer the research questions in chapter 3.1 on page 68ff.

public spectacle. (cf. Ibid., p. 221 + 222).

The age of acceleration

In postmodern times, despite increased self-determination, people face greater dependencies and alienation, challenging genuine interaction and agency over actions. (cf. Rosa, 2016, p. 9) Rosa's resonance theory posits that engaging with the world — whether through nature or shared experiences like cinema — allows it to respond, enhancing our connection to it. However, the rapid acceleration of transport and communication technologies⁶⁵ has significantly altered how we engage and resonate with the world.

Holidays as counter to acceleration In postmodernism, there exists a counter-movement to acceleration, where the quest for idyllic tranquility from a mythical past coexists with and even reinforces and induces the acceleration of the world. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 106) This has led traditionally to the creation of de-acceleration spaces such as wellness temples and holiday destinations in general, with recent trends including monastery accommodations and yoga retreats. Sometimes, the acceleration processes themselves create slowness, as seen in traffic jams or ski lift queues. (cf. Rosa, 2016, p. 196-197) Similarly, engaging deeply with fandom can be viewed as a form of de-acceleration, involving long-term interest and intensive interaction with the source material.

Mechanical speed When the railway was new, the acceleration and speed of the train was frightening to many people. The world felt like it was flying past them at less than 50 km/h - absurd by today's standards. The introduction of (mechanical) speed marks a turning point in history and opens doors to other worlds. With the railways came industrialization, which put the world to the beat of machines. (cf. Deutschlandfunk NOVA, 2020b, p. 1)

The train came from acceleration to relaxing The railway, a symbol of early acceleration, established cinematic dispositives that have evolved into modern media forms. Today, programs like a popular German after-hours show use contemporary train footage which echoes the aesthetics of early silent train films⁶⁶, offering a nostalgic yet relaxing experience in our fast-paced world (figure 2.17). Similar screen products are concepts like "Earth Night" and Norwegian slow TV phenomenon⁶⁷, which provide a serene counterpoint to contemporary life's speed. (cf. Böcher and

⁶⁵Drivers of this acceleration are mostly capitalist processes, which are explained in more detail on page 192 and also here (Ibid., p. 14ff).

⁶⁶Described in detail on page 36

⁶⁷The so called Norwegian slow TV hype are popular videos offering serene imagery of trains, ships and natural landscapes from the Hurtigruten.

Pasternak, 2018, p. 38 + 75) What began as a symbol of progress and acceleration has transformed into an icon of relaxation and tranquility in popular culture.



(a)

(b)

Figure 2.17: (a) "Railway trip over the Tay Bridge (Silent, UK, 1897)" (Source: YouTube video from National Library of Scotland). (b) "The most beautiful train tracks of germany (ARD, 28.06.2013)" (Source: YouTube video from GerSnooker).

The scaling of the world

The agency of networked media In the 20th century, media technologies shifted from one-way systems such as cinema, radio and television to two-way mobile media (devices) that rely heavily on internet-connected applications, services and platforms. This shift has greatly expanded user agency, making technology a profound influence in almost every aspect of life. Social media, in particular, has become one of the dominant forces in shaping how we perceive and engage with our world. For example, destinations such as Maya Beach in Thailand became globally recognized through films such as 'The Beach' (Boyle, 2000), but it is now social media that amplifies and manipulates these mediated perspectives. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 179) As the space loses control, it gives the user greater influence over these spaces. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 179; Jansson, 2018, p. 104).

The world in your pocket The smartphone, a device small enough to fit in your pocket, represents the shrinking of both our world and our devices. Unlike public media like cinema, smartphones are highly individualized: Each one tailored to its owner through personalized logins, algorithm-driven apps and unique home screens, making them as distinctive as fingerprints.⁶⁸ (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 53) This shift marks a contraction in media consumption spaces, from cinema in pub-

⁶⁸The individualization of the smartphone environment can also lead to an individualized medialisation and mediatisation, which will be discussed more in section 2.2.3.

lic spaces to television and radio in shared living rooms, down to the personalized pocket device of the smartphone. Today, while you can access the world from your smartphone as you relax alone on a deck chair at a resort, it underscores a more solitary interaction with media.

Individualisation of the world

Modern individualism The modern era is often termed the age of individualism, characterized by conveniences like microwaves or cars that support a lifestyle emphasizing personal flexibility and private goals. This individualism has granted significant freedoms in Western societies but also contributed to issues like the climate catastrophe due to a lack of individual responsibility. As always in postmodernism, individualization is part of a conflict between banal rituals and the reflexive human: Despite the appearance of individuality, many behaviors are merely repeated social rituals, though there is a continuous effort to reflect on and improve these practices. As the desire and emotion of holidays and travel is a deeply personal experience, its satisfaction is largely collective and simultaneous. (cf. Korsmeier, 2007, p. 1 - 4; Groebner, 2020, p. 43 + 44)

Oszilation between individualism and society Media and tourism reflect a blend of individual and group experiences, from private reading on the beach and individualized algorithm-driven online consumption to public cinema and mass rail transport. Despite this, the trend toward individualism is growing, challenging the collective norms in post-modern society. "By their very nature coaches collectively package people into a mobile unit, and this is antithetical to what Rojek [...] terms as the leaning toward 'individuation' in (post)modern society (Mordue, 2009, p. 339)." Daily activities also show this dichotomy: one might fly to a destination, then switch to private car travel, or consume local and home media simultaneously. With in-flight cinema, collective traveling and individual viewing of the screen come together in a perfect example. This represents not merely a coexistence but a significant conflict between individualism and collectivism - a struggle that has not yet been decided. (cf. Ibid., p. 339; Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 3)

The selfie The selfie, a modern staple of digital communication, reflects increasingly individualized lifestyles since modernity's rise. Unlike traditional portraits, selfies are defined by their widespread distribution and social interaction. The selfie pose is standardized and a tourist convention (figure 2.18). More than just capturing a moment, selfies serve as calls for social interaction, garnering comments and likes that assess and validate the experience. They are not merely mementos but a call to communicate with the subject of the selfie and by that tools for fostering relationships. The selfie propagates the crafting a market-aligned, neoliberal identity through con-

tinuous self-reflection and adaption to compliant strategies of representation: (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 17 - 21 + 56)



Figure 2.18: Women use their cellphones in Duomo Square in downtown Milan (Italy) on 25.02.2016 (Source: Taylor, 2018, p. 14).

A performative individualism? The performative turn reevaluates individualism by highlighting how personal actions often represent public self-display⁶⁹, suggesting that what is considered individualism may actually be a blend of performance and consumption. "The act of 'consumption' is at the same time an act of production, of reinterpreting, reformulating, redoing, decoding what is encoded in the present (Du Gay et al. (1997), cited in Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 206)." For tourists, it is more than individual consumption of past texts, but also the creation of future texts through

performances. (cf. Ibid., p. 206; Cavanaugh, 2015) This intersection of consumption and production characterizes the Web 2.0 era, leading to the concept of a "prosumer society" (Neuhofer et al., 2012, p. 5). Performance acts both offline and online as a link between the collective and the individual: The individual performance in the collective tourist gaze at the destination, or you connect your personal life in a fandom to fictional narratives through enactment at the screen location. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 285 + 286)

Mediatisation and medialisation

Crisis of representation Medialisation and mediatisation represent a shift from direct to indirect experience of the world, leading to a "crisis of representation" (Sharp and Lukinbeal, 2016, p. 2) where it becomes difficult to distinguish between these experiences. As society increasingly engages with the world through screens, informed by 'cultural ways of knowing' (Sharp and Lukinbeal, 2016, p.2), confirming reality becomes a challenge. The rise of audiovisual media has changed the way we perceive reality, which means that we need the other sense to confirm that what we see and hear is real. This emphasizes the need for physical presence and experi-

⁶⁹This places contemporary discussions of social media representations of individualism in the context of an ongoing transition that began long before social media was developed, the Internet was conceived and television became widely accepted.

ence⁷⁰ to confirm our perceptions - at least if you are interested in confirming your medialised view of the world. (cf. Sharp and Lukinbeal, 2016, p. 2; Rodaway, 2011)

Close yet separate medialised lives The medialisation of our gaze alters how we perceive daily realities, leading us to mediatize our perceptions to fit these medialized conceptions. Empirical studies by Raab suggest the existence of distinct spaces of perception⁷¹, where social construction depends more and more on translation into these medialised spaces. While the omnipresence of media in shaping our understanding of place might seem negative, it also highlights the diverse realities presented, creating a world rich in contrast. (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 29; Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 18) Social media exemplifies this by encapsulating us in bubbles⁷² which, although distinct in nature, are closer in the digital realm. This closeness is facilitating intense interactions and the rapid spread of content: When they collide, big and ugly debates erupt in forms like the shitstorm. When memes go beyond your bubble, you have a so called viral hit. This is illustrating the fluidity and proximity of digital spaces today. (cf. Bruns, 2019)

Medialised destination In the early stages of tourism, medialised photos greatly influenced travel, primarily disseminated through limited gatekeeper media like cinema, which often served as the only window to the world for the less affluent and those in the Global South - Which is still mostly true today. Despite an increase in tourists and a concurrent rise in media usage, the impact of media on perception of travel destinations remains significant. Media continues to shape how these places are seen, even as more people visit them than ever before. (cf. UNWTO, 2024, p. 1; Zenith, 2019; Statista, 2023c) Cresswell notes that "place is constantly produced and reproduced in a world in movement, open to change, mediation and contestation (Cresswell, 2011)", expressing that a distinction between direct and indirect spaces of experience cannot be maintained in a hyper-medialized culture. Initially dominated by film, this trend has persisted and evolved with television and series significantly influencing place-making today. Fletcher, Lukinbeal and McHugh write that television now plays an overlooked but significant role in place-making. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 13)

Medialised tourist perception More and more spaces do not exist as 'lived in' or 'been there', but as 'seen on screen'. The spaces in the destinations are directly dependent on the media system, how people use them, act on them, represent them. (cf. Ibid. 13, Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 21; van Es et al., 2021, p. 8) "[...] different modes of mediascape induce a diversity of travel modes in the social and physical land-

⁷⁰This also has implications for the experience economy on page 207.

⁷¹*Social perception* is not so different from Urry's concept of the *collective gaze*.

⁷²bubbles that extend from our analogue lives.

scapes (Wang et al., 2012, p. 372)." 77 percent of travelers surveyed by Globetrender (Globetrender, 2020, p. 1) feel compelled to visit the most popular tourist attractions. This comes from the social consent for a must see sight seeing spots defined, supported and delivered by screen products. The result is that the most picturesque places are intensely overcrowded. (cf. Ibid., p. 372 + 373; Globetrender, 2020, p. 1; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 160) Mediatized perception can also be shaped by sharing one's experience directly on the web. Mediatization is visible when we try to fit the content into the constraints of the screen when video calling a friend or sharing in social networks under the vertical paradigm.

Minimizing strangeness The conflict between foreignness, authenticity and familiarity in tourist destinations in the story of the tourist who wants domestic food at the buffet in the destination. They want the exotic and the recognizable. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 70) The media helps to reduce this conflict by familiarizing tourists with exotic places and customs before they arrive. Medialisation extends to our holidays through smartphones and travel guides that translate and highlight regional authenticity, although subjectively. (cf. Ibid., p. 245) Guides and media offer a curated slice of reality, giving the tourist as little exoticism as necessary and as much familiarity as possible. The physical sensation of being at a destination remains a uniquely personal experience. Holidays are usually a guided experience with a pan over the most beautiful sights. The last truly unique experience you can have is the physical sensation of being at the destination, which is not about the surroundings but rather something internal. The de-differentiation of the world of tourism in order to individualize the specific tourist experience, and the result is that tourists find the strangeness within themselves.

Art as a system Art, in its many forms, has evolved into a crucial social subsystem formulates an (avant-garde) interpretation of landscapes. Artist interpretations gradually influence public perception through media, dictating which landscapes are noteworthy and how to adopt them.⁷³ (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 109) Particularly television and cinema now mediatize our imagination and became the main storytellers of our time. The stories are linked to the real world by the actors who play the characters and by the locations and landscapes used. This top-down system leads tourists through its narrative directly to the destinations. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 16)

mediatized ownership Screen products turn objects, people and spaces into commonly owned entities through mass consumption, embedding them in popular culture. Viewers that become fans often feel a sense of ownership over these primarily

⁷³How this "circuit of the imagination" works is explained in detail in the book "Places of the Imagination" by Stijn Reijnders. (Reijnders, 2016, p. 110)

fictional elements. Examples of excessive fandom or intrusive behavior include following one's favorite actor, cosplaying, or planning one's holidays solely based on screen locations. This emotional attachment can create real-world tensions at for example screen location, such as invasions of privacy, property damage or sometimes even unjustified claims of ownership. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 285 + 286; Mordue, 2009, p. 341 - 342) An example in the case study is the privately owned "Hof Köpfing" at the WK, which is the screen location of the BD Gruberhof, restricted access to the property because fans blocked the narrow mountain roads while using it as a parking area for a quick look. Managing these sites requires balancing the rights of owners with the expectations of fans, ensuring respectful and sustainable tourism practices. Which was solved in case of the Gruberhof screen location with the designation of a car park for the fans⁷⁴ and the development of walking route as well as tractor tour for the lazy walkers. (cf. Tirol Werbung, na, p. 3; Wilder Kaiser Destination, na) In the case of the Heartland tourists, the inhabitants of Aidensfield and the county of Goathland (UK) are working against the mediatised logic imposed on them by the masses of enthusiastic fans. The use of screen locations bound to the mediatisation should only go as far as the owners of the site feel comfortable with. (cf. Ibid., p. 338 - 342; Tirol Werbung, na, p. 3; Wilder Kaiser Destination, na)

Screen tourism overwriting history ST mediates local history, often overshadowing real historical narratives with global pop-cultural portrayals. For instance, "Gladiator" (Scott, 2000) influenced tourist behaviors in Rome, shifting interest from historical authenticity to Hollywood-inspired experiences. Tourists began favoring photo ops with costumed characters over exploring archaeological sites, even critiquing the authenticity of the costumes compared to the film: They "were cheap, their helmets plastic and 'they're not exactly Russell Crowe (Tzanelli, 2007, quoted from BBC News (2002))" was one opinion. (cf. Ibid., p. 1 - 5) The powerful off-sight marker of screen products, its applied arm of STs and hurried ahead DMOs have the ability to deviate from the local on-sight markers overshadowing the local history and reality. Screen products and fandom can redefine local identities, transforming media images into new, globally recognized popular identities. The screen product narratives become the story of the place, and over time the history of the place - and perhaps gets a marker on-sight in the destination (cf. Ibid. 4 + 5)

Victims of off-sight markers Off-site markers add new meanings to places, often eluding local control. Local communities, particularly in developing countries, become the inadvertent victims.⁷⁵ Their lives and spaces are transformed under global

⁷⁴The BD parking spot is visible in figure 5.7 and the mundane banality of this space is analyzed in this chapter on page 195.

⁷⁵But are we not all perpetrators and victims in this game? We are all each other's tourists, and what

pop-cultural influences. (Ibid., p. 144-145) These communities are compelled to adapt to the economic demands of a new, mediatised reality shaped also partially by cultural imperialism and global capitalism. (cf. Ibid., p. 144 + 145) The interplay between media representations, tourist expectations and the pushing tourism industry significantly impacts local places, societies and economies.

Television

Usage of television Television remains a major leisure activity in industrialized countries like the US and Germany (figure 2.19), often ranking just after work and household duties in time spent. (cf. Seven.One Media GmbH, 2023; Adams, 1992, p. 118) It's seamlessly integrated into daily routines, often used passively, leading to its influence being underestimated. Television usage is consistent worldwide because owning a TV typically results in similar viewing habits across different demographics and countries. The decisive factor in television consumption is just whether you have one. This differentiation in TV consumption predates the influence of screen products and other post-modern effects. (cf. Ibid., p. 118 - 120; van Es et al., 2021, p. 8)

The public and private sphere of tv watching Television, as an evolution of cinema, shifts the public experience of the cinema into the private sphere of home viewing. Whereas film (in the cinema) excels at conveying a sense of place because of its visual scale, television's episodic nature builds a strong sense of place over time, enhancing its place-making power. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 16) Regular viewing of

is done to us, we do to others. A spiral driven by the capitalist engine (page 192) and the subjective illusion that we are not tourists at all (page 186).

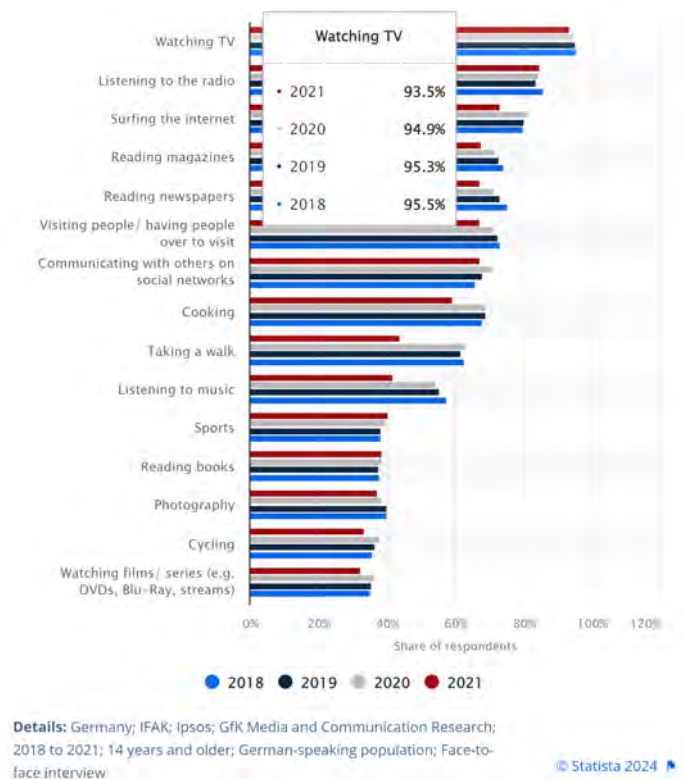


Figure 2.19: Most popular leisure activities, hobbies and sports (undertaken at least multiple times a month) in Germany from 2018 to 2021 and the dominance of watching TV (Arbeitsgemeinschaft Verbrauchs- und Medienanalyse, 2021).

TV series fosters a deep familiarity with their settings.⁷⁶ This can promote cultural exchange and understanding, especially when shows are distributed internationally. Viewers become emotionally involved in the lives of the characters, and the act of watching becomes an integral part of a normal weekly routine. (cf. Ibid., p. 16ff + 80; Mordue, 2009, p. 334; Adams, 1992, p. 120) And it is not just the time we spend watching: "Televisual place-making is, therefore, a dynamic and ongoing process which unfolds as we watch and wait to return (Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 80)."

Television as place Television transforms perspectives, enabling viewers to experience different realities. This is illustrated by Adams' imaginative scenario: A coffee cup that is not a place for a human but when you shrink down to the size of an insect it could be. Television, as an apparatus that can show this, also has the ability to transform a non-place into a place. (cf. Adams, 1992, p. 123) The television screen moves the cinematic experience into private homes, creating a unique sense of place. Adams described television as a "social context," "sensory communion," and "social congregation" (Ibid., p. 117), emphasizing its role in shaping social spaces. To speak of television as a place is not an attack on the definition of place, but it indicates a shift in society away from a place that depends on a physical location. Unlike traditional geographic places, television serves as a communal space, influencing viewers' perceptions and interactions, when watching a famous TV programme simultaneously in front of a screen. (cf. Ibid., p. 117 + 122 + 124) The TV is a versatile space as it can serve additional (and the sum of all) functions normally provided by many different places: Its capable of hosting social gatherings in a space where people and objects can acquire value and, unfortunately, it can also construct an *Us vs. Them*. (cf. Ibid., p. 130) This multifunctional and simultaneously nature of television can significantly impact real societies and spaces.

Bonfire shows on TV Television both expands the public sphere and creates a private space for viewers, who engage by watching. (cf. Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 15) In Germany, *Lagerfeuer-TV* (eng.: campfire tv) describes popular broadcasts that unite many viewers.⁷⁷ Such events include sports (Soccer world championship), elections (Vote for the German parliament), special events (Oscar show) and popular series ("Tatort" (Griesmayr et al., 2024)), fostering shared cultural moments. The weekly as well as seasonal return of the BD series brings together not everyone, but an ever-growing fan base in front of the TV. These recurring shows cultivate a growing audience and influence pop culture, with TV remaining a central "gathering place" (Adams, 1992, p. 177).⁷⁸ (cf. Ibid., p. 118 + 125; Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 17)

⁷⁶Visiting the WK in the BD series for 16 years now, with over 155 episodes (as of November 2022).

⁷⁷More info on this from the TV-Brand Panasonic (Ger.)

⁷⁸In recent year the web 2.0 version of live TV became prominent with the rise of the platform

New centralities and distance The strong sense of place in television media does not change the placement of churches and government buildings in the centre of our city centres, but these old communal centres have to compete with a new centre of gravity. It establishes new centralities that often seem more significant and visible than traditional structures. Examples like televangelism (in Germany "Gottesdienst am Sonntag") and C-SPAN channels (in Germany the channel "Phoenix"), television has medialized and overtaken these old centralities in Germany. (cf. Ibid., p. 126) With TV series such as the German "Traumschiff" or BD, it is also taking on the challenge of changing another major force in society - tourism. But what is actually shown on TV is usually distant in real space and far away from the real social status of the viewer. (cf. Ibid., p. 126) But distance is not an obstacle as it could even be the explanation for ST. The allure of these portrayed spaces often stems from their perceived distance to the everyday as well as the distant screen location can be reinterpreted as exotic destination for the next holiday trip. Distance itself could be part of the motivation for television viewers to become STs.

The continuum of the TV place Massey suggests that place is a continuum, shaped by practices and performances, challenging traditional notions place tied solely to physical locations. (cf. Massey, 2012) Rubin notes that increased television viewing aligns people's perceptions of social realities more closely with what they see on TV. (cf. RUBIN et al., 1988, p. 108) Place is resonance and the TV place continuum can offer that and expand when people invest in it. Television's influence expands the concept of place beyond the physical to include imagination, memory and media knowledge, akin to André Malraux's concept of the *musée imaginaire*. (cf. Adams, 1992, p. 120; Buchmann et al., 2010, p. 17) Place does not have to emerge from presence alone, but can be constructed with the components of the *musée imaginaire*. The simulated world of television drags its signs, symbols and images onto the physical landscape. Then the world is extended and enhanced. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 21) Tourists then carry the *musée imaginaire* to far corners of the world, interacting with real spaces and the collective imaginations of others.

Similar enough to be desirable Everyday activities like work or school runs might seem mundane, but when depicted on TV or in movies, they appear more glamorous and sometimes even desirable. (cf. Ibid., p. 110) Fictional narratives present causality as it unfolds in real life, making them relatable yet glamorous. (cf. Levine, 2015, p. 135)". Serialized TV narratives, simply unfolds over a longer period, mirroring our daily routines but with a touch of glamour, allowing viewers to form long-term attachments to the characters. These shows offer a blend of familiarity as well as

Twitch and its prominent streamers. (Statista, 2023b Graph one und two)

aspirational glamour, making their depicted lifestyles seem attainable yet more desirable than our own. (cf. Ibid., p. 135) Similarly, tourism balances the exotic appeal of new destinations with the comfort of familiar amenities, echoing the *home away from home*⁷⁹ concept.

The generation shift

Intragenerational change leads to an interest in the life of others With generational shifts and the acceleration of global processes, family dynamics have evolved. Modernity disrupted traditional life, invoking nostalgia for simpler times (MacCannell.2009, p. 91ff). (cf. MacCannell, 2009, p. 91ff) As MacCannell once wrote: "Modem Man [sic] is losing his attachments to the work bench, the neighborhood, the town, the family, which he once called 'his own'⁸⁰ but, at the same time, he is developing an interest in the 'real lives' of others (Mac Cannell, quoted in Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 139)." This outward gaze is reinforced by societal shifts toward a production system called *fordism*: Focusing less on personal confines and more on collective functioning as everyone does their job so you can do yours. As change continued to accelerate from inter- to intragenerational change, interest in other people's lives also grew. The use of social media that came with the latest generations is part of this interest in other people's lives. (Hudson, 2020, p. 203-208; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 129; Perruci, 2011, p. 82-87)

The spearhead of travel trends across generations Gen Zers draw travel inspiration from social media, especially from friends' posts, being particularly receptive during the decision-making phase. They seek unique, photogenic experiences, reflecting an "all-or-nothing approach to travel (Southan, 2017, p. 6). As digital natives, they favor cross-device, visually compelling and trend-focused marketing strategies. As the first generation after Gen Y to come into full contact with digitalization and technology, meta-tourism trends are shifting. (cf. Ibid., p. 1 - 7; Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 123; Dimock, 2019, p. 1ff) This generation epitomizes the shift towards individual networks over traditional social groups indicating the evolution of post-modern society. (cf. Turner, 2015, p. 109) In Generation Z, we are looking under a magnifying glass at what a post-modern society will look like at its possible end. The pre- and post-holiday consumption phases are becoming smaller, as gen Z travelers are becoming more spontaneous overall, and post-holiday consumption is increasingly taking place near-live at the destination with the smartphone on social media. Tourism strategies must adapt to accommodate the preferences of these tech-savvy, spontaneous travelers, with social media playing a crucial role. (Social) media is the

⁷⁹This is discussed further on page 197.

⁸⁰Maybe also a feminist change in the patriarchy.

tool of choice as it is involved in every step of the process and is changing more than just Generation Z but is present in all other cohorts too. (cf. Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 123)

2.3 Inspiration and demarcation

Inspirations, idears and continued tracks

As mentioned in the introduction (page 5), this work draws heavily from Lynne Kirby's "Parallel Tracks" (Kirby, 1997), which examines the parallel development of cinema and railroad technology. Kirby's insights were crucial for our study (Böcher and Pasternak, 2018) on Los Angeles Union Station (figure 2.20) as a cinematic icon, conducted during a field methods course⁸¹ led by Professors Chris Lukinbeal and Elisabeth Sommerlad. This research paper builds upon the studies conducted in Los Angeles, Kirby's ideas and transports them into the post-modern era.



Figure 2.20: The LA Union Station is still a cinematic star (source: own photo from 2016).

The mentioned course also included a habitat analysis, refined in this work using geo-located photos and heat maps. Inspired by Lukinbeal's work (e.g., Lukinbeal and Sharp, 2022), this study incorporates the Production as agent in ST.

Case-study approach The case study approach is common in ST research.⁸² This paper uses the TV show BD as its case study (chapter 3.4) to narrow down possibilities. In ST research, choosing a suitable case study is crucial due to the variety (decade, genre, space etc.) of screen products and their differing impacts. To avoid the limitation of isolated examples, this work incorporates big data from Instagram, aiming for broader insights from the abstract level of the digital follow-up communication. Unlike typical ST studies that focus on a case study and its conclusions, this re-

search starts with media-tourism history and ends with theory, using the case study to substantiate these deduced findings.

Institutes focus on film geography The University of Mainz's Institute of Geogra-

⁸¹The work of another graduate student Julian Zschocke was later publicized in the GeoJournal Special Issue "Film Geography" as an essay (Zschocke, 2022) that focuses on another famous screen location in Los Angeles, the Nate Starkman Building in the LA Arts District.

⁸²Over 25 ST case studies were part of the sources used for this work like Beeton (Beeton, 2001), Busby & Klug (Busby and Klug, 2001) or Mordue (Mordue, 2009) to just name a few.

phy⁸³ focuses on film geography, inspiring my master's thesis on "Game of Thrones" (Creators: Benioff and Weiss, 2019) ST in Dubrovnik. (cf. Böcher, 2018b) Influential works by (Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2006), Escher (Escher et al., 2008), Lukinbeal (Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008), Beeton (Beeton, 2016), Kim (Kim, 2010) and Macionis (Macionis, 2004) provided the theoretical and methodological foundation.⁸⁴ The master thesis evolved into a Ph.D. project, analyzing the BD screen product's impact on ST communication and the WK destination, using concepts of medialisation and mediatisation. Escher's text "Naturaneignung durch Hollywood?" (Escher, 2012) highlights media's role in shaping perceptions, paralleling this study's ideas and findings.

International influence Paul C. Adams' "Television as Gathering Place" (Adams, 1992) and Lukinbeal's "Cinematic Landscapes" (Lukinbeal, 2005) shaped the understanding of place and space. Sangkyun Kim's work on ST re-enactments (Kim, 2010) and Macionis' continuum of film-induced motivation (Macionis, 2004) contributed to the development of the study design (page 10 & 11) and a new definition of ST phenomena, addressing gaps identified in Connell's 2012 overview (Connell, 2012).

Additional techniques First, combining quantitative and qualitative data through the trace interview method created *thick data* (page 71). Secondly, separating geo-located photos into photographer and motive points added depth to the data quality and insights. This approach, enhanced by privileged access to production data, provides new possibilities for film geography research.

Demarcations, differentiation and turn arounds

Lukinbeal and Sommerlad outline key research approaches in film geography (Lukinbeal and Sommerlad, 2022): 1. Film as Text, 2. Cinematic Cartography, 3. Film Industry Geographies and 4. Videography & Documentaries. This work does not use film as analysis method (4.) so no moving pictures were harmed in the process. Film Industry Geographies (3.) were addressed through Instagram data from Production accounts and collaboration with the broadcaster (chapter 5.3, page 227). However, it lacks a comprehensive understanding of the screen product's creation, unlike studies unlike for example Parmett's work on New Orleans (Morgan Parmett, 2019). Cinematic Cartography (2.) methods were limited but used to analyze screen locations from the first ten seasons for narrative importance and appearance in posts, mapping major screen and post locations with GIS. Film as Text (1.) was minimally applied, mainly viewing the BD TV show as an influence on the ST phenomenon,

⁸³at the time led by Prof. Anton Escher

⁸⁴Escher, Zimmermann and Lukinbeal all were once lectures or Professors at the Institute at the University of Mainz.

noting themes of family and the exalted. This research overall incorporates elements from most of these approaches but is not confined to one.

Case study supports theory development The theory chapters 2.2 and 5.2 connect observations about tourism and media, building on Kirby's work (Kirby, 1997). Using deductive reasoning, the study draws conclusions from established theories, verified through case study findings.⁸⁵ To avoid the pitfalls of correlation, causation and convergence in deductive reasoning, case study findings verify the continuation of the tourism-media nexus in a postmodern context. This approach differentiates this work from others like Escher, Riempp and Wüst (2008) or Kim (2010), situating the case study within the broader historical (page 17ff) and postmodern (page 178ff) contexts of media-tourism relationships.

Technology driven data acquisition The researcher employs the latest digital analytics tools and platforms, leveraging media data expertise for data collection. Using social media photos to gain insights about photographers and quantitative interaction data, which provides meta-information that captures life snapshots (page 73). This tech-driven method allows for comprehensive data acquisition, processing and analysis, distinguishing it from traditional data collection methods in ST research.

Not one but many boxes This work integrates approaches from film geography, cinema science, mass media, cultural geography and data science. It aligns with Lukinbeal and Sommerlad's view of film geography as a multi-layered field: "[...] consider film geographic perspectives [...] not as separate approaches, but rather as interrelating spheres that can be creatively combined (Lukinbeal and Sommerlad, 2022, p. 6)". The study examines the BD show's influence on everyday cultures via social media, yielding tangible outcomes applicable beyond academia.

⁸⁵For example, Kirby connected trains and silent cinema; today, planes and cars succeed trains and screens continue cinema projections, suggesting their connection.

Chapter 3

Method and data for the content analysis

Tourism research is interdisciplinary, blending fields like geography, sociology and marketing, to study mass tourism holistically. This creates a transdisciplinary field, although a marketing and business research approach is most common in tourism research. ST introduces now film geography, mass media studies and media economics to the growing mix of disciplines. ST research has to already deal with these different disciplines and approaches because this cultural practice in itself traverses different dispositives, is interconnected with other parts of life and moves between fiction and reality. In this work the chosen methods, the different research questions and the embedding of the results of the case study observations in the development of travel and media should allow for an overarching and integrative perspective. (cf. Steinecke, 2010, p. 23 + 24)

Connecting knowledge like a wiki page This thesis should be structured like a Wikipedia page, using hyperlinks to connect knowledge. Since the Internet and social media are networks of pages and people, this work will integrate URLs to the internet, references to other chapters, figures to images, text to relevant footnotes, citations to the sources and tables to the data. This approach creates a knowledge system where all findings, theories and methods are interconnected. This web of information enables deeper understanding and broader learning, allowing readers to explore background information, related subjects and detailed explanations if they wish to. Different entry points enable starting for example with the conclusion and backtracking to relevant methods, theories or findings. This document is best read as a PDF on an internet-connected computer. Optionally, a GitHub account can provide a repository with additional information.

Structure of this work ST research has always been concerned with both practical problems and theoretical issues. Normally, researchers tend to separate these two

areas. (cf. Beeton, 2016, p. 243) This thesis also aims to approach the topic with a theoretical foundation and a historical derivation on the one hand, but also to look at the practical results and issues of ST communication with the case study. In the final chapters of this thesis, the two perspectives will be integrated into a current state of ST.

Mantle and core chapters Popular narratives and common phenomena will become visible in the analyzed communication of the three ST agent groups. These descriptive results will be interpreted together with the state of knowledge in the scientific literature and current paradigms in tourism and media research. The thesis has therefore two parts: The mantle part is positioning ST within media and tourism evolution, and the core part is a detailed case study of BD ST communication on Instagram.

3.1 Research Question

Much scientific research in tourism focuses on the human in the equation, the tourist, and how he or she influences places. As the tourist is still the link between the everyday and the holiday, the home and the destination, the real and the narrative, transport techniques and travel spaces, the research question of this thesis asks for the role of the screen and the media. This work will focus on the place that is remade by the screen product, its consumption and reproduction. Rather than individual sites, buildings and designs, the research questions focus on the configuration of space at the WK and the impact of the mediated Instagram tourist gaze 3.0. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 119)

3.1.1 RQ 1: What is the Connection, Differences and Similarities between the Involved Agents in their Communication of Screen Tourism over the Social Networks?

Research question one is the overarching question answered in chapter 4.4 on page 145. The individual groups of agents have each their own sub RQ 1.1 to 1.3. This research question is about all of them and their similarities and differences. Some small hints to research question 1 are already given in the answers to research question 1.1 to 1.3. If a clear difference or similarity could be found between at least two groups of agents in the corpus, it was included in this chapter. It aims to show connections and patterns that are stronger than the single group and point us towards broad conclusions about ST. This is why It can work as a summary of the findings

in chapters 1.1 to 1.3 and could be a discussion chapter in its own right. The first research question covers all data sources, from the quantitative Instagram data to the qualitative trace interviews, as well as the geolocation and post description analysis. The question is primarily concerned with ST communication on Instagram.

RQ 1.1: How and why are Tourists Communicating their Screen Tourism over the Social Networks?

This research question deals with the tourist who becomes a WK ST induced through the consumption of the BD screen product. It is answered in chapter 4.1 on page 98. The how is answered with the amount of quantitative data from social networks: Social media metrics, description text and geolocation of the photo. The why is answered with the qualitative trace interviews with some of the ST accounts behind specific posts in the corpus. For this work, this is probably the most interesting group, which translates into a lot of lines in the final document.

RQ 1.2: How and why is the Destination Marketing Communicating their Screen Tourism over the Social Networks?

This research question deals with the Destination agents in the WK, which are the most difficult to define¹. This question is answered in chapter 4.2 on page 116. Here the distinction between ST communication and regular tourism content is more difficult than for the other groups and could be controversial. The destination is often analyzed together with the ST in film tourism research, but these questions are still relevant because they remain the main protagonists of the ST sector. With the additional participants of various tourism beneficiaries such as restaurants, hotels or a ski shop, research question 1.2 opens up to more than the usual Destination subjects such as DMOs or other political or governmental organizations supporting tourism. The how and why are answered similarly to research question 1.1.

RQ 1.3: How and why is the Production Crew Communicating their Screen Tourism over the Social Networks?

This research question looks at the ST communication of the accounts directly or indirectly involved in the Production of the BD at the WK. It is answered in chapter 4.3 on page 132. The how and why are answered similarly to research question 1.1. The Production is an agent that is not considered in most ST research. Research question 1.3 attempts to shed light on it, to show its role in the medialisation processes of this phenomenon and of ST as a whole. As the agent groups in research questions 1.1 and 1.2 have a more established base in the academic literature, the

¹Which is explained in detail on page 13

outcome of these research questions seems more predictable than that of 1.3. The group of Production accounts becomes a wild card.

3.1.2 RQ 2: What is the association from the Bergdoktor Case Study to the current development of tourism and media and its future?

This research question is answered in chapter 5.2 starting at page 178 as part of the solution. As explained in page 67, this research question is part of the mantle. As chapter 2.2 tries to show the development up to the appearance of ST, the discussion in chapter 5.2 tries to continue this path until current developments in tourism, media and society overall. Research Question 2 now attempts to link the findings of Research Questions 1 to 1.3 to the mantle part. The research question looks at the ST communication of the three groups of agents and tries to link this to the coevolution of media and tourism. The research question will mainly cover postmodern developments, 21st century theories and the tangible findings of the BD case study. Therefore, the discussion chapter will consist of a discussion of the case study findings additionally to how these findings are embedded in current developments.

3.1.3 RQ 3: What is the Benefit of Screen Tourism and the Communication in Social Networks for the Production?

This question tries to find benefits for production in the results of research questions 1 and 2. It will be answered in one of the last chapters as part of the discussion in chapter 5.3 on page 227. The question has been included in this work because the broadcaster of the BD, ZDF, is supporting this scientific case study. The answers are mostly tailored to the orientation and regulations of a public-private broadcaster, but if crucial benefits for commercial actors were identified, they would not be discarded, but would also be included in this chapter. For the purposes of this question, the broadcaster is seen as a spatial medium that is assumed to have an influence on many details of the ST process. The benefits identified may be purely theoretical and will not have the opportunity to be tested in real life. They are nevertheless included because they may offer an opportunity to change the way production and broadcasting companies view their influence on geospatial developments. This will be the smallest and most independent section on a research question in this thesis.

3.2 Method of Data retrieval

From big data to thick data

Thick data merges qualitative and quantitative research to address their limitations—quantitative data lacks insight into motivations, while qualitative data struggles with broad applicability. This approach combines statistical trends with detailed human experiences, offering rich, contextual insights that go beyond aggregated numerical data. Thick data, as pioneer Tricia Wang explains is "precious data from humans that cannot be quantified (Tricia Wang, 2016, 00:11:40)". (cf. Latzko-Toth et al., 2016; Jemielniak, 2020, p. 41 - 47, 86 - 92)

Enrich the data with trace interviews To enrich quantitative Instagram data, trace interviews are used. These follow up with users to understand their motivations and behaviors, creating a meta-discourse that evaluates digital ST communication. Different posts were identified and the accounts and people behind them responded to a survey about their digital traces in the case study corpus. (cf. Sloan and Quan-Haase, 2016, p. 203 - 237) The qualitative questions in the trace interview are largely open-ended. This not only increases the complexity of the answer, but also captures many boundary conditions that one would not otherwise have recognized as a researcher. The questions are in German and can be found in the appendix of this paper and as code for SoSciSurvey in the Git Hub repository. Trace interviews offer deeper insights into the context and reasons behind Instagram posts, revealing the emotions and experiences behind user behavior. For example, the trace interview could explain why users decide to post a particular photo or message. By combining instagram data analysis with qualitative trace interviews, I can gain a more complete picture of the social and cultural factors that shape involved agents behavior in relation to the phenomenon of ST.

Using a saved search boolean filter

The Crowd Tangle analytics and dashboarding tool was used to identify ST communication. This used a feature called *Saved Search* to filter out ST communication about the BD from millions of potential posts. Here is a list of keywords used:

- **Series:** Bergdokter, derbergdokter, der Bergdokter, zdfbergdokter, ZDF Bergdokter, orf Bergdokter
- **Roles:** Martin Gruber, martingruber, drmartingruber, Hans Gruber, Lilli Gruber, lilligruber, Elisabeth Gruber, elisabethgruber, Susanne Dreiseitl, Roman Melchinger, Alexander Kahnweiler, drkahnweiler, Linn Kemper, Franziska Hochstetter

- **Actors:** Rebecca Imanuel, rebeccaيمانuel, Andrea Gerhard, Simone Hanselmann, Mark Keller, markkeller, Monika Baumgartner, monikabaumgartner, Natalie O'Hara, natalieohara, Ronja Forcher, ronjaforcher, Heiko Ruprecht, heikoruprecht, Hans Sigl, hanssigl
- **Screen locations:** gruberhof, bergdoktordorf
- **Spaces:** Wilder Kaiser, wilderkaiser, Skiweltwilderkaiser, Brixental, Ellmau, ellmauer, Söll, Koasamandl, hintersteinersee, Österreich, austria, Alpen, rübezahlm, going (-going to), tirol, hexenwasser
- **Destination marketing:** visitaustria, visit austria, inechtnochschöner, in echt noch schöner, lovewilderkaiser, lovetirol, visittirol
- **Miscellaneous:** tourismus, film tourismus, bergdokterfantage, fantage

The posts on Instagram were searched for these keywords using a Boolean search. This stored search looked for tourism keywords from the WK linked with an AND variable to keywords from the fictional TV show of the BD. So every post found should have at least one tourism keyword and one from the BD. As the word of the small town *Going* in the WK is too close to the English word *Going to sth.*, it was excluded by a negative search.

Keyword Group	Word Count
Spaces	345
Series	262
Actors	37
Screen Locations	34
Roles	25
DMO	-
MISC	-

Table 3.1: Groups of Saved Search Keywords used in Crowd Tangle

Keyword bias in the data Due to the nature of identifying posts by keywords, these keywords are likely to be more prevalent in an analysis of the words and hashtags used in the posts (table 3.1). Words about spaces (345) and the BD series (262) dominate the keyword list. 703 keywords were found in the corpus posts by the Quanteda analysis². As Crowd Tangle does not represent all posts on Instagram, the extracted data could potentially be skewed towards accounts with more followers, as they are more likely to be included in the Crowd Tangle database in the first place.

Expected post performance or the Crowd-Tangle-Score Crowd Tangle calculates an expected number of interactions by looking at the last 100 posts of a certain type

²The Quanteda text analysis is done without the hashtags, so something like #wilderkaiser or #bergdoktor is not included. This makes the sum of the description analysis smaller than the actual keywords found with the Saved Search boolean filter on Crowd Tangle. This is also why the total number of documents is only 567 and the actual number of analyzed posts is 1,432.

(in our case photo posts) with the same post age. The top and bottom 25 percentiles are dropped and a mean is calculated from the middle 50 percent of posts. The actual number of interactions of each post is divided by the expected number to get the (performance) score. In other words, the score shows whether the post is performing better than the other posts on the account? (cf. crowdtangle.com, 2024, p. 1; crowdtangle.com, 2023, p. 1)

Using scraper technology for additional data

This study used *web scraping* alongside official Instagram data from Crowd Tangle, employing the tool Instaloader³ for large-scale social media analysis. Instaloader automates data collection from Instagram, extracting data like geotags and photos not available through Crowd Tangle.

The content analysis as overarching method

Content analysis allows a quantitative, objective examination of communication content and helps to identify themes in ST. It's a non-reactive method, meaning the corpus posts remain unchanged regardless of the frequency of analysis, and can analyze past communication systematically and transparently. (cf. Merten, 1983, p. 59ff) This method was applied to corpus posts from Instagram and 10 seasons of a BD TV show, examining text, photos, hashtags, mentions and screen locations in the show. All identified ST communication posts and the episodes of the BD tv show are public and reviewable⁴. The content analysis focuses on the kind of content published and user interaction with that content. The trace interviews that follow only add personal insights from the creators.

Focus on the photo and Instagram The tourist was since its emergence at the mid of the 19th century driven by images but also increasingly producing new photos on their journeys. Economic growth in the late 20th century, affordable reflex cameras, and the digital revolution popularized photography worldwide, turning us into image prosumers, with smartphones playing a key role. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 20; Eberle, 2017, pp. 11 - 13 + 17 - 21) Photos reveal more about the photographer, and to some extent the viewer, than about the subject. They reflect the photographer's dreams, perceptions and, as Groebner philosophically writes, "That's the way it will have been" (Translated by deep1.com; Groebner, 2020, p. 65). In the sharable environments of social networks, photos shed light on the viewer when interacting. Photography follows the logic of a message. A message that is amplified when uploaded to social media. (cf. Ibid., pp. 65-76) Uploading makes the photo available for every-

³More information on the Git-Hub page of the Instaloader developers.

⁴If not deleted by the owner.

one to see, even for research. Photos are key in this study, and Instagram was chosen because of its prevalence and focus on photographic aesthetics. These snapshots of life can be used to capture social reality, which is procedural and ephemeral, and the sociological community has always had the problem of its methodological fixation. (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 11 - 21) The Instagram posts provide a unique perspective on ST and offer methodological advantages that were previously unavailable.

The text is giving context In postmodernism, where context and form are increasingly important, the descriptive text of social media posts complements the photos. As photos show us reality, language tells us about reality.⁵ Language plays a crucial role in comprehend everyday reality because only the words we know can explain it to ourselves and others.⁶ Social media highlights the synergy between visual and textual content in shaping users' perspectives and contains overlooked knowledge that can also be used by researchers. Images become more powerful when words are insufficient to convey complex scenarios or emotions, and this is the strength of visual media in general. (cf. Ibid., p. 50; Berger et al., 2018, p. 39; Senouci, 2019, p. 2; Haase and Martin, 2008) Instagram, chosen for its mix of imagery and narrative, was analyzed using Quanteda to explore these dynamics.

Using text plus images for analysis While images and videos are key in social media, text remains essential for communication, often in conjunction with visual content. Analyzing both linguistic and non-linguistic content together enhances sociological insights. (cf. Q188.5SM247) However, the evaluation of images on social networks is challenging due to the sheer volume and the resulting problems in selecting a representative sample. (cf. Sloan and Quan-Haase, 2016, p. 247; Öz, 2015, p. 1011) Textual content, which is more accessible to various research methods such as R and ChatGPT or even simple text searches, compensates for the difficulties in analyzing images.

Median vs. average Why did I choose the median rather than the average to represent the mean? In the English language, there are different terms to describe the middle number in a set of numbers: The mena can be either average or median and also modus but this last option does not matter for this work. In this study, we differentiate between "mean" as a general term and specific calculations like "average" and "median," which are mathematically distinct methods⁷ for determining the mean. We primarily use the median for calculations due to its robustness against outliers.

⁵A similar connection and relationship that quantitative and qualitative data have: While photos show *how*, texts explain *why*.

⁶What George Orwell once called *Newspeak* in 1984 is now a subliminal tactic of politicians and capitalists. Language shapes our perception of reality, a concept explored in the work of Martin Haase.

⁷An explanation of the differences can be found here: [vocabulary.com/articles/chooseyourwords/mean-median-average](https://www.vocabulary.com/articles/chooseyourwords/mean-median-average)

The median provides a more accurate representation of typical data, avoiding the skew caused by unusually viral⁸ social media posts. While the average could be influenced by these outliers, the median remains stable, offering clearer insights regular post interaction.⁹ In certain situations, other methods are used if more appropriate, with each choice clearly marked.

Quanteda textual analysis The content analysis of the text data in the description of each Instagram post was mainly done with the R package Quanteda, which works with tokens, corpus's, dictionaries and similar tools.¹⁰

Cleaning the data Prior to the analysis, the description texts were cleaned to remove social media features such as hashtags, mentions, emoticons, stop words, URLs, etc.¹¹ The plan was to analyze hashtags and mentions separately, but this was later dropped due to time constraints. Mentions of actors with established social media accounts were filtered out, leaving only textual mentions of people or fictional characters without Instagram accounts. Monika Baumgartner is part of the main cast and remained in the analysis as a distorted artefact because she can only be mentioned in text due to her lack of an Instagram account.

The importance of field research in geography

Visiting the WK was crucial to this research, going beyond the Campus Mainz to understand first-hand the motivations and perspectives of the STs at the screen locations. Fieldwork provided a nuanced view of the WK region, emphasizing the importance of geographical context in research and comprehension. Experiencing the destination in person enhanced the validity and reliability of the data, and contributed qualitative data for richer analysis. Photos taken during visits to the WK helped to identify screen locations and BD-related attractions, such as a BD-themed car park, merchandise shops, or a large banner across the road as one enters the town of Going that reads "Welcome to the Mountain Doctor Village" (translated from `deep1.com`; Figure 3.1).¹² In geographical research, a field trip to the case study provides a unique insight that cannot be achieved with remote research tools such as Google Earth.

⁸The tool crowd tangle even has a metric called Score that can actually measure the virality of a post and is explained on page 72.

⁹As the work will show there is a skew in the data between different subgroups of the corpus agent groups as shown on page 172.

¹⁰More information on the functionality of the R package can be found on their website: <https://quanteda.io>.

¹¹See the script `clean_text_function.R` in the git repos for a complete overview of the detailed cleaning process.

¹²The banner was actually never photographed in the corpus of this case study, a valuable insight only possible with field research.

Stakeholder questions

The trace interviews were divided into three parts, targeting different stakeholders in ST. The focus was on the ST, as they are at the centre of this phenomenon, with fewer questions for the Destination accounts and Production crew. Some questions were common to all groups but tailored to their perspectives, such as favorite screen locations from the ST or the Destination. The questions in the trace interviews were aimed at addressing the research questions from Chapter 3.1. A smaller set of questions sought demographic information to contextualize responses and aid data analysis as a possible independent variable. The questions are detailed in the appendix on page 279.

The timetable of data acquisition

The PhD project started in June 2019, with the corona crisis affecting tourism and research capacity. This provided a unique perspective on ST at the WK. Initial Instagram data collection began in September 2019, with monthly updates until July 2021. Additional data was downloaded from the scraper from September 2021 for Destinations and Production, and from February 2023 for ST. Posts that were deleted between the initial collection and the addition of the scraper were removed from the sample. Trace interviews were conducted from November 2021 to July 2022, starting with Destination accounts, followed by ST, and finally Production, who were expected to be the most difficult group to engage¹³. Additional qualitative geolocation data was collected from July to September 2022.

Geolocating the corpus photos

In this study, original Instagram geotags were not used. Instead, the photo spaces were redefined, distinguishing between the photographer's and the subject's or mo-

¹³which was absolutely true, as only one actor responded and the production company did not make much effort to disseminate the survey within the Production staff.



Figure 3.1: A banner over the road welcoming visitors to the BD town of Going at the WK, designed by the DMO. (Source: Own Photo).

tive position. This data was gathered through SoSciSurvey interviews completed by the WK DMO, Mountain Doctor fan club leaders, and myself. Incorrect geolocations were identified and excluded, leaving 474 photos with correct dual coordinates. Vector calculations in an R script¹⁴ then generated a viewpoint triangle for each photo (figure 7.1).

Operationalising the BD locations

I also analyzed the first 10 seasons of the BD show and associated winter special, recording locations in an Excel table. Added locations in over more than years of the show were noted by their season of appearance. To detail usage, frequently used locations were later divided into categories, such as inside vs. outside sets or various hospital sub locations. This leading to discrepancies in total location counts, however, these distinctions weren't compared or used together in analysis, avoiding potential issues.

Narrowing down the dataset

The focus on the BD series and the WK region was chosen to create a manageable case study, limiting data and variables. Instagram was chosen because of its visual nature (explained earlier) and significant user base (Statista, 2023a, p. 1). Also, the amount of travel-motivated and inspirational content on Instagram¹⁵ makes it ideal for analyzing travel content. In this study, only Instagram photos, specifically the first photo if it is an album-post, were considered for trace interviews. The data was narrowed down to ST posts from three groups: STs, Destinations and Production. Local accounts and numerous fan pages were excluded. Trace interview questions and SoSciSurvey metrics further refined the data into a validated sample.

¹⁴The precise vector calculations and the coded steps can be found in the R-Scripts in the Git repository under the file name `vector_functions.R`, with detailed mathematical procedures in the appendix on page 302

¹⁵as 2.4 in Chapter 2.2 shows.

3.3 Mode and modality of the acquired data

3.3.1 Mode

The mode of the data

The origin of the data The source of the data is the social network Instagram. Only photo posts were allowed for this study. All quantitative data and photos come from the network. The TV show itself was another major source of data providing information on the screen locations used on the BD. The last major source of data is the respondents themselves from the trace interview about their individual post. Smaller sources were screen plays of the BD, additional data from the media bi department of ZDF and the BD production company Neue Deutsche Film (NDF).

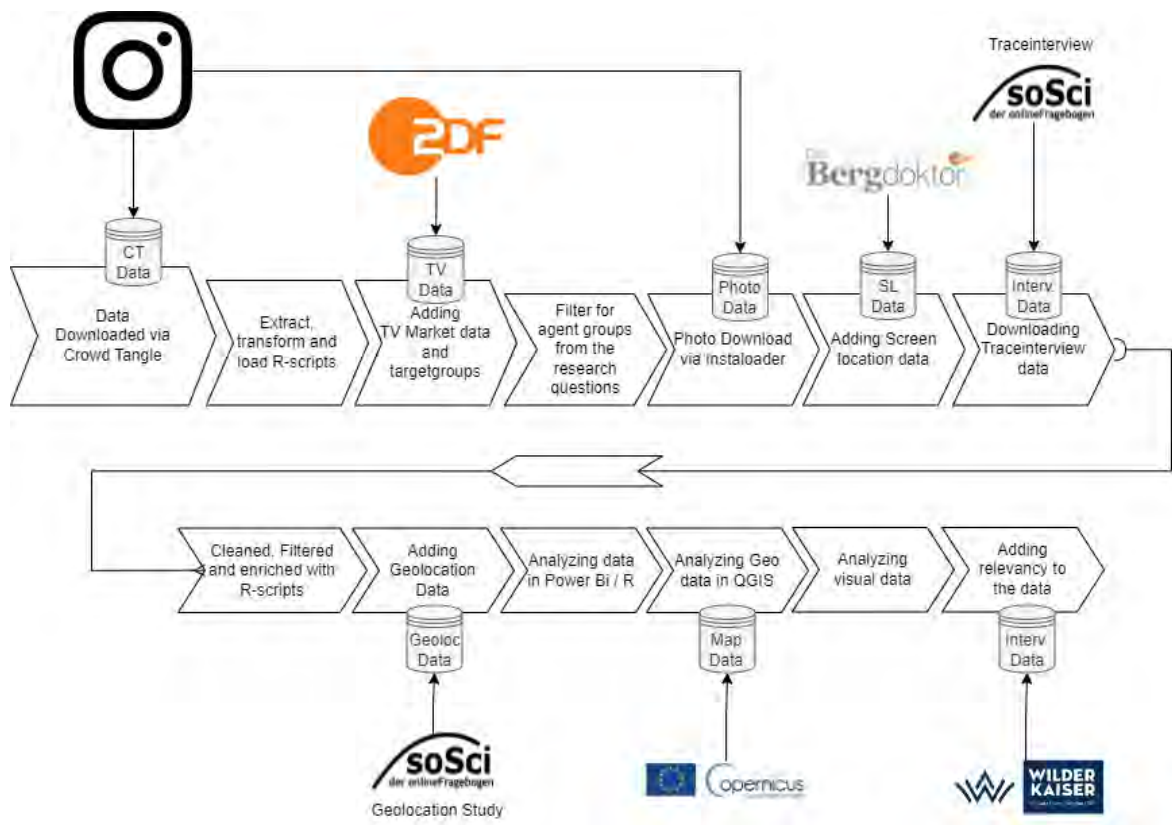


Figure 3.2: The data funnel from downloading over thickening to analyzing (source: own graphic).

The data funnel Access to the data was provided by ZDF Digital and its Crowd Tangle account. With a saved search, the tool already filtered for ST communication. This data was downloaded and saved to local storage. Several R scripts were used to extract, transform and load the data after it was acquired. The data was then cleaned and filtered for good quality responses. At this point, the data was already enriched with qualitative metadata about which group the account belonged to: AT,

Destination, Production or something else. This was necessary because only posts from these groups were retained, and accounts from local residents or particularly dedicated BD fan accounts were filtered. The filtered CT data by group was the input for the next two steps. First, it was fed into the Instagram scraper. For each identified ST post, it scraped a JSON file with additional geodata and the photo(s) associated with the post. Secondly, the filtered data was used for the SoSciSurvey interviews. But if an account had multiple posts, these were randomly filtered down to just one to be used as the subject of the trace interview. SoSciSurvey as an online questionnaire tool was the perfect way to ask people about their posting behavior. In a secondary study via SoSciSurvey, the photos from the posts were localized by people who knew the Wk destination: People working at the DMO and members of the official BD fan club helped to locate the photos on a map of the WK. Both the trace interview and the geolocation study were downloaded to local storage after the survey periods had ended. Some of the trace interview questions acted as filters on the Instagram data to ensure data quality. Additional data was generated by operationalising the screen locations seen in seasons 1 to 10 of the BD. This qualitative data was merged with the geolocation and trace interview data, as well as the quantitative data from Instagram, in multiple R scripts. The quantitative data from Instagram was enriched with the interview data and is now in a state of *thick data*. Finally, the data was analyzed in R, specifically Quanteda and ggplot, and visualized in Power BI. The R scripts used vector maths to evaluate the viewpoint triangle between the photographer's and position the subject or motive point. An overview of the data funnel and the sources is visible in figure 3.2.

The data wrangling process The data wrangling is done entirely within the R statistical language, the R-Studio IDE and its packages (mostly dplyr). A list of the packages used for this work:

- General: tidyverse, dplyr, tibble, stringr, tidyr
- Utilities: httr, jsonlite, rjson, reshape, openxlsx, stringi, lubridate, utils, textclean, janitor
- Statistical analysis: tidycomm, quanteda, quanteda.textplots
- Vector calculations: pracma
- Plotting: ggplot2, plotly

The code documentation can be found on the Git Hub¹⁶. Only minor adaptations were made for data visualization purposes later in the Power Bi dashboarding tool.

¹⁶The link to the Git Hub repository containing the code, chapters, documentation and more: git.zdf-digital.com/boecher.d/bergdoktorarbeit

Software and tools used

The Instagram post data was accessed through Meta's own analytics tool, Crowd Tangle, using a boolean saved search. Additional data was scraped directly from Instagram using the tool *instaloader*¹⁷. The trace interviews and the additional request for location data were conducted using the online tool SoSciSurvey.¹⁸ The visualizations are mainly done with the Microsoft dashboarding tool Power Bi. Additional visualizations are done in R and R-Studio using the packages *ggplot2* and *plotly*. The text, visualizations and images for the final pages were written and compiled in LaTeX within Visual Studio Code. Microsoft Excel was used as the input tool for the screen location data from the BD series. *Deep1.com* was used for the translation of german quotes and answers from the trace interviews. For the proofreading of the work (abbreviations, error correction, consistency and formatting), *deepl.write* and Karen X Chengs custom Chatgpt Be Concise were used to avoid paid lectorship.

The quality of the geodata

Challenges when working with Instagram geotags Usually people geotag a place like a town or more specifically a tourist attraction like the Gruberhof. It is also possible to geotag whole regions like the WK or states like Tyrol and even countries like Austria. Where these higher level geotags are placed can sometimes feel random as the tagged place of the photo is often far from the actual geographical location of the photo. Where should a geotag of Austria be placed anyway? One of many answers to this question can be found in figure 3.3.

The location quality of some of these geotags can also be questioned: A geotag named "Ellmau, Salzburg, Austria" (post id: CHsnVRxhXfk) links to a location over 74 kilometers from Ellmau in the WK and 52 kilometers from Salzburg, inaccurately placing it near Sankt Johann im Pongau. Putting a town and a city together that are 78 kilometers apart does not make sense as well as placing the attached geotag in a third place. Similarly, a geotag for "Eifel" (post id: CP-GAl4F1_4) in Albania is misplaced, as it refers to a region in Germany, not Albania. The reasons for these geotag discrepancies are unclear. The proportion of totally displaced geotags does not seem overwhelming¹⁹, but the precision can not be guaranteed. Geotags like "Going, Tirol, Austria" and "Going am Wilden Kaiser" refer to the same place but appear in separate locations on the map, a common issue with popular places due to vari-

¹⁷Documentation on the third party tool can be found on Git Hub: github.com/instaloader/instaloader

¹⁸The code is also available on the Git Hub repository. The XML files can be used to recreate the trace interview within SoSci Survey. You can also find the XML files for the additional surveys for the photo positions.

¹⁹but of course not all geotags can be checked

ous accounts creating differently located geotags. The geotag "Ellmau/Going" tries to merge two WK towns into one (just like the first example in this paragraph). This illustrates how virtual and actual geography can diverge, with social media geotags not accurately reflecting real-world places.



Figure 3.3: A post from @andreagerhard_tall_area from the WK destination with the geotag "Austria" (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id Bza11ZfIX8l).

and photographer positions. A depth not achievable with Instagram's single geotags, enriching the study with qualitative data and steering it towards thick data.

3.3.2 Modality

The data in numbers

This research compiled 3.29 GB of raw data across 8,312 files. The quantitative data has 4,801 posts from Instagram, covering a timespan from January 2017 to June 2021. I analyzed the first 10 seasons and 96 episodes from the BD tv show. Post-filtering, 3,376 photos from Instagram were identified, many within albums and not all detailedly analyzed. SoSciSurvey facilitated 59 interviews with STs, Destination representatives, and Production members. Only one Production interview was usable at the end unfortunately. Additionally, over 225 photos were enriched with qualitative geolocation data for both motive and photographer positions. The cleaned dataset was reduced to approximately 26 MB²⁰ in 25 files, with 28 trace interviews selected for in-depth study. Analysis of over 6,200 words from Instagram descriptions resulted in a word cloud visualizing the top 100 words (figure 3.4).

²⁰The photos are not included because they alone account for 1.54 GB.

Discarding the geotag data Challenges with geotag accuracy led to excluding them from the case study analysis. Despite potential insights from geotag discrepancies, these were set aside for possible future research. Instagram's geotag data, easy to collect and suited for large-scale studies, was not utilized. Instead, with assistance from DMO and fan club members, 474 photos were analyzed, assigning two geolocations each. This approach allowed differentiation between subject/motive

rescue theme.²² Fans often follow both shows²³, highlighting a preference for soap-like mountain-set series. (cf. ZDF.de, 2024, p. 1) Apart from German TV series, "Babylon Berlin" (Handloegten et al., 2022) and "Grey's Anatomy" (Shonda Rhimes, 05) were notable exceptions, indicating some interest in high-quality and US productions. Overall, this suggests that BD fans value public television and stories about family and relationships set in the Alps, reflecting a wider appeal for such themes.

Demography of the screen tourists The

median year of birth of the respondents was 1976²⁴ with a range of 36 years between the youngest and the oldest (table 7.26). The Destination also estimated the STs in a range of 16 to 80 years making them an average of around 48 years old (table 7.45). This matches the reported number of the actual ST in the corpus and can now be assumed for the entire demographic of BD STs at the WK. This age puts BD ST on the edge of the boomer generation. STs come from all over Germany, but most of the small se-



Figure 3.5: The aesthetic of the tv show "Die Berggretter" (ZDF.de, 2024) is similar to BD up to the naming of the two shows (Source: ZDF screenshot from Episode "verprannte Erde (1)").

lection come from western and southern Germany, which is closest to the WK and Austria.²⁵ Only three ST out of 15 live in big cities, most in small towns, rural communities and one even responded in a single building without connection to a settlement (table 7.28). The BD ST mostly live like what they see on the screen and later find at the destination of the WK. Only four out of 15 ST have a university degree, and most of them have received vocational training on the job (table 7.27). Interestingly, the most common job sector is "Advertising, marketing, commercial and editorial media professions (translated by deep1.com)", which shows that a few people in the media sector also enjoy ST and communicate about it on social media. The other professions are divers, from medicine to hairdressing to tourism²⁶, as well as textile and

²²The similarities do not end there: "Die Berggretter" (ZDF.de, 2024) can be seen as a kind of companion show to BD. It is scheduled to be shown on ZDF in the same time slot as BD. The two TV shows have the same duration of more than 15 seasons and have a similar naming convention, with one being called "Die Berggretter" and the other "Der Bergdoktor".

²³The fandom recognizes this by creating Instagram fan accounts that incorporate both TV shows, such as @bergdoktor_bergretter_fangirl

²⁴which would make them about 46 years old at the time of the interviews in 2022.

²⁵The answers of the STs are not visualized in a table (in section 7.3.2) because its sensible personal data and can be just presented on an aggregated level.

²⁶also people who work for tourism are tourists themselves and probably hate tourists in their

leather professions. 13 out of 15 are married or in a relationship (table 7.29).

The connection to the Bergdoktor tv show ST respondents typically watched nine seasons of BD (table 7.4), with over 55 percent identifying as super fans. When asked about their fan status, most rated themselves as "definite fans" (table 7.6). Despite this enthusiasm, about half acknowledged being part of the fandom, while the rest did not (table 7.7)! This is suggesting that many travel with partners or friends who might not share the same level of fandom.²⁷ Destination respondents have watched at least one BD episode, but STs are more engaged, with 50 percent viewing over 50 episodes.

Instagram usage ST and Production were asked how much time they spend on Instagram on an average day: 17 out of 21 people use Instagram for an hour or more a day. During this hour, they are most interested in the topics "Traveling and destination" and "Friends and family" (table 7.9). Stars and starlets" is the least popular topic among the STs of the WK and the actors of the BD are definitely among them on Instagram.

everyday life at work and on holiday :-)

²⁷But even when some said they were not fans and not part of the fandom (like in this example on page 109), they still posted about the ST experience at the WK on social media for everyone to see. This discrepancy highlights that even non-fans recognize the social value of the show.

3.4 Case study: Bergdoktor basics

The content of the Bergdoktor

The genre of the Bergdoktor "Der Bergdoktor" (engl. Mountain Doctor, ZDF, 2024) is a German television series as part of the public private broadcaster ZDF. A new season with eight episodes and around 90 minutes of runtime airs every year from December to April on the channels of the ZDF (Germany) and ORF (Austria). It falls primarily into the drama genre and typically combines elements of medical drama and family drama, focusing on the life and work of a doctor in a picturesque Alpine town of Ellmau at the WK in Austria. The show explores complex relationships, ethical medical dilemmas and rural medical practice challenges. It can be also considered a prime-time soap due to its ongoing episodic nature, focus on personal relationships and dramatic plots. The picturesque setting and the medical context add unique elements to the typical soap opera formula, but the core focus on drama and character development aligns well with the primetime soap genre.

The mountain doctor is coming home The BD coming home is the central theme of the BD series' pilot in 2008. Dr. Martin Gruber, a successful surgeon with a global career, returns unannounced to his rural childhood home from New York, marking a pivotal change in his life. (cf. Schulze, 2010, p. 1; translated by deep1.com)²⁸ This dilemma of choosing between his rural roots and a prestigious urban career recurs throughout the early seasons, reflecting the character's ongoing internal conflict.

The Bergdoktor show as continuation of the Heimatfilm The BD series explores themes of *homecoming, family, love, rural community, farm life, and nature*, resonating with the Heimatfilm genre that became popular in post-WWII Germany. Initially, these films provided an escape from wartime atrocities, evolving over the years into modern TV series, albeit sometimes seen as quaint. (cf. Höfig, 1973) BD reflects this evolution, incorporating horizontal storytelling²⁹ into traditional Heimat themes. The storytelling changed but the themes stayed the same and these are still fitting well with the enduring allure of the Alps.

Wilder Kaiser landscape as metaphore Like Lukinbeal explained in his article "Cinematic Landscapes" that when landscapes become metaphors "they exceed the bounds of the image (Lukinbeal, 2005, p. 13)". The landscape is naturalized in the BD TV show, "where a narrative seeks to pass off that which is cultural as natural (Lukin-

²⁸The excerpt of the episode from the BD fan club.

²⁹Horizontal storytelling is a narrative technique in TV productions where the plot unfolds over several episodes or seasons, allowing for detailed plots and character development. This contrasts with vertical storytelling, where each episode is a standalone story. This approach is beneficial for creating complex, engaging narratives and can also be applied to branding and online marketing efforts, including those by the ZDF. (cf. Ferrari, 2021)

beal, 2005, p. 13)". The landscape of the alps is shown (figure 3.6 (f)) as exalted and lovely (page 2.2.1) sitting above the problems of the human tensions in the BD drama narrative. They are shown as majestic mountains but with these metaphors attached to them they exceed what they are and become signifiers in the TV show, the ST communication on Instagram as well as in the WK destination.



Figure 3.6: Screen location (a) Gruberhof, (b) BD practice, (c) WK guesthouse, (d) Hintersteiner lake and not a location but the recurring theme as transition shots (e) car on street and (f) mountain panorama .

Source: ZDF/Mediathek screenshots from the episodes (a) "Heimweh", (b) "Zwei Väter (1)", (c) "Der schlimmste Schmerz (1)", (d) "Dunkle Wolken" and (e and f) "Zwischen den Stühlen"

Movement in cuts in the bergdoktor series

The BD series creatively addresses the potential disconnect in space and time between scenes. Transition shots showcasing the Alpine landscape, including time-lapse views of mountain panoramas or sunsets, offering viewers a sense of complete geography. Additionally, scenes with the protagonist driving or using a mobile phone to call other places serve to connect different times and places, help maintain geographical continuity. While cuts still exist, these techniques effectively represent journeys or time passage, enhancing the narrative's cohesion.

The BD on the streets of the WK The BD series features 150 scenes with cars, making it a significant recurring location (table 3.2). Often with the protagonist, Dr. Gruber, driving and frequently involving phone conversations on a speakerphone to various stationary characters. While the BD moves between locations in his car,

other characters typically remain stationary.³⁰ These transition scenes vary in location but always feature the same old green Mercedes (figure 5.5 (b)), affectionately nicknamed *Ranzbimmel*³¹ and is famous amongst fans and the actor Hans Sigl (figure 3.7). These car scenes serve as transitional elements, bridging different screen locations and contributing to the narrative flow.

The outside tv show

In the BD series, outdoor shots dominate the most locations like Gruberhof and the WK guesthouse, with quantifiable more exterior than interior scenes (table 3.2). The exception is the BDs practice, where interior scenes prevail due to the nature of medical examinations. However, even typically indoor locations include exterior shots, as evidenced by 97 exterior scenes in the BD practice. The (mountain) panorama contributes to the outdoor setting with



Figure 3.7: The thumbnail of the BD tv show on the VOD-platform of the ZDF shows the importance of the car as a prop (Source: ZDF Mediathek).

over 900 scenes across 10 seasons. These various panoramas are used as transition shots between themes, making them a very common recurring visual theme. In total, there are 1,401 exterior to 365 interior scenes, highlighting the series' preference for outdoor environments at a ratio of 5:1 (figure 3.6).

The locations of the BD

The narrative importance of BD locations If I had to rank the locations after watching ten seasons in order of importance for the fictional story of BD, then I would choose 1. the Gruberhof (near Söll), 2. the BD practice (in Ellmau) and 3. the town square (of Going) with the locations of the WK Guesthouse, the church and the pharmacy. The ranking is qualitative and consists of subjective but careful considerations of the scientists about the narrative plots and the stories told at these locations. The official BD fan club had a slightly different top list (Bergdoktor Fanclub, 2023, p. 1):

1. BD Practice
2. Gruberhof

³⁰See page 88 for more details on other characters and their connection and relation to various screen locations.

³¹More information about the car in the tv magazin article "The Mountain Doctor: What Dr. Gruber's car means to Hans Sigl".

3. Town square Going

- Church
- WK Guesthouse
- Pharmacy

4. Hospital

5. In the car (Mercedes)

6. Hintersteiner Lake

7. Lillis School

8. Train station

The hospital's prominence in the BD series, ranking fourth among locations, is justified by its narrative significance. However, this doesn't translate to it being a frequently visited screen location. Unlike other locations, the hospital's narrative importance and its mention in posts vary, possibly due to its real-world geography. Filmed outside the WK region (map 3.10), the hospital's location contrasts with the alpine setting of other locations. While the series uses a real hospital within the WK for some scenes, the main hospital setting is external, and the intensive care unit scenes are shot on a set (See page 92), further disconnecting it from the WK valley's immersive environment. These geographical and narrative distinctions might explain why its on-screen prominence doesn't lead to increased visitor interest. The scenes in the car have a similar effect, because they cannot be summarized in a coherent place that can be visited at the WK. This is why it is not comparable, because the narrative meaning cannot be focused on a single screen location in the way that the Gruberhof, for example, can.

Characters for locations The BD is the most mobile character in the show, frequently seen in changing locations and driving (table 3.2) In contrast, other characters are often anchored to specific locations, resembling part of the interior design. For example:

- Susanne Dreiseitl is usually at the WK Guesthouse.
- Dr. Roman Melchinger is found in his former, now the BD's, practice.
- Elisabeth Gruber, the BD's mother, is the heart of the Gruberhof.

These characters are portrayed as almost *living* at these locations, while others, like hospital doctors Dr. Vera Fendrich, Dr. Alexander Kahnweiler, medical assistant Linn Kemper or pharmacist Franziska Hochstetter, are almost shown exclusively at their workplaces. They are depicted in their personal or professional spaces within the WK, seldom seen elsewhere, emphasizing their roles within these fixed settings.

Screen location	Inside or outside	Scene count
Gruberhof	Both	565
Gruberhof	Outside*	133
Gruberhof	Inside*	129
Gruberhof Eating Table	Outside*	83
BD Practice	Both	457
BD Practice	Outside*	97
BD Practice	Inside*	140
Church	Both	27
WK guesthouse	Both	239
WK guesthouse	Outside*	77
WK guesthouse	Inside*	37
Hospital	Mostly Inside	616
Hospital Forum	Inside*	59
Hospital Intensive care unit	Inside*	112
Hospital Heliport	Outside*	3
Hospital misc	Both	141
Hintersteiner Lake	Mostly Outside	18
Panorama Mountains	Outside	748
Panorama Town	Outside	99
Panorama City	Outside	60
School	Outside	43
Train station	Outside	6
Car in the street	Outside	150
Town center	Outside	28
Ellmau	Both	29

Table 3.2: Scene count of the main locations of the first ten seasons of Mountain Doctor TV show. *The distinction between inside and outside shots was started later in the operationalising process so early seasons are not differentiated on this dimension - so summing up "inside" plus "outside" does not add up to the the numbers of the "both" row of the location.

The summer TV show

The production for the TV show at the destination usually starts around the end of April and lasts through the year into the start of the winter season.³²

The BD winter drought Most of the screen locations are closed in winter, but there is a special BD hiking tour that you can do in winter. (cf. Wilder Kaiser Destination, 2024a, p. 1) Destination trace interview responses indicate that summer and spring are the seasons in which ST predominantly occur (Table 7.3.2).

The winterspecial The word *Winterspecial* is coined by the BD production as they have every season one very special episode called the Winterspecial.³³ It is always set in the winter season of the WK and not like the rest of a regular season mostly in the summer. This allocation of episodes towards winter and summer reflects the tourist season of the BD ST at the WK. The so called winterspecial does not have a strong and lasting influence on the ST to be pushed further into a winter activity at the WK - Skiing is the traditional winter focus of these alpine destination and the BD tourism is not touching this.

³²One of the first Instagram posts about the start with post id CrdA-LbNC94 and of the end with post id ClyfCAIPWRL.

³³Here an example for the use of the word *Winterspecial* on Instagram with post id CloGvJVt3QQ.

3.5 Situation of Wilder Kaiser as screen tourism backdrop

Screen tourism travel to the Wilder Kaiser

STs who follow the BD series typically organize their own trips, but still balancing between exclusive and mass tourism, according to Destination respondents. The STs mainly come from German-speaking countries, notably from around Munich, which is close to the WK region. As the BD is a very popular programme on German television and is also part of the Austrian public broadcaster ORF, it

makes sense that the BD fans are split between domestic and international. This interest drives significant German-speaking viewers to visit, marking it a mass tourism event. STs prefer traveling by car, with public transport as the second choice, while flying is less common for this group, suggesting a regional draw.

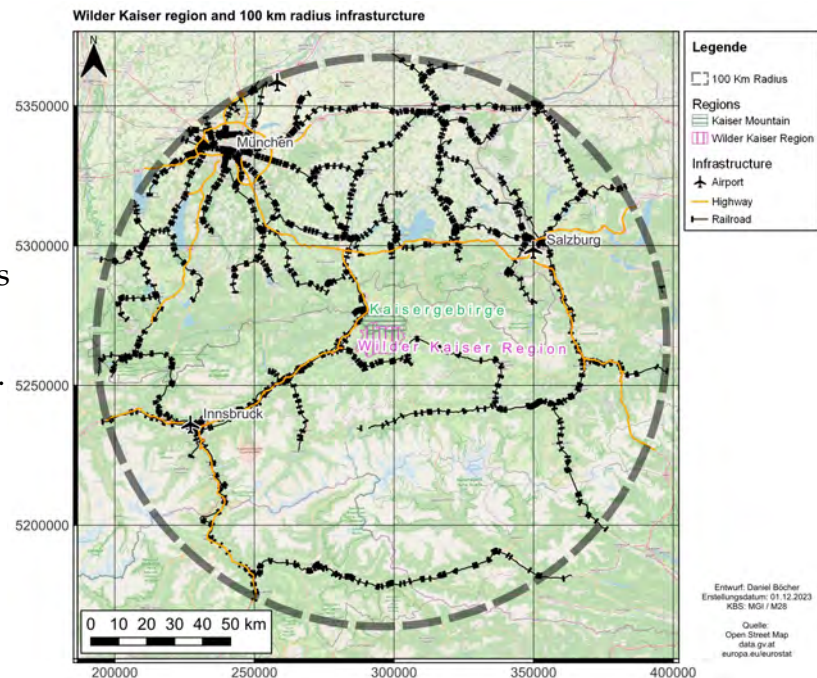


Figure 3.8: The munich metropolitan area and the transportation infrastructure in the austrian valleys are clearly visible (Source: Own Map).

The 100 km circle

The WK region, close to Germany's border and near the german metropolis of Munich, and the austrian cities of Innsbruck (capital of Tyrol), and Salzburg, benefits from proximity to major cities and airports, enhancing its accessibility via motorways and railways (map 3.8). Although it lacks a direct railway through the valley, nearby lines in the valley west and south facilitate access. The region divides into the Kaiser Mountains in the north (map 3.8 in green), four valley communities (Söll, Scheffau am Wilden Kaiser, Ellmau and Going am Wilden Kaiser) in the middle (map 3.8 in purple) , and the smooth ski hills in the south offering a mix of natural beauty and cultivated landscape in the hills as well as rural town life in the valley below.

These three areas define the boundaries of the WK's destination. Its strategic position near Munich (1 h by car) is seen as an advantage, by the producer of the BD at the ZDF (Böcher, 2018a). As the famous Kaiser Mountains are sparsely populated and a region for hikers, climbers and mountain farmers, as well as flora and fauna, the WK communities are where the majority of the population lives. It is also the space of the Wilder Kaiser-Brixental ski area to the south of the WK valley (map 3.9). These hills are not as rugged as the Wk mountain range in the north and are mostly covered with trees and mountain pastures. To the south and west of this hilly ski region are the Brixental and Kitzbühel valleys with the towns of Reith, Kitzbühel and Aurach, which are not in the WK destination but play an important role in the region's ST communications as we will find out later.

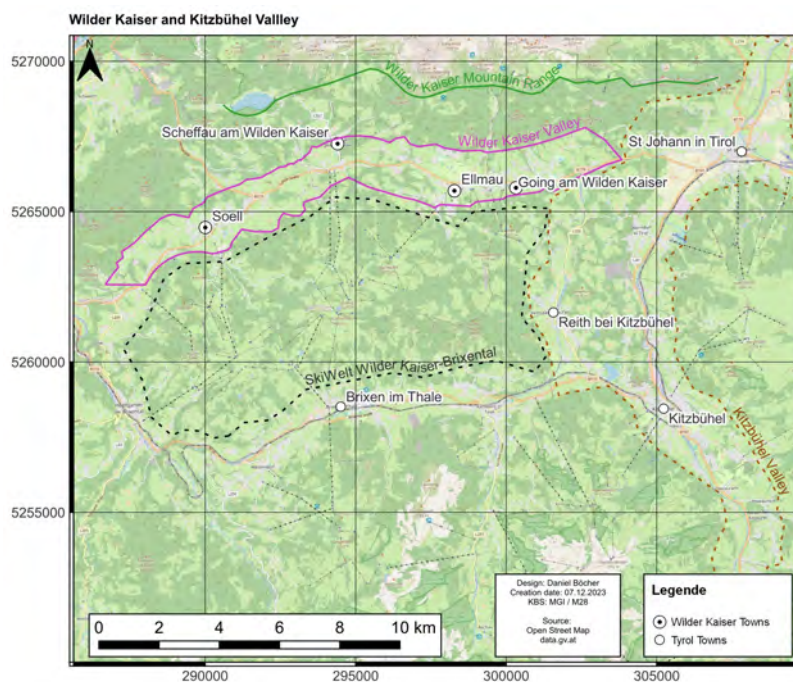


Figure 3.9: Map of the regions around the Wilder Kaiser with important towns for the region and the screen product (Source: Own Map).

est content as they stated in their trace interviews.

Screen locations in the broader region

Most screen locations are in the WK region (map 3.11), with a few in larger towns outside (map 3.10). The main hospital building is 50 minutes away from Ellmau by car, in a different valley towards Innsbruck. The screen location of the school is in different nearby towns as well as the hospital of the BD show. The hospital's exterior

The region of the WK

It is part of the DMO's strategy in the area to focus exclusively on the four towns of Söll, Scheffau am Wilden Kaiser, Ellmau and Going am Wilden Kaiser (map 3.9). In promotional material, on their website and in the tourist information they focus on these towns (Wilder Kaiser Destination, 2024b, p. 1). The Destination accounts have a strategy on Instagram to provide active, interesting, casual and honest content as they stated in their trace interviews.

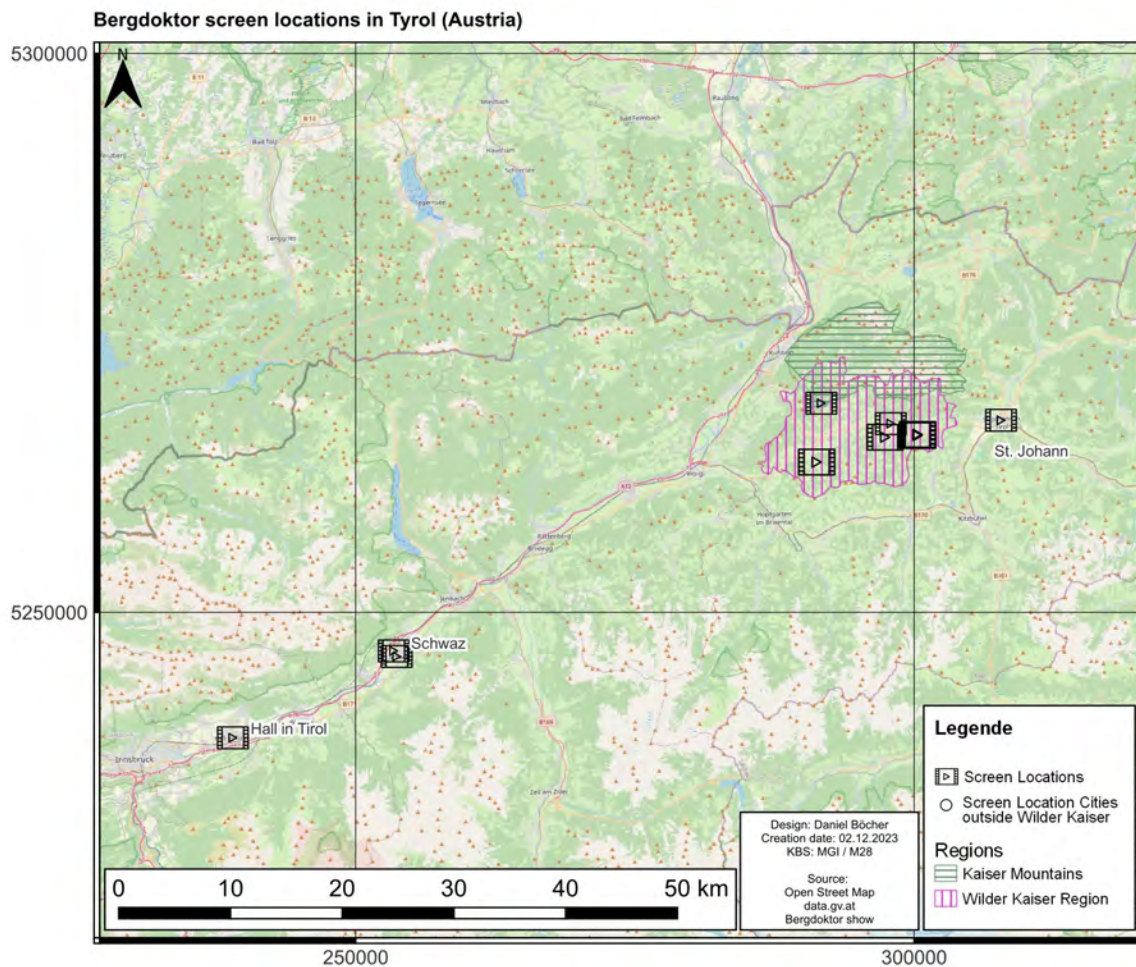


Figure 3.10: Recurring screen locations in the Wilder Kaiser destination and the surrounding area in the federal state of Tyrol (source: own map).

and entrance hall are filmed at different places, with its intensive care unit set in a tennis hall. Unlike Gruberhof and the BD practice, these screen locations have an important regional function as a hospital or tennis court. Visitors are seemed to be mindful not to disturb patients, doctors, and athletes as the study will suggest.³⁴

Screen locations within the WK destination

The three main locations of the Bergdoktor The Gruberhof, a key series location, is not easily reached as it's on a mountain, accessible only by a narrow road, unlike central WK valley screen locations. It also remains private, with entry limited to paid, official tours. The BD practice or the town square are near or the actual center of the towns in the valley.

Hinterstiner Lake vs smaller screen locations Hintersteiner Lake is 1.4 km across, offering hours of varied views, while the town square's sites are within a 75-meter

³⁴Page 108ff are talking about the findings in the corpus data.

range, seen by simply turning around. The town square features the church, WK guesthouse and pharmacy, allowing for quick visits to each.³⁵ You spend more time seeing them all at the town square but probably less time on each one individually as the Hintersteiner Lake screen location can individually take more time to be completed.

The Wilder Kaiser as media backdrop

Chapter 3.4 already demonstrates why the WK mountain range and the alpine backdrops of the BD TV show are considered to be an actor in their own right with a powerful influence on the tourist gaze³⁶ as proven in chapter 4. But also secondary content like the documentary "At home with the mountain doctor - En route at the

³⁵Beyond this, Going's town square offers little else, except a hidden shop with BD merchandise. The merchandise discussion is touched in chapter 5.3 on page 233.

³⁶Urry's theories of the tourist gaze already discussed on page 50.

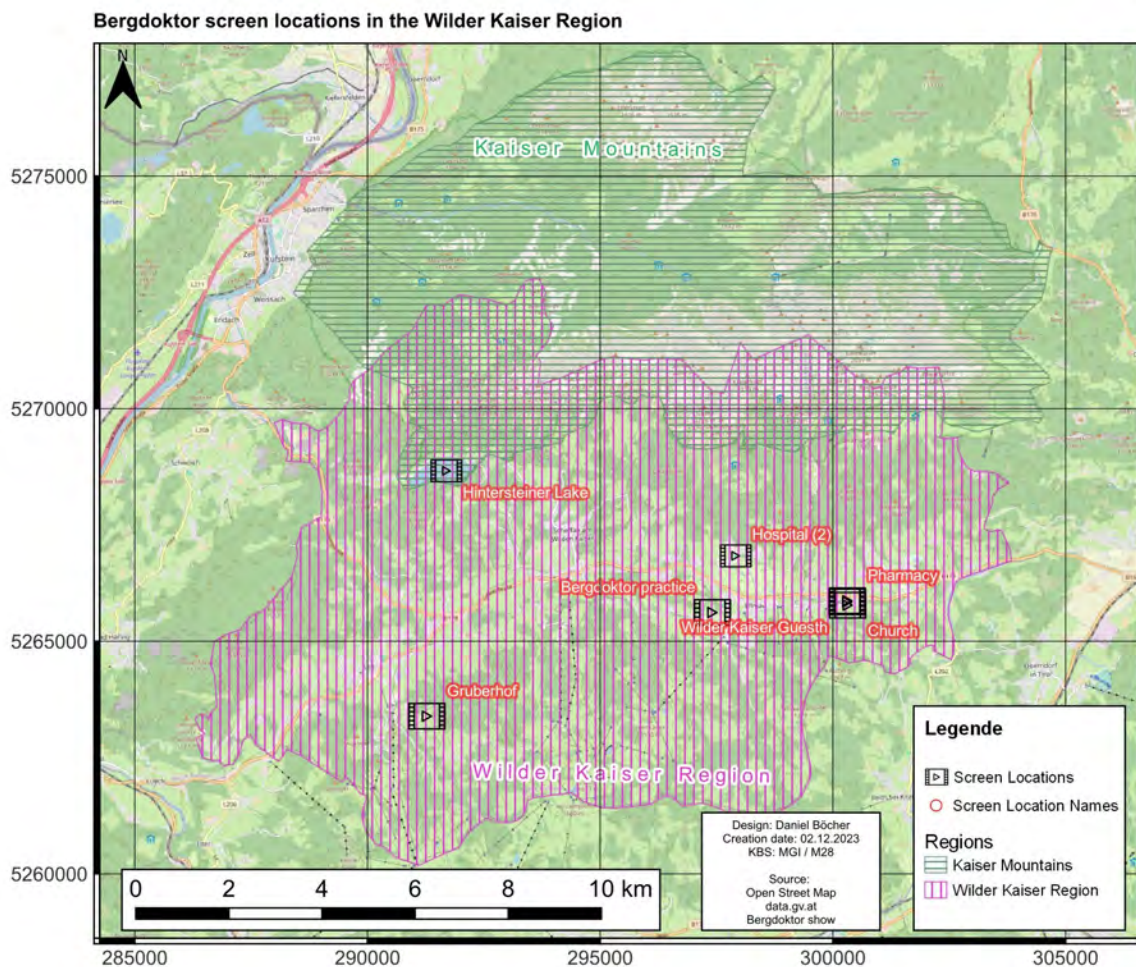


Figure 3.11: Major recurring screen locations in the region of the Wilder Kaiser and the Kaiser mountains (source: own map).

Wilder Kaiser (Translated by deep1.com)" emphasizes the scenery's importance beyond mere background: "This mini-documentary promotes the background of the series rather than the Bergdoktor itself. [...] The numerous camera pans over mountain peaks, mountain lakes and green alpine meadows could have been used directly in the series: 'At home with the mountain doctor' it seems to look exactly the same as with the Bergdoktor. (Translated from deep1.com; Focus Online, 2021, p. 1)"

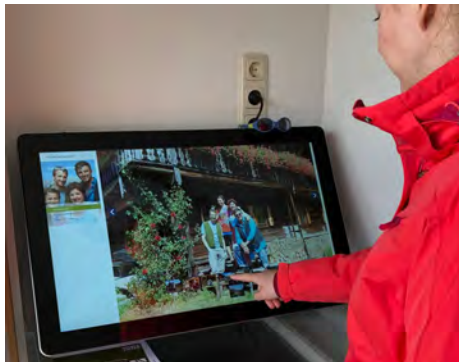


Figure 3.12: A touchscreen terminal at the tourist information at the WK with information about the Bergdoktor (source: own photo).

Relevancy of the mountain doctor screen tourism

Changing the destination The WK destination has adapted to the success of the BD TV show with tangible changes and (literal) signs. The BD ST has its own subdomain on the official WK DMO website, offering themed hikes, guided tours, and more. At WK, BD is present in tourist information (figure 3.12) and banners welcoming tourists to the BD town of Going (figure 3.1). At the BD practice screen location, a sign indicates the fictional practice rooms (figure 5.12). Infrastructure for BD ST, like a themed car park, has been built (figure 5.7). The show's success led to an established fan fest for the most "specific film tourist", to stay in the terminology of Macionis (Macionis, 2004). These are all signs and clues of the relevance for BD ST.

Screen tourism relevancy for the destination Public numbers about the success of the BD ST are unavailable at the moment of this work.³⁷ However, a 2021 WK DMO survey (Krösslhuber, 2024b) of over 600 tourists revealed³⁸ that 98 percent knew the BD TV show, 36 percent discovered WK through it, and 12 percent visited mainly because of it. Additionally, 44 percent visited BD screen locations even if not initially induced by the BD TV show. This indicates nearly every second tourist is a BD ST when she leaves the WK destination. (cf. Krösslhuber, 2024b) Already in 2013 the WK won a price for the DMO concept for BD ST: "The jury justified the award by stating that the two Bergdoktor weeks would revitalize the low season in the Wilder Kaiser region. Thanks to the high television presence with original names of the re-

³⁷Because of giving the impression that the WK profits too much from a public-private broadcaster screen production. The fear is that the WK in the BD TV show could be regarded as *location placement* (Krösslhuber, 2024a).

³⁸These information were exclusively shared by the DMO for this work!

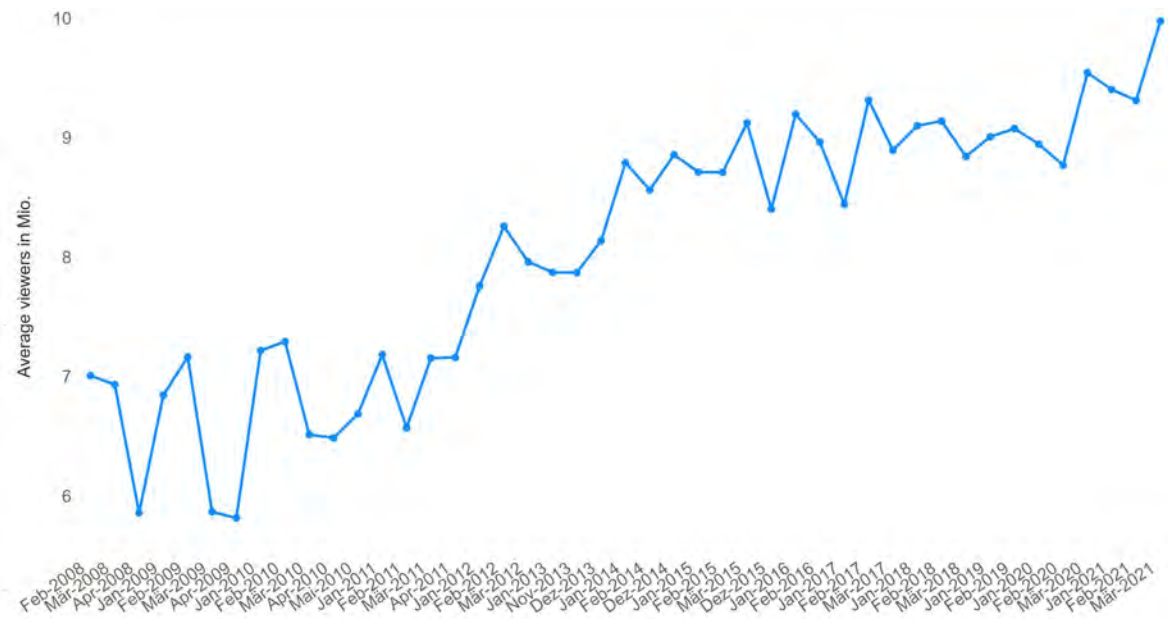


Figure 3.13: The average Bergdoktor viewer development between 2008 and 2021 (source: own graph, ZDF Medienforschung data).

gion, more and more people would decide to spend their vacation in the Bergdoktor region (translated by deep1.com; ORF, 2013)." The relevance for the WK at this time was still growing alongside the popularity of the TV show - visible in the market share of the TV show (figure 3.13). The show's popularity, shown by high ratings and viral ST posts, extends its relevance beyond WK and for a wider audience in front of the screens.

4.1 Social Media Communication of Screen Tourists

4.1.1 Instagram description analysis

Top 100 most used words

As figure 4.1 shows, the BD is clearly at the centre of the STs' conversations. Of course this was to be expected, as it was part of the search terms of the method that identified the posts, and it is an inducing factor for the STs to be at the WK in the first place. (Q: 2023-02-10_traceinterview_st, Question: IT07) But when you look at the other groups¹ it shows that it is not that simple, because the variation cannot be explained by these initial factors alone

Screen product terms: screen locations, Bergdoktor and production terms Other words in the top 100 (figure 4.1) show the devotion of fans to their favorite series: "Der Bergdoktor", "Praxis", "Gruberhof", "Dreh", "Serie", "Staffel" and "gedreht". These posts are primarily a conversation about tourism, but the use of these words in the description tends to make them ST posts.

Destination terms: places, towns and regions

The region "Wilder Kaiser", along with names of places and towns like "Ellmau", "Going", "Kaiser", "Hintersteiner See", and "Wilde" (as an inflection of "Wilder"), features prominently in the top words of figure 4.1.² Above the WK level are broader geographical references such as the country "Austria" and the province "Tyrol," with adjacent notable places like "Kitzbühel" and "Reith" (visible on map 3.9). These numerous and diverse mentions underscore the region's significance in ST communication

The corona virus in the posts

The term "Corona" ranking in the top 100 words is notable (figure 4.1), especially since the corpus analysis started well before the pandemic and extended into the summer of 2021 (explained in chapter 3.3 on page 81), which was the second season of the pandemic. Despite being mentioned in only seven posts, its presence highlights its impact on ST communication at the WK. This is even more remarkable as Covid was never part of the BD narrative despite being a show about a doctor. This has a simple reason as the actor of the BD explains in an interview: "[...] we want to produce entertainment and provide relaxation for the viewer, and Covid simply doesn't fit into that (Hans Sigl quoted in Weber, 2022)." For the a few (screen)

¹See Chapter 4.4 on page 145 for the difference.

²You could probably add the names of the screen locations discussed in the paragraph above to the list of places in the WK region.

tourist this was notable event anyway. An example post describes a return to the Tyrolean mountains for a break from Corona-related topics, emphasizing relaxation and nostalgia for pre-pandemic times: "Tonight we're off again to the beautiful Tyrolean mountains. Just a little light TV and forget the Corona topics for 90 minutes. Pure relaxation! [...]" (Translated by [deep1.com](#); post id CKCHI1AFuYK) This type of post can be considered a tbt (#Throwbackthursday) post. The post features a collage of photos from previous visits to the WK, serving as a throwback to better days, untainted by the pandemic.

Advertising in posts

Unexpectedly, the term "Werbung" (Advertising) is among the top 100 words of the STs. The STs were assumed to be the private group in the corpus, just posting about their holidays. But these accounts and the use of the word suggest that there are professional influencer accounts among the STs, who tag their posts as #add. Posts like this: "There are two filming locations for the Bergdoktor series: the exterior shots were taken from the old Dorfkrämerhaus on the town square in Going and the interior shots were shot in the renowned Föhrenhof restaurant in the Auwald district of Ellmau. Going has even more to offer nature-loving, serene, down-to-earth - a real town that radiates tranquility, with a unique landscape that makes hearts beat faster (unpaid advertising) (Translated by [deep1.com](#); post id CGfKex6q0dh)." Of course it is not useful and unnecessary to mention "unpaid advertising", but the leisure accounts of would-be influencers and STs feel they have to when talking about screen locations and WK places.

4.1.2 Instagram post metrics analysis

Instagram interactions

This section looks in more detail at Instagram likes, as they are the most present metric and interaction feature of social networks. The Instagram likes on STs' posts range from 3,642 to a minimum of only one, with an average of 182 per post. The median is more than half the mean, which means that there are more posts with a lot of likes than with few, in other words that there are more positive outliers³ than negative ones. The different posts fluctuate around the mean of 363 likes.

The long tail of regular tourists Only a few accounts can generate a lot of interactions with their ST posts. The long tail (figure 4.2) shows that there are significantly more posts with little interactions than big ones. Even in the top 95 percentile, the number of interactions drops very quickly after the first four. This shows that most

³in the social media world we call these posts *viral hits*.

accounts are smaller, and this suggests that the people behind most of these accounts could be considered regular WK tourists. Another clue that they are regular tourists might be that the median number of posts of the ST accounts is 1. This makes sense, as most people just make one topic-related post (about their holiday) and then immediately move on (with their daily lives).

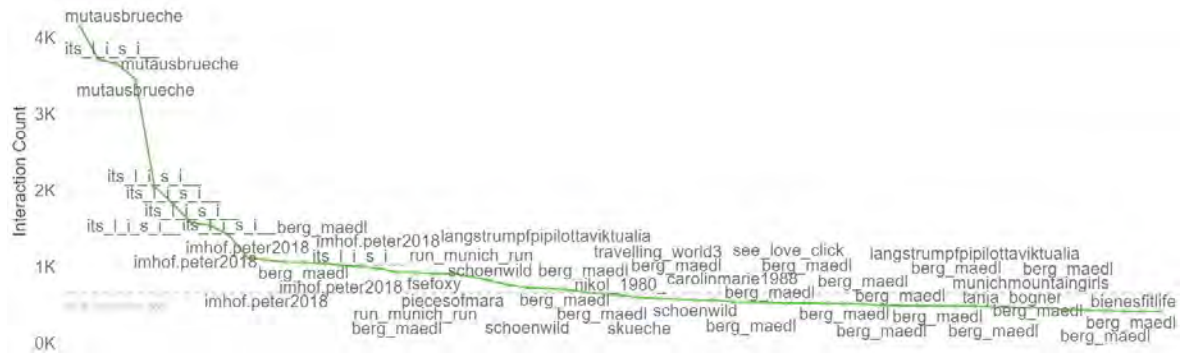


Figure 4.2: The long tail of the number of interactions per post in the ST group (source: own data).

Popular accounts and posts

The most popular accounts according to median interactions with ST content from the BD at the WK are:

- @mutausbrueche
- @its_l_i_s_i
- @imhof.peter2018
- @fsefoxy
- @piecesofmara

The account of @its_l_i_s_i makes a total of over 13 k interactions with her seven ST communication posts. With a median of 1.6k, she has more than 20 times the median interactions of all ST posts combined. This explains the large sum of interactions.

The Bergdoktor practice as prime screen location The Instagram account @its_l_i_s_i posted six⁴ photos (Figure 4.3), all taken at the popular screen location of the BD practice. These photos were shared over a period from December 2019 to January 2021, suggesting the ST user visited the screen location on four separate occasions⁵ — twice in summer and twice in winter. Trace interviews with STs confirmed that this site is a favorite, often visited and where they spend significant time. These answers as well as the several photos from different trips underscores the screen location's significance within the BD fandom and its attraction to STs.

⁴the seventh has been deleted.

⁵Photos (b) and (f) as well (d) and (e) were taken on the same trip.



Figure 4.3: Collection of all available photos (album covers) in the corpus of the account @its_l_i_s_i_ (Source: Instagram screenshots).

Outlier posts from the winter ST at WK is usually considered a summer activity, but photos (a), (b), and (f) in figure 4.3 are the exception to this rule. For an account that feels like a typical influencer⁶ it probably does not matter if an attraction is considered a winter or summer activity, as content needs to be published every day.

Throwback posts The posts (e) and (f) (figure 4.3) are #throwback posts, as the description says. This is a common behavior on social media with vacation photos. STs want to remember their good times at the destination, and influencer accounts like @its_l_i_s_i_ try to tap into these feelings of nostalgia to create compelling

⁶This can be seen in the standardized aesthetic of the subject as the persistent content of a photo with recurring poses in front of changing backgrounds. An aesthetic that fits well with regular vacation photos.

content and connect with their audience.

Special access to the screen location Finally, but certainly very interesting, is the special access of the account to the balcony (Figure 4.3, photo (d) and (e)) of the BD practice. The normal perspective of most STs is the perspective of photos (a) to (c) and (f), but having access to the balcony of the BD practice screen location is unique in this corpus.⁷ Since photo (e) is just the cover of an Instagram album post, the second photo and the mention of the DMO on the photo itself provide evidence that this post may have been sponsored by the DMO.⁸ While this set of photos has some unique aspects, one crucial thing is the same: Like most of the other posts by the STs, the photos @its_l_i_s_i__ are also taken from the outside, looking at the main entrance door of the BD office (except (d)).

Most successful posts

Posts with no ST communication The most popular posts from ST accounts come in at 48th place after Production and Destination posts. It has 4,156 interactions and belongs to the account @mutausbrueche. (Q: 230504_ct_some_analysis.pbix, Inter User) Looking at the photo of the post, it has nothing to do with ST Communication (Post id C1cx24RBQKS). Only on the second photo of the Instagram album is the actor Ronja Forcher, who is part of the main cast of the BD series. Looking at the post, it was just the keywords that were picked up by the boolean search (see page 71), so it ended up in the corpus. The post is ST communication by definition, but for the research question nothing substantial can be added except that people are using the hashtags, mentions, and names of the BD and WK to push their content that has nothing to do with ST or the WK. Only a few of them ended up in the corpus, but they will not be mentioned in the following lines because they are not related to the research question.

Background actor At the end of the description of the post by the ST account @mutausbrueche (post id CDB-NK_B96B), she makes a statement about how she wants to be part of the BD: "[...] And I tell you, one day I'm going to apply to be an extra - even if I'm just playing a tree or a rock in the background. [...]" (Translated by deep1.com; post id CDB-NK_B96B)" It is interesting that she emphasizes that it does not matter what additional roles she could play and offers to play the literal background. Looking at the BD series (as in chapter 3.4 and 3.5), it is clear that the

⁷The DMO of the WK confirms that the balcony is usually closed for safety reasons. (cf. Krösslhuber, 2023a, p. 1)

⁸The local DMO of the WK denies any involvement, but perhaps this was done by the state or country DMO or directly by the owners of the set. The local DMO also wrote: "[...] but you know what influencers do for a special photo". (Translated by deep1.com; cf. Krösslhuber, 2023a, p. 1)

background and environment play an important role in the stories and tone of the series. The background could be considered not a real actor, but a separate entity in the BD universe. The fans recognize this by traveling to the screen locations at the WK, but also by these kinds of statements. For them, the nature and environment of the WK is without question a part of what they love about the tv show. As they try to become a part of it, they offer to be the background.

The tokens of the most successful posts The top 100 posts (by interactions) include 108 words with more than four uses. The words and posts come from 19 different ST accounts, with a median of 491 interactions. "Heute" (today) is the most used word. Most prominent in the top ten after the first place are: "Tag" (day), "Bergdoktor", "Abend" (evening) and "Wilder Kaiser". Why people use BD and WK terms so often should be clear when you look at ST communication at the WK, and could be explained simply by the fact that the corpus was technically filtered for these keywords. But the question that remains unanswered is why they use time descriptions like day, evening, or today⁹

Time tokens That people use these words a lot is well established, but the interaction data shows that they are also successful. Each word explaining time was used an average of 11 times in the top 100 posts. For example, "today" was used 40 times in 34 different posts by 7 different ST accounts. The average number of interactions of the posts using these words is 560 (figure 4.4) - which is above the already high interaction count of all the top 100 posts. So even among the top words, the time terms are performing stronger than others.

Screen production tokens Consider the three groups of tokens defined paragraphs above: Destination (page 98), Production (page 98) and Time (page 147), there is a clear winner! Posts using screen production terms receive over twice the interactions compared to other terms. The top 100 posts discuss the BD and its production processes, highlighting their popularity. This interest likely stems from the BD's broader recognition outside of the ST bubble, making it more familiar than the WK destination. The BD's screen product is a highly successful TV show, whereas the WK destination lacks similar popularity.

Expected post performance

Looking at the difference between the median of the expected interactions¹⁰ and what the posts ended up getting, the ST communication from the STs is performing better than expected. The posts of the ST communication get higher scores than posts

⁹An attempt to explain this was made earlier on page 4.4.1.

¹⁰An explanation of how the expected post performance is calculated can be found in Chapter 3.2 on page 72.

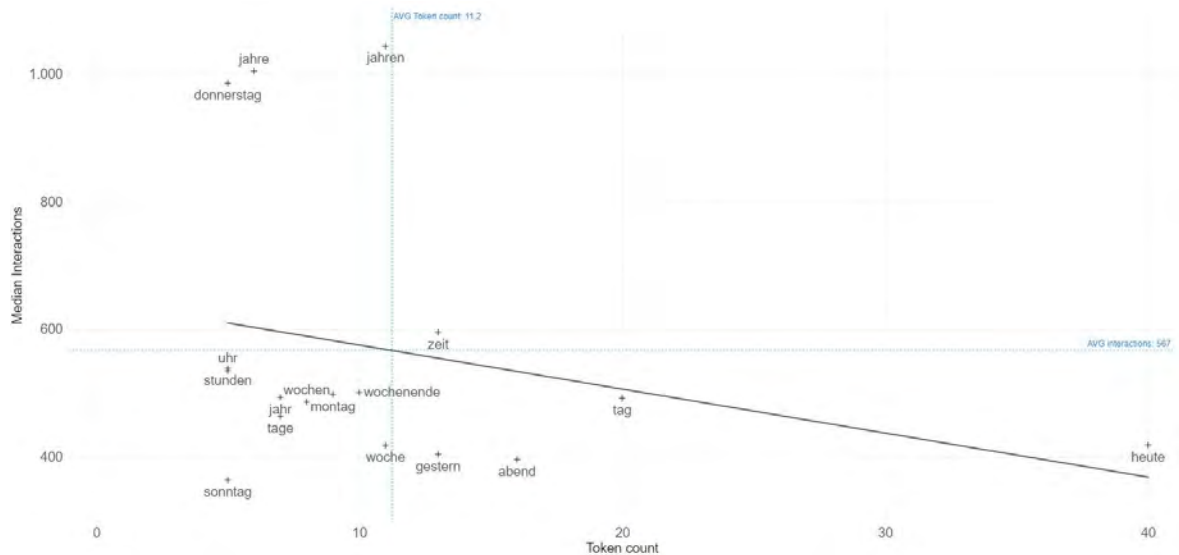


Figure 4.4: Comparing the amount of time-tokens to the median interaction of the post they were written in. Filtered for the top 100 posts by interaction and more than three uses of the token (source: own data).

with other topics. They have a median difference of 39 interactions per post and gather an additional 15 k interactions above the median of comparable posts. For ST these posts are very successful and for their followers something worth seeing, showing how widespread but still interesting the themes of ST are in society.

4.1.3 Trace Interviews Answers

The influence on screen tourists

Holiday preparation phase The interviewed STs researched the WK region on Instagram before their visit, focusing on posts from other tourists and DMO accounts. For vacation preparation, they valued these accounts over those of the Production crew and actors, which appeared less relevant. While production-related posts might inspire visits to WK, destination-specific accounts are preferred for actual trip planning in the pre-travel phase. Thus, Production accounts serve mainly to inspire, while Destination accounts provide practical travel guidance as local experts. Destination accounts can skip the Inspire phase for STs and start giving actual advice for the already planned trip.

Influence of tourists and the production The interview revealed that STs felt they were not influenced (As expected) by other tourist groups, likely due to the common negative views tourists have about each other¹¹. However, Production accounts from the BD series significantly influenced their decisions. But as the paragraph above

¹¹described in chapter 2.2 on page 51 and chapter 6.2 on 186.

showed that the focus of the ST can potentially shift: The Production primarily inspired the choice for the WK, but shifted towards the Destination accounts when specific information for actual trip planning was needed. While selecting a destination feels like a major decision, the numerous smaller decisions made during trip preparation may cumulatively have a greater impact on the travel experience.

Situation of the photo and post

Family first Some STs in the interview link the photo's context to "Family", suggesting they were with their families, portraying the WK as a family-oriented destination¹² and/or gives the impression that BD ST is a family activity. Family themes dominate the BD show (page 85) and it is often viewed with families (post id CDB-NK_B96B), influencing similar vacation group compositions. Descriptions explicitly confirm this family focus, as shown in one example: "Family Family means never being alone again for the rest of your life. #familytime #wilderkaiser #holiday #bergdoktor #gruberhof #inechtnochschöner #söll #austria #happyfamily (Translated by deep1.com; post id CHuRXBPn3Al)"

Different experiences of the other tourists Interestingly, there is a dichotomy in the description of the situation at the WK. One side writes that it was "Super weather, **many tourists** (post id CDataSXBhvF)" or "It was in the summer, there was **a lot going on!** You could visit the practice, which I did. Unfortunately, you could only go into the hallway and the rooms were locked (post id B24EWo4ihK1)" (All quotes translated by deep1.com; Emph. D.B.). The other side writes: "Imperial weather, **few tourists, quiet** (post id CEuAlz3pKk4)" or "Was with a friend, since we were in the area anyway. **Otherwise no visitors** (post id CHU-pLyM0pk)" (All quotes translated by deep1.com; Emph. D.B.) Tourists experience the WK differently, influenced by factors like visit timing, chosen attractions, weather, and personal perceptions. All the mentioned STs visited the BD practice during fall, as indicated by their photos and post dates. All photos (figure 4.5) intentionally exclude other tourists, showcasing settings without any people ((a) to (c)) or just family members (d). The tendency to exclude other tourists is obvious and the fact that people have different subjective opinions about what many and few tourists are. Based on experience in the field, what is present in the photos can objectively not be called crowded, but actually empty, as in comparisons with situations at the WK, where the BD practice forecourt is packed with people waiting to go inside (figure 5.1 on page 165).

Inside and outside One particular post (post id CF45-iyIHIL) describing the situation talks about the relationship between the inside and outside of a screen location:

¹²From my own history of vacationing in Austria and the experience of traveling to the WK I can confirm that a vacation in Austria is predestined as a family destination for several reasons.



Figure 4.5: Photos of an empty Bergdokter practice screen location with different subjective opinions about the crowd. Post id (a) CHU-pLyM0pk Quote: "no visitors", (b) CEuAlz3pKk4 Quote: "a few tourists", (c) B24EWo4ihK1 Quote: "a lot going on" and (d) CDataSXBhvF Quote: "many tourists" (Source: Instagram screenshots)

"One could visit the Gruberhof for a 8 Euro entrance fee. But we were not **inside**. Photos were taken from **outside**. But there were some visitors **inside**. (Translated by deep1.com)" The fee must be very important to the respondent since he mentioned it first and specifically, which could indicate that the fee might be the reason he did not go inside. The photos were taken outside and that was apparently enough for them. Looking at the corpus for a more evidence: The random sample of photos collected in figure 4.6 shows that the focus of ST communication is outside - 91 percent of the sampled photos to be exact. The outside as the object of the gaze is first psychologically primed¹³ by the inducing screen product, which also prefers outside shots, as shown in chapter 3.4 on page 87. This choice of the quoted account reflects broader trends rather than personal affordability or fan dedication. Since most of the photos in this corpus are from the outside, the trace interview answer above seems to fit and speak for the majority of STs.

The familiar image of the WK On Instagram, the WK seemed as expected to many interviewees, but surprisingly, most found it more beautiful in person than the photos on Instagram suggested.¹⁴ This goes against the tendency of photos in Instagram being filtered, edited and enhanced representations of life. The reason why the WK exceeded the expectations formed by the social media platform could be maybe explained by another question in the trace interview: "What were your reasons for visiting the locations of The Mountain Doctor in the WK?" and one of the

¹³More on priming and the social psychology behind it in source Bargh and Chartrand, 2000 on page 1 - 39

¹⁴Also the disagreement with the control statement "my expectations from the Instagram posts could not fulfill the WK on site" supports the result.

	Spend the most time	Number of Visitors	Felt closer to BD	Number of tokens	Number of photos on locations
Square and church*	2	21	82	31	*68
Hintersteiner Lake	3	19	34	12	14
BD practice	3	22	97	44	123
WK Guesthouse*	3	19	51	13	*68
Gruberhof	4	17	101	50	92
Pharmacy*	5	19	16	3	*68
Hospital	6	9	13	1	0

Table 4.1: Time spend and visited screen location by the ST
(* Location of the town square)

statements they could agree on the most was "I have the feeling that I know the WK through the series" (table 7.16 on page 291; All quotes from the question translated by deep1.com). The expectation were never set by Instagram in the first place but by the screen product before.

The screen locations at the WK

Screen locations in the WK are grouped by token frequency (table 4.1 column 5): the pharmacy (3 tokens) and hospital (1) are least mentioned; Hintersteinersee (12) and the WK guesthouse (13) are mid-range; the BD practice (44) and Gruberhof (50) are most mentioned. Mention frequency does not correlate with time spent (column 2) or visitor numbers (column 3) but its best indicator is by how connected

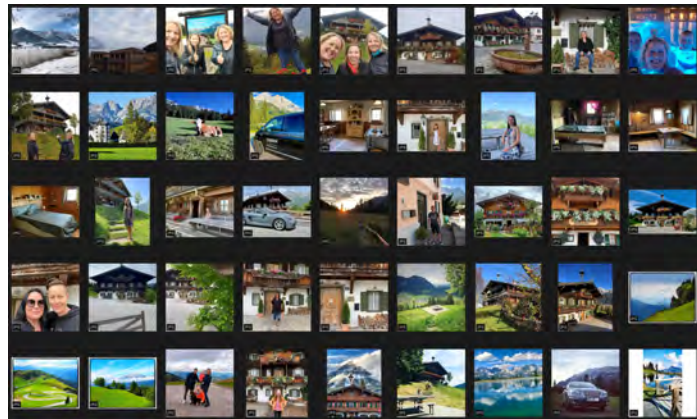


Figure 4.6: Of the last 45 photos (in alphabetical order) of the ST group, only four photos were taken indoors. (Source: Instagram screenshots of corpus posts).

STs feel to the BD series at each screen location (column 4). The number of mentions closely matches the number of photos posted (column 6), reflecting the usual combination of photos and accompanying description in each posts.

Bergdokter practice vs Hintersteiner lake People spend most of their time at the town square, the lake, and the BD practice (table 4.1 column 2). The BD practice is the most visited screen location by counting different STs (table 4.1 column 3), but it is not where people spend the most time. The explanation for this discrepancy is

probably that the lake is just a huge place (as explained in chapter 3.5 on page 93). This suggests that the STs who come to these places do not simply see it as a check mark, but stay if the place offers more than just the screen location of BD. This shows that within a ST there is always a regular tourist.

The ignored hospital screen location While most of the other major screen locations are visited regularly (table 4.1), the hospital is not. Not many people visit the hospital (9 STs), spend much time there (less than any at any other screen location), write about it in their description (1 token), or even take a photo of it (actually 0)! This was expected because the screen location of the hospital is the least important than the big three (page 87), less coherent portrayed¹⁵ and not as stunning of a screen location compared to for example the Hintersteiner lake.

The geographical problems of the Gruberhof and the hospital screen location Visit differences at WK screen locations are due to geography and accessibility: The Gruberhof, though important in the narrative (page 87), had only 17 visits, fewer than the pharmacy, because it's privately owned and only easily accessible by car or foot but mostly via an official BD tours (page 93). The hospital, similarly less accessible and private, has in addition various indoor and outdoor shooting locations (table 3.2). It attracted fewer visitors - highlighting the importance of accessibility - who also spent less time and posted no photos - showing that vicinity is important. Normal building usage also affects visitor behavior, as decent tourists typically avoid disturbing inhabitants, workers and operations (page 92).

Closeness as indicator for published posts The connection between how close interviewees felt to the fictional world of BD in various screen locations (table 7.20 on page 293) and their Instagram posts is clear: The Gruberhof, the doctor's home, is where people felt most immersed in the TV series (Median 101 out of 101; table 4.1 column 4). Many photos show this screen location, and it has the most tokens in the description. The sense of closeness is similar for the BD practice, with a median score of 97, but the practice consistently engaged even those who felt less connected, which was only 21 (table 7.20) at its lowest. The hospital was the least connected screen location, scoring only a median of 13, with a narrower range of closeness, indicating a general agreement with its lower level of engagement. These feelings of closeness significantly influenced what visitors chose to post. Narrative salience drives feelings of closeness in a given screen location, and this in turn influences how much people write about it and visually document it on a social network like Instagram.

¹⁵The hospital actually has the most scenes in 10 seasons (table 89) but has many different looking sets and screen location as will be further explained in the next paragraph.

Text

A strong link to the BD Five description texts of the STs interviewed had a strong connection to the BD. They make a connection to the BD mostly through the screen locations, once to the main character of the show or their own fan relationship like this example: "I have to admit that I am a big fan of the Mountain Doctor, but I also love the region We go to Austria every year with our caravan, and every time we are in a different place. [...]" (Translated from [deep1.com](#); post id B24EWo4ihK1)" In the trace interview, the user repeats the statement from the public description that she wrote the text because she is a big fan. Other ST posts mention the involvement of fellow travelers: "The view from our vacation home in Itter, Austria. Very close to Ellmau and **the, by my wife, so beloved mountain doctor**. Only the series, of course. (Translated from [deep1.com](#); emphasis added; post id CJHhDPEJI3Y)" These posts seem to be directly triggered by the ST experience and the proximity to the screen locations. This opens up emotions and a closeness groomed¹⁶ through the fictional world of the BD.

Hashtag

Some choose hashtags based on simplicity: "Goes with the photo (post id: CGw14x-hST1)" or "Because I thought of these hashtags (post id: CB_YtMmqjah)". Others understand hashtag mechanics: "To reach many people who also love this landscape (post id: B1g4Eh8ijwp)" or "So that many mountain doctor lovers like this (post id: CF45-iyIHIL)". Similar as the motivations above STs mention "other people" as motivation: "To reach a lot of people (post id: CEuAlz3pKk4)" or "To inspire others (post id: CDataSXBhvF)". Destination ties also motivate: "Ties to the region (post id: B9Ri2GSo_9J)" or "To show why we are here (post id: CJHhDPEJI3Y)"¹⁷. One response links back to the motivation for choosing the hashtags to the one of the photo (mentioned in the paragraph above): "Because I wanted to show other people how beautiful it is at the Wilder Kaiser (post id: BjFpI0CgwTl)". Some use the automated suggestions from Instagram: "More suggestions have been made at #bergdoktor. I just took them over (post id: CHU-pLyM0pk)". A few themes emerge, but no clear strategy is evident. What is clear is that everyone uses hashtags, even if the motivation is "just for fun (post id: BSeBTgLDNCy)", and most understand the technical function and how to use them properly in a social media context. As there is no overarching strategy for STs to choose hashtags based on motivation but it is clear that they use it mostly strategical to reach others in general or a bigger audience.

¹⁶More on this in chapter 2.2 on page 57.

¹⁷The latter motivation for hashtags can be interpreted as proof of being there, discussed in theory chapter 2.2 on page 48.

Photo

In contrast to the motivations for the other parts of a post (hashtags, mentions, post overall) that were all over the place and not congruent, the one for selecting photos, however, has a pretty clear answer. 9 out of 16 wrote that it was just beautiful and great:

- "Great impressions, showing other people **how beautiful it is** there (figure 4.7)."
- "Because **it was beautiful** there."
- "I liked this one the best. Just the background **looks so great.**"
- "Because I wanted to show others where I was and that **it was beautiful.**"
- "Because of the **beautiful moment.**"
- "**Beautiful scenery**"
- (All translated by `deep1.com`; Herv. D.B.)

Sometimes the motivation for the photo even becomes its description: "Is just too beautiful the panorama of the `#wilderkaiser` `#bergdoktor` `#wonderful` `#nature` `#naturephotography` (Translated by `deep1.com`; post id `BjFpI0CgwTl`)" To communicate the "beautiful scenery" is an important motivation for the photo as the poster of figure 4.7 answered in the trace interview.

4.1.4 Geolocation Analysis

Heatmap of the overall photo data

The heatmap analysis (map 4.8) shows three visible circular clusters in the south of the valley: Gruberhof, BD practice, and the town square in Going. These three clusters with a radius of one kilometer, account for 169 out of 246 photos (54 Gruberhof, 73 BD practice, 42 Town Square). Another spatial cluster is visible above the WK mountains to the north (map 4.8), from (left to right) the rock slide slope Tuxeck over the Ellmauer Tor in the center to the peek of the Ackerlspitze. This cluster contains 74 photos within a one-kilometer buffer zone. The highest density is near the Ellmauer Tor and the western flank of the Ellmauer Halt. These mountain features mentioned are high and visible from

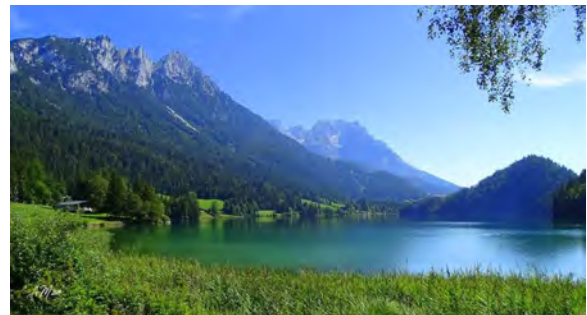


Figure 4.7: An example of ST photos of the beautiful landscape at the WK (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id `B1g4Eh8ijwp`).

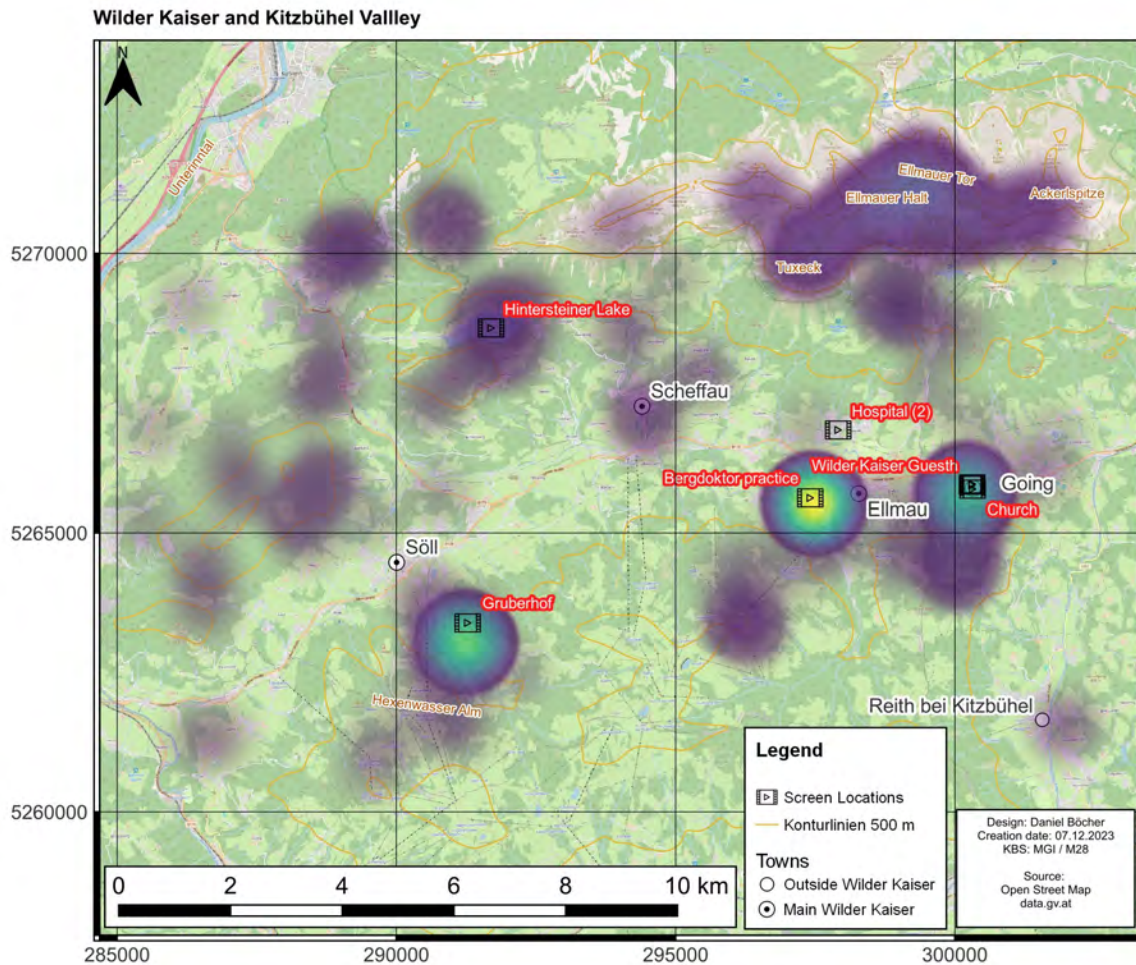


Figure 4.8: Heatmap of screen tourism posts at the destination Wilder Kaiser (Source: Own Map).

many points, making them frequently photographed. The Ellmauer Tor (figure 7.4) is a major geological feature and visually concise so it is easily recognizable by most STs.

Heatmap of the photographer

Isolating photographers from motive positions changes the clusters' appearance. The aerial cluster above the WK mountain range has almost¹⁸ completely disappeared (map 4.9 top). Circular clusters around the three major screen locations remain unchanged. Most STs photograph the WK mountain range from main screen locations, rarely the other way around. Photographing from the WK mountains into the valley is unpopular. When scaling down into the remaining major clusters the distribution follows no rules except in its density: They are densely packed in the

¹⁸Some points (10) still remain that look like hikers on different altitude levels on the way to the Ellmauer Tor.

major screen location, up to 300 meters in diameter. At the minor screen location of the *Hintersteiner lake* for example, points are 200 to 1000 meters apart (map 4.9 top). This is simply due to size differences between a lake and the other clusters tied to just a few small town buildings.

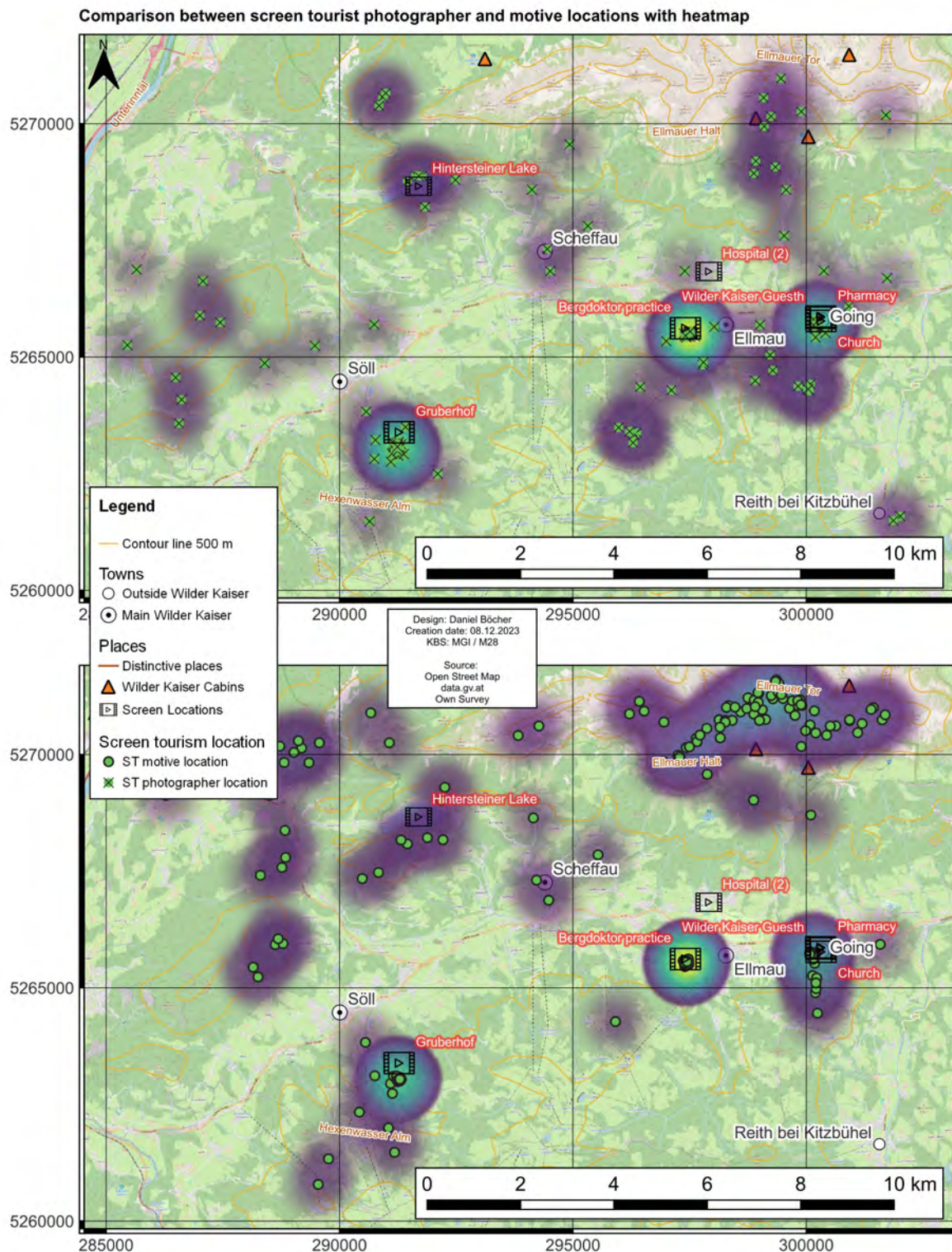


Figure 4.9: Top map: Screen tourist photographer positions. Bottom map: Screen tourist motive points. (Source: Own Map)

Heatmap of the motive

Isolating the motives of Instagram photos (map 4.9 bottom) brings back all clusters from the overall map 4.8. Comparing motive geolocations with photographer positions shows motives have more clustered and are further spread out. The Gruberhof and BD practice screen locations remain densely clustered. The WK mountain cluster has the majority of motive points when looking at total dispersion. Only two points in the one-kilometer buffer zone (heatmap circle) belong to a photographer point. Few people hike up to the WK mountain range for photos but most STs prefer photographing it from the valley, especially the three major screen location.

The motive of the Wilder Kaiser mountains

The WK mountain motive cluster leads to perspective analysis: Connections between photographer and motive are plotted on an x-y axis (figure 7.7). The area beneath the line has the three circle clusters around screen locations (f.l.t.r Gruberhof, BD Practice and Town Square) again and a spatial motive cluster in the upper right quadrant. The blue line represents the smoothed rolling average of points with variation.¹⁹ The lines between the dots show the photographer's perspective (cross) on the motive (circle). The WK mountain cluster is mainly photographed from the town



Figure 4.10: Photo from the screen location Gruberhof through the valley onto the opposite mountain range (Source: Instagram screenshot with Post id CDMyx-sFLBx).

square and the BD practice screen locations. The rugged mountains that gave the destination its name "Wild Emperor" support the dramatic scenes (as silent actor) that often begin at the BD practice or town square screen location. The situation is similar at the third screen location, Gruberhof. The higher screen location of the Gruberhof offers spectacular views to the other side of the valley. The western WK mountains in Söll are less rugged, appearing peaceful like alpine pastures, which fits the intimate family setting of the Gruberhof screen location. Photos typically show a screen location in the foreground with the opposite mountain range in the background (example in figure 4.10), representing a typical mountain panorama found

¹⁹This shape almost looks like a river in the valley of the WK valley, which it is not, but it shows how the motive and photographer points are distributed on both sides of the valley.

in many alpine and tourist visuals.

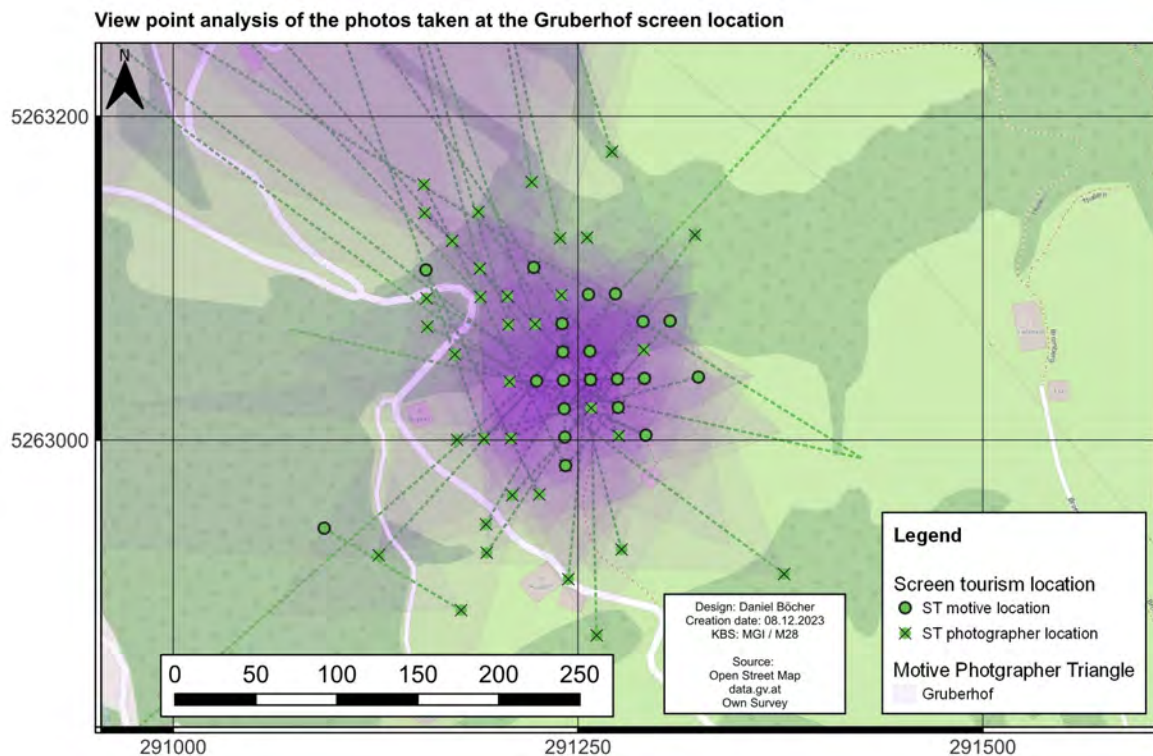


Figure 4.11: Perspective of each screen tourist photographer position at the Gruberhof screen location (source: own map). The stronger the purple, the more perspectives overlap and show the same place.

View is not everything

Great panoramas are not everything. Some photos at the screen locations show another pattern. Zooming in, some photos ignore the views, focusing on one element (map 4.11), often the screen location or fellow travelers. The stunning Gruberhof view sometimes takes a backseat to its architecture. This is evident at the Gruberhof screen location in map 4.11. A similar shift occurs at the town square screen location, especially with the church (map 4.12). It is less photographed with the WK mountain panorama due to its architecture (entrance in the north) and position (south of the town square). Photos of the church mostly have the green hills of the ski slopes at the opposing side in the background (figure 7.5). This might explain why the church appears less frequently in photos and clusters compared to the WK Guesthouse. The church's potential could be improved if it were more accessible for panoramic photos but you can not change the architecture. The small examples show that view is not everything, but it helps a lot!

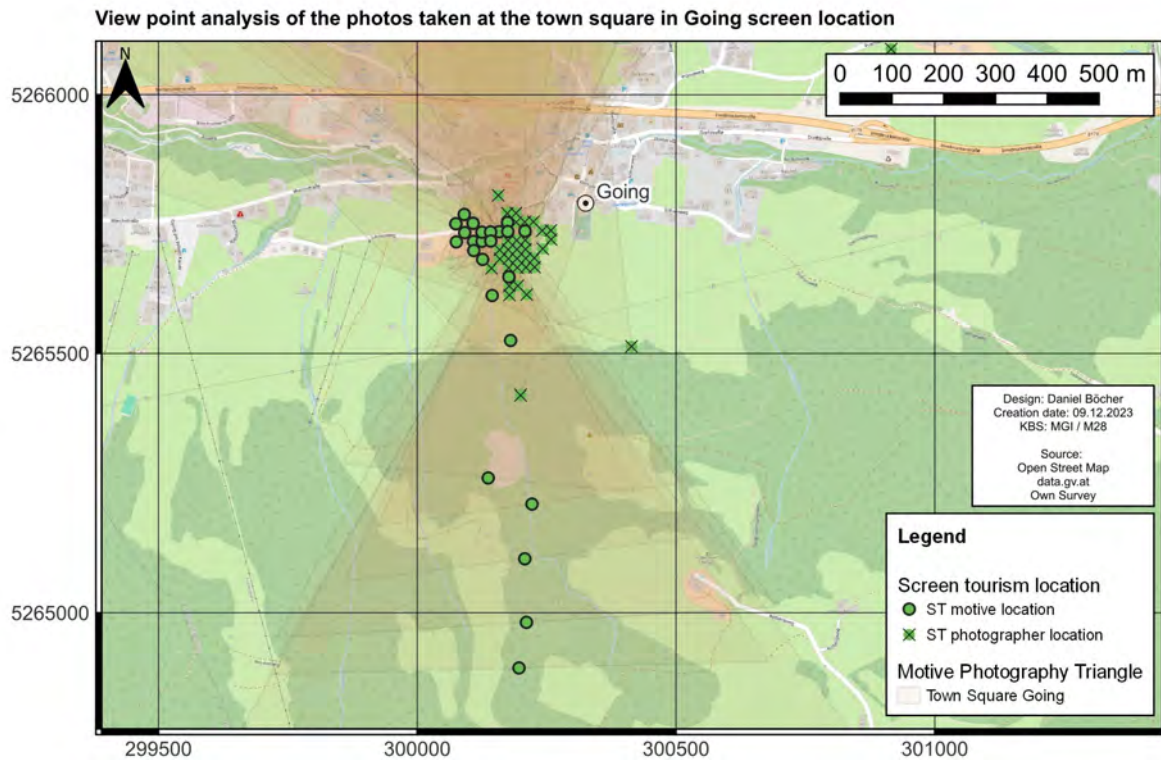


Figure 4.12: The Screen tourist perspective of every photographer at the screen location of the town square in Going (source: own map).

The stronger the color, the more perspectives are overlapping and showing the same place.

The Scheffau-gap

Scheffau am Wilden Kaiser, one of the four major WK towns, has minimal presence. Within a two-kilometer radius of the town center, there are only eight points, and only six in the mountain range north of Scheffau (map 4.9). The perspective analysis (map 7.6) just shows a gap between the Gruberhof and the BD practice screen location cluster. Scheffau is rarely photographed from or chosen as a central motive, and it's mostly not even visible in the background of other shots. It barely features in ST's Instagram communication. With good will the Hintersteiner Lake points can be counted towards Scheffau, but it still lacks the activity of the other towns, likely because the other towns have screen locations within their borders.

4.2 Social Media Communication of the Destination

4.2.1 Instagram description analysis

Words of destination places

"Reith" is the most prominent word for the Destination group, followed closely by "Ellmau" and "Wilder Kaiser". Geographical words are among the top words used. Other words in the top 100 word cloud (figure 4.13) related to places and towns in the area: "Reither", "Kitzbühel", "Going", "Auwirt" (name of a hotel), "Ellmauer", "Gruberhof" (screen location), "Bergdokterhaus" (same screen location). They generally write more about real places and place names at the destination than the fictional do screen locations. The screen location terms are on the same level as

general places like "Region" (Region), "zu Hause" (Home). This suggests that the Destination accounts do not talk about screen locations as much as expected. This is counterintuitive, because it is the only thing that connects their destination to the fictional universe of the BD series. And going further down the chain, it is the thing that brought the STs to the WK in the first place. But maybe they do not need to, as the fans already know everything about the BD, but have gaps about the real destination spaces.

Tourism communication

As a Destination, it is logical to use tourism communication jargon such as "Gäste" (Guest), "Besuch" (Visit), "Aussicht/Ausblick" (View), "Woche" (Week), "Tour", "Foto/Photo", "Infos" and "Urlaub" (Holiday) (figure 4.13). These words are normal tourist communication and the screen does not change that.



Figure 4.13: Word cloud of the top 100 words in the Destination group (source: own data). The larger the word, the more it was used. Same color means similar number of words.

It is all about the photo

It is quite obvious how much the Destination accounts use terms around the topic of photos (figure 4.13): "Bild", "Bilder", "Bildes" (picture with different inflections), "Foto/Photo" and a "Fotowettbewerb" (photo contest). They use it in different situations and in different languages, with a count of 163 times in 155 different posts. The Destination is the only group that uses the word "photo" in its English spelling. The word "Fotowettbewerb" is even more exclusive, as it is only used by the account @mehr_reith. This specific term is accompanied by the words "Einsendungen" (Transmittal), "Geldpreise" (Money prizes), "Gewinner" (Winner). Photos must be very important to the Destinations posting strategies in either a general description (probably to induce photo making by tourists) or a community call-to-action for UGC-content²⁰.

Screen tourism in the winter or summer?

The interview responses indicate that ST primarily occurs from spring to fall, with summer being the peak season. It's surprising that "Winter" appears frequently in the Destination group's top 100 words (figure 4.13), mentioned 20 times alone as well as 20 in combination phrases like "Winterspecial"²¹ "Winterstimmung" (Winter mood) or "Wintersportlerin" (Winter athlete). However, most posts mentioning "Winter" are not related to BD, using BD hashtags for more reach. Only official DMO accounts provide substantial BD content without just exploiting hashtags.²²

4.2.2 Instagram post metrics analysis

Instagram interactions

Likes and interactions 54 different accounts produced over 643 ST communication posts. These collected over 228 k likes with a mean of 355 per post and a median of 72. The large gap between the mean and the median indicates that there are a few strong posts that push the mean up. The maximum number of likes confirms this with a maximum of 6,779 and a minimum of 5. The standard deviation from the mean is only 916 likes. The top Destination accounts ranked by median likes (figure 4.2) are one national (@discoveraustria), a state account (@visittirol) and three regional (@wilder_kaiser, @skiweltwilderkaiserbrixental, @bezirk.salzburg). The rest of the account are local hotels (like @stanglwirt) and one real estate agent. What is immediately obvious is the enormous amount of likes the DMO account of

²⁰More on that in chapter 5.2 on page 224

²¹This is related to BD screen production. More info in chapter 3.4 on page 90.

²²e.g. the Instagram posts from the DMO account @koasamandl with post id BvMgXjgB6ed or from the ski area operator @skiweltwilderkaiserbrixental with post id B8lCsJfF0v.

Accounts	Sum of Likes	Median of Likes
@visittiro	13,773	3,574
@discoveraustria	2,566	2,566
@wilder.kaiser	162,049	2,544
@stanglwirt	4,806	2,403
@skiweltwilderkaiserbrixental	2,216	487
@bezirk.salzburg	336	336
@hotel_leitenhof	945	218
@engelvoelkerstirol	207	207
@hotelderbaer	413	207
@sport_hotel_ellmau	181	181

Table 4.2: Top ten Destination Accounts by median likes

the WK has collected. With over 162 thousand likes it leaves a big gap to the next account of the state DMO account @visittiro. The high amount of likes is relatively easy to explain with the sheer amount of additional posts the WK DMO makes: With 60 posts in the corpus it is again the most active, @visittiro comes in second with only four different posts.

Comments The Destination posts collected 6,336 comments, with a mean of ten and a median of one. This suggests that there are a few posts with a lot of comments that push the mean up to ten, and a long tail of posts with only one comment or even less. ST communication posts have the potential to reach high numbers, but many of them do not produce a response from people who want to express themselves below the post. The maximum number of comments per post is 750, with a minimum of 0. The standard deviation of comments is 40. Only three accounts are in the 95th percentile, which represent the majority of the Destination accounts' comments: @wilder.kaiser, @hotel_leitenhof and @jodlhof.

Popular accounts and posts

The key factors of success of @visittiro The four posts that boosted the DMO account @visittiro to the top of the interaction ranking are shown in figure 4.14. Their success is largely due to Instagram's follower-based algorithm. With over 182k followers at the time of the study, @visittiro has a higher reach and interaction potential. Other key factors for their success include high-quality photos (Which is perfect for Instagram) and direct engagement with ST themes, such as showing BD screen locations (figure 4.14) and providing additional ST information in the descriptions. For example, a story (figure 4.14 (d)) that perfectly illustrates the power of ST: "When

the Ferdigg and Wohlschlager families made the 'Gruberhof' [...] available for filming, they never expected that the series would one day be so successful. Then the ratings skyrocketed and there was no stopping it. 'With the tourism association, we thought about the solution with guided tours and fixed opening hours. The alternative would have been a three-meter fence around the house,' says Margit Ferdigg. 'Once six young girls came, about 20 to 25 years old. Each one knew a little German. After the tour, we learned: They are from Hawaii. We were already thinking: Are we in the wrong movie? The women went to Tyrol especially for four days to see the series environment. They watch every episode on the Internet in Hawaii.' [...] (Translated by [deep1.com](https://www.deep1.com); post id COa1NH5I2mG)" It demonstrates everyone's awareness of the powerful inducing qualities of screen products. The audience of the account obviously (literally) likes these stories that give a little peek behind the curtain.

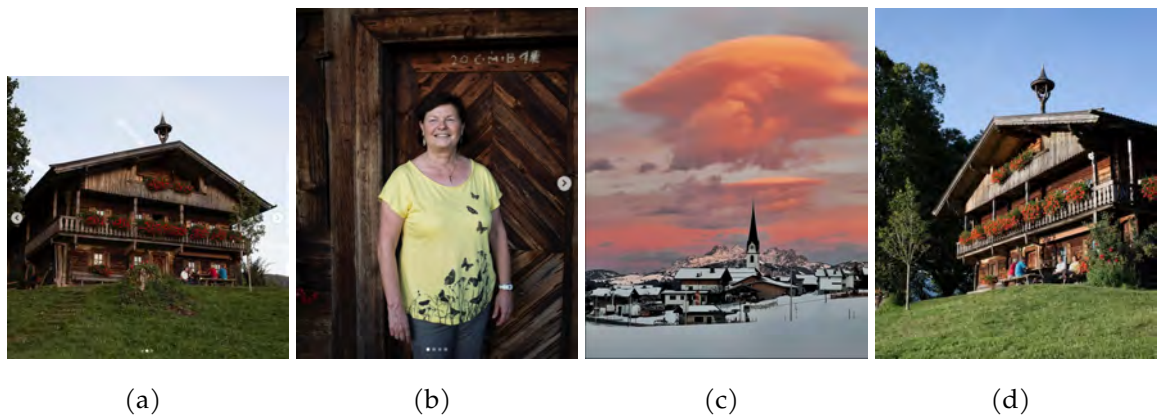


Figure 4.14: The four successful posts of the DMO account @visittirool: (a) , (b) and (d) are posts about the screen location of the Gruberhof and a story about its real life owner. (c) A post about the Bergdoktor practice.

Source: Instagram screenshot with post ids (a) BijlBTpAt1F, (b) B1x7zi-glF6, (c) CM2rXpIgYAj, (d) COa1NH5I2mG

Best practice posts The regional DMO account @wilder.kaiser dominates the top five most successful accounts. Only one post is from the state account @visittirool (post id CM2rXpIgYAj). The most successful Destination post has 7,135 interactions and is from @wilder.kaiser. It is an album of the town square of Going am Wilden Kaiser (post id CLrdQ4xl1wV) - The album post is not just a regular collection of photos but a 360-degree photo divided into five overlapping, swipeable photos, showcasing a professional best practice technique. The description reads: "The most famous square in Tyrol? [...] (Translated by [deep1.com](https://www.deep1.com))", indirectly referencing the BD series where the square appears in almost every episode. This technique, combined with the screen location's fame, makes for a calculable highly successful

post. Two other top-five posts also feature this town square.

Off-location posts The other successful posts show the town of Ellmau (post ids B7To0xAqbfm and CM2rXpIgYAj). They do not directly show a screen location, but with Ellmau they probably have the town that is most closely linked to the fictional narrative of the BD of the real towns at the WK. These posts about Ellmau demonstrate that you do not have to show a direct screen location to make a successful post, although Ellmau is definitely linked to the fictional universe of the BD. The transition shots in the BD series mentioned earlier (page 86) look similar to these photos. The question now is whether the DMO accounts modeled these posts after the aesthetics of these transition shots in the TV show, and whether they are so successful because users recognize the motifs - and maybe it is booth.

The true past amidst overlapping fictional narratives The only post from the DMO account @visittiro1 (post id Ibid.) in the top five is about Ellmau and tries to solve something many destinations with famous screen locations struggle with. It tries to show the real history of the place, which is in danger of getting lost behind the fictional stories of the place. @visittiro1 tries to use the BD content to show the history of the town and its families: "Ellmau is literally a picturesque town on the Wilder Kaiser. In addition to the view of the Wilden Kaiser, Hans Sigl has also become a fixed part of the townscape of Ellmau. His 'mountain doctor's house', the Hinterschnabel-Hof, dates back to the middle of the 17th century and has become a kind of landmark of Ellmau. A lively exchange of people, goods and information has always characterized Ellmau am Wilden Kaiser - and not just since the Bergdoktor was filmed in Ellmau. The town is located on the route between Innsbruck and Salzburg; there was already a post station here in 1616. The 'Hotel Alte Post' is still run by the same family that provided the Ellmau postmasters for a long time. [...]" (Translated by deep1.com; post id Ibid.)" It is again a repost from a local Tyrolean. The description tells the story of how the main actor of BD became part of the townscape of Ellmau. The screen location of the BD practice is linked to the real history of the 17th century building called Hinterschnabel-Hof. But it is not this historical background that makes the building a landmark, but rather its current use as a screen location! In the next sentence they express (post id Ibid.) that the exchange of "people, goods and information" was already part of the town of Ellmau when the BD production started filming. They give the example of an old Ellmau family that still runs the Hotel Alte Post (Old Post), which literally was the old post office their ancestors worked for. Especially the last sentence conveys the implicit criticism to look behind the fictional history of the place to see the real history of the town and its real inhabitants. It is this history that made the town what it is today, and the BD only uses it. It is only seen by the DMO as an addition to the view of the WK.

The tokens of the most successful posts In the top 100 posts by median interactions, 23 different terms appear more than four times, originating from 16 different Destination Accounts. The most common word is "Photo" (21 times), likely due to photo credits in reposts (21, table 4.3). The second most used keyword is "Bergdokter" (20 times), and together with its article "Der Bergdokter" (place eight, six times), this is highlighting the strong ST communication. The town of "Ellmau" is mentioned 17 times and "Wilder Kaiser" 14 times (table 4.3), indicating their importance both geographically and in the BD narrative. Ellmau is not only the geographical center of the region, but also the center of the fictional universe in the BD series, which apparently translates into the ST communication of Instagram. Wilder

Kaiser is *the* word of the region best known to the BD fans and tourists alike as its the official name of the DMO and is often mentioned in the BD show. These two areas of reality and fictional setting seem to be superimposable and that is the explanation why they are so successful in these posts. The town "Going" appears seven times (table 4.3), reflecting its role in the series²³. despite being a smaller town. "Gruberhof"²⁴, a key location in the BD series, is used six times (table 4.3), underscoring its significance in generating user interactions.

The term "Gruberhof" generates more interactions than "Wilder Kaiser" and "Ellmau" (figure 4.15). While "Wilder Kaiser" and "Ellmau" might be overused, "Gruberhof" attracts more attention due to its significance in the BD series and targeted use. Similarly, "Going" receives more interactions than the frequently used "Bergdokter", despite being mentioned less often. This suggests that varied and specialized posts could be more engaging than repeatedly using major locations and keywords.

Expected post and tokens performance

Expected post performance The expected median of interactions was 82, and the actual published posts were around 74 interactions. This means that ST communication from the Destination accounts performs worse than other posts from those accounts. This is a small difference of minus eight interactions. Because these small

Token	Count
"Photo"	21
"Bergdokter"	20
"Ellmau"	17
"Wilder Kaiser"	14
"schon" (already)	13
"Bild" (picture)	10
"wer" (who)	10
"Der Bergdokter"	8
"Going"	7
"Gruberhof"	6

Table 4.3: Top ten used tokens of the top posts (source: own data).

²³The full ranking of important locations in the BD narrative is on page 87 in chapter 3.4.

²⁴Interestingly, the name "Gruberhof" is not the real name of this place (which is Köpfinghof), but the first part "Gruber" is the surname of the fictional family in the BD series.

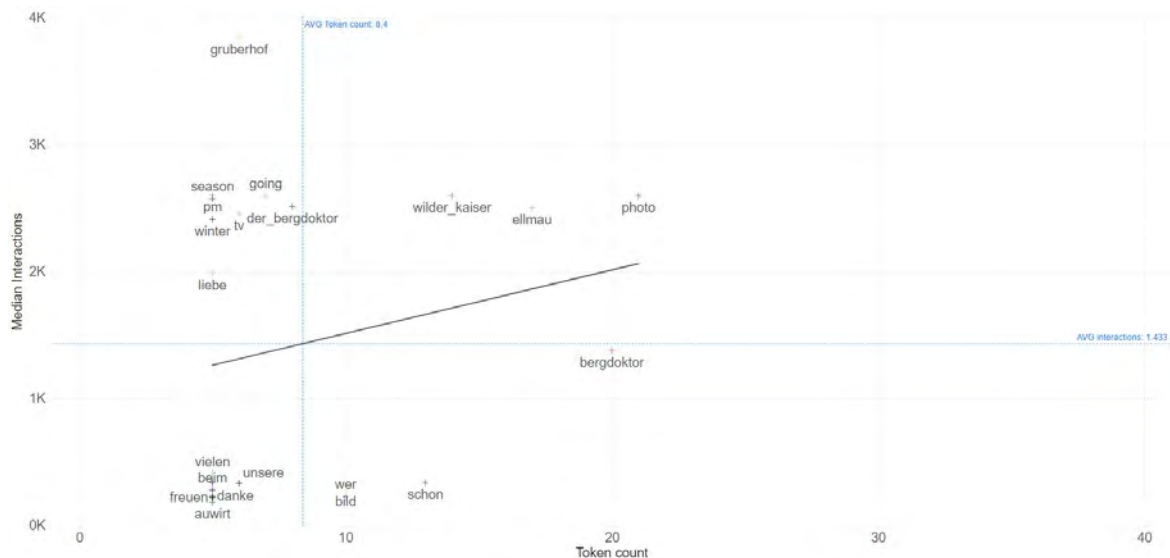


Figure 4.15: The top 100 Destination posts by median interactions with more than five uses (source: own data).

differences may just be a normal variation, these values do not indicate that ST communication always or mostly performs worse.

Towns of Tyrol The word "Reith" (town near the WK) is used a lot, but many terms are more successful than that. This adds to the findings that the closer you get to the center of the WK and BD screen locations, the more successful the tokens and posts become. "Ellmau" and "Wilder Kaiser" are used less and perform better. You can also see that "Going" is used even less, but generates a better score than "Wilder Kaiser" and "Ellmau".

At home at Wilder Kaiser More interesting is the use of the word "Zuhause" (at home) with less usage but high performance. Half of the posts using this word had nothing to do with the BD. The topics associated with the word feel similar to the themes regularly discussed in the BD series. At least two posts (an example here with figure 4.16) refer to a documentary called "At home with the mountain doctor"²⁵. The documentation also uses "Home" in the title because it picks up on themes from the TV show. At first glance, many of the posts with the term "Zuhause" have no connection to the BD, but that is wrong as it is just not a direct one. There is no connection in terms of content, but in the leitmotif of BD tv, which makes all the shallow unconnected posts connected to the BD.

Bergdoktor terms "Bergdoktor" has an above-average appearance (which was predictable), but also an above-average success. The term "Bergdoktorhaus" (another word for "Gruberhof") has a below average appearance with an above average performance. Since "Gruberhof" is the name of the fictional location, the term "Bergdok-

²⁵For a small summary of the documentation go to chapter 3.5 on page 95



Figure 4.16: A post from @koasamandl that writes about the Bergdokter documentation (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id COunhoFqOsl).

torhaus" tends to the real side, since it does not use the name of a fictional character, but the extradiagetic title of the series. The posts that contain this screen location perform very well. Not only in absolute numbers of interactions, but also in relation to the average of the other posts of the accounts.

In echt noch schöner

The DMO-created hashtag #inechtnochschöner, meaning "even more beautiful in real life," was used 258 times, primarily by the DMO accounts @Wilder.Kaiser and @Koasamandl. It was rarely used by ST or Production accounts in their ST communication. This hashtag is part of the DMO's strategy to build an image, suggesting that the real-life experience surpasses what is shown as photos and in advertisements²⁶, promising an ideal vacation. However, as a marketing tool, it lacks traction outside these DMO accounts.

4.2.3 Trace Interviews Answers

A recommended view

The account @hexenwasser discusses (see page 127) the photo frame (figure 4.17)

²⁶That this is not an empty claim was already proven by the answers of the STs in the trace interview in chapter 4.1 on page 106.

installed on their property. This frame offers a recommended view that includes a BD screen location, subtly communicating to those familiar with it.²⁷ Unlike tourists who avoid including the frame in their photos, @hexenwasser uses it to promote their attraction. The view through the frame is a small highlight at the Hexenwasser Alp, creating a layered post that puts the physical photo frame at the WK into the digital frame of an Instagram post. This is the referential postmodern world visible through a tangible object and its communication.

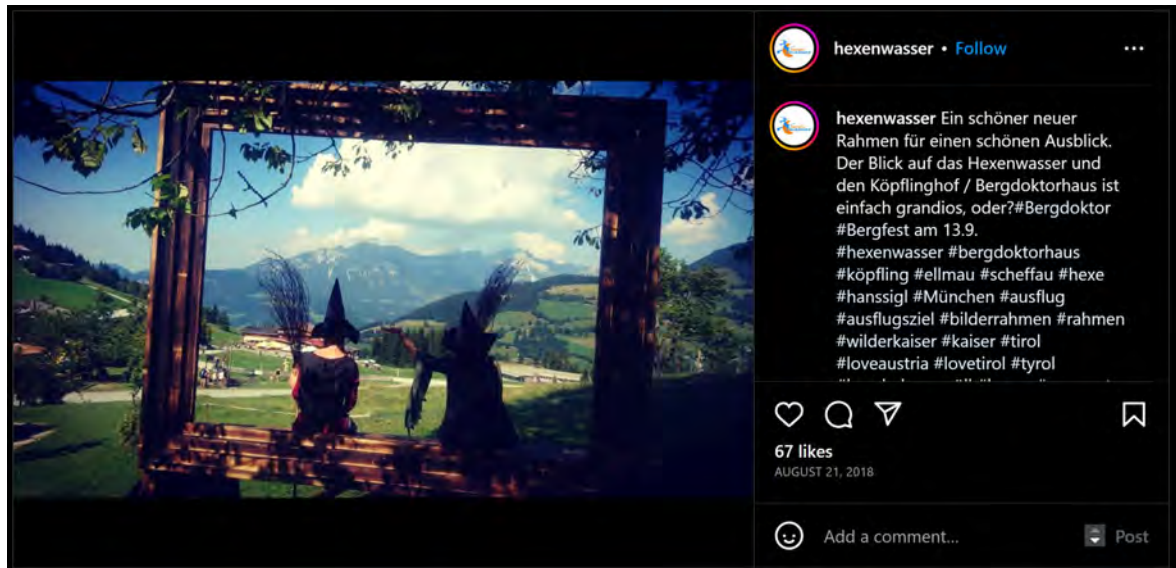


Figure 4.17: The photo frame in Hexenwasser has the Gruberhof firmly in view (source: Instagram screenshot with post id Bmu3VOdngGL).

Text

A professional approach The Destination accounts have a more professional approach to the descriptions of their Instagram posts. For example, their motivation is "Appropriate text to reach the target audience (post id Bmu3VOdngGL)" or "Apartment info (post id CQeDwZxjHtP)". The descriptions and other parts of the posts are professional and, unlike the (ST) influencers, they can say this actually more freely: "The text is intended to encourage followers to share their personal experiences related to the Bergdoktor practice. (All quotes translated by deep1.com; post id B_SeQyzlPop)"

Fictional stories connect to personal experiences As shown in figure 4.18²⁸, the post encourages tourists to share their experiences. The connection to the BD is not directly mentioned and only hinted at. By linking fictional BD stories from the past 15 seasons to the building and the tourists' personal realities, it prompts reactions

²⁷The subliminal ST communication is further explained on page 125.

²⁸It is actually one of the few posts that are written in english.



Figure 4.18: This post from the Destination account @wilder.kaiser encourages the ST to tell their stories (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id B_SeQyzlPop).

and comments on Instagram. The blend of reality and fiction that is a priori part of a screen location naturally extends to professional ST communication on the platform. Screen location serve as an ideal backdrop for ST experiences, getting intertwined with the BD series narrative. The goal of the post was to spark conversations about "personal experiences", and it succeeded, garnering more comments than the median. Post like in figure 4.18 show these normally hidden phenomena and make them visible to science.

Subliminal screen tourism The average post is similar to the one in the figure 4.19: Fans are almost never directly mentioned or focused on in the post, as the approach is more subliminal. The phrase "If you know, you know" is a colloquial expression²⁹, that seem to apply to most of the DMO posts in the corpus. The post features a beautiful photo of the WK Guesthouse and the town square in Going, with only the hashtags hinting at the BD series and a subliminal "Wilder Kaiser" sign from the TV show in the background above the front door. Content like this³⁰ can be for tourists as well as BD fans because of its subliminal messaging tactic. Most Destination accounts

²⁹This phrase is typically used to imply that the knowledge or understanding of a particular subject, joke, or situation is exclusive to those who are directly familiar with it. A thing that seems typically for tourism and especially for the sign heavy ST.

³⁰For example: post ids CB1GM6HDkXI, B7To0xAqbfm, CLrdQ4xl1wV, COqIU_qlMYz and more.

would not risk cutting out all the potential tourists they could have reached with subliminal ST communication.



Figure 4.19: A post from the Destination account @wilder.kaiser in a neutral tone (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CIX8qSUFyPD).

Photo

Professional strategies Even vor the professional Destination accounts the motivation for a certain photo is sometimes between vague and an eventuality (Example post id B-pElxgDExJ) but a lot seem again very professional: "Photo of a guest with interior and great surroundings in good weather to attract guests (post id CE_81ZajsBl)" or "Apartment Info (All quotes translated by deep1.com; post id CQeDwZxjHtP)".

One photo is sometimes enough Especially, the account of @wilder.kaiser is aware of social media methods and what they assume how the ST would react: "The motive: mountain doctor's office was chosen because the followers 'recognize' this place and thus a good reach can be achieved (Translated by deep1.com; figure 4.18)". They know full well that veteran ST and BD fans (who could have never been to the WK) will recognize the screen location and react accordingly. They know how prominent and recognizable the building is! The photo becomes self-explanatory to the BD fan without any hint in the text. The photo in this constellation is the crucial point to recognize the post as ST communication about the BD, and the reach as well as interactions after that is in most cases a sure-fire success.

Hashtag

The use of hashtags is the height of professionalism, as one of the accounts is using hashtags that an agency explicitly found and created for them (post id CE_81ZajsBl). For the other Destination accounts it is pretty much the same as they state that it is for advertising.

Hashtags of the Wilder Kaiser The hashtags of the @wilder.kaiser are explained in detail in the trace interview response: "The hashtags are partly our 'standard hashtags' e.g. #wilderkaiser #tirol #ellmau. Some are due to the Corona situation at the time, e.g. #thinkpositive #stayhealthy #werreisenliebtverschiebt #innaherferne. And the others (#bergdoktorpraxis #bergdoktor #urlaubimkopf) are used so that the contribution of the desired target group (Bergdokter fans) is played out. (Translated by deep1.com; post id B_SeQyzlPop)" This account demonstrates a detailed understanding of the complex social media landscape. Their hashtag strategy is divided into three parts: "standard hashtags" for a general audience, situational hashtags relevant during specific events like the Corona crisis, and hashtags targeting BD fans. The second group's situational hashtags like #urlaubimkopf is showing how severely the corona crisis impacted Tyrol, highlight how the pandemic affected (screen) tourism at WK.³¹

Holidays at home The hashtag "#urlaubimkopf" (engl.: vacation in the head) was sorted by the response answer (quote from post id Ibid. on page 127) into the group of BD hashtags. So the Destination account is implying that the ST experience or - even before that - being a fan of the BD sitting in front of the tv is like taking a vacation in your head. It could be that exactly these thoughts are the inducing push that tips the BD fan over the edge of becoming a ST to the WK destination. Looking at the time the hashtag was used another reason might also be possible: Corona, because the other hashtags used are for example "#werreisenliebtverschiebt" (Engl.: those who love to travel postpone), which were typical (perseverance) slogans at the time of the global pandemic. If you actually *postpone your travel*, then the only thing left in the pandemic is a *vacation in your mind*.

Fanfest at the WK The account @hexenwasser explains their motivation for the post in figure 4.17: "In September we have the Bergdokter Fan Fest at Hexenwasser. During the Bergdokter week (around the festival) we offer special programs for Bergdokter fans. Autograph session with the actors (Monika Baumgartner, Ronja Forcher...) The photo frame of the Hexenflugschule offers a wonderful view of the Gruberhof. However, we do not have a film location on the Hexenwasser Alp. The

³¹It shows that it is worth exploring, but it is outside the scope of this work and could be done in subsequent research or by probably countless other scholars in the near future.



Figure 4.20: The Destination account @hotel.hochfilzer advertises the BD fan-fest in the photo and the description (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CIX8qSUFyPD).

film tourists [...] (Translated with deep1.com; post id Bmu3VOdngGL)"³² Hexenwasser hosts the BD Fan Fest, a major tourist event organized twice a year by the WK DMO. As a local attraction, Hexenwasser provides the venue and amenities, recognizing the importance of ST tourists. Despite lacking a screen location³³, they attract BD fans through this tangible event. Other Destination accounts also promote this event on Instagram (figure 4.20), making Hexenwasser a must-visit for BD fans during that time. With the event they create an additional touch point for engaged STs and by that enhancing the appeal of the WK destination.

4.2.4 Geolocation Analysis

Geo located photos

Heatmap of the overall photo data The Destination has two major hot spots and one that is less dense (map 4.21). The first is around the Gruberhof with 89 posts from 12 accounts, including Jodlhof, Ferienbauernhof, and Hexenwasser Alp. The

³²The answer from the trace interview seems incomplete because it cuts off in the middle of the last sentence.

³³they only offer a view of one of the screen locations, the Gruberhof, through a photo frame. It was already mentioned in a paragraph above on page 123.

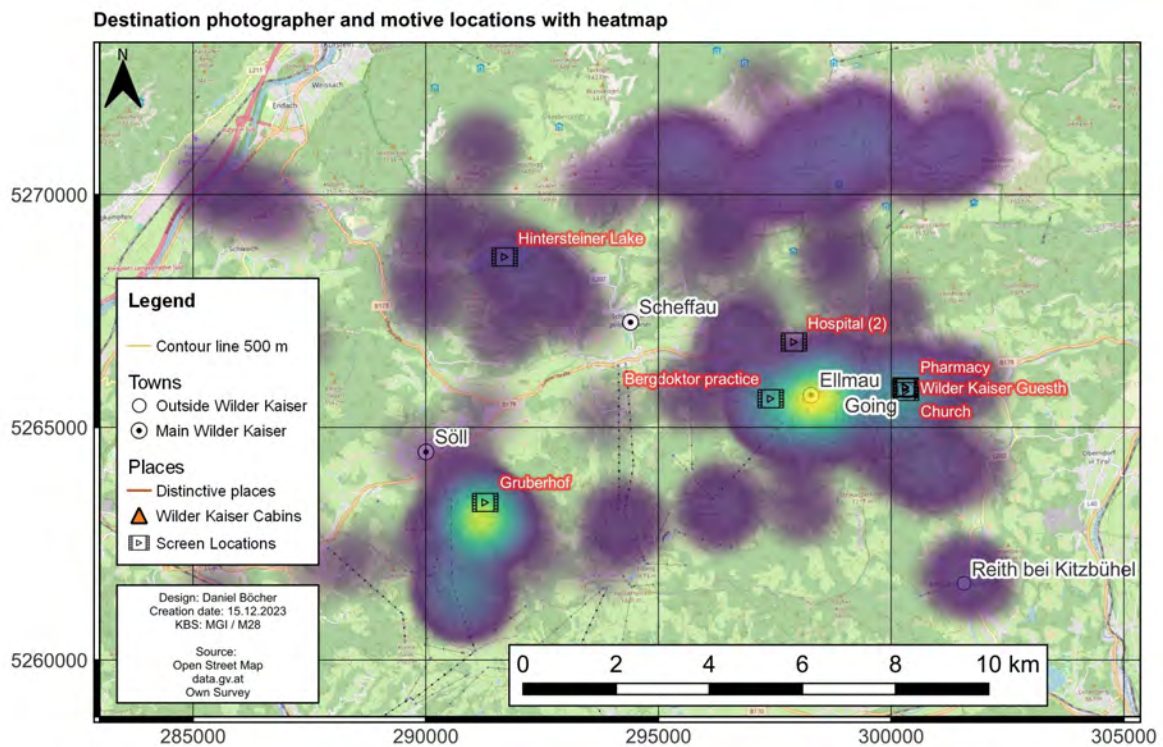


Figure 4.21: A heat map of the Destination photos with photographer and motive points (source: own map).

second hot spot is Ellmau and Going am Wilden Kaiser, with 147 posts from 19 accounts. A third, more spread-out area covers the WK mountain range in the north with 57 posts from 17 accounts. Other points are too scattered to form hot spots. Activity mostly stops west of the Gruberhof and east of Going, concentrating on the south side of the WK valley.

Heatmap of the photographer Looking only at the positions of the photographers of the Destination photos, the hot spot above the Wk mountains has disappeared. The other two hot spots look the same, as they are still clustered in the same areas around the Gruberhof and the Ellmau and Going screen locations as before. If you zoom into the hot spot around Ellmau (map 7.8), it splits into three sub-hot spots with the two screen locations of the BD practice and the town square and Ellmau in the middle. Ellmau has the most photographer points in the hot spot with 38 posts from 10 different accounts. This is interesting as this part of the down does not have a major or regular screen location. But Ellmau is probably the town that is most connected to the BD TV show as it is mentioned in the narrative of the show and the communication about the BD show in other media.

Heatmap of the motive The hot spot of points above the WK range is back if you look at the isolated motive points in the map 4.22. The other clusters are still the same as for the photographer points. The points of the motives of the WK moun-

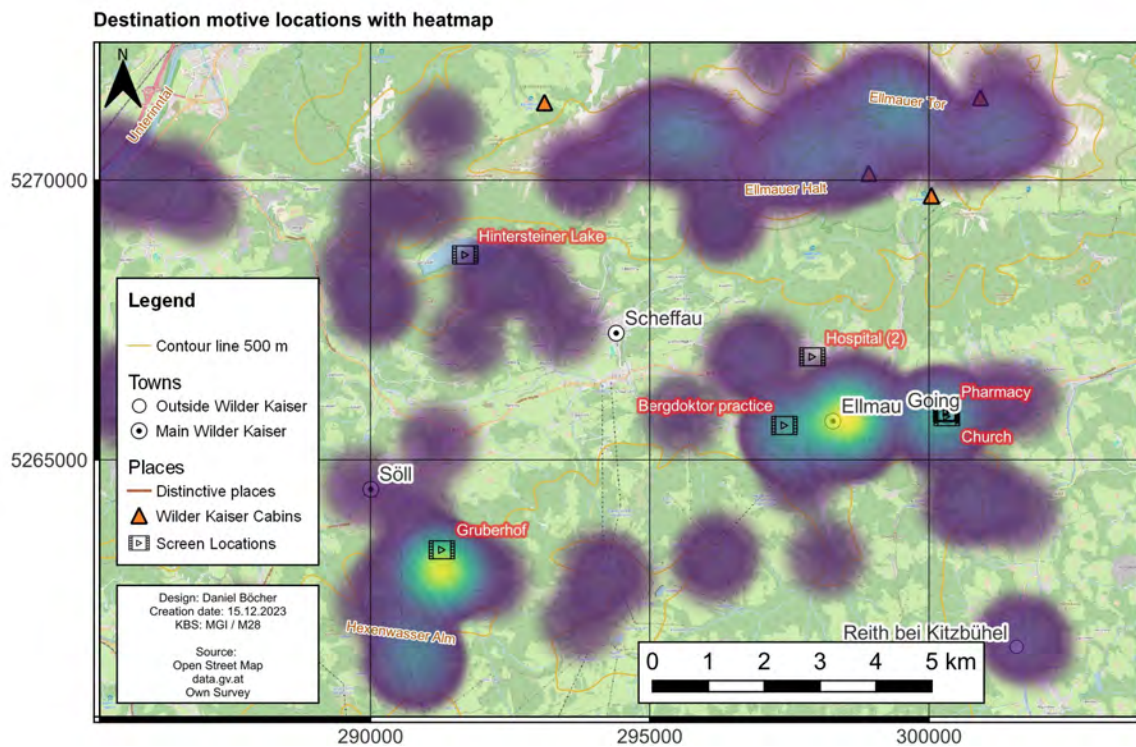


Figure 4.22: A heatmap of the Destinations photos with motive points (source: own map).

tain are located all along the mountain range from the west to the east. They can be found wherever the rough rock of the WK mountains rises above the tree line. A slightly denser center can be found at the Ellmauer Gate in the visual center of the range, just behind the main town of Ellmau. The hot spot of the motives above the WK mountain range probably also explains the many photographer points in the town of Ellmau. As the connection analysis in figure 4.24 will show are these photos from Ellmau not photos of the town but of the WK mountains.

More perspectives on one motive The screen location clusters of the Destination offer different perspectives (Figure 4.24). The Gruberhof screen location offers an almost 180-degree view. Located higher in the valley, it offers better angles and the opportunity for panoramic shots. Many photos of the BD practice and the town square focus inward, without showing distant backdrops. The diagonal connections

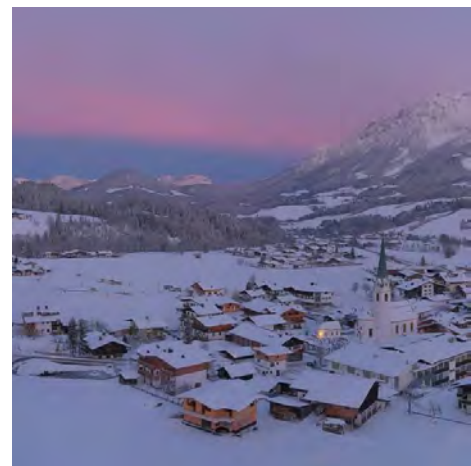


Figure 4.23: A rare perspective along the Wilder Kaiser valley (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CKioKeBjJs-).

from the Ellmau cluster to behind the Hintersteiner lake are the few exceptions like in figure 4.23. For the rest: When photos are not focused on their own architecture, their main perspective is towards the WK mountains - a common theme in photos both inside the clusters and outside clusters. Most photos with distant backgrounds show views from south to north (figure 4.24), across the valley toward the WK mountain range. So it seems that except for the photos that focus solely on the architecture of a screen location, all other photo motives show the exalted WK mountains.

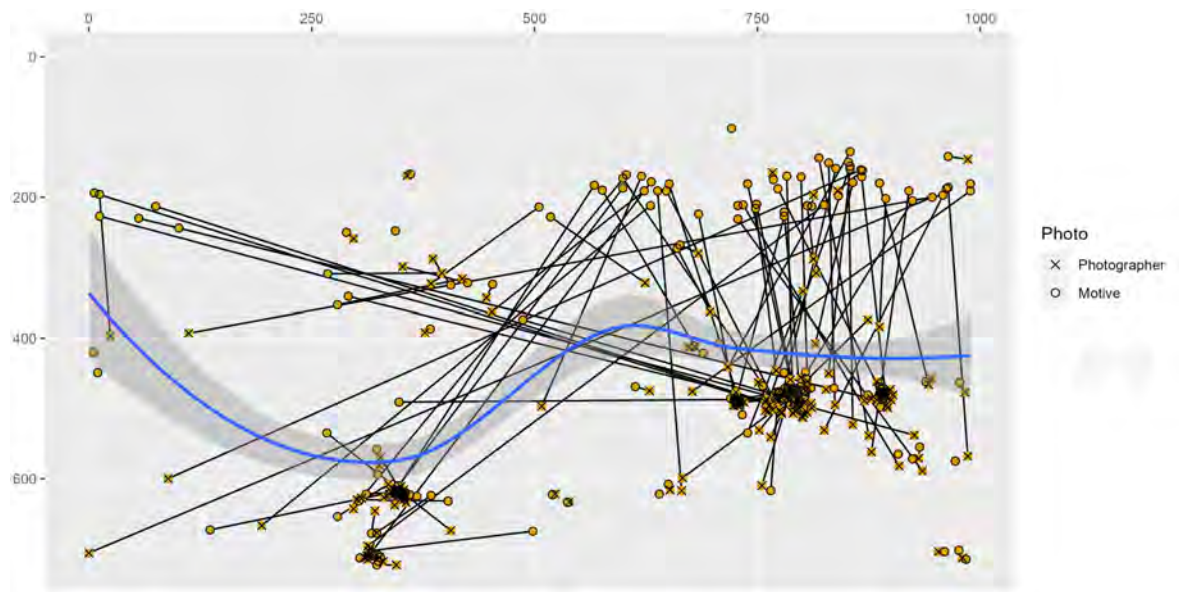


Figure 4.24: The connections of the Destination photos with photographer and motive positions (Source: Own Data). The blue line is the regression line with the confidence interval in grey.

4.3 Social Media Communication of the Production

Looking at all the posts from the Production, it is very quickly obvious that the actors dominate the posts. Not only the number of posts, but also the performance as shown in paragraph 134. Also, there are only a few non-actor accounts visible in the corpus. The account of @zdfmediathek is performance wise (table 4.5) and a photo of a cameraman on an aesthetic level (figure 4.29) are exotic examples.

4.3.1 Instagram Description Analysis



Figure 4.25: Word cloud of the top 100 words in the Production group. The larger the word, the more it was used. Same color means similar number of words. (Source: own data)

because they are at the WK for work, not vacation, and their public social media presence reflects their professional roles. This context is important when analyzing their photos and descriptions.

Actor names Also in this category are the names of a BD character such as "Linn Kemper/Linn" and an actress "Monika Baumgartner" (figure 4.25). The actress of Linn Kemper is young and very active on social media with her account @andrea-gerhard_tall_area. All 13 mentions of the name come from this account - The ac-

Fokus on the screen product

Screen product terms The screen product is at the center of their communication (table 4.4): "Bergdoktor" (59), "ZDF" (49, name of the channel), "Der Bergdoktor" (35) and "Staffel" (32, season) in the top 20 most used words and more in the top 100: "Casting", "Winterspecial"³⁴, "Set", "Drehtag" (Shooting day), "ORF" (The Austrian TV channel for the BD), "Kollegen/Kolleginnen" (colleagues), "Dreharbeiten" (Shooting), "Kamera", "Regie" (Director) and "arbeiten" (working). The Production team frequently discusses the screen production itself (figure 4.25)

³⁴More information about why this is a production term can be found on the page 146.

count of the actress herself. The explanation of the high frequency of the name of the oldest actress in the ensemble of the BD "Monika Baumgartner" is a completely different story: It is most likely a technical artifact of the data transformation process explained in chapter 3.2 on page 75.

Tokens	Count	Tokens	Count
Bergdokter	59	immer	22
Heute	57	Grüße	21
ZDF	49	Jahr	20
Danke	43	Abend	20
Der Bergdokter	35	Morgen	18
Staffel	32	geht	18
schon	30	Wilder Kaiser	16
Liebe	29	Woche	16
mal	26	gehts	16
ganz	22	Ellmau	16

Table 4.4: Top Words of the Production

Time terms of the Production

Talking about time is very prominent in the descriptions of the Destination accounts: "Heute" (Today), "Jahr" (Year), "Woche" (Week), "Abend" (Evening), "Uhr" (Clock), "Drehtag" (Shooting day), "immer" ("always"), "Wochenende" (Weekend), "Tag" (Day), "Gestern" (Yesterday) and "Wochenstart" (Start of the week) are 11 different words in the top 100 used to express something related to time (Figure 4.25). The word today is used so often simply because of posts like this: "**Today** [Highlight D.B.] The 14th season of Bergdokter starts at 20:15 on ZDF. I hope you will be there. [...]" (Translated by `deep1.com`; Post id CKB_S4fFxDa)" The hole cast constantly posts about the new episodes that will air that day. These posts are often illustrated with photos from the set or sometimes screenshots from the episode. Screenshots from the set together with only the information about air times are probably on the edge of being a ST post, because the connection to the WK is weaker than to the screen product itself. The posts were picked up because they contained WK and DMO keywords (more about the process in chapter 3.2) in addition to the screen product keywords, which makes them ST communication by this definition (see chapter 2.1 on page 14). The use of the other time-related terms is similar, as they are either related to physical work on the set, or advertise something that will happen at some point in the future. Mostly they use photos from the set of the BD at the WK to illustrate these

kind of posts.

Account	Sum of Likes	Median of Likes	Post count
@ronjaforcher	199,816	8,807	22
@sigl_hans	25,546	7,333	3
@markkeller_official	143,884	3,087	35
@simon.boer	5,381	1,483	3
@natalieohara_official	15,206	1,461	10
@yekaterina.nesytowa	1,290	1,290	1
@lennartbetzgen	4,822	1,270	4
@sinatkotsch	1,061	1,061	1
@thedanielerizzo	866	866	1
@zdfmediathek	4,527	591	8

Table 4.5: Top accounts of the Production after likes

4.3.2 Instagram post metrics analysis

Instagram interactions

Basic interaction distribution The Production has collected over 450,000 likes with 234 posts from 29 different accounts. They have a mean of 2,000 likes and a median of 448 likes per post. The maximum number of likes per post is 15,000 and the minimum is 46, resulting in a standard deviation of 3,000.

Median and sum distribution of likes Production accounts with the most posts also have the most likes overall. However, table 4.5 orders them by median likes, showing that posting more doesn't guarantee success. For instance, the main actor's account, @sigl_hans, ranks second with just three BD-related posts. His higher likes-per-post ratio reflects his character's importance and his star power.

Millennial accounts profit In particular, the accounts of @andreagerhard_tall_area and @ronjaforcher benefit from their age, as they are part of the millennial cohort, which makes them part of the first Internet-affine generation. This makes social media posts a natural thing for them and their generation because they are more likely to have a social media account, follow them, and interact with them.

Two stations against the mighty actors Actors dominate the top Production accounts as expected due to their large followings and fame. Interestingly, the broadcasting channel's account, @zdfmediatheks, ranks 10th. This ZDF account is for the channel's SVOD portal. The Austrian BD broadcaster, @orf, ranks 12th, making it one of the only non-person accounts in the top 25 along with ZDF. The first non-actor or broadcaster account is a cinematographer at 21st place.

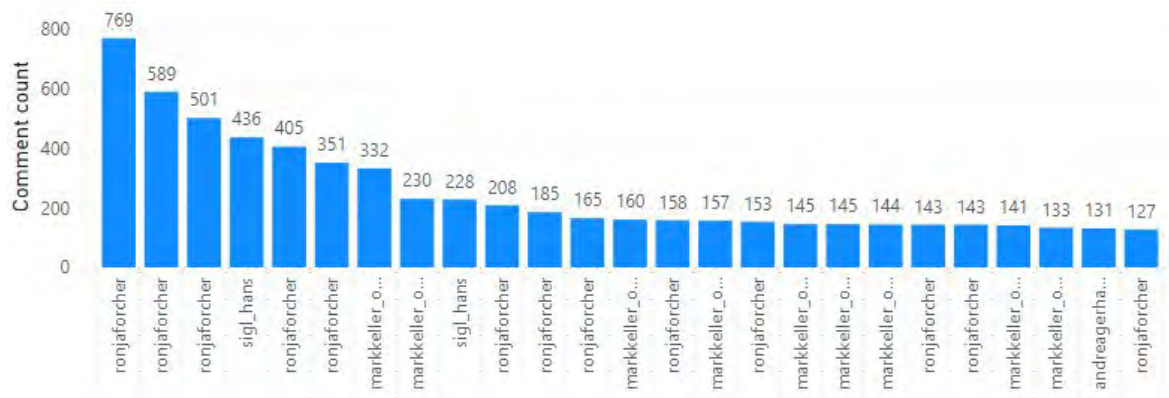


Figure 4.26: The top 20 posts from the Production by total comments (Source: own data).

Basic comments distribution The 234 posts from 29 different accounts have accumulated 11,000 comments. The minimum is 0 and the maximum is 769 comments on one post. The mean number of comments is 48 and the median is 18 per post. The standard deviation is 92 comments.

Documentminating comments for actor posts The main cast actors @ronjaforcher accumulates 4,700 comments, @markkeller_official is second with 2,900 and returning actress @andreagerhard_tall_area is third with 14,000. The top 20 basically mirrors the likes results in the table 4.5. The main character of the BD and his account @sigl_hans has the best comment to post ratio with 250 and a median of 228. He did this with only three posts and the account of his fictional daughter @ronjaforcher published 22 posts and only got a rate of 214 comments per post and a median of 143. Looking at individual posts (figure 4.26), @ronjaforcher dominates the first six places, interrupted only by a single post from @sigl_hans at place four. @markkeller_official comes in at places seven and eight.

Popular accounts and posts

The center of attention Looking at the top ten posts by interaction, it is clear that portraits of the actors themselves dominate (figure 4.27). In some of them you can see the background, in some it is the typical WK mountain panorama (post ids CQEdlD2nU7w, CP8nV88HpnN), in others you can see that the photos come directly from the BD sets (post ids CMkXkUnnp2, CJtqtqPHDlq). Only in three cases are other people visible in the photo (post id CQEdlD2nU7w)³⁵ and in two of them they are not actors (post ids CMkXkUnnp2, CQrBYX6nhzB). Eight of the top ten photos show the actress Ronja Forcher (figure 4.27 (a, c, d, f, g, h, i, and j)), and all of the posts are from her account. Two photos show the BD's lead actor, Hans Sigl

³⁵Not counting the dog in @markkeller_official posts in post id CLuYxVUFYPT

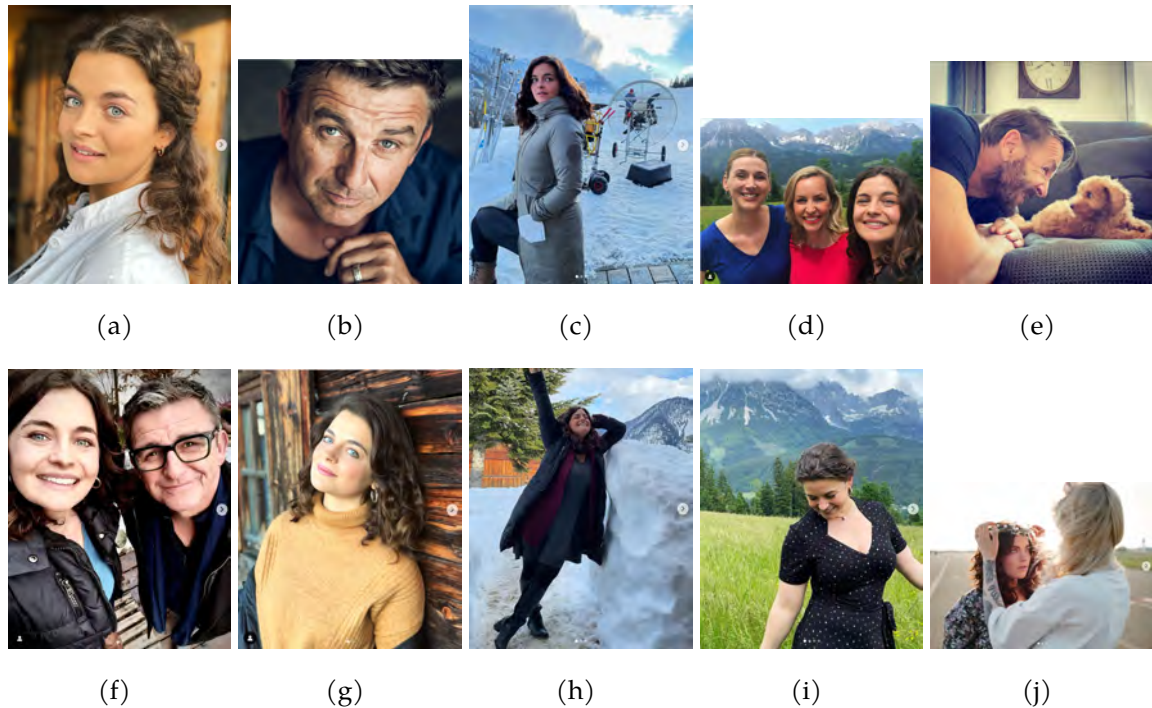


Figure 4.27: The top ten posts by interactions from left to right: (a) post id CPz5CrOndiH, (c) CMkXkUnnpg2, (d) CQEdlD2nU7w, (f) CI3c8GinJwD, (g) CJt-gtqpHDlq, (h) CMhy6SrHsPd, (i) CP8nV88HpnN, (j) CQrBYX6nhzB all @ronjaforcher (b) CPz3dg_hMEN @sigl_hans (e) CLuYxVUFYPT @markkeller_official (All source: Instagram screenshots)

(b, f), but only photo (b) is from his account. Photo (e) from the figure shows the lead actor Mark Keller, and photo (d) additionally shows the two returning actresses Andrea Gerhard and Simone Hanselmann. Individual photos of the account owners dominate the top 10, while there is only one group photo (d) and one photo with a dog (e).

Most successful posts Posts above the 95th percentile have a total of over 148,000 interactions on three different accounts. They have a median of 12,000 interactions with a maximum of 16,000 and a minimum of 9,700. Only three distinct accounts dominate the top 20 with their posts, similar to the figure 4.26. Most of them are Instagram albums with several photos and videos per post³⁶. The most successful post (figure 4.27 (a)) is from @ronjaforcher and has 15,700 interactions.

Holiday production Figure (figure 4.27 (a)) is an album post featuring various photos and a video of actress Ronja Forcher, taken at different BD production screen locations. In the description, she addresses the destination, writes about highlights from the set and mentions traveling to Tirol: "HERE WE GO AGAIN (emphasis in original) Attention attention, I'm on the train to Tyrol, the scripts in my luggage, full

³⁶For this study, only the first photo is analyzed in detail and asked for in the trace interviews

of anticipation! The 15th season is in the starting blocks, [...] (Translated by deep1.com; post id CPz5CrOndiH)" She writes about her mode of travel³⁷ and luggage, reflecting a typical ST scenario. The vibe is happy, with anticipation of the upcoming time, like she is going on a holiday. Although she is at the WK for work, not a holiday, is worded like the work is more like a holiday. Similarly, @davidlindermeiers collage from his one-time role also conveys a holiday vibe: "'In the mountains is freedom' (Wanda Rutkiewicz) dream location during the filming of @derbergdokterofficial [...]. (Translated by deep1.com; post id CQY7iJDppAE)"

Photos of the less relevant winter Winter is crucial for the WK's year-round tourism but less so for the BD series, which mostly sets episodes in summer, typically having only one winter special per season. However, two of the top Production posts (figure 4.27 c and h) are winter scenes with snow surrounding the actor. The third most popular post, photo (c), features Ronja Forcher on a snowy set with typical filming equipment like lighting stands, a wind machine, and a sled, likely a prop. The description suggests they are filming the season's finale, probably the winter special: "Season finale. Today. Awesome. For 14 years we've been allowed to tell this story, play these characters. Over half of my life. Thank you. Thank you guys, thank you for always looking at us, for being so supportive and loving. Tomorrow is the release of my single THANK YOU. (emphasis in original) I couldn't have dreamed of a better time. The song is for you guys. Here's to many more years together. Thank you to this colorful, awesome, crazy, loving ensemble, there would be no better colleagues for this rad journey together: [...]" (Translated by deep1.com; Post id CMkXkUnnpG2)" But the post is self-reflective of the last 14 years she plays her role in the BD series. The winter does not play a role in the description as it is neither mentioned or hinted at.

A layer of advertising atop of ST communication In the middle of the description (figure 4.27 (c)), she sneaks in a little promotion for her new single and ties it directly to the emotional theme of the post by thanking her co-actors as well as WK itself, represented by the DMO account of @wilder.kaiser. Considering that a social media account can be a mode of self-representation, especially in an influencer context: The post advertises the BD series, but also her upcoming music. These are different layers of promotion, stacked on top of each other, with the better known supporting the lesser known. From another perspective, she is taking the core values of the BD series and attaching them to her single, making an ST communication post effectively an advertisement for her single and helping to build her brand as an influencer, musician and actress. For the Production posts, this level of promotion

³⁷The trace interviews actually revealed that the preferred mode of traveling to the WK is the car but also a lot of bus and train.

and "Jahr" (Year) etc. are very popular (88 times) and generate a lot of interactions (average 2,890).

Token	Token count	Post count	Median of Interaction
Bergdoktor	39	37	3,133
Heute	32	28	2,979
Danke	26	15	8,622
ZDF	23	21	2,770
Staffel	17	12	7,474
ganz	16	12	7,342
Gewinnspiel	14	4	8,731
schon	14	12	1,638
Liebe	13	11	7,607
Abend	12	12	2,867

Table 4.6: Top ten Production tokens by median interactions and more than four uses

Expected post and tokens performance

18 out of 29 accounts have a median score above 1, indicating above-average performance in ST communication. Notably, @sigl_hans (2.2 score), @andreagerhard_tall_area (2.1), @ronjaforcher (1.6), and @markkeller_official (1.1) are above average but not leading like in the other metrics. @zdfmediathek also scores well with a score of two, placing fifth. Surprisingly, the top median scores belong to smaller accounts, @davidlindmeier and @supergraf, each with fewer than 5,000 followers (as of 16.06.23). These accounts only posted once, achieving significant success, highlighting that ST communication can be a powerful tool to get the attention of an audience you could not reach before.

The post of a cameraman The post by @supergraf is notable because it features one of the few photos made and showing a crew member behind the camera, specifically the cameraman (figure 4.29).³⁹ It focuses on the actual crew rather than the scenic backgrounds typical of BD ST communications. The photo shows the mountains and nature in the background but lacks the panoramic perspective seen in so many other photos of the corpus. The arrangement of people resembles a painting, emphasizing the crew and their work rather than the account owner. This contrasts with most Production photos but actually highlights the de-differentiation in actor-posts.

³⁹Despite being in English and not fully analyzed, @supergraf's account includes various work-related posts, including some from the BD production.

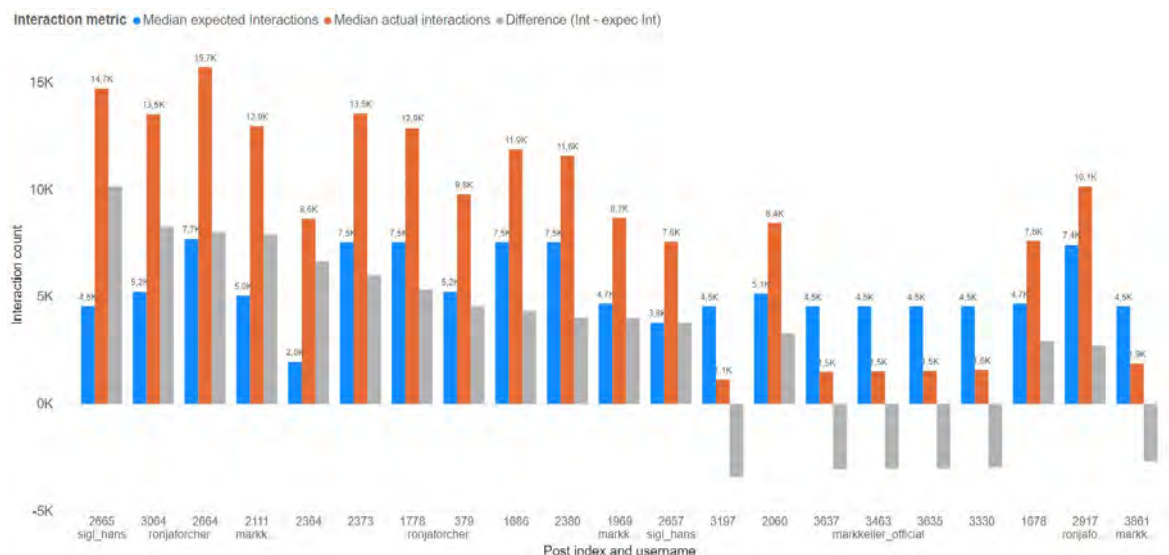


Figure 4.30: Top ten Production posts by median interactions of expected and actual performance (source: own data). Sorted by the absolute difference between actual and expected interactions.



Figure 4.29: Photo of the production crew behind the camera from the account @supergraf (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CKJ2cBqhex8).

Expected post performance The expected total median of Production interactions was 638, but the posts in the corpus had a median of 462, falling short by 176 interactions. This indicates that ST communication is not an effective tool for generating high interactions or growing the account. The analyzed ST communications for Production accounts generally do not perform as well as other content they produce. While they occasionally achieve viral success, their performance is ranging from unpredictable to disadvantageous. Factors outside the scope of this work, such as

the timing of new episodes, exclusive post content, promotional techniques and third people influence, could impact these outcomes. Figure 4.30 shows that big accounts like @sigl_hans, @ronjaforcher and @markkeller_official dominate the absolute interaction difference, with positive differences ranging from 10,000 to 4,000 interactions. For larger accounts, successful ST posts can feel like viral hits due to these high interaction differences.

Ms. Kemper is bound to the screen location of the Bergdoktor practice The tokens

"Macht" (make), "Frau" (woman), and "Kemper" (surname of Andrea Gerhard's character) are each used six times but generate high scores around 3.⁴⁰ The terms "Frau Kemper" and "Praxis" (practice) are notable, with "Praxis" (Score 2.4). These terms are used exclusively by @andreagerhard_tall_area, as her character is the receptionist for the mountain doctor in the practice, making this location central to her posts' descriptions.

4.3.3 Trace Interviews Answers

Disclaimer: The return rate of trace interviews from the Production was low, with only one individual providing input about their ST communication of the BD from the WK. Therefore, it is unnecessary to have different subparagraphs for the trace interview questions as in other chapters. The analysis is condensed into these brief paragraphs, representing the perspective of at least one individual, though not the entire Production group.

Photo and text

The freedom of the exalted alps The motivation for the post: "The saying at the beginning fits thematically to the mountains and is something 'special' at the beginning and makes you think. Then I thanked the people involved and wanted to express my joy at working for the project and in such a beautiful place. (Translated by deep1.com; Post id CQY7iJDppAE and figure 4.31)" As we saw in the token analysis, thanking people, the crew, and praising one's work as an actor is a common (table 4.4 or 4.6) theme in Production posts (see chapter 4.4.2 on page 153). The saying that makes you "think" as the interviewee wrote is: "In the mountains there is freedom" by Wanda Rutkiewicz. The saying is very simple and not very complex and multilayered, but it describes the established image of the alpine regions that has been built up over the last centuries. The feeling of freedom is built into the exalted Alps (page 22).

An uncommon portfolio The post's photo collage (figure 4.31) is unusual, combining various photos and the BD show's title. Unlike most accounts that use albums or simple filters, this is a collage with edited text in the BD corporate font on it. It looks like it just consists of plain photos likely taken with a cell phone during production breaks. The explanation reveals the collage was intended to showcase the project, the actor in costume and various shoot settings. It also supposed to offer a quick overview into a portfolio to see "at a glance what it's all about (Translated by

⁴⁰The two later terms are actually used exclusively together as a multi-word token, but this one slipped through the cracks of the Quanteda analysis (more info in chapter 3.2 75).

deep1.com; Post id CQY7iJDppAE)". It mixes typical production photos (e.g. figure 4.27) with professional destination photos (e.g. figure 4.14) and regular ST posts (e.g. figure 4.10).



Figure 4.31: A collage of photos from the screen production from actor account @davidlindermeier (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CQY7iJDppAE)

Professional use of hashtags and mentions

The specific hashtags in the post demonstrate professionalism and serve as a marketing tool. The actor uses Instagram as a portfolio to showcase current projects, similar to the influencer style posts of the ST group. He enjoys the process of choosing hashtags that match the project and place. He also aims to reach a wider audience. This shows his understanding of hashtags' power for self-marketing, as confirmed by the trace interview and other findings in this chapter.

Guidelines for posting

Guidelines for publishing BD content were not provided by the DMO, but the production company and broadcaster had some general rules as @davidlindermeier explains in his trace interview for his post in figure 4.31:

- Post scenes on social media only after the episode airs.
- Name the broadcasters and photographers involved.

- Always check permissions to stay safe but contracts usually cover this.
- 'Bergdokter' was lenient, allowing advance costume posts.

These rules are standard in media and focus on timing and credit rather than content style. The last point highlights the Production's flexible approach to sharing content. from an outside perspective on the content that is made by the Production in the corpus.

4.3.4 Geolocation Analysis

Geo located photos

Heatmap of the overall photo data The top hot spot in the Production photos heatmap (top and bottom map 4.33) is the BD practice screen location, with 23 posts from five accounts. This concentration is partly due to actress Andrea Gerhard, who frequently posts from her role as a doctor's assistant there. However, various Production accounts also post from this screen location. The second-largest hot spot, the town square screen location, has twelve posts from six accounts. Other notable places with higher photo density, though not true hot spots, are the Gruberhof screen location and above the WK's central mountain range near Ellmauer Tor. Points near Scheffau, Hintersteiner Lake showing a wide gap of activity between the east and the west side of the WK valley.⁴¹ The town of Ellmau is also missing from the data.



Figure 4.32: Photo of the screen location of the Bergdokter practice without a Wilder Kaiser mountain in the background (source: Instagram screenshot with post id CMP_sZDh9H2).

Heatmap of the photographer and motive The hot spots remain stable with many photographer points in the BD practice and town square screen locations (map 4.33 (top)). The hot spot above the WK mountains only exists for the photo motives (map 4.33 (bottom)). Production accounts likely do not hike extensively in the WK mountains due to work commitments, using the mountains as a backdrop instead.

⁴¹Same as the Scheffau Gap for the STs on page 115.

Small trips to ski hills like Hexenwasser or Hartkaiser are feasible due to their tourist infrastructure access as well as the BD fanfest that was at this place, luring production members to this place.

The Wilder Kaiser mountain motive

The perspectives of the Production photos from the BD practice and town square hot spots generally face the WK mountain range. The schematic in figure 7.9 illustrates pretty clear that photographers at these positions often aim north towards the WK mountains, especially near the Ellmauer Gate, from the south side of the valley.

Focus on the screen location

Posts in the BD practice cluster mainly focus on the screen location itself, with only three photos directed towards the WK mountain range. The screen location offers ample photo opportunities: an old alpine-style house, balcony flowers, props like cars and a decorated picnic table. The correlation is clear, as Production accounts logically often at the screen location when they are shooting scenes for the BD and the place is in its prime, with fresh flowers and available props, making the BD practice screen location the central focus, as seen in figure 4.32.

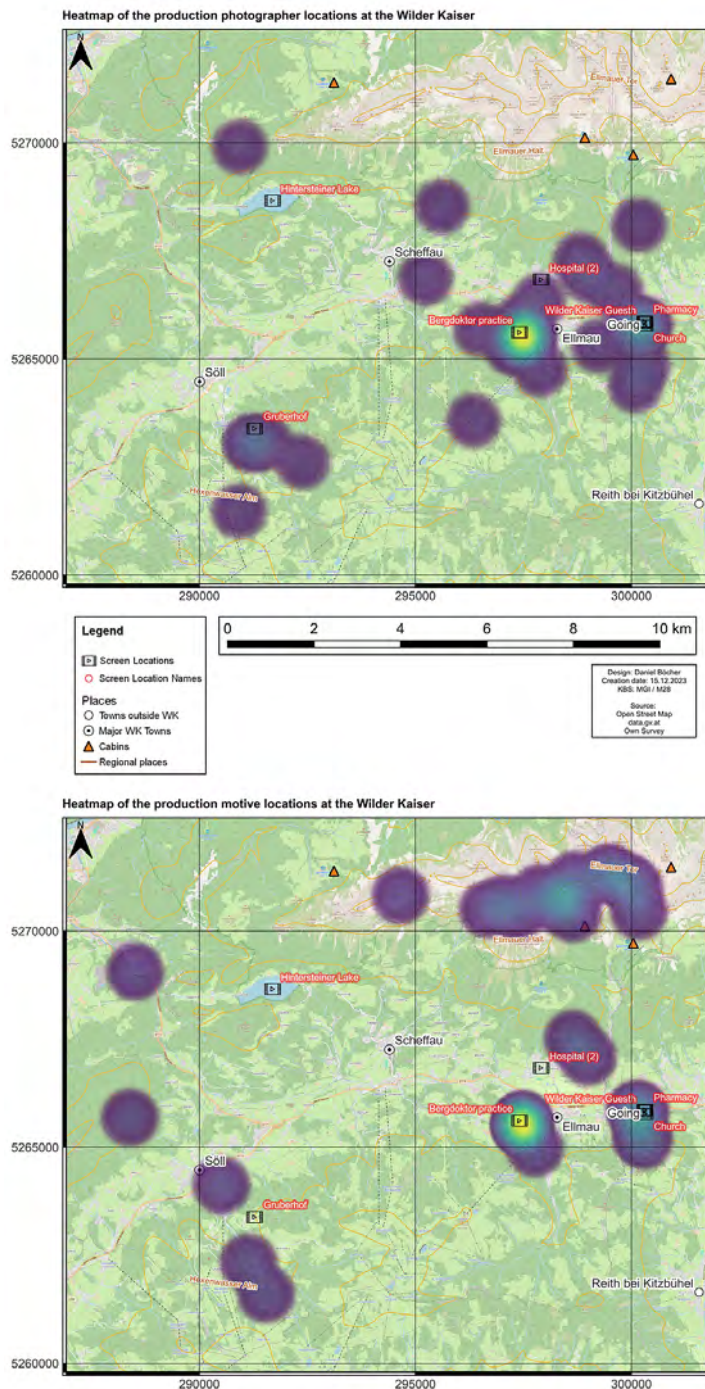


Figure 4.33: Heatmap of the Production accounts photographer (top) and motive points (bottom) (source: own data).

"Wilder Kaiser" (61), "Reither"⁴³ (39), and "Gemeinde" (31; engl. municipality). ST also highlight "Wilder Kaiser" (48), "Ellmau" (38), and "Going" (31). Production accounts primarily use the multi word phrase "Wilder Kaiser". These are just the words for real places and towns. but the STs also uniquely focus on screen locations, like "Praxis" (practice) appearing 23 times. This is reflecting their interest in these fictional sites, which is supported by the trace interview findings that the most visited screen location is the BD practice (table 7.18). Thus, Destinations emphasize the wider WK region⁴⁴, STs focus on screen locations, and Production accounts highlight the production itself.

	Winter	Winter-special	Winter*	All
Screen tourists	5	0	4	9
Destination	20	2	18	40
Production	0	13	1	14
All	25	15	23	63

Table 4.8: The count of the token "Winter" in the different groups. The asterisk after the word means that it can be continued at will as a wildcard.

	Sommer	*sommer*	All
Screen tourists	13	6	19
Destination	7	11	18
Production	2	2	4
All	22	19	41

Table 4.9: The Count of the Token "Sommer" in the different groups. The asterisk before and after the word means that it can be continued at will as a wildcard.

4.8). This indicates that while the Destination focuses on broader seasonal terms, the Production crew is more centered on the BD screen production itself. STs rarely mention winter, as they typically visit WK in midsummer (August-September). Conversely, STs frequently use summer-related terms (table 4.9) such as "Sommerurlaub"

Signs of seasonal tourism

As discussed in chapter 4.1 on page 117, the DMO doesn't classify ST as winter tourism but still references "Winter" and the BD together in a few posts. The term "Winter" and its variations predominantly appear in Destination accounts, except for "Winterspecial," used mostly by the Production group (table

⁴³The inhabitants of the town of Reith.

⁴⁴All towns and places visible in the map 3.9.

(Eng.: Summer holiday), "Sommerabend" (Summer evening) or "Sommersprossen" (Freckles). Destination accounts also use summer terms, aligning with their strategy to appeal to a diverse audience year-round. Production accounts seldom mention either season, suggesting they focus on the screen product rather than seasonal changes and the different kind of tourism the seasons cultivate.

Time description words

Interestingly, the Production frequently uses time-related terms (table 4.4) such as "Heute" (57, Eng.: today), "Jahr" (20, year), "Abend" (20, evening), "Morgen" (18, tomorrow/morning), and "Woche" (16, week). These variations are more diverse than the Destination accounts, which mainly use "Uhr" (50, clock) and "Heute" (45). STs also frequently use time terms like "Heute" (65), "Tag" (26, day), "immer" (24, always), "Zeit" (24, time), and "Abend" (23). It's notable that "today" appears often across all groups (167 times in 154 descriptions in table 4.7), highlighting the immediacy of ST and Instagram posting. Trace interviews confirm that most people post immediately after taking a photo. For Destination and Production accounts, this could also be due to promoting events or show screenings happening close to the posting time (Shown on page 133).

More keyword use because of professional involvement

A total of 758 keywords⁴⁵ were identified in this corpus, evenly distributed among the agent groups: ST (285), Destination (241) and Production (232). However, considering the total number of different post descriptions — 555 for the STs, 641 for the Destination and 230 for Production — it is evident that STs and the Destination use fewer ST keywords than Production accounts. This may be because the Production crew, with their professional involvement in the screen product, return annually for new seasons, developing a routine that influences their social media habits. Unlike regular tourists on a one-time⁴⁶ two-week trip with varied activities at the WK, for the Production crew, the screen product is a primary focus, resulting in more keyword use. Because the BD screen product is set in the WK Destination all the social media communication about it can be mostly categorized as ST communication.

4.4.2 Instagram post metrics analysis

⁴⁵Keywords are the words defined in chapter 3.2 in the list 3.2 for the boolean saved search on Crowd Tangle.

⁴⁶Actually, the STs surveyed traveled on average more than 2 times to the WK.

	Account count	Post count	Posts per Acc.
Screen tourists	169	555	3.3
Destination	54	643	11.0
Production	29	234	8.1

Table 4.10: Posts and account number of the different groups

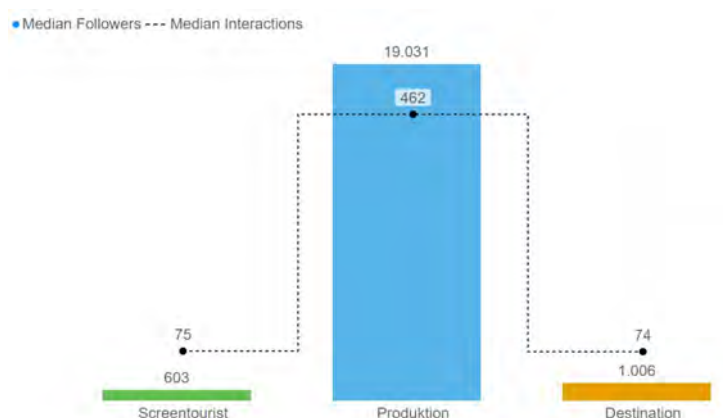
the WK compared to people of the Destination or Production. Destination accounts averaged 11 posts due to their professional Team and approach, while Production accounts had a ratio of 8 posts due to their need to market themselves. STs averaging 3 posts because they are typically post only during vacations. Especially, the STs have finite material from a limited amount of time at the destination. Destination accounts can post year-round, while Production accounts post frequently due to longer stays and seasonal work. These real life constraints and opportunities influence the ST communication online.

Most corpus posts came from the Destination group, followed by ST and Production (table 4.10). Conversely, most corpus accounts were in the ST group, followed by Destination and Production. The high number of ST accounts is expected due to their greater quantity of regular tourists at

Instagram interactions

Likes and interactions

Figure 4.35 shows the dominance of Production accounts with a median of 19,000 followers due to many well-known actors. Destination accounts behind with 1,000 followers because of a few large DMOs and popular hotels. ST accounts come third fol-



lowers 600, only boosted by a few influencer STs. Success on Instagram is driven by follower count, as more followers typically mean more interactions as clearly visible in the graphs of figure 4.35.

Dominating actors and influencers Chapter 4.3.2 first paragraph shows that actors' accounts dominate performance metrics, overshadowing others. Despite ZDF's prominence, its account, like Austria's ORF (table 4.5), ranks lower due to its diverse audience and content. @zdfmediathek's varied posts target different groups, unlike

actors who have a unified fan base. Fans are more likely to follow actors than TV channels, giving actors a content and follower advantage. Just as actors dominate Production posts, the same is true for influencers in the ST group (more on page 99). Influencers and actors are structurally comparable as they are well known and have more followers than the other accounts in their groups.

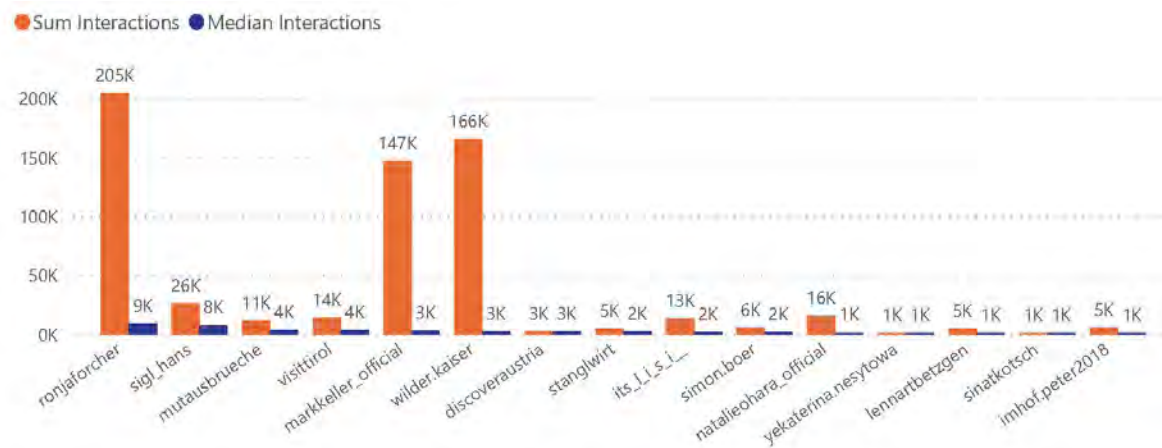


Figure 4.36: The top 15 accounts of the corpus with sum and median of interactions (source: own data). Sorted by median interactions.

Popular accounts and posts

Profesional content is dominating ST communication Production accounts like @ronjatorcher and @sigl_hans lead in interactions, followed by the first ST account @mutausbrueche and the first Destination @visittiro (figure 4.36). Together, these four have 1,432 posts and over 800,000 interactions. Production accounts dominate with 463,000 interactions, with Ronja Forcher's account alone achieving 204,000. The top Production accounts accumulate more interactions than all Destination and ST accounts combined, showing their dominance in ST communication on Instagram. The influencers of the ST and prominent Destination accounts come in second, highlighting the impact of professional accounts like influencers, DMOs, and actors on social media's portrayal of ST.

Portraits of the Production As noted in chapter 4.3.2 on page 135, Ronja Forcher's photos often place her at the center, typically looking towards the camera (figure 4.27 (a), (c), (g), (h) or (i) etc.). This portrait style mirrors her TV show portrayal, sometimes even in character costume, such as a gown (post CCJVqjgH6lk) from later seasons⁴⁷. Production accounts often feature portraits with minimal background, though some include spectacular landscapes with actors still in focus. They skillfully

⁴⁷ After season 10 so not the seasons analyzed in detail by this study.



Figure 4.37: Selfie cast photo by Ronja Forcher (Production) at the Bergdokter practice (source: Instagram screenshot with post id CQEdlD2nU7w).



Figure 4.38: Professional cast photo from Wilder Kaiser (Destination) at the Bergdokter practice (source: Instagram screenshot with post id B7GmkGoquC5).



Figure 4.39: A screen tourist puts herself in the screen location of the Bergdokter practice and also shows the landscape (source: Instagram screenshot with post id CGVKJusHm1K).

avoid showing main screen locations like it is common for Destination and ST photos, keeping them just out of frame, recognizable only to those familiar with the WK screen location.

Aesthetic of the destination The Destination has a focus on many countryside-, mountain- and townscapes. They sprinkle in a few photos of the cast, mostly standing indoors and in groups. Since the Production also has cast photos, they have a completely different aesthetic. The photos from the Destination seem to be from promotional material and are clearly taken by professional photographers. While the Destination opts for professionally arranged photos (figure 4.38), probably provided by the production company, the Production accounts (mostly actors) choose an influencer aesthetic with poses (figure 4.27). At the end it is the same persons but with an almost diametrical aesthetic.

Screen tourists as protagonist It is interesting how the ST literally placed itself in the screen location (figure 4.39) and in many others as a kind of protagonist of the show. The border crossing discussed in the theory chapter happens not so much at the screen location, but definitely later in the photo. Or, to put it another way, the ST becomes the actor in the screen location, but in the photo he is ultimately the *character*.

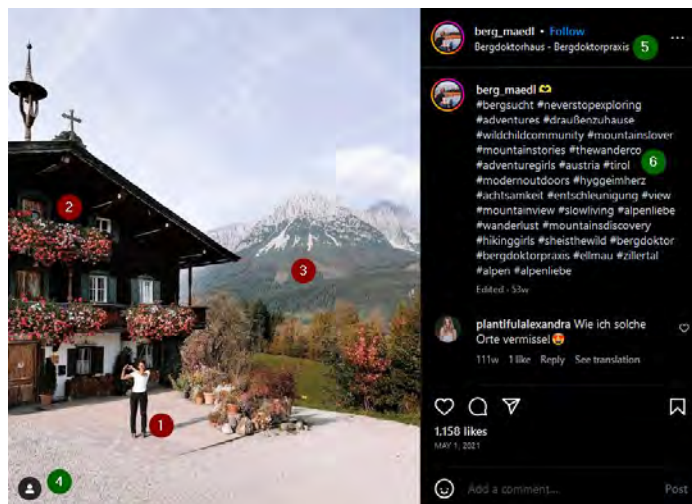


Figure 4.40: A post from @berg_maedl which is typical for screen tourist posts (source: Instagram screenshot with post id COUc6X6lzOI). The red numbers indicate diagetive standards in den photo as the green numbers are extra diagetive on social media.

the set pieces like remnants of their beloved fictional world. For the STs it is also not

The look behind the curtain Production posts (figure 4.27) often provide a behind-the-scenes look at BD production, a tactic also used by Destination accounts (figure 4.14). This perspective reveals real places, actors and production details, possible know only for those involved in the production. Regular STs lack this insider view, seeing the screen screen product just from the outside. However, visiting screen locations offers STs a glimpse behind the scenes like in figure 4.3. This akin to exploring a theater set after a performance as visitors can now go on stage and look at

more than a gimps when they visit a screen location, because they can see what is behind the curtain, but not what *actually happened*. STs place themselves within the frame (figure 4.40 (1)) in relation to the screen location (figure 4.40 (2) and (3)). This is them taking the stage as the tourist becomes the protagonist (in the photo). In the extra diageitic methods like geotaging (figure 4.40 (5))⁴⁸ and mentions (figure 4.40 (4)) connect the post with the Destination, Production, and fan accounts. The behind the scenes look at the screen location will never be like being part of the show but it still supports bridging their experience from reality info fiction.

Most successful posts The top 25 posts of the corpus are completely dominated by only Production posts from three different actors of the main cast (figure 7.3). The top Production post is from @ronjaforcher (post id CPz5CrOndiH). The first non-production post is from @wilder.kaiser (Post id CLrdQ4xl1wV) at place 28, while the first ST post is from @mutausbrueche (Post id: C1cx24RBQKS) at place 49!



Figure 4.41: (a) Screen tourist photo with the town square in Going. (b) Destination photo with the town square in Going. (c) Production photo depicting actress Ronja Forcher. (Source: Instagram screenshots with post ids (a) CJAhiFXM0Kc, (b) CLrdQ4xl1wV and (c) CPz5CrOndiH)

Differences between the top posts of the three groups The difference between top posts of Production vs. Destination and ST is clear (figure 4.41): Production posts emphasize personal experiences (e.g. figure 4.41 (c)), while Destination and regular ST posts⁴⁹ highlight the background (e.g. figure 4.41 (a) and (b)). Interestingly, both Destination and ST often feature the same popular screen locations⁵⁰. In these

⁴⁸in this case a fictional location from the BD.

⁴⁹The exceptions are the influencers who behave similar to the actor accounts of the Production.

⁵⁰It the example case it is the combined screen locations of the town square in Going and when actually looking at the trace interview answers, it is one of the most popular screen locations.

posts, the landscape or townscape is the focal point, with subtle hints in descriptions indicating ST communication.

The tokens of the most successful posts The word cloud in figure 4.42 displays 43 tokens above the median interactions, each used more than four times. These tokens appear 394 times across 90 posts from ten accounts: two ST, four Destination, and four Production. The top five tokens are "Bergdokter", "Heute" (Engl.: Today), "Danke" (Thank you), "Ellmau", and "Photo". "Bergdokter" is the most used, uniting all groups around the WK Destination. But each group also has preferred tokens (as described in chapters 4.1 to 4.3): STs favor "heute," Destinations use "Ellmau" and "photo," and Productions frequently use "danke." For STs, "heute" reflects living in the moment and posting about what happened/happens today. Destination accounts emphasize regional ties with "Ellmau" and their promotional role with "photo" (more details on page 121). Production accounts⁵¹ use "danke" to express gratitude to fans and the BD screen production team.



Figure 4.42: The top 100 tokens by median interactions (source: own data). Filtered for tokens with more than four uses. The larger the token, the more times it was used. Color does not matter.

Time terms of the Production and Screen tourists The token "Heute" (Engl.: Today) is frequently used by both Production and ST accounts, indicating their posts'

⁵¹The actress @ronjaforcher alone uses it about 18 times in eight posts - she must be very grateful. She even named her first single "Danke," which she promotes heavily in her ST communication (details on page 137). The single is available on Spotify

time-sensitive nature, along with other time-related terms (described on pages 133 and 103). These terms appear over 52 times in 36 posts. A few examples of the use of the Production:⁵²

1. "**Tomorrow** we start with the 15th season (Post id CPz3dg_hMEN)."
2. "Season finale. **Today**. Awesome. For 14 years we've been allowed to tell this story, play these characters. More than **half of my life**. (Post id CMkXkUn-npg2)"
3. "**Tonight 20:15** on ZDF. Do not forget the Bergdoktor (Post id Bt2xeSKDxG0)."

ST use them in these contexts:

4. "Good **evening** ...and off home ...the sofa calls quite loudly ..and I have to come out ...**THURSDAY evening** runs the #bergdoktor ...Sorry THAT MUST BE [capital letters emphasis in original] (Post id B8PEawfoTXa)."
5. "**Today** a few impressions from Kitzbühel and Going. Wish you a nice **day**, Greetings Wilfried (Post id CQffQ-jMujw)."
6. "**Tomorrow** at the crack of dawn we're off to the ski resort Ellmau (where the Bergdoktor is filmed) There Schatzi and I make a **week** winter vacation with friends (Post id BgZQflNDw86)."

Production accounts, as professional marketing tools, use them to promote new seasons (list above 1. and 2.), episode airings (list 3.) and themselves. STs, on the other hand, use these terms to express fandom and, similar to diary entries, relating their activities to specific time (list 5. and 6.). For the STs, the mentioning of the BD broadcast (list 4.) is just an outing of being a fan, but not an advertisement of the show. This pattern shows Production using time terms for promotional purposes, while STs use them for personal, time-specific reflections. An observation made in this BD case study but a trend likely common across social media themes and relations.

The ZDF The token "ZDF"⁵³ is used almost exclusively by Production accounts, as ZDF is the main TV station for the BD series. It appears in posts about BD episode airings, indicating where to watch. Production accounts, closely tied to ZDF (their employer), use social media as a marketing tool to promote episodes and their involvement, could be considered as part of their job or at least helpful to keep the job. Other accounts, like STs and Destinations, do not promote the broadcaster or do not need to promote anything. While ZDF is the initial platform for the BD narrative, it looks like it is not significant in Destination experiences but obviously not in the subsequent ST communication on Instagram, as analyzed in their top words (figure 4.1).

⁵² All bold letters by D.B.; all sentences translated by deep1.com

⁵³ Abbreviation for **Z**weites **D**eutsches **F**ernsehen

Expected post and tokens performance

Figure 4.43 illustrates a pyramid where the Production group tops the interaction metrics. The median for Production is lower than expected.⁵⁴ ST and Destination metrics remain stable, with their interaction numbers aligning closely with expectations.

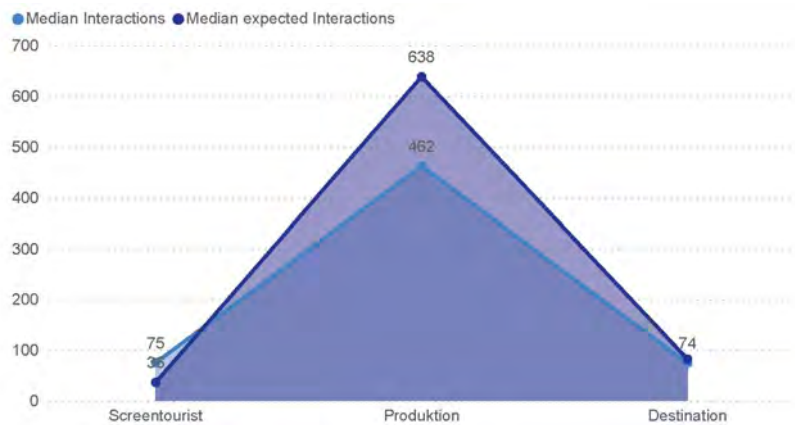


Figure 4.43: Median interaction of the actual post performance and its expectation (Source: Own data).

tations. ST accounts still uniquely benefit from ST communication, performing better than their regular content probably due to the novelty and interest of WK experiences for their followers. Destination accounts, always immersed in WK content, lack this novelty, making their posts seem less unique. For Production, it is similar because they spend a lot of time at the WK and return every year.⁵⁵ They have more time to produce content from the destination, and since the posts from the WK are not as special, they do not benefit as much from ST communication. Figure 4.44 shows ST posts performing 39 interactions better than expected, while Destination posts have a minor fluctuation of -8, and Production posts see a significant drop of -176 interactions. Thus, ST communication boosts ST but decreases Destination and significantly shrinks the interaction of the Production group.

Expected token performance The score of all tokens that are used more than four times and are better than a score of one is 1.6 and they appear on average 12.8 times (figure 4.45). The multi-phrase token "Der Bergdoktor" has 58 occurrences and a score of 1.9. Names of actors like "Linn Kemper" (10 appearances; 2.2 score), "Heiko Rubrecht" (7; 2.0), "Monika Baumgartner" (5; 1.9) or "Hans Sigl" (10; 1.7) appear in the posts. Words related to television production are "ZDF" (43; 2.1), "Serie" (11; 1.4), "gedreht" (Engl.: filmed; 9; 1.6), "drehen" (shooting; 7; 2.3), "Drehorten" (locations; 5; 1.5), "Dreharbeiten" (filming; 14; 1.9), "Regie" (director; 9; 1.8), "Drehtag" (day of shooting; 10; 1.7), "Film" (6; 2.3), and "Staffel" (season; 37 appearances; 2.3 score) are among them in figure 4.45. All of these tokens were part of entries that performed above what was expected of them. These tokens indicate why certain posts performed better than others, because the content resonated with the audience

⁵⁴More on what is happening here is already explained in chapter 4.3.2 on 140.

⁵⁵This is the same reason why some profiles publish more posts than others discussed on page 148.

and resulted in higher interaction numbers. For example, posts about the actors and actresses as well as content related to the movie production performed better than other ST communication content.

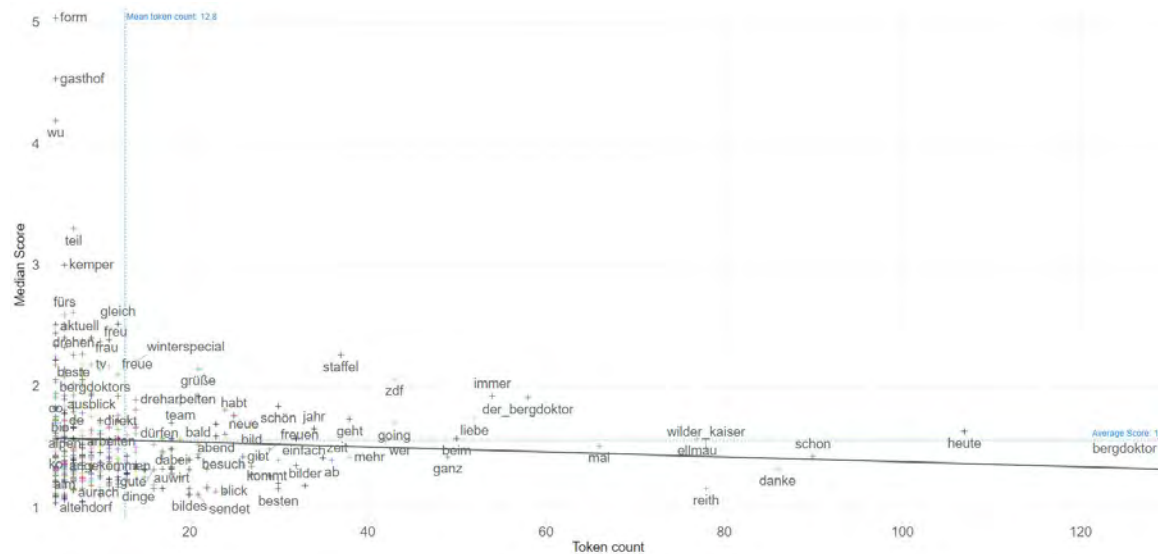


Figure 4.45: Top tokens by median score and appearance count. Filtered for tokens used more than four times and with a post score better than one (source: own data).

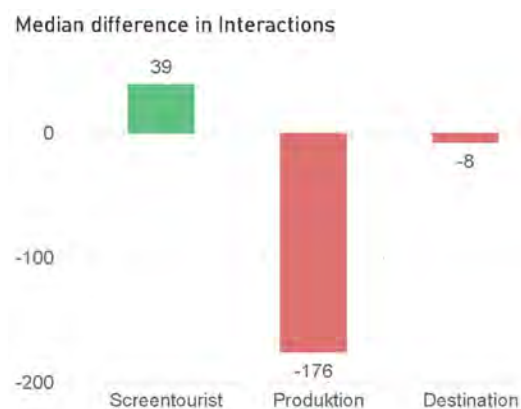


Figure 4.44: The median interactions the difference between expected and actual interactions coming from figure 4.43 (Source: Own data).

Space tokens perform exceptional Names of attractions, towns, and regions are also very popular in the corpus, as there are more than a dozen of them: "Österreich", "Tirol"/"Tiroler", "Kaiser"/"Wilder Kaiser", "Going", "Scheffau", "Ellmauer", "Kitzbüheler", "Hintersteiner See" and "Auwirt", but of course there are also the names of places from the BD like "Praxis", "Gruberhof", "Bergdoktorpraxis" and "Bergdoktorhaus", and some ambiguous ones that could be used in other situations, but are mostly associated with the BD series, like "Gasthof"⁵⁶ (Engl.: Guesthouse) and "Dorfplatz"⁵⁷ (town square). These space tokens are all part of very successful posts performing above the median of the corpus but also against other posts outside of

⁵⁶as in "Gashof Wilder Kaiser": A main screen location since the first season of BD.

⁵⁷The town square of "Going am Wilden Kaiser" with a few key screen locations, such as the WK guesthouse, the church or the pharmacy (in later seasons).

it. So it is unfortunate that the Production uses them way lesser (only 1/3) than the other groups (table 4.11).

	Screen tourist	Destination	Production
Token count	140	124	45
Tokens distinct	15	17	9
Post count	137	138	50
Median interaction	81	110	905
Median Score	1.6	1.4	2.2

Table 4.11: Tokens related to space by the groups

4.4.3 Trace Interviews Answers

Dimension: professional vs. privat

In the text, as in all other parts of a post, motivation is divided into two sides of one dimension: It is a continuum between, either 'professionally planned' or 'privately emotional'. On the professional side are the Destination (post ids Bmu3VOdngGL or CE_81ZajsBl) but also most of the Production (post id CPz3dg_hMEN). Since many Production accounts behave like influencers (post id CMkXkUnnp2) with competent strategies and at the same time supposedly authentic private content, they act on the edge of the professional side. The private emotional side is the ST (post ids B24EWo4ihK1 or CGw14x-hST1), They also have influencers in their group (post ids CAQTjn9HnbL), and they act more professional the bigger their accounts get.

Dimension: Open vs. subliminal On the one side of this dimension your content is "open and transparent" and on the other "Subliminal and hidden". Almost all STs, as well as most Production posts, often state the connection to the BD. Destination, on the other hand, uses subliminal messages in ST communication (post id B_SeQyzlPop). The actors in particular can not deny their direct involvement with the BD as they are literally the most visible part of the tv show. Their postings are so aligned with the screen production that they end up just being open about it and do not hold back at all with their connection to the show (post id CPz5CrOndiH). ST's motivation for clear and open communication about the BD is that they are fans and they are showing what they love (post id BSeBTgLDNCy) - Sometimes it is as simple as that. The Destination accounts have the same motivation as the Production, but their aim to reach every potential tourist changes the outcome, especially on the photo and its description. In many posts, especially in the photo and text, the ST background is a *secret of the obscure*. Only if you are one of the enlightened BD

fans of the *Astral Ward* you can see that the photo and the text are ST communication. For regular tourists, the photos and texts are not *kryptus*, but rather the additional meaning is invisible for them. This technique makes the post and its photo still aesthetically appealing to them and they can understand it separated from the BD subtext.

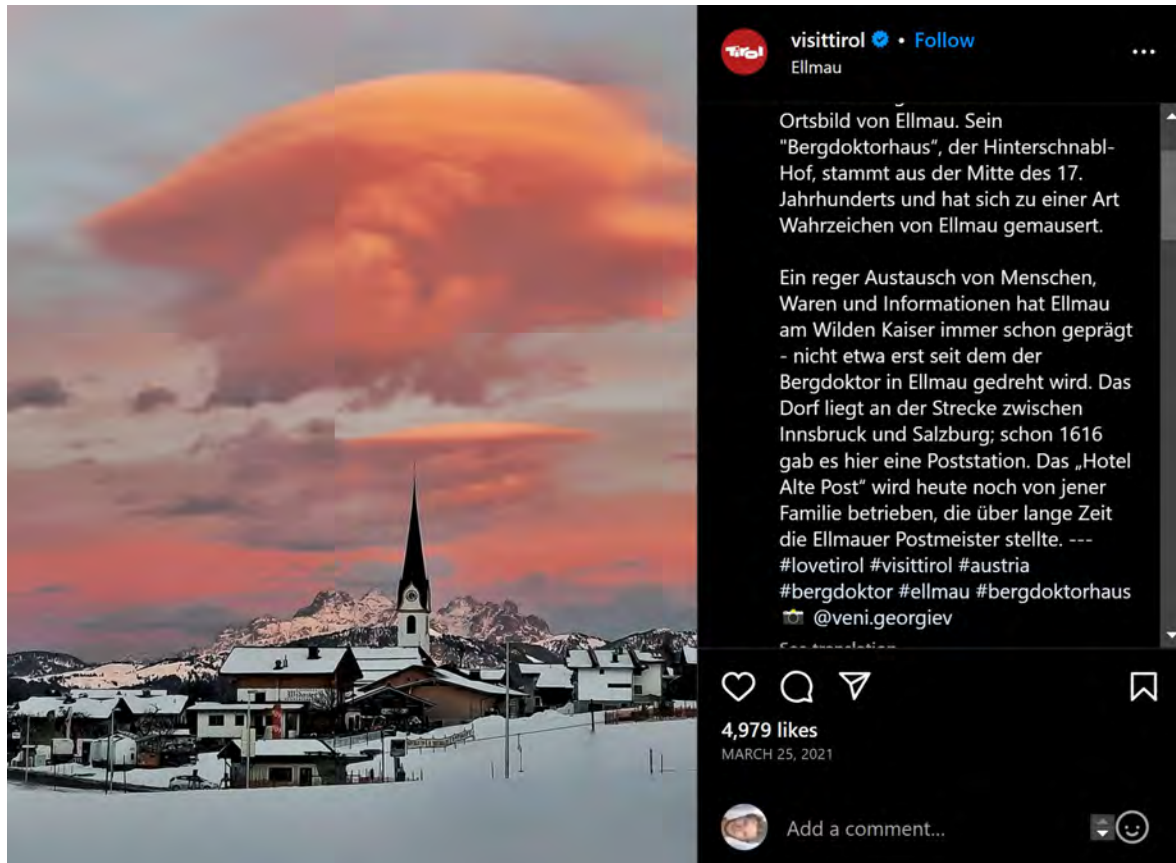


Figure 4.46: The description of the DMO account @visittiroel matches the photo (source: Instagram screenshot with post id CM2rXpIgYAj).

A collage of beautiful photos and professional messages

The main reason STs publish photos is their sheer beauty (page 110), especially of the WK landscape (e.g. post ids B1g4Eh8ijwp and BjFpI0CgwTl). They discovered the WK as a stunning backdrop for the TV show first and then choose photos for their aesthetic appeal, constructing meaning and emotions around them. Destination accounts, however, are more strategic and professional, understanding social media dynamics and user reactions (e.g. post id B_SeQyzlPop). They select high-quality photos that align with their marketing goals, ensuring the photo and message fit seamlessly (figure 4.46). Production accounts likely share similar motivations, driven by professional and influencer strategies, though specific motivations

were less clear from the limited interviews. All the motivations result in a collage of beautiful photos showing the WK as a dream destination.

4.4.4 Geolocation Analysis

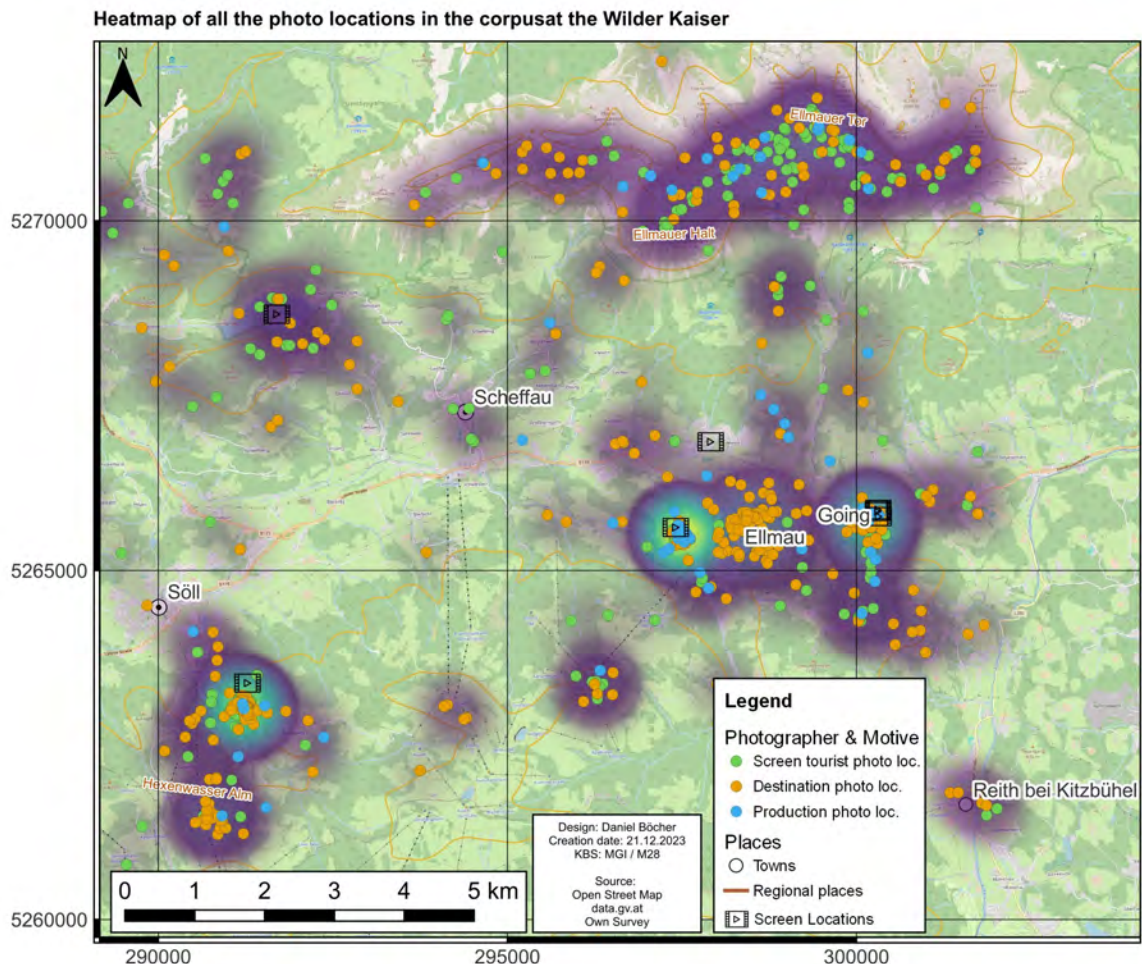


Figure 4.47: Heatmap of all photographer and motive points in the corpus (source: own data).

Geo located photos

Three screen location hot spots The three main screen locations of the BD TV show are: The Gruberhof, the BD practice and the town square in Going. These are also the main hot spots of the corpus (map 4.47) photos. At these three screen locations each group has its share of points. As expected, it does not matter where the photos come from at these main screen locations, since the screen locations are the places everyone can agree on.

Motive cluster WK mountain range All groups share a common focus on the WK mountain range as their background (4.47): Among 149 photos from 65 accounts, the WK mountains often serve as a backdrop for screen locations. ST and Production

accounts highlight the central part around Ellmauer Tor, while Destination accounts also feature the western range. This aligns with DMOs' perceived goals to present a diverse image of WK, to cater for all attractions and appeal to different target audiences. The central parts attract BD fans and crew, while other areas may attract a different demographic or shows other specific attractions.

DMO hot spots Ellmau and Hexenwasser With Ellmau and Hexenwasser the Destination has two exclusive hot spots (map 4.47). At Hexenwasser there are both photographer and motive points. So it is not only a place to look at, but also to be in - at least that is what the Destination thinks about this place and promotes it with ST communication. Neither the STs nor the Production seem to really care about it, as only a handful of photos have been published with this position for these groups.

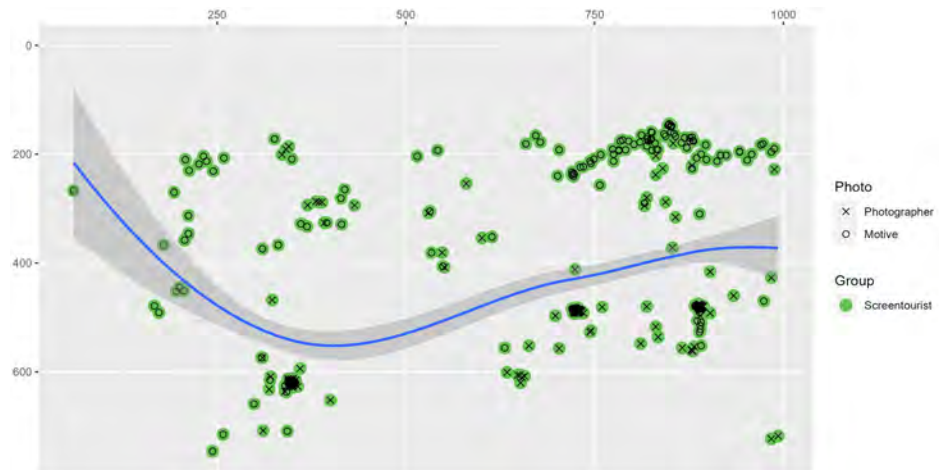
The great divide In figure 4.48, most points are clearly placed south and north of the WK valley. While figure 4.48 (c) has fewer photos, (a) and (b) highlight these trends more clearly. Photographer and motive hot spots are evident on the south side of the valley, with three main screen locations (page 159), and a hot spot in the north above the WK mountain range. The moving average line runs through the graph like an actual river in the WK valley. All graphs have a similar overall appearance⁵⁸ with key differences: for Destination accounts, a bump to the north shows an expanded perspective of the WK mountain range. Most points for all groups are divided into south and north parts, as indicated by the blue average line. The center of the valley between the WK mountains to the north and the "Skiwelt Wilder Kaiser-Brixental" to the south can be recognized in the mathematical calculation of the average line in the schematic diagram in figure 4.48.

Divided by position, united by motive

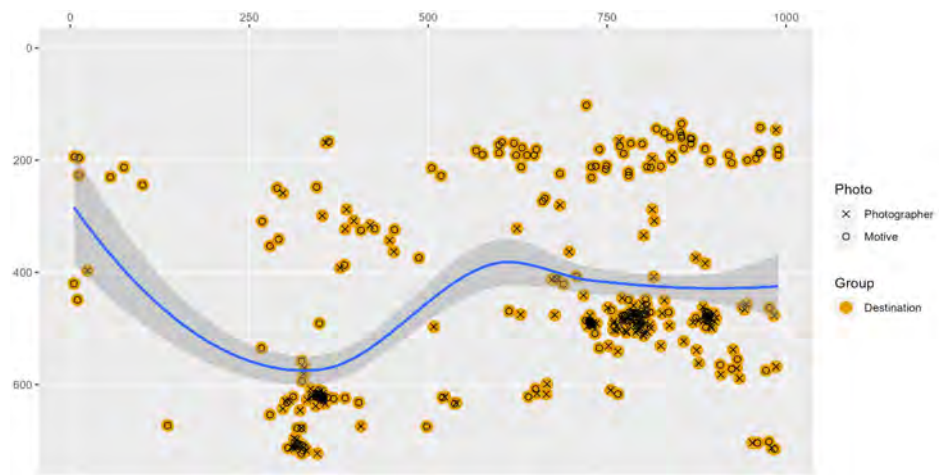
Beyond allocating photos on the map 4.47, it is about the connection between photographer points and photo motives. In figure 7.10, many longer connections stretch from southern photographer points to northern motives. This is not just a distribution along the WK valley slopes; it's concentrated around key photographer points. The perspective typically comes from the three main screen locations — Gruberhof, BD practice and the town square — looking at the WK mountain range on the opposite side of the valley. All three groups share this commonality, making it a very dominant and explicit feature of BD's ST communication. Thus, while points are divided into two valley sides, the photographers' perspectives unite them, resulting in numerous screen location photos connecting to a stunning mountainscape backdrop.

Focus on the screen location All groups in the corpus focus on screen locations,

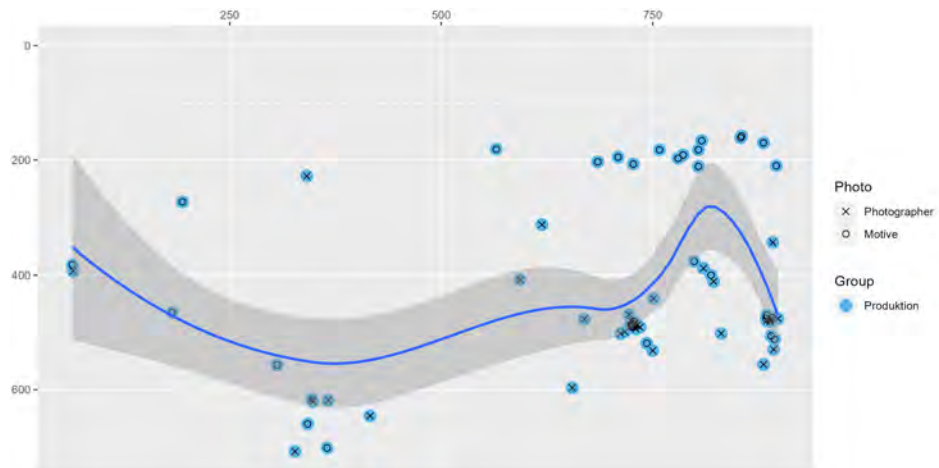
⁵⁸When disregarding 4.48 (c) with recognizable less points and a greater confidence interval which makes interpretations difficult.



(a)



(b)



(c)

Figure 4.48: Schematic x-y graph of all photographer and motive points (source: own data): (a) Screen Tourists, (b) Destination, and (c) Production accounts. The blue line is the regression line with the confidence interval in gray.

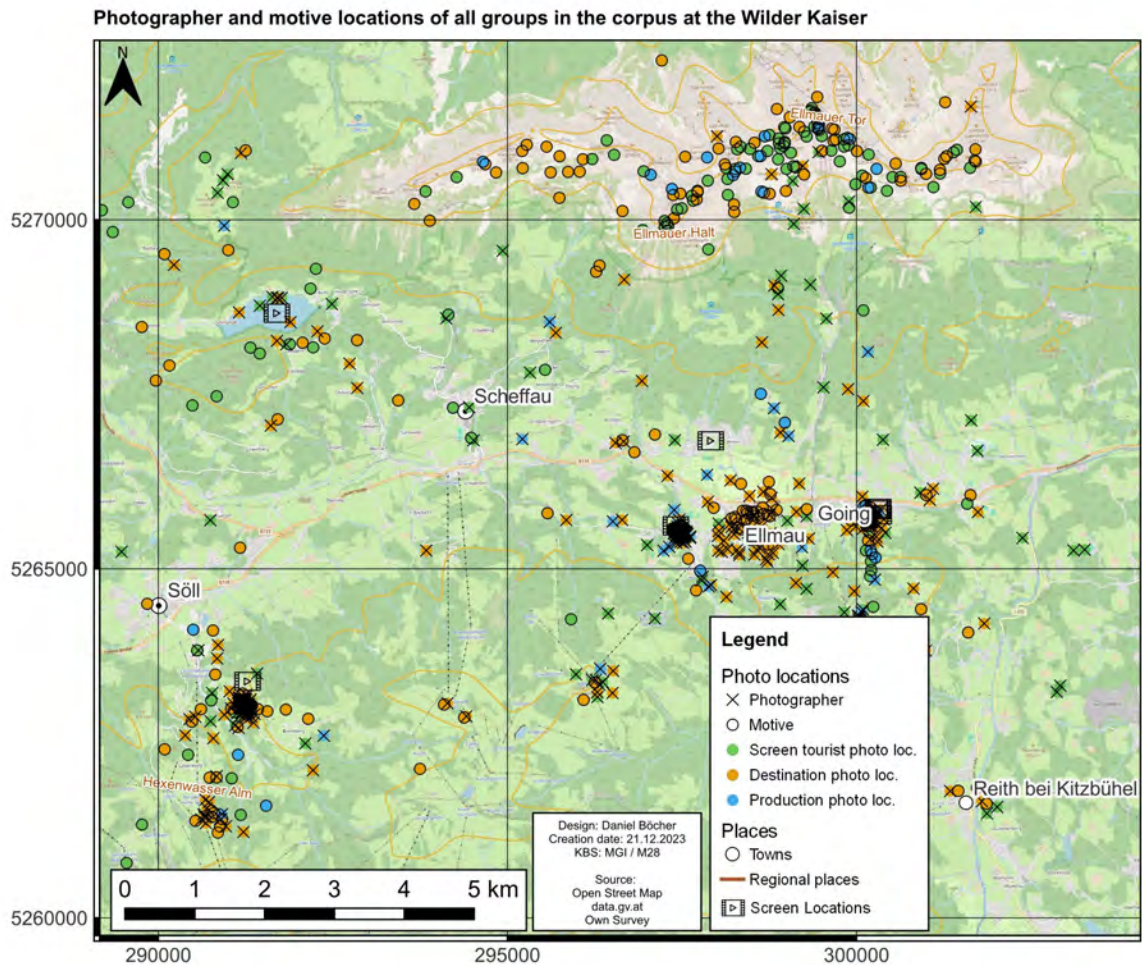


Figure 4.49: Positions of photographers and motives grouped by Screen Tourists, Destinations and Productions (source: own data).

as shown in maps 4.8 and 4.21. When considering the WK mountain range panorama as a screen location due to its frequent use in transitions and backgrounds of the TV show, most photos in the corpus are shot at or depict screen location. Only Destination accounts offer additional hot spots like Ellmau, Hexenwasser and the Kitzbühel Valley. Despite also focusing on main screen locations, Destination accounts provide the most diverse points across the WK region (map 4.49).

The struggle of minor and older screen locations Beyond the three main screen locations, the frequency of appearances drops quickly, and some TV show locations are even untouched. Trace interviews with STs about returning screen locations (table 4.1) indicated more diversity and a higher frequency of screen location but they show a surprising lack of photos from Hintersteiner See and the hospital. Despite 19 interviewees spending significant time at Hintersteiner See, only 12 posts mentioned it, and it was photographed just 14 times (table 4.1). This lack of photos suggests that, although STs know about and visit the lake, they don't feel compelled to pub-

lish posts about it or even take photos. Perhaps the photos were used outside of ST communications, and so the Boolean search could not identify them.

The absent screen locations The hospital set, over 50 km from the WK region, never appeared in any group photos, despite being shown very often in the BD TV show (table 4.12). Even within WK, some screen locations were underrepresented. For instance, indoor shots of the hospital filmed in Wimm appeared in 112 scenes over 10 seasons but lacked photos or text mentions in the corpus.⁵⁹ This might be due to tourism posts favoring cheerful sights (WK guesthouse) over dramatic ones (Hospital). Other overlooked screen locations include Lilli Gruber's school and the train station but they also appear less in TV show or were only important in older seasons. Hintersteiner lake, though less featured in recent seasons, still sees some social media activity. Scene counts (table 4.12) can indicate photo frequency in the destination but do not explain everything, as seen with the hospital and Hintersteiner lake screen locations.

Screen location	Scenes
Gruberhof	565
Bergdokter practice	457
Wilder Kaiser guesthouse	239
Panoramas:	
- Mountain	748
- Town	99
- City	60
Train station	6
Hintersteiner lake	18
School	43
Hospital	616

Table 4.12: Total scene count of screen locations in the BD TV show from season 1 to 10 (source: own data).

⁵⁹ An attempt to explain why this major screen location in the TV show did not translate well into social media posts and photos was made in chapter 4.1.3 on page 108.

Chapter 5

Discussion of the case study findings and the current developments of media and tourism

5.1 Evaluation of the Content Analysis Case study

The influence in the pre holiday phase

STs stated that their destination choice was influenced by the Production's accounts (page 104), yet these accounts were not used in trip preparation (page 104). Instead, they consulted various other Instagram accounts with WK content. As BD fans, they were already persuaded by the Production accounts in the decision phase, when they started into the planning phase. After the decision phase the ST see other sources as more fitting and relevant for planning the trip at the destination. This suggests the screen product and the involved social media accounts are the key factor in destination choice, despite its limited role in the planning phase, where the Destination accounts and these of fellow tourists take over. Destinations can adapt this when they provide Information for already hooked ST for different attraction in the destination and do not need to lure them into the destination. Production accounts could use this fact as in collaborating with the destination to play their role of inducing ST to the destination - Which the WK DMO already does.

The priming of the outdoors

The TV series is dominated by outdoor shots (page 3.4), emphasizing the mountain panorama, which draws STs' attention at the destination to landscapes and the outside. Despite some interviewees expressing disappointment about closed rooms at

the BD practice screen location¹, this again still reinforces the influential power of the screen product because inside photos increase when inside scenes are featured. The BD practice screen location is one of the rare cases where there are more scenes inside than outside (table 3.2). You can actually see the line of people wanting to go inside the BD practice in this photo in figure 5.1. Despite the BD practice screen location, one of the rare indoor-focused sets, the show's focus on outdoor scenes shapes Instagram posts. Generally, the series' outdoor vibe is mirrored in STs' photos, aligning with the DMO's image of an alpine holiday in the exalted natural mountains (page 22). Which the WK DMO already does.

Other tourists

The ST at the WK had completely different experiences when it comes to a crowded or empty screen location (Page 105). When looking at the screen locations of their photos and the dates they were published there was no indication of whether the perception is justified. Of course like in the theory chapter mentioned (page 51) tourists most of the time do not like other tourists and despise them even if they are doing exactly the same in the perspective of others.

That could lead to over exaggerating the few tourist that are at the screen location. This seems the case when looking at the photos of the album (e.g. in figure 5.2) and comparing it with the situation I found on the field trips to the WK (figure 5.1). And that you are alone at such a place is just a tourism illusion (page 17). An illusion carried by the DMO and their projection of the image of the WK but also by the tourists themselves who are trying to avoid other tourists in their (public) photos about their holidays. The photos in this corpus tells the story (figure 4.6) of an empty destination that is just here for you and your family.



Figure 5.1: It is raining and there is still a long queue in front of the mountain doctor's practice at the Wilder Kaiser (source: own photo).

¹Example on page 105 with post id B24EWo4ihK1.

The corona virus and its impact on ST communication

The corona virus on STs The topics around COVID weigh heavily on people, leading them to seek escape through the BD narrative, viewing the TV show as a gateway to the Tirolean mountains². The show is framed by its producers and actors as light entertainment, offering a temporary escape. Viewers recognize the show's limitations of a medialized experience but can recall real memories if they visit the destination. This shows that while people are aware of the screen's artificiality as the escape is only as long as an episode, the suspension of disbelief is powerful³, especially during crises like a pandemic.

#inechtnochschoener hashtag The DMO account @Wilder.kaiser created the hashtag #inechtnochschöner⁴ (Engl.: "Even more beautiful in real life").⁵ This hashtag emphasizes that the true beauty of WK can not be captured through media — you must experience it firsthand. It suggests prior medialised contact with the WK before visiting, contrasting the "real" destination with its media portrayals. Both the BD TV show and social media offer different kind of medialised experiences, yet are used together, often far from the actual destination. This marketing slogan ties into the discourse on media and tourism, highlighting the blend of real and fictional in tourism promotion and memory.

Beautiful landscape

The findings in chapter 4.1 on page 110 showed that the beauty of the WK destination motivated people to post photos, consistent with other tourism studies (e.g.: Aschenbrand, 2017). From the beginning, tourism landscapes had to be scenic (page 18), and infrastructure was built to showcase this beauty (page 30). This result was expected in the corpus, as landscapes generally drive ST, especially BD ST, which heavily relies on spectacular background shots for storytelling, scene transitions and



Figure 5.2: A photo from a screen tourist that claims there were *many tourists* (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CDataSXBhvF).

²Ignoring the fact that Tirol was one of the europe's hotspots of the pandemic in the first wave.

³A thought developed on page 184

⁴It is, of course, a marketing slogan and that is its whole meaning at the end but maybe it's also the most visible expression of a deeper pattern.

⁵More info about the usage description on page 123.

establishing shots. The TV show's focus on the landscape and its beauty translates to the posting aesthetic and motivation of the ST at the WK.

The photo as gateway for screen tourists The ST navigates the WK screen location, but in the final social media photos, it becomes the world of BD. This is evident in many examples in chapters 4.4 and 4.5 with an example on page 151. The photos often mimic the screen production process: the ST as the actor, the screen location becomes the set of a fictional world, and the cell phone as the camera. The post and final photo act as a transport device (for yourself) and a window (for the viewers) into BD's fictional world. This ongoing fictionalization makes the photo a transcendence tool for STs, not just a marketing tool as for the PRoduction and Destination, serving as a gateway rather than a mere sign.

Better than expected for the screen tourists

For STs, the WK often exceeds expectations (page 106) set by Instagram posts seen pre-travel. This positive outcome is probably linked to the Alpine region's image (page 22) and the BD series' portrayal, making it familiar yet exalted. The BD TV show prepares viewers for the trip, offering a broader perspective than marketing materials alone. With a mean of nine BD seasons consumed, STs feel well-acquainted with the WK (page 106 in chapter 4.1.3) beyond compressed and overly positive marketing messages. Despite potentially exaggerated Instagram photos, the destination can often deliver more than expected. The DMO reacts to and leverages this with the hashtag *#inechtnochschöner*⁶ (Eng.: Even more beautiful in real life.), reinforcing that the WK exceeds expectations - and for ST this actually works.

Reposting content and encouraging user generated content

Destination accounts on Instagram use reposting for ST communication (e.g. on page 121). They effectively share, remix, and redistribute content, leading to high engagement. Reusing the photos of the community means they have a similar aesthetic than other tourists with the striking difference being that the Destination posts are more polished. though more polished. You can see this even more when contrasting the with the Production accounts' aesthetic (page 149). The Destination accounts are actively encouraging UGC content when they host a year-round photo contest (page 117), collecting and reposting community photos. Involving the audience on Instagram is a best practice as it is a social network as well as beneficial because it helps maintain consistent posting schedule. These photo contests are an effective

⁶Explained in chapter 4.2.2 on page 123.

tactic for DMOs to promote tourism and are promising for ST communication as the results demonstrate.

Impact of the Covid pandemic

The pandemic significantly impacted (screen) tourism, as evidenced in this paper. It was not the photos but the words and hashtags used that changed in the ST communication of the Destination accounts. With vacations postponed (page 127), streaming services viewership increased by 27 percent and TV by 20 percent worldwide (Statista, 2024). Screen products became the only way to see the world, with the BD series offering a temporary escape, offering to be a valve of holiday emotions that could not go elsewhere in this crisis. The BD TV show is allowing people to fantasize about holidays at home (127).

Background screen tourism communication

For Destination accounts, ST communication happens subtly in the background⁷, unlike Production accounts which emphasize it. The dominant subgroup of Production is BD actors, whose presence is tied to the show, making it pointless to hide in the Instagram posts. STs on the other have a different reason with the same result as they are transparent in their communication, eager to show their fandom on Instagram. This is different for Destinations as they aim to reach diverse audiences by using obscured ST communication, trying to make posts entertaining for all (page 157). This background communication relies on mostly hashtags (e.g.: figure 4.19) and ambiguous text (e.g.: figure 4.18), and sometimes even photos.

Maximize the reach with broad message Most photos from the Destination group do not overtly relate to ST but only in the text and hashtags they hint at it - unless of course you are a fan of the BD series and recognize the place from the show. This contrasts with Production accounts, which openly feature BD content e.g. in figure 3.3 or in the use of tokens in table 4.6. Destination accounts use subtle ST messages to reach a broad audience, avoiding niche targeting. Although BD has a large fandom as it is one of the most successful German TV shows but for tourism marketing, it remains a special interest group. Thus, the Destination posts often appeal to general tourists while subtly signaling to BD fans (figure 4.19).

Serendipitous screen tourists on screen locations The findings prove that you can reach BD fans with subtle ST communication without deterring regular tourists. This aligns with how ST typically works, as the link between a screen product and a place is mostly not obvious to most tourists unless they have seen the screen prod-

⁷Also in Master thesis about the "ST of Game of Thrones in Dubrovnik" I found this phenomenon of subliminal ST communication.

uct. Serendipitous ST (page 10) occurs frequently because of that. STs have a deeper connection to a place than regular tourists, who might only see an old Austrian farmhouse in BD practice unless they become fans of the BD TV show.

Connection through the same motif The themes of home, belonging, the joy of coming home and feelings of security are deeply emotional human experiences. These are central motifs (leitmotif) of the BD TV show and can be leveraged in posts. Even with subliminal ST communication, using these motifs (as explained on 122) can create a stronger connection to the BD show than hashtags, character/actor mentions or screen location photos. By tapping into these fundamental emotions, posts can bridge the gap and make the subliminal connection more impactful.

Most important part of the post is the photo

Photos are central to Instagram and (screen) tourism communication, as shown in chapters 4.1 to 4.3. For Destination accounts using subliminal ST communication, the screen location photo may be the only clue for that it is ST communication (page 126). Photos can go along with hashtags, texts and mentions but since these other parts rely on the photo, it retains its power independently. Photos in a post evoke ST emotions, a sense of connection to places and closeness to characters and actors. Since ST is visually driven, photos are optimal for ST communication, allowing diverse audiences to interpret them differently and ST specifically. Every part of a post can be interpreted but the photo is the most versatile.

A peek behind the curtain As the posts of @visittirool showed, audiences enjoy behind-the-scenes looks (page 118). This peek does not break the immersion of the fictional world that surrounds the screen location. Fans of the BD show, who already recognize the townscape and its name, are interested in more than what they see on TV. DMOs need to offer additional content, and bonus DVD-style material is a perfect way to satisfy fans' burning desire for more.

A tangible event beside the screen locations

The set up and organization of the fan fest at Hexenwasser Alp (page 127) illustrates how screen locations function in WK. It is one of the few spaces that get published outside of traditional screen locations as these are by far the most popular spots for STs (map 4.47), with few other attractions. The heat map and geotags (figure 7.2) show that the influence of these screen locations beyond its immediate vicinity is limited regionally. To draw STs, additional artificial attractions like gift shops (Filmshop-Ellmau), fan days (Bergdoktor-Fantage), and plaques (Ellmauer Sterne)

are necessary.⁸

Creating artificial ST spaces

The Ellmauer Stars (figure 5.3) demonstrate that STs will visit artificially created ST places. Modeled after the Hollywood Walk of Fame, this attraction in WK features star plaques in Ellmau's Kapellen park, with notable figures like the oldest actor of the BD Siegfried



Figure 5.3: Screen tourist post of the *Ellmauer Sterne*, the Tyrolean version of the Hollywood Walk of Fame (source: Instagram screenshot with post id B1DiNoYBRRk).

Although not an actual screen location, the attraction provide an extended screen space loosely connected to the BD TV show. The real death of a BD mentioned actor inspired the theme of the post in figure 5.3 and made the STs go to the Ellmauer stars. While not hugely successful, the existence of such posts indicates STs' connection to these places, suggesting a potential broader, less visible audience⁹.

The neglected town of Scheffau

Scheffau am Wilden Kaiser is one of the four major towns in the WK region, as defined by the DMO (page 92), but this is not reflected in ST communication on Instagram, not even for Destination accounts. Unlike Söll (Gruberhof), Ellmau (BD practice), and Going (town square with the WK Guesthouse, pharmacy, and church), Scheffau lacks major BD screen locations and as well as scenic advantages, because it is on the *wrong* side of the WK valley. Even the minor screen location, Hintersteiner See, isn't promoted. Scheffau lacks all of its which supports the theory on page 114 that a good view is not everything - you still need an attractive foreground. This all implies that screen products dictate ST popularity, not DMO strategy. Decisions about successful screen locations are made by the BD show's writers, directors and location scouts. Thus, Scheffau remains overlooked by STs, who find no connection

⁸The WK did not as of today go as far as establishing a real BD Disneyland but there are other examples in the history of film and television as explained on page 50 or 199.

⁹as seen with Hintersteiner See for example.

to the show or its characters there as the Destination accounts also surrendered in creating tangible connections for the STs.

ST communication in relation

The analysis in chapters 4.1 to 4.4 shows that only STs benefit from ST communication. When STs post about their experiences in the WK, they receive more interactions than with other content. Destination accounts, however, see stagnation with ST communication, and Production accounts get less attention for ST posts¹⁰ compared to other content. This trend suggests that ST communication is not universally and automatically successful. While detailed numbers are complex, the chosen mean metric highlights that ST communication's impact varies, benefiting STs but not necessarily others.

Marketing yourself

Chapter 4.3 proved, as illustrated in figure 4.27, that Production accounts focus on their bodies and faces, similar to influencer accounts in the ST group. This is expected since actors and influencers market themselves as commodities, using social media to promote their personal brand. This posting behavior was expected. The actors leverage their involvement in the BD narrative and WK screen locations to create ST communication that enhances their brand. Additionally, actors promote other products and projects, like their latest single (page 137), wrapping the marketing message in ST communication. Thus, ST communication serves as a vehicle for marketing attractions, personal brands, and commercial products to the BD fandom on Instagram.

Work where others go on vacay

Most of the time, when actors write about their work (page 136), it sounds like a holiday — a tradition dating back to early Hollywood Westerns (page 38). This connection is more natural when filming in touristy places like WK. For actress @ronjaforcher on page 136 or @sigl_hans in figure 2.13, work and vacation merge in her social media posts. For viewers, it is the opposite: watching the TV show or social media posts is a break from work, and visiting the screen locations where others

¹⁰If you were to categorize the actor's post, it would actually be a photo of him/her at work, would it not? And it is not surprising that there are fewer reactions. If the actor from *The Mountain Doctor* traveled to Dubrovnik and took a photo of himself in Kings Landing, that would also be ST communication and I would expect more reactions there as well. Since it was not part of the scope to analyze the posts of the involved accounts outside the corpus, it is an interesting question when the actor becomes the ST and what is the actual difference between what they normally post and the ST communication posts.

worked on the screen product becomes a vacation surrounded by the tourism industry. This mix of vacation and work in actors' posts is part of an influencer-style marketing agenda, while for STs, it is another (post modern) blend of the different worlds found at the screen locations.

Screen location actors

As shown on page 88, most BD characters have designated locations. This extends beyond the fictional narrative, when for example, the new BD's medical assistant, *Mrs. Kemper*, is mostly seen at the BD practice (page 141) - both inside the show but also in posts on Instagram. Her narrative role influences ST communication on Instagram, facilitated by the actors: Actors film primarily in their character's designated screen locations, spending significant time there and becoming personally connected. Consequently, their digital ST communication often reflects these physical positions. The BD narrative confines actors to specific locations, determining the screen locations they feature in their posts. This narrative influence extends to what both STs and actors publish, with actors constrained by the production process and STs by the fictional BD narrative.

The elite of Bergdoktor screen tourism communication

Figure 4.35 in chapter 4.4.2 shows that follower quantity greatly influences reach on Instagram. Established followings make it easier to get content in front of more users, creating an elite with more control over Instagram communication. Production accounts, especially actors with large followings like @hans_sigl, @ronjaforcher and @markkeller_official, dominate ST communication. This dominance is typical for social media and is explained by Instagram's algorithm, which favors accounts with more followers.¹¹ Thus, actors have an advantage not just from followers but from dedicated fans, making it challenging for regular STs and regional Destination attractions to compete even if they would have the same follower numbers.

Time sensitive communication

Both Production and STs frequently use time terms (page 153) because their stays at WK are brief, unlike those managing Destination accounts, who live at WK. The BD production crew typically stays for a few weeks, while tourists usually stay less than two weeks. This limited time makes these accounts more aware of their time at the destination and screen locations. Production accounts also have time-sensitive promotions for the show's broadcasts on ZDF and ORF channels. STs, on the other

¹¹For example, the TikTok algorithm works differently so that the distribution of content does not depend solely on the number of people who follow the account (TikTok, 2020).

hand, often post diary-like entries, recording their activities and plans tied to specific times and places.

Capturing the lack of time In the age of the *stream* (page 48), we are increasingly conscious of time. Tourism thrives more on the anticipation of vacations than on the memories, making the moment of the experience at the destination crucial. Photography captures these fleeting moments (pages 20 and 19), as do social media postings, diaries, and postcards. The importance of the moment extends to the broadcast of TV shows like the BD, where the content is ephemeral, and screen content is released along a fixed schedule.¹² The moving image also initially fought against the constraints of time (page 40). Despite holidays being zones of relaxation (page 20), the dominance of time persists, influencing both the reception, the experience and the depiction of the Destination. The use of time terms in ST communication (page 172) highlights this ongoing struggle. While television and the destination are still steeped in the regime of the time, photos, diaries, postcards and social media postings are ways to fight back against time, to capture time instead of being chased by it -

Concentration of screen locations

The corpus data focuses on three main screen locations across different analytical dimensions: Grubertshof in Söll, the BD practice in Ellmau, and the town square in Going. STs and Destinations rated the popularity of these screen locations in the trace interviews similarly to the corpus findings. STs visit other screen locations like Hintersteiner Lake, often staying longer there than at major screen locations (table 4.1), but they post less about these visits. The choice of what to post is influenced by the dominance of the few main screen locations and the importance in the narrative. In the BD TV show which repeatedly features a few screen locations (page 87) similar to daily soaps and sitcoms. The story and the use of screen locations have enormous influence of what the ST communication will look like. Fans become familiar with these locations' interiors and exteriors, which can aid the DMO in directing STs and giving them a sense of security.

The endless summer of ST communication

Winter is not prominent in WK's ST communication (page 137), despite each BD season having one specially branded winter episode. While there's a slight increase

¹²This only changed when ZDF accidentally uploaded an episode of the tv show to their VOD platform a week in advance to make it a total success and fans flocked to the platform to see it before it aired on tv! It has been that way ever since it broke free from its constraints. (cf. Böcher, 2018a, p. 1)

in winter-related words (page 146), visually, winter is almost absent. The few winter entries in the corpus do not reflect the importance of winter tourism for the region. In BD's ST communication, WK is portrayed as always sunny, green and warm, with summer photos of places and people dominating (e.g.: figure 5.4). This aligns with ST travel dates, Destination account expertise of the trace interviews and summer terms in descriptions of corpus posts. Most BD episodes are produced in summer, rarely showing snow-covered pastures, influencing the aesthetics of ST communication on Instagram. An even when snow is occasionally visible it is rarely part of the narrative, except in the winter special where it is incorporated but framed as anomaly and as something special for the BD. The strong influence of the TV show on the choice of ST's communication on Instagram becomes quite obvious. The BD TV show does not so much influence how all the groups show something but more what they choose to depict and with that the screen product becomes a kind of gatekeeper for places of ST communication at the WK.



Figure 5.4: An example of a summer post by a screen tourist in front of the Gruberhof (source: Instagram screenshot with post id CQYFv10tRpp).

Professional content

The dimension of professionalism cuts through all groups (page 157). ST accounts span the entire spectrum, while Production accounts appear more professional but often styled to seem like private content. Destination accounts generally maintain a professional demeanor but also influenced by account size. The best explanation for the professionalism dimension is probably the size and reach of the account in the different groups. Larger and more successful accounts use best practices to create professional content (page 119), which includes:

- 360 degrees (post id CFMPNCDfPte and CHhna20FQFz)
- Are very well photographed (post id ByZcZ6wl350)

- Layered foreground and background (post id CGISQbsnnff and Bns4QqGhwk2)
- depth of field (post id Bx4FMVfl_uW, B5Htm5_Iqi4 and COuMoqOqVtO)
- warm colors (post id CIX8qSUFyPD, CIJCUruH0Lx and CDwJi4hlPX) spectacular views
 - night views of the town (post id B7To0xAqbfm)
 - at sunset (post id CM2rXpIgYAj)
 - from a drone (post id BntY6Z0nIEt).

With these techniques and the elite advantage, they dominate ST communication on Instagram (page 149). Influencers and Production accounts, while sometimes appearing private, engage in professional communication because influencing is a business after all. Most influencers, as well as Destination and Production accounts, produce professional posts motivated by business incentives, whereas smaller accounts and regular STs post more personal, emotionally driven content (page 157). Actors' professional content leading the way as the ST communication with the highest reach but the real divide is between large, professional accounts and smaller, private ones.

The product in the photo

The actors take center stage, with minimal screen production as background (page 135). Fans expect this self-promotion, similar to influencers, because that is why they are following actors on Instagram and this does not change with publishing ST content. For Destination accounts, the focus is on selling a place or service and not themselves per se, promoting attractions, accommodations and in a broader sense also the alpine landscapes. Regular STs may not sell anything specific but maybe their social and fan status to others. They steer towards being an influencers when they get bigger (earlier on page 171), shifting from regular tourists (e.g.: figure 4.5 (a) - (d)) to become the product themselves (e.g.: figure 4.3 (a) - (f)). They do that by pushing themselves and their bodies more and more into the foreground of the photo.

The exalted background

The WK mountain range, with a focus on the rocky peaks near Going and Ellmau to a lesser extend the green meadows near Söll and Scheffau, is for all groups¹³ a key feature in ST communication (map 3.9). All groups agree on the central photo motive being the WK mountains between Ellmauer Halt and Ellmauer Tor (figure 7.4), alongside the main screen locations' buildings. At Gruberhof (figure 4.10), the

¹³See page 307 for the STs, 131 for the Destination and 308 for the Production

high altitude offers breathtaking panoramic views that lets you easily connect to the exalted feeling of alpine photography. But this is a feeling the WK destination can evoke throughout the valley due to the visibility of its dominant mountain range. The striking mountain range of the Wilder Kaiser (Eng.: Wilde Emperor) that gave the region its name is also leaving its mark on the screen product that transports it into ST communication. The screen locations perfectly combine these stunning backgrounds with the fame of a TV location.

Holidays in your head

The theory shows ST is closely tied to emotions (page 22), fantasy (page 29) and mental maps. The hashtag #Urlaubimkopf (Eng.: holiday in your head) perfectly encapsulates this (page 127), though it does not increase post reach due to its specificity. These hashtags foster the WK community, attracting super fans who dream of the destination even when they can not visit. Also potential STs, having mentally traveled to WK through the TV show, are an ideal target audience. When they are physically visiting the real WK the destination triggers emotions and fantasies, that yet again are only happening within your mind. This exemplifies the metaphysical experience in a nutshell that we so often encounter in a post modern world. The post-modern destination is neither false nor true, but on a spectrum, simultaneously true and false.

The variation of the photographer is lost by the motive

Comparing motives and photographer points shows that motives are more clustered than where the photographer stands. The photographer sees a greater variety by moving around, but the published motive is what followers see on Instagram. Thus, the diversity of the photographer's points is often lost to the dominant motives. The strong images of screen locations and the WK mountain range, tied to a TV show's narrative and emotions, overshadow the photographer's unique perspectives. This is of course only the case when photographer and motive points are far away from each other (e.g.: figure 4.14 (c)) and not within a very short walking distance (figure 4.32). Mostly it is panorama shots that the photographer position gets simply ignored (figure 4.7).

Convergence of authenticity and fiction

Famous actors and big influencers share much in common (page 148), often functioning as influencers themselves. Both sell themselves as a product, with influencers appearing more authentic and actors more fantasy-driven. But is it really authentic, while actors are mostly able to clearly separate fiction from real life (figure 4.31), in-

fluencers often blur these lines by staging everyday authenticity (figure 4.39) mixed with sponsorships (figure 4.3 (c)).¹⁴ This convergence of staged authenticity and fiction is an integral part of ST communications and on screen locations. Within their influencer personas, they combine the staged authenticity of reality with the fiction of the perfect life. Influencers and actors seamlessly fit into social media, tourism and the intersection of real destinations and fictional universes.

Fiction vs. landscape vs. itself

STs, Destination and Production share similarities but offer detailed varied photo compositions.¹⁵ Production accounts focus on selling themselves, centering on them in the photo composition. Destination accounts sell the region, landscape and attractions, always incorporating these elements in their photos. Regular STs fall in between, showcasing beautiful landscapes while positioning themselves within the BD world, connecting with beloved characters. They aim to be part of the BD narrative, similar to influencers but not to sell themselves. STs focus on the fictional aspect, Destination on the landscape, and Production on itself.

¹⁴At the end it might more clear what is real and what is fiction for the actor when he takes the stage than the influencers' life that became a stage.

¹⁵Chapter 4.4.2 on page 151 for STs, page 151 for Destination, and page 149 for Production

5.2 Subsumption of the Case Study into the Development of Media and Tourism

Marketing tourism in a Global Cities environment

Commercial tourism photos, according to Urry, overwhelm human vision by staging geography to create desire. These photos present a beautiful place aesthetic superior to what one sees in person, enhanced further by digital editing capabilities today. Marketing generates strong visual stimuli, with ST being particularly compelling. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 174)

The power of live events ST and live concerts share four key factors:

1. Devoted fan bases for musicians, actors and their stories.
2. Media products draw people into fandoms, making them STs or concertgoers.
3. Live experience spaces offer proximity to stars and narratives.
4. These venues foster community among like-minded fans.

As ST developed, the relationship to "live entertainment has changed profoundly in recent years (Romano, 2023, p. 2)". "The age of streaming media has brought with it increased access to concert footage, front-row fan cams, and highly mobilized fan bases who approach everything about the concert season like it is their job. From buying tickets (good luck) to prepping for the big night by carefully planning the perfect concert outfit, these fans do it all - and many of them do it on camera, sharing the whole experience with other die-hards online. (Romano, 2023, p. 2)" The Taylor Swift Eras Tour exemplifies this shift, with live streams and movies about the tour, mirroring how BD fans engage with new episodes and social media. The same is true of their behavior at the site, as they both capture the moment with their cell phones and put themselves in the photo to prove they were there. This begs the question, why do we still go? "If we already know what we are getting before we roll up to the stadium, and if we are not present in the moment because we are on our phones filming, is there anything left to the live experience beyond what social media has already provided? (Ibid., p. 5)" Despite knowing what to expect and constantly filming with phones, live experiences "can still retain its power (Ibid., p. 5)". Live streams and social media connect fans but can not fully replicate the in-person experience. (cf. Ibid., p. 2ff) The WK DMO offers first the screen locations where fans get close to the narrative and its characters, and second the fan fest where they get close to the actors, bridging the gap between parasocial and real connections. Clips from Taylor Swift's concerts, photos from the BD set are unavoidable anyway, so why not embrace them to enhance your fan experience and make you excited about what you can experience live on site.

Uniqueness through the screen production Tourist destinations are seen as extraordinary, contrasting everyday life. They must offer unique experiences that satisfy escapist tourists. Marketing promotes these unique experiences, often creating or using myths to shape the destination's image. Television can enhance this by making places "hyper-meaningful" (Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 117), a technique few other marketing techniques match. (cf. Ibid., p. 117; Chen and Chen, 2017, p. 3) ST sites effectively label a place as unique and mythical, providing a marketing edge over global destination competitors.

Superreplicator tourism In social sciences, tourism is termed a super-replicator: "It promises the fulfillment of needs that it has created itself, and thus enforces constant repetition (Translated by deep1.com; Groebner, 2020, p. 44)."¹⁶ This paradox accumulates just enough disappointment to drive the desire for another trip, keeping people on the tourism hamster wheel. Marketing, like Tirol's "Heart of the Alps" image, fuels this desire and create the justification that you go on vacation not because of the destination but your everyday life. The tourists keep thinking that it is their lack of ability to fulfill their own dreams and everyday life that is the problem if destinations are not as imagined. The industry uses a limited set of images repeatedly, driven by technical reproduction, collective gaze, social networks, and medialisation. These limited images focus und reproduce the same image tourism as the self created promise. (cf. Ibid., p. 44 - 55) Screen products and social network content perpetuate this cycle, embedding tourism desires casually into everyday life.

Evolving of the post tourist

The post tourist comes after the tourist to abolish what he does himself. From a theoretical standpoint, post tourism involves a postmodern critique of traditional tourism. It involves questioning the images and structures that have historically defined tourism, including the pursuit of the 'exotic' and the consumption of places and cultures. Post tourism suggests a more reflexive, informed and sometimes cynical engagement with the tourism industry. (cf. Jansson, 2018, p. 100ff)

Post tourism and social networks Social networks like Instagram often intersect with tourism. Jansson calls them "spreadable media" (Jansson, 2018, p. 101), noting their advantage in personalized communication but a disadvantage in eroding cultural distinctions and boundaries. The social transformation of tourism following the trends of packaged tour in the 19th century and mass tourism at the beginning of the 20th century was first noted in the 1980s. More people had access to tourism and the circulation of tourism media increased. The rise of the Internet, with ubiquitous mobile connections and devices, further transformed tourism, blending useful

¹⁶The world's *first* working perpetuum mobile!

information with emotional "phantasmagoria" (Ibid., p. 101). Web 2.0 and social media have established new ways of navigating, interacting, creating, and distributing all kinds of content with visuals at its core. This new tourism trend accepts the staged nature of mass tourism and in a playful mode performs tourism along the media images rather than searching for the authentic destination. The post tourism image of space undermines mainstream tourism. However, the widespread success of tourism content production and consumption on social media risks cultural inflation, diminishing the uniqueness of these experiences. of over-exposing the new post-tourist gaze, leading to cultural inflation and making it less unique. (cf. Ibid., p. 101 - 104)

Post tourism starts at home Post-tourism begins at home, often in front of a screen, with media creating desires and new perspectives for travelers. Post-tourists play with tourism codes seen on social media, treating travel as a game where "the world becomes a stage (Jansson, 2018, p. 102)". They accept and perform staged authenticity at the destination but also actively play the role of a tourist¹⁷. (cf. Ibid., p. 102; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 115) Sometimes the post tourists even re-enacts popular scenes at screen locations.¹⁸ (cf. Kim, 2010) This trend aligns with theories by Baudrillard, Lash, Urry and Eco, who suggests the "ironic traveler" (Eco, 2014) navigates hyperreal environments and proclaiming the "end of tourism".¹⁹ (cf. Lash and Urry, 2002; Jansson, 2018, p. 101). Post-tourism is more the notion that tourism (theory) is becoming blurred at the edges "due to people's everyday involvement in virtual travel through media and visual consumption (Ibid., p. 101)". However, tourism persists, with post-tourism blurring traditional boundaries through everyday virtual travel and visual consumption. Post-tourist theory emphasizes the constant engagement from home all the way to the destinations with screen content that lets you gaze into and at places. (cf. Ibid., p. 101; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 116)

Post tourism and web 2.0 When *post-tourism* was coined in the 80s, Web 2.0 was not part of the concept. Today, we not only consume but also create screen content through the Web 2.0, becoming (co-)creators of our vacation destinations on platforms like Instagram. Geotags allow us to re-code tourist spots. With Web 2.0 so closely connected in time (immediate posting at the place) and space (tagged

¹⁷Like the footprints of many tourists (figure 7.11 (e)) in an empty-looking photo of Horseshoe Bend in figure 7.11 (d)

¹⁸Actually a habit that was not seen much in the corpus of ST communication of the BD. And when, then only maybe in special places like the famous lunch table at the Gruberhof in figure 4.10 but the fans never went that far as getting a costume or recreating scenes.

¹⁹After the war to end all wars comes the post tourist to end all tourism. But as we see in the 20s of the 21st century, the possibility of war is still there, and tourism does not look like it will die out anytime soon.

places) to our carbon-bound reality, the "relations between the authentic and the simulated are continuously challenged (Jansson, 2018, p. 102)". Tourism logic now pervades social life, with holiday photos being highly commented on social media, tourism strategies expanding into various consumer sectors, niche interests being marketed in tourism²⁰ and tourists contributing to destination image-making and holiday stereotypes. Thus, tourism is "nowhere [in space, D.B.] and yet everywhere [in society, D.B.]" (Urry, 1995, p. 150). (cf. Jansson, 2018, p. 103)

Imaginary zeitgeist

The reality behind the boundaries of organized tourism Stijn Reijnders describes a Dracula tour where tourists feel a sense of underworld within a safe tourist bubble: Tourists wear plastic gloves for a fingerprinting activity involving a hired homeless person, experiencing controlled otherness. Reijnders notes that the gloves symbolize the separation of reality and imagination: "ultimately it is this thin plastic layer that keeps the two worlds apart" (Ibid., p. 108). The packaged tour, acting as a barrier, protects tourists from full immersion in imagination in favour of a staged experience. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 108)". Similarly, tractor tours to the Gruberhof or the BD Fan Fest are artificial, bundling experiences to serve local and commercial interests.

Imagination against the chaos we call reality Reijnders and colleagues argue in "Locating Imagination in Popular Culture (van Es et al., 2021)" that imagination helps us cope with modern life's chaos, channeling "all those sensations [...] into the idea of a coherent and univocal reality (van Es et al., 2021, p. 2)". While universal, imagination is culturally shaped, when it allows immersion in imagined worlds, the line between reality and imagination blurs. Screen and heritage tourism part of this trend in modern imagination. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 2 - 3)

A global musée imaginaire Popular culture, along with television and film, serves as a "musée imaginaire"²¹, acting as a repository for imagination. In post-war Germany, the "Heimatfilm" genre offered familiar narratives of home and family, themes echoed in the BD narrative, aligning with the postwar need for belonging. Globalization has amplified this role, creating a need for familiar stories for people moving globally. These stories, characters and landscapes provide a sense of belonging. (Institut, 2009; Koll, 2012; Höfig, 1973)

Social media as a place of both worlds In luxury packaged tourism, reality and fiction are separated, but on social media, they merge into a *magical place*²². Here,

²⁰Like the heavy metal cruise ships that have become popular in recent years.

²¹a term coined by André Malraux (1901-76), author, war hero, and French Minister of Culture 1959-69, from his book "Psychologie de l'Art: Le Musée imaginaire" (Paris 1947).

²²Tahiti?

photos of the tourists reality and artists' imagined images coexist, turning barriers into gateways. Social media allows us to witness different layers of worldviews.²³ Similarly, ST, particularly ST communication, serves as a magical place where reality and fiction converge as the case study proved.

The embodied imagination of screen tourism The embodied experience of ST immerses fans physically in fictional settings, similar to a pilgrimage. "It is often one that fans find difficult to put into words, as it is entirely contained within the body (van Es et al., 2021, p. 289)," writes Abby Waysdorf in her article on "Placing Fandom". This physical immersion allows fans to fully embrace their imagination and another reality, which is part of the fascination of live events explained on page 178. Imagination is experienced both in place and in the body, with these bodily experiences being favored by memory over time. (cf. Ibid., p. 289)

Memory favors imagination Memory plays a crucial role in recalling places of imagination, as Reijnders defines it as "nothing more or less than the imagination of an event from the past (Reijnders, 2016, p. 114)". Memory often favors imagination, explaining post-tourism's indifference to authenticity: If physical experiences in tourism blend real and fictional stories in our memory, making them indistinguishable, then not separating them in the first place is just consistent. And it is, unironically, the physical space itself that helps to "provide the decor for the stories - historical and fictional. Simultaneously, the stories are experienced as 'real' because they are put into place. (Ibid., p. 114)" For instance, Transylvania is remembered as a place of vampire myths and historical violence.²⁴ (cf. Ibid., p. 113-114)

Tourism utopia

At the beginning of the 21st century, vacations appear to be the last utopias, offering +/-30 days²⁵ of perceived freedom. Despite being a consumer of the service industry, holidays are marketed as paradises of anti-work. These utopias serve as a childlike fortresses for adults and seniors, with cheap food and forever stable gas prices, and they offer the kind of fun you cannot have at home. This tourist utopia symbolizes the good life, setting standards for happiness and freedom in other parts of life. (cf. Ibid., p. H15 - 16 + 46 - 53; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 6 + 29)

Dream destinations of others Dream destinations reflect societal desires rather than personal ones, driven by social components beyond individual control. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 122) Establishing such destinations requires more than guide-

²³The layers are discussed in more detail on page 5.2.

²⁴Memory does not distinguish between fiction and reality, similar to how fake news and conspiracy theories influence perceptions in the age of post-truth. More on this later on the page 198.

²⁵more if you are a teacher or university lecturer :-)

books; it needs for example viral hashtags, geotags (figure 7.11 (a)), or blockbuster movies²⁶ to connect with collective desires. These places, desired by all, become backdrops for personal stories, blending nature and culture: "In their alpine variants, from St. Moritz to Kitzbühl and Aspen, they are creations of industrial high modernity, where first grand hotels in reinforced concrete construction and then ski stations provide a man-made super-nature [or a hyperreality, D.B.]: Thanks to technical infrastructure, visitors can relax in the high mountains from all the disturbing aspects of highly industrial technology (Translated by deep1.com; Ibid., p. 110)." The promise of the dream destination is that time will pass slowly and you will be younger, thinner, stronger, better looking and more sexually attractive. The stories told about these destinations are so ubiquitous that everyone knows them. Venice, Tahiti²⁷, Japan could be considered dream destinations and we have an immediate image of what it would look like and what it can offer. "Most of the destinations I long for are not really existing cities, mountains or beaches, but locations for an imagined film starring me. I didn't come up with the script myself, but took it from movies and books (Translated by deep1.com)", says Valentin Groebner in his book "Ferienmüde" (Ibid.) about dream destinations. It is what he calls "Inception" (after the same movie; Nolan, 2010) that dream destinations are just a transfer from other people's fictional sequences into your own mental cinema. Here the personal facts matter less than the narrative created by and for others. (cf. Ibid., p. 120) Today, social media is the primary mode where you can witness this phenomenon.

Critique on Utopia Intellectuals like Susan Sontag and Siegfried Kracauer recognized the flawed utopia of tourism. Sontag noted that "They are not all nice, the beautiful things (Sontag (1977), quoted in Groebner, 2020)", while Kracauer described entertainment venues as "Asylum for homeless person (Translated by deep1.com; Ibid., p. 45)".²⁸ Tourism was criticized but postmodernism embraced and developed the tourist utopia even further. Today, holidays are safe spaces for staged pleasure and freedom. This is leading us to smile in vacation photos and present an idyllic image, because we know what it is supposed to look like. What is fictional elsewhere is accepted during vacations (figure 5.5) despite its few critiques, where staged authenticity and fictional stories become the reality for post-tourists. (cf. Ibid. 16 - 17 + 48 - 62; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 10; van Es et al., 2021, p. 291)

Pseudo events and artificial ST places Urry describes "pseudo-events" in tourism,

²⁶An example is the movie "The Beach" (Boyle, 2000) after an unsuccessful book. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 112)

²⁷"It's a magical place!"

²⁸The criticism of tourism is as old as tourism itself, and the critics themselves are trapped in a repetitive cycle of stereotypes, arguments, and complaints that "there would be nothing new to see out there in the foreign land (Translated by deep1.com; Groebner, 2020, p. 104)".

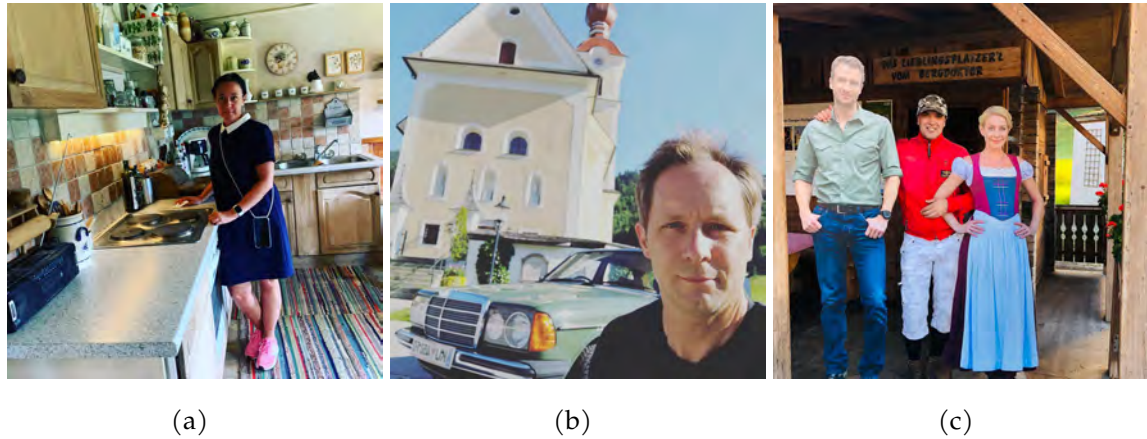


Figure 5.5: (a) Playing with a rag being part of the household in the Gruberhof. (b) Putting yourself in scene by the screen location of the church with the famous BD mercedes. (c) Making photos with the characters in the destination but they are just made out of cardboard. (Source: Instagram screenshots with post ids (a) CQVgnCdDiqC, (b) CCSm7iwoyqR and (c) BpGV7gfHujY)

where mass tourists, isolated from the local environment and people, enjoy contrived attractions and ignore the real world. This creates a cycle where the tourism industry offers more extravagant experiences, distancing tourists further from reality. Examples for the BD at the WK include fan fests (figure 4.20), contrived tourist spots like Ellmauer stars (figure 5.3), and guided tours designed to mimic the famous lunch scenes at the Gruberhof (figure 4.10). (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 8)."

Utopia for fans Holidays are ideal for fans, who often engage more in their fandom while on vacation. "The structures and rhetoric of being 'on vacation' support acting as a fan in ways that 'everyday life' does not," writes Abby Waysdorf (van Es et al., 2021, p. 291). Tourists have the freedom to indulge in fandom, especially at screen locations where they behave differently as Waysdorf discovered. The holiday sets the mood for fandom, but ST promotes to a special degree the performance of fandom, not feeling ashamed and embracing to act like a fan. (cf. Ibid., p. 291 + 292) Fans embrace the utopia of tourism and bring with them the passionate belief in utopias of narrative and to be someone in these fictional worlds.

Suspension of disbelief The suspension of disbelief in watching screen products extends to the induced ST. We seek utopia, knowingly embracing its fiction. Screen-induced tourism transfers this fiction into reality, where fans accept the utopia's existence even faster. Despite recognizing inconsistencies, fans find joy in the blend of fiction and reality, when they can speculate about production processes. The inconsistency between reality and fiction can even provide an opportunity for die-hard

fans²⁹ to dive into new fantasies and imagined realities. Tour guides enhance this with fantastical stories about the on location filming. (cf. Ibid., p. 209; Böcher, 2018b; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 73ff + 245) However, tourists never fully experience the setting like the production crew or characters, because they are coming as tourists. But as the "suspension of disbelief" exists and is strong within ST the differences they try to overlook exist beyond what you believe. These are the gloves of tourism³⁰ you cannot take off but the post-tourist values the experience over authenticity (cf. Frost, 2006, p. 3)

The tourism industry knows the utopia but do not care either Nothing diminishes the appeal of staged authenticity:

1. Tourists seek utopia far from home.
2. Fans and STs dive deeper into imagination.
3. The tourism industry prefers easy-to-package pseudo-events.
4. Local residents, living post-modern lives, participate for the promise of tourism's benefits.

That the industry and locals support pseudo-events for economic reasons, is not a simple North-South power dynamic but a global trend. (cf. Raban, 2011, p. 194ff) Some places are so dominated by the image of these pseudo-events of people in costumes that they can hardly think of anything else as seen with for example traditional costumes (called *Trachten*) in Bavaria and Austria (Example in the case study in figure 5.6), and events like Munich's Oktoberfest. Locals play along knowing the everyday reality differs but engage with tourism's promising potential. For DMOs, promoting tourism is just a job, competing globally. For all of them either locals, tourists, DMO or even the production crew the stages authenticity is around them anyway because the fictional and the fake is now part of post modernism zeitgeist.

Holidays are a (wrong) treat Valentin Groebner asks if holidays are a reward born from despair in everyday life. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 47) Enzensberger notes already 1958 that "The flood of tourism is a single flight from reality. [...] But every flight, however foolish, however impotent, criticizes that from which it turns away (translated by deep1.com; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 56)". Tourism critiques the outbound society in contrast to praising the destination. It is a temporary escape from mundane life, similar to watching a movie but lasting longer than 2 hours. These escapes prevent addressing root problems at home. Enzensberger says tourism asks the right question but offers the wrong answer: The tourist does not change the place, but goes to another space. (cf. Ibid., p. 56; Berger et al., 2018, p. 28; Groebner, 2020, p. 47 -

²⁹This is for all the "Die Hard" (John McTiernan, 1988) Hans Gruber fans.

³⁰The same gloves from Stijn Reijnders on page 181.

48) Out of the despair of their everyday lives, they seek a different world at home (BD TV show) and in the distance (holiday destinations). The screen product narratives are the sugarcoat that makes the holidays feel like a treat, but it is essentially medicine. It is medicine for the symptoms, but the real cause of their despair lies at home and in the everyday life.



Figure 5.6: Concert with traditional costumes on the town square of Going am Wilden Kaiser (Austria). The building on the right is the Wilder Kaiser Guesthouse screen location (source: own photo).

Traveling to the past For Boll-
now, hiking's evolution into post-tourist utopia is not an escape but a polarity between everyday life and nature. The WK mountains and nature counteract modern life³¹: No big houses, paths that seem to follow the terrain and a simple, straightforward space in the valley between the mountains. Our artificial and complicated daily life in postmodern cities evokes feelings of nostalgia, not for lived times but a mythical past, pure and "not yet spoiled by modernity (Chen and Chen, 2017, p. 3)"³². Since the 18th century, proto-tourists equated travel with a journey back in time but what they meant were

spaces where the beauty of the past was still (lived) reality³³. The WK, with its traditional farms, romantic mountains and hiking paths, embodies this nostalgia and is showcased in the Heimatfilm genre (page 85), highlighting traditional values and harmony with nature (page 85).

The subjective tourist is never a tourist Every tourist believes their way of traveling is superior, dismissing others as less authentic. Despite proclaiming, *I am definitely not a tourist*, they often criticize fellow travelers. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p.

³¹How feelings of nostalgia and the exalted nature of the Alps fit together is explained in paragraph 2.2.1.

³²that hiking was the beginning of modernity and a big step towards a different life experience that drives all the changes up to this point is of course again the postmodern simultaneous dichotomy that can be ignored.

³³This is what we can call post-romantic.

224 - 225; Groebner, 2020, p. 105) The influx of tourists to the Alps in the 1860s sparked fears of destruction and so the disdain dates back to the 19th century with the stereotype of the "ugly tourist" (Ibid., p. 90). The ugliness of the tourists flowing into the Alps through an industrial complex was contrasted with the beauty of the mountains. (cf. Ibid., p. 46 + 90 - 94) The ideal tourist is seen as flexible, not weak to carry its luggage, independent, adventurous (with a dash of Indiana Jones) and educated traveler. This ideal is in contrast to the perceived inadequacy of others and even yourself as it is often unattainable. In a world where you cannot live up to the expectations, you are not in the desired world, but in a tourist dystopia. (cf. Ibid., p. 50 + 95 - 97; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 224ff; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 202) Screen products like the BD TV show perpetuates these ideals of for example empty mountains, but actual destinations rarely meet these romanticized expectations, leading to mixed feelings among tourists about the others (page 165) they are symbol of exactly that it is not romantically empty destination.

Unbound screen locations without reference Places like Los Angeles and California are so saturated with media images that they are often perceived only through screen products. Lukinbeal notes that "In the End, Orange County is what it becomes on TV (Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 122)." TV and media narratives circulate between screen products, social media and staged tourist utopias. This creates a Baudrillardian scenario where screen products disconnect from real spaces, becoming signs referencing other signs. Television is now free of its absolute referent in a real place. Shows like "The O.C." (Schwartz, Josch, 2007) illustrate that places exist as much in our minds as on the screen, transcending their original screen locations. Space has transcended the confines of its original location and can now be found and defined anywhere. Social media can depict these unbound places, which is the reason this work looks at social media. (cf. Ibid., p. 110 + 121 - 126)

The visual utopia we want The tourist utopia is a romantic pursuit of social, cultural and mediated dreams. Strain states that "visual technologies have always been at the heart of these," with travel and cinema sharing the "illusion of demediating mediation (Strain, 2003, p. 3)". Certain cultural experiences claim to "erase the mediation of reality altogether (Tzanelli, 2007, p. 5)". Tourism and cinema promise a purifying encounter with unspoiled otherness, but this is a romantic illusion. Both film and tourism simulate utopia while denying they are a simulation. The mediators themselves proclaim they do not mediate, a paradox so obvious only because of all the mediators nowadays. In a postmodern context, even when noticed, we actually mostly do not care. (cf. Ibid., p. 5)

Spatial turn

Proximity is transformation From the diverging realities in the media and your personal experience of the world comes a desire for proximity. People want to be close to the stars and stories they encounter in media. ST is exactly that: Bringing people from their media world of David Hume's so-called "absent present (Hume, 1740, p. 123)" to be on-site witnesses at the destination.³⁴ ST is just one form that fulfills this desire to ground the imagination in material places. Place is still important and today no less than before.³⁵ (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 106; van Es et al., 2021, p. 5 - 7 + 294) But it is always ambiguous in postmodernity, as Waysdorf notes: "To be there, however we define 'there,' is important, even if 'there' doesn't really exist (Ibid., p. 294)." These processes of transformation change not only each group involved, but also the physical destination and the networked spaces, as the case study in sections 4.1 to 4.4 has shown..

A big push with GPS GPS technology has accelerated the spatial transformation of everyday life. The technology shows us the intertwined nature of physical and digital spaces and already further between the real and the possible. These features of smartphones and the Internet show that they are not always used to retreat from physical spaces, but to maximize the potential of the spaces surrounding one's life. The impact of GPS, geotags and other geospatial technologies has been revolutionary in several important areas of our organized society in the global north.³⁶ (cf. Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 3; Frost, 2006, p. 23)

Post modernismus

"To move and to experience the absolute nowness appears to be the road to salvation in post modernity [...] (Wasburn and Meyrowitz, 1988, p. 13)." Tourism offers fulfillment and societal mediation, shaping the spaces we visit. However, postmodern tourists feel insecure with too many available choices for the marketed salvation. (cf. Ibid., p. 13; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 63ff; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 6) ST offers a way to select destinations through fandom, making it easier to find the personal paradise for everyone.³⁷ It is like finding the dream destination in the stories first and then the physical space is read to discover. Yet, it can also add complexity by

³⁴There is a long tradition of people trying to locate places from media, possibly beginning with the work of Petrarch as early as the 14th century, and with a big boom during the Age of Romanticism that continues to this day. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 7)

³⁵Also visible in the use of geotags (page 224) to place the digital social media posts in the world.

³⁶For more on GPS, its technology, and its world-changing capabilities, see paragraph 5.2 on page 224.

³⁷Over 18 percent of the questioned ST came to the WK only because of the BD. Another 42 percent are there because the BD was one reason many.

layering fictional choices over reality. Despite this, post-tourists continue to seek out new spaces, because personal fulfillment can only be found in the present and never in a past vacation. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 285ff; Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 63)

Symbolic value of mountains As Wöhler puts it: "Goods and services were enchanted in the post modernist times (Wasburn and Meyrowitz, 1988, p. 45)." Goods and services are valued for their symbolic meanings rather than their functions or prices. The symbolic meaning is not just what it means to myself, but what it means to others. This shift changes the relationship between media and tourism, making the consumption of places an act of interpretation. Mountains, for example, now symbolize cultural meanings beyond just being a potentially hostile environment and challenging activity. Now they have a culturally embedded meaning of place as exalted and as a protest against everyday life in capitalist Western societies. As marketing can only cite established symbols, DMOs rely on symbols created by art and culture, using these to promote locations. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 73) This symbiosis works well with screen productions at holiday destinations.

The meta trend of de-differentiation In seeking new experiences, tourism often creates uniformity through standard hotels, landscape stereotypes and pop culture influences on local landmarks. Mass tourism and Western cultural spread lead to a monotonous world, contrary to the exotic experiences desired. Even in the 19th century, tourists felt there was already nothing new to see.³⁸ (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 95 - 97; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 8) In a world full of signs and continued growth of media presumption, the gaze is further streamlined. Postmodernism tends to de-differentiate spaces and the practices within them. Television and its content have been described as a "vast wasteland (Esslin, 2017, p. 103; Gitlin, 1987, p. 3)" symbolizing the final point of de-differentiation. Urry describes tourist culture as "anti-auratic," valuing reproducibility over uniqueness because today everything can be mechanically, electronically or digitally reproduced. Tourists do not care about de-differentiation. This is visible under certain hashtags and geotags on Instagram, as in figure 5.20. (cf. Ibid., p. 98) But postmodernism is too complicated for a one-sided answer as they have contradictory behavior. As the de-differentiation of tourism in the carbon world grows, the post-tourist is increasingly looking for new areas of the *real*. These new areas can be found in ST, shaped by screen products, showing us a new level of differentiation of post tourists. Post tourism could be seen as a "generalized social condition (Jansson, 2018, p. 103)" of postmodernity: "A condition that includes both de-differentiation and a complex set of reactions³⁹ to this prevailing

³⁸The counter agent at that time formulated in 1908 by the industrialist Albert Kahn coming back from a world tour was: "Take photographs!" (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 96)

³⁹How post tourism is actually against tourism is explained in paragraph 5.2.

trend towards de-differentiation (Ibid., p. 103)."

Screen tourism de-differentiation In Goathland, UK, the front stage of the fictional TV series *Heartbeat* merges with the back stage of the real town of Aidensfield, forcing the countryside into progressive de-differentiation. The rural myth⁴⁰, reinforced by TV series, is contested by locals⁴¹ but in a capitalistic world, the streamlined gaze and the myth are stronger than the inhabitants at the screen location. Lash, in 1990, thinks that de-differentiation is the "fundamental structuring trait of post modernism (Lash, 2014, p. 11)". Twenty-first century pop culture and the ST (industry) solidify and ground these myths in reality. Places are culturally performed, with ST playing a major role in these new performances happening all around the world in an also de-differentiated manor. (cf. Mordue, 2009, p. 336 - 337 + 342 - 343) Social media further amplifies this effect⁴², similar to TV and film, reinforcing rural myths and de-differentiation.

Spaces of integrated fiction Today, we cannot dismiss the impact of screen products as purely fictional. The lines between fiction and reality are blurred, and often, we don't care to distinguish. Television influences us daily, shaping our perceptions with exaggerated stereotypes of people, spaces and events. We have a zoom call at work, we have dinner in the evening, we watch a series on TV and then talk about it when we do the dishes. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 91) A perfect example of integrated fictions comes from the focus group study by Andreja Trdina and Maja Turnsek (van Es et al., 2021, p. 210) that actually also about the BD: "The father of Bergie's⁴³ girlfriend Anna has just died. And it was in that episode. Two days later we went on a trip. One acquaintance called me and joked, he said, now I know, you are going to the funeral. Do you have funeral garland? (laughs) Yeah, Arthur died. And we did also go to see the cemetery. And there actually is a cemetery. A nice, great cemetery. It was interesting that, and I was fascinated about it, that there is no marble, it is really a place to calm your soul. Greenery, grass, and everything was so modest, so simple. (van Es et al., 2021, p. 210)" In this example the death of a fictional character in the BD TV show led viewers to visit a real cemetery at the WK depicted in the series, highlighting the overlap of fictional events and real-life experiences, which they are aware of but just do not care really much. In this overlap without rupture, one can see the tremendous impact on the (screen) tourists' sense of place. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 210; Wasburn and Meyrowitz, 1988) Just as we cannot live without imagination, Ang says: "The mediated and the material coex-

⁴⁰Described in more detail in paragraph .

⁴¹Nothing similar is known for the Tyrolean residents of the WK against the BD ST.

⁴²More on this in paragraph 5.2 on page 217.

⁴³A nickname for the the BD's main character Martin Gruber aka the mountain doctor.

ist (Deleuze, 1986)" When visiting screen locations, people experience both real and fictional spaces simultaneously, illustrating the postmodern paradox of coexistence and collision. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 91 + 105)

The simulation integrates reality Perhaps Baudrillard is right, and we are already living in a simulation, integrating reality into fiction rather than the reverse. A participant in Trdina and Turnsek's study describes waiting for a character from the BD series: "[...] we were just waiting for Susanne⁴⁴ to come out. [...] Wow, here I am. You are expecting that she will come out [...] and say something. You can just see her.⁴⁵ (van Es et al., 2021, p. 210)" They are waiting at the WK Guesthouse, expecting her to appear, highlighting the blurred line between fiction and reality. On the screen location, reality can integrate with fiction which is said by the study participant: "Perhaps when you're out there you experience the series more than at home [...]" (Ibid., p. 210)." Screen locations sustain the fantasy of merging fiction with reality, with fictional narratives seeping into fans' real-world spatial and cultural practices. (cf. Ibid., p. 210 + 211)

Life imitates art The postmodern world allows life to imitate art swiftly. Destinations adapt to screen worlds, sometimes with small changes like street furniture or information boards, and sometimes with larger ones driven by a screen product's success. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 111 + 121) For instance, the TV show "The O.C." (Schwartz, Josch, 2007) led to many changes in Orange County (USA), including renaming cities and events, changing official buildings signs to OC and creating the OC Marathon. (Griffin (2008), quoted in Reijnders, 2016, p. 121). Residents, however, note that only tourists use 'the OC' (SIC; emphasis in original; Ibid., p. 121)".⁴⁶ Similar rebranding occurred in Goathland (UK) renamed "Heartbeat Country" after the TV series "Heartbeat" (Byrne, 2010). This "invites tourists into an immediate, 'real-life' consumption drama that can somehow bridge the fictional world of 'Heartbeat' and the actual sociogeographic condition of the Goathland area and set the epistemological framework through which tourists negotiate and interpret experiences (Mordue, 2009, p. 336)." These changes, driven by media, suggest that real life follows a medial logic, rather than merely imitating media. Media mediates life and not life imitates art.

Many modern worlds Postmodernism reveals plural and multiple worlds. Photographs embody associative and ambiguous qualities, making them ideal for post-

⁴⁴Main cast character of the actress Natalie O'Hara

⁴⁵This you can read as a kind of spiritual experience for fans. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 210)

⁴⁶Similar phenomena of changing real place names to fit the fictional counterpart occurred numerous times, to name just a few: "Bond County," "The Home of Middle Earth," or, of course, the case study of this work, "Mountain Doctor town." The scientific term for this practice is localization.

modernism's undefined communication. Pixels that show (the reality) but can be interpreted (in a time of ambiguity). (cf. Rosa, 2016, p. 86; Schreiber, 2020, p. 40) Social media exemplifies in the case study this through photos of STs: Fans associate the photos of the screen location with the drama and characters, while non-fans see them differently. Highlights for the tourist can be annoyances for locals, as the ST sometimes forget that they are not in their fantasy but in a real neighborhood. Social media not just shows many perspectives of ST but expands the audience of one post to have many different perspectives on ST communication. On location, in a photo and sequentially in social media you can see many upon many modern worlds looked upon from multiple worlds. (cf. Ibid., p. 40ff; Rosa, 2016, p. 186)

Connecting and digitalisation

From celuloid to ones ond zeros The material basis of cinema has shifted from traditional theaters to various digital platforms, services and devices, losing its original material connection. (cf. Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 1-2) Similarly with photography, as analog cameras declined around the turn of the century, replaced by millions of digital cameras. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 181) Today, photographing is part of the everything device of the smartphone (figure 7.11 (c)). Tourism evolved similarly, moving from being grounded in actual environments to being shaped by global digital cultures, hyperrealities and dreamlike projections.

Connectivity of tourism Connectivity is a crucial aspect for tourists, constantly fluctuating between being connected and disconnected. Questions like roaming costs, trail connectivity and wireless availability in accommodations are often unpredictable and felt at the moment. This dynamic state highlights the impact of connectivity on travel and the question most tourists ask themselves: Do you just want to be always connected on vacation? (cf. Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 138) Rodanthi Tzanelli further argues that "the internet has the power to erase the boundaries between leisure and work [...] (Tzanelli, 2007, p. 18)", creating a space where physical and virtual mobility interact. The Digital has inserted itself into many social interactions and the boundaries maintained in tourism longer than in other social spheres are crumbling. This connectivity bridges previously separate social spheres, leading to digital tourism, as demonstrated in the case study of BD ST. (cf. Ibid., p. 18)

The age of turbo capitalism and cultural imperialism

The revenue of virtual travel For a long time, tourism was exclusive to elites, such as those on the *Grand Tour*. Capitalists like Thomas Cook developed mass tourism models. Historically, factors like gender and class restricted travel opportunities, making virtual travel the only option for many. Rodanthi Tzanelli noted that "print

capitalism gave birth to the modern virtual tourist (Tzanelli, 2007, p. 15)". (cf. Ibid., p. 15ff). The elite's travels fueled the public's desire for exotic destination and different experiences, satisfied only temporarily for two hours by cinema⁴⁷. "[...] it is the promise of the journey to represented locations that, enables them to enjoy the film (Ibid., p. 15)", leaving again the money for the tickets in the hands of the same people who created the demand. The Internet made virtual travel cheaper and more accessible but also more addictive although it never really replaced modern mass tourism and only temporarily satisfies the craving. (cf. Ibid., p. 15) Virtual travel overall is cheaper and aligns with capitalist interests: Staged authenticity is easily reproducible, scalable and it does not has to be appropriately. It also is closely related to the capitalist meta trend of de-differentiation.⁴⁸. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 53ff + 128ff)

Dream destination barrier Dream destinations have long existed in tourism but remain elusive. The tourism industry perpetuates desires it can not fulfill, placing dream spots in exotic, remote spaces. Visiting the BD's homeland, for instance, requires effort and expense, such as climbing mountains for high Alpine views. These capitalist-built dreams are costly and often fall short of expectations. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 109) Even upon arrival, the reality rarely matches the promise, though some ST visitors found the WK more beautiful than Instagram photos suggested.⁴⁹ Yet, the cycle continues with the hope of achieving the dream destination (*now actually really*) next year. (cf. Ibid., p. 44; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 10)

Tourism as (pop) capitalism Enzensberger noted that the tourist is a reflection of what he wants to leave behind, echoing their status, cultural perspective and capitalist influences even while attempting to escape them. Tourism commodifies this escape, turning travel into a product of the same capitalist system. When you escaped it once the tourism loops itself so the struggle comes back with every summer holiday season. The global North's turbo-capitalism is inescapable, affecting every aspect of travel: "Tourism is pop, a global industry of as-ifs, quotes, ironic remakes, and endless recycling loops of the familiar. Tourism is also pop because it faithfully assures its customers that it is the opposite of an industry, namely a personal, individual experience. And like pop, tourism has transformed itself from a social counter-design, revolt, and "escape," as Enzensberger called it in 1957, "into an omnivore that easily incorporates every dissenting position - eco, alternative, sustainable, indifferent⁵⁰ - into the mainstream and makes it commercially viable. (Translated

⁴⁷The feeling in a cinema is best described in paragraph 2.2.2.

⁴⁸The underlying process and the term *Mcdonaldization* is explained on page 207. in paragraph 5.2.

⁴⁹On page (page 106) the ST agreed with the statement "it was more beautiful on site at the WK than the Instagram pictures could show".

⁵⁰Today's examples would be heavy metal fans on cruise ships: Full Metal Cruise.

by deep1.com; Groebner, 2020, p. 102)" Tourism, once seen as a counterculture or escape, has become a mainstream industry that commercializes all forms of dissent. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 98 - 102) Even backpackers, thinking they evade capitalism, rely on infrastructures like railroad tracks, hostels, hiking huts and the roadside vendor, which serve tourism needs. Staged authenticity in attractions like the WK's Kaiserschmarn hut hides the capitalist forces at play, sometimes using fabricated narratives to mask the commercialization of experiences. ST delivers this perfectly, with tourists themselves bringing fictional narratives from third party screen productions to destinations, than can label paid experiences as authentic.

Screen colonialism The concept of screen colonialism refers to ST, where exotic screen locations in peripheral countries are often overwhelmed by hordes of tourists and dominated by international pop culture themes. Developing countries in the global South may struggle to earn their fair share of the profits from the tourism industry, as the influence of Western sign industries often overrides local culture. This situation is linked to historical colonialism and highlights the inseparability of cultural power from economic power and prosperity. But this is not just a problem of the global South, but also within the North, where global cities accumulate more cultural power and influence than the spaces in between. Capitalist forces can overwhelm local agency, making the success of ST an uncontrollable force. (cf. Reijnders, 2021, p. 5; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 167; Tzanelli, 2007, p. 144 + 145)

Urban workplace vs freedom of the rural

The thirst of the city for the rural As more people live and work in urban areas, characterized by dense, enclosed spaces, they seek compensation in their leisure time.⁵¹ (cf. 99% Invisible, 2022; Mordue, 2009, p. 332) It becomes a mystical land of ancestors that is desired and associated with freedom that you do not have in process heavy urban areas. Psychiatrist Reinhard Haller notes that while urban hiking can offer some benefits, it lacks the exhilaration of reaching a summit and being at one with nature. (cf. P.M. Magazin, 2023)." This yearning for authentic rurality is embedded in TV shows like the BD, attracting city dwellers to its screen locations and the rural WK landscape.

The countryside ideal as critique on the city life Tourism has always critiqued modernity, from its Romantic Age beginnings to neoliberal times. Aschenbrand found that historical sights externalize critiques of modernity, connecting them to landscapes that evoke a "genius of great and past times (Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 105)". Historical tourism spaces and pre-modern lifestyles often symbolize an alternative to capitalist

⁵¹Not coincidentally, as people moved into the city in masses with industrialization, interest in houseplants skyrocketed.

life, with landscape like the Alps becoming a medium of critique against modernity. With their chalky and beautiful alpine pastures, small wooden huts and wide views of mostly untouched, rugged alpine nature the (WK) Alps are serving as an ideal backdrop. (cf. Aschenbrand, 2017, p. 105) The often used example of the TV series "Heartbeat" (Byrne, 2010) portrays rural life as both romantic and modern, suggesting "the feeling that life is better, the people are kindlier, and the existence 'truer' [...]" (Mordue, 2009, p. 333)." This western pattern of the "countryside ideal" (Bunce, 1994) critiques capitalist urban lifestyles. The first episode and season of the BD TV show explores this theme, with the main character returning to his rural WK home and grappling with urban-rural tensions, represented via his ex-girlfriend from the world metropolis of New York. Such narratives and many more make rural vacations appealing to city dwellers, as they criticize their own perceived inferior living conditions compared to an ideal of the countryside. (cf. Mordue, 2009, p. 333)

Different realities of the supreme and enclaves

The everyday and the experience of banality



Figure 5.7: Screen tourism post about the Bergdoktor parking lot near the Gruberhof screen location (source: Instagram screen-shot with post id CP829Yfh2Ui).

The banality of everyday life reveals more about our existence precisely because it is routine and omnipresent. Smartphones, as everyday devices, exemplify new banalities that significantly impact others. The banal is everywhere, influencing us profoundly due to its ubiquity. It can teach us fundamental truths because it is so commonplace. (cf. Korsmeier, 2007, p. 2) We can transform the banal into something extraordinary: for BD fans, a simple parking lot at the WK becomes significant when branded as "mountain doctor parking" (figure 5.7). Similarly, BD STs sitting at the Gruber family's breakfast table turn an ordinary meal into a meaningful experience, re-enacting family life with deep emotional significance stemming from a fictional narrative. (cf. van Es et al., 2021, p. 208)

Baseline reality Life encompasses different realities: firstly everyday life, secondly our dreams and lastly the image we project to others. The reality of everyday life, being the most manifested, could be considered the supreme reality. It is defined by our physical space and present time, forming the baseline of our experience and shaping our worldview. The reality of dreams and self-presentation (figure 7.11 (b))

offer escapes. However the everyday reality extends beyond the immediate present, experienced in varying degrees of proximity and distance, both spatially and temporally. (cf. Berger et al., 2018, p. 24 - 28)

Modifications of the supreme reality My immediate living space is defined by what my eyes can see and what my body can reach, resulting in an agency where I can modify my reality. Technologies like smartphones⁵² interfere with the everyday reality by changing our habits and behaviors. Smartphones, for example, direct us even in our own neighborhoods when we look for an address. (cf. Ibid., p. 25; Bhattacharjee, 2019, p. 2) As social media grew in the 2010s, it became a part of daily life of many, making networks accessible everywhere (Adams, 1992, p. 120). Digital communication brings remote realities close, making the distant visible to the eye, but mostly inaccessible to the body. This integration changes our "geographical universe" (Adams, 1992, p. 120) creating a hybrid reality. Other realities seem like enclaves of everyday life, with fixed boundaries and surrounded by the supreme reality. (cf. Ibid., p. 120; Berger et al., 2018, p. 26)

Tourism destinations as enclaves of your reality Everyday life is the starting point for exploration and the reference for everything else. Tourist realities are short trips from this supreme reality. Berger and Luckmann illustrate this in "The Social Construction of Reality" (Ibid.): "The transition from one reality to another in a theater [and the cinema, D.B.] is marked by the rising and falling of the curtain. When the curtain rises, the spectator is 'transported into another world,' a world of its own coherence and its own laws, which may or may not have anything to do with the orders in the everyday world. When the curtain falls, the spectator returns 'to reality,' that is, to the supreme reality, to the everyday world, with whose reality the one on the stage now seems meager and ephemeral, [...]" (Translated by deep1.com; Ibid., p. 28)" Film and tourism are other realities we juggle alongside with our daily life. (cf. Ibid., p. 28; van Es et al., 2021, p. 210 - 211) Visiting screen locations in a destination is not the passover from the supreme reality to the enclave because this already happened when going on a vacation" This is just a movement between different enclave realities.

The light of the supreme reality The Supreme Reality, being familiar, is where you feel most comfortable. Everyday life feels brighter, making other enclave realities like dreams or tourist destinations seem gloomy. You cannot know everything, so there are more unknown, dark realities than familiar, bright ones. Your everyday experience can help as "[...] an instrument with which you can cut a path through the jungle (Translated by deep1.com; Berger et al., 2018, p. 46)" of dark realities. It

⁵²More on the implications of the smartphone on page 213.

can illuminate adjacent things and help maneuver through unknown territories. Social media and screen products can also act as flashlights expanding your knowledge of the enclave realities.

Daily life and the hollywood drama Our lives in the supreme reality, no matter how spectacular, can never match the level of fictional screen stories, which are not bound by mortal rules. Even the most idealized and beautiful places can lack excitement because they inherently fail to meet our medialized expectations, which are heightened by our own idealizations. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 105 + 110; Groebner, 2020, p. 97) Holiday destinations and films highlight social constructs, making everyday life seem dull by comparison. However, we prefer monotony over the chaos of a Hollywood drama. Or as Blothner puts it: "The monotonous everyday life is a construct of the people out of fear of its monstrous aggravations (Translated by deep1.com; Blothner, 2003, p. 33)." It is nice to experience the fictional world in the enclave reality of the destination but it is also nice to return to the safe have of the supreme reality afterwards.

Overcome the reality of our lives Reality TV and soaps⁵³ are close to everyday life, using melodramatic elements to provide compelling stories that help viewers "overcome material meaninglessness of everyday existence (Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 83)". These elements reassure us that life is not banal. Without them, these TV shows would be documentaries of daily life. They simulate the opportunity to live melodramatic lives. People seek in media and tourism what they lack in real life, whether complementary or compensatory. Media and tourism combined, like ST, strongly help overcome everyday realities. You compensate for the tensions of your supreme reality in the enclaves of leisure. (cf. Blothner, 2003, p. 238)

The home away from home Tourists often find themselves in familiar social environments, categorized by ancestry, education and income, limiting the freedom they seek. The paradox of post modern post tourism is that it offers both freedom and independence, yet it is a controlled escape guided by class. The great illusion of tourism only returns your place in the hierarchy of your everyday life - but now with palm trees. (cf. Bäuerlein, 2020, p. 58 + 64) Many tourists seek a "home away from home" (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 15) feeling emotionally attached to a destination they have spent years at (e.g. in a screen product) and invested in before arriving (e.g. interacting on social media). Tourism must balance familiarity with new experiences. ST achieves this by allowing visitors to explore recognizable spaces while experiencing excitement beyond what was previously only mediated through screens. (cf. Ibid., p. 15ff)

⁵³The BD series could be considered part of the prime-time soap genre (more on this in chapter 3.4).

Age of Post-truth

The truth about facts and meaning Post-truth politics and conspiracy theories pre-date Trump and Pegida. The mystification and heroization of certain historical reference points remain resilient despite scientific findings. Fictional and historical narratives are intimately connected, as history essentially serves as a narrative about the past. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 30; Reijnders, 2021, p. 5) Truth in history is often a function of power, because as Nietzsche noted "Whichever interpretation prevails at the given time is a function of power and not truth (Quoted in Weller, 2013, p. 24)." Postmodernism has made truth relative, with the (social) internet and fandoms influencing this dynamic. In a postmodern context, meaning takes precedence over proof, with virtual spaces prioritizing imagination over facts. (cf. Ibid., p. 24; Albarran, 2013) Fictional stories and journeys offer cultural opportunities for deeper meaning beyond everyday certainties. Even in the spatial humanities, the search for ultimate answers is futile and the focus shifts to asking "new questions and developing fresh perspectives (Weller, 2013, p. 35)" to understand the complexities of life. (cf. Weller, 2013, p. 35) The age of definitive answers is thought to have passed, or perhaps it never existed, and the ultimate answer may be the recognition that it never did.

Ambivalence as post-truth method

Photos have an indexical connection to their content, but with easy editing tools, photo credibility is diminishing. Initially used for documentation, photos are now often edited, distorted and remixed, especially by younger generations. Fake news often uses doctored photo references to support its false claims (figure 5.8), exploiting our visual fixation and network algorithms. When even the winners of the World



Figure 5.8: Photos of the Trump Administration's "Viral Lie" About the 2018 Inauguration Crowd (Swaine, 2018, p. 1)

Press Photo Award are questioned, the credibility and reliability of the form deteriorates. Photos always suggested ambivalence (page 191) but this is now professionally abused to fabricate post-truths. (cf. Swaine, 2018; Schreiber, 2020, p. 204 - 205) WK Destination posts use similar editing techniques to create misleading dream destinations, driven by marketing in a post-truth era. I would not go so far as to call it

fake news, but after all, tourism is a sign industry that is mostly dominated by marketing aspects and they have been working with post-truths since the beginning of time.

Is the post-truth progress? The postmodern habit of questioning, playing with the aesthetics of reality and the death of the original often makes the fake seem more real than the real. In a complicated world, the simple answer of action and reaction seems more plausible. But this is a world without depth, or as Lash calls it, "a new flimsiness of reality (Lash, 2014, p. 15)". Modernism problematized representations of reality but in postmodernism we began to problematize reality itself, leading to a post-reality. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 99 - 100) Provocatively, one could say that post-truth is social progress. Because reality was less important, we created our own post-truths and started playing with the aesthetics of reality.

Playing with the aesthetics of reality

Generations Y and Z, growing up with digital media, accept alternative facts and see life as a party, resolving everything into a joke, as Blothner puts it in 2003. This generational shift, starting in the 1980s, makes them more attuned to visual stimuli than their digital immigrant boomer parents. (cf. Blothner, 2003, p. 251) They play with the aesthetics of reality, unlike older generations who are misled by it.⁵⁴ These newer generations dominate the group of post-tourists, seeking the best experience regardless of authenticity. They understand that travel photos on Instagram are staged and accept this as part of their social interaction. (cf. Southan, 2017, p. 5 - 7; Kim, 2010, p. 60 - 63; Jansson, 2018, p. 103 - 108)

Destination Disneyland The most excessive example of playing with reality is creating perfect fake attractions like Disneyland, which use their own media to attract tourists for themselves. Building fakes is easier and allows for ideal shaping without real-world constraints. For instance, Disney's animatronic animals are always visible, active and happy, unlike real animals of a Zoo. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 105) Disneyparcs are probably old enough now to have developed their own history⁵⁵ that was built on fiction with reality following. This trend is likely to grow with increased medialisation. The WK is not Disneyland yet, but screen locations like New Zealand with "Lord of the Rings" (Jackson, 2003) show the path that many similar destinations pursuit. The BD TV show is already transforming the WK destination with name changes (figure 5.7), special facilities (figure 5.7) and fan events (page

⁵⁴sometimes leading from the perception of the supreme reality to a (white) supremacist reality.

⁵⁵Like a recent development surrounding the right of Walt Disney World in Orlando to operate as its own municipal government with all the privileges and responsibilities (Levenson et al., 2022, p. 1).

127).

Digital photo practices Digital cameras exist on a spectrum between documentation and imagination, capturing true-to-life photos with an indexical connection while allowing for creative editing, remixing and contextualization within pop culture on social platforms. This creates a unique aesthetic that blends reality and imagination. Younger generations see filters and stickers as normal and authentic, unlike older generations. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 201ff) Similarly, fan communities have their own sense of authenticity, finding it normal to pose with decorated sets or cardboard cutouts of the mountain doctor (figure 5.9), viewing these experiences as 100 percent authentic and worth staging it for an Instagram photo.

Hyperrealism and made reality

"We can no longer talk of film representing, or mimicking, reality because we can no longer assume that there is a single reality waiting out there to be filmed (Aitken and Dixon, 2006, p. 326)." Living in a simulation, or each of us in his own⁵⁶, fictional narratives blend easily into our lives. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 18) Mass media provide a perfect platform for the reel, fake and simulation, showing us subjects that

are usually far from the immediate environment but at the same time are able to reach us right there. This makes us want to experience real spaces as seen on screen. The tourism industry would be foolish not to cater to this by offering experiences in "real-life pseudo-places (Adams, 1992, p. 121)". (cf. Ibid., p. 121)

Runaway production Whether a screen product is shot on location or resembles it does not matter. "Braveheart" (Gibson, 1995) was set in medieval Scotland but filmed in Ireland. Another examples is "The Matrix" (Wachowski and Wachowski, 1999) filmed in Sydney that is supposed to resemble a generic North American city.⁵⁷ Most



Figure 5.9: Screen tourists posing next to a cardboard cutout of the actor of the BD (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id Chxe3wyqycR).

⁵⁶Live is a simulation on YouTube.

⁵⁷More example are: "Superman Returns" (Singer, 2006) or "Charlotte's Web" (Winick, 2006) among many more.

often, logistical and economic considerations force productions to use other screen locations as stand-ins⁵⁸ As long as a "landscape signifies a real space (Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 67)", it achieves realism. As long as the setting is the same as the screen location⁵⁹, everything is clear for the ST. More tourists visit the narrative setting (Scotland for "Braveheart") than the screen location (Ireland). (cf. Ibid., p. 67; Frost, 2006, p. 8 + 9)

Mise-en-scene manipulation



Figure 5.10: Post from the account @ski-weltwilderkaiserbrixental about the mountain doctor fan event at Hexenwasser alp. They are very impressive with their witch costumes, true to their name. (source: Instagram screenshot with post id BntY6Z0nIEt).

"VFX houses have shown just how much of a film's mise-en-scene can be manipulated and redesigned in post-production in ways that are consonant with audience expectations of authenticity (Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 8)." Similarly, the tourist industry stages authenticity, showing Eden-like places with artificial heritage figure (figure 5.10) and even tourists stage their visits (figure 4.3) with filters, perspectives and quotes on social media. Even real locations can be transformed to fit a narrative, like "Blade Runner" (Scott, 1982) turning LA's Union Station into a futuristic police station.⁶⁰ Or even at the WK, a tennis court is transformed into an intensive care unit of the local

hospital in the BD series (page 163). Places are sometimes chosen not for their real-life function but for their suitability as a backdrop for simulations. (cf. Böcher and

⁵⁸In the post-studio era, they often used a mixture of design sets, studios and screen locations. In recent years, movies and TV series have tended to use cheaper screen locations that can easily be disguised as the expensive other setting. (cf. Frost, 2006, p. 9)

⁵⁹Which is the case for the BD series where the fictional world and the real location are basically the same, as the signs in the TV show suggest.

⁶⁰Further information on LA Union Station in source Strauss, 2014 as well as my own research Böcher and Pasternak, 2018.

Pasternak, 2018, p. 59)

Hating other tourists Other tourists are often problematic for travelers. The tour operator Wikinger, for instance, instructs guides to avoid large tourist buses. Tour companies even advise customers on how not to appear as tourists⁶¹, adding to post-modern paradoxes. The problem arises because tourists flock to the same sights, without ever really questioning their decision. They are desiring to see what they already know⁶², while guides must make these sights seem new. Social media exacerbates this by showing empty, idyllic destinations, creating a false sense of solitude that fuels overtourism. As a result, 24 percent of tourist photos show empty landscapes and 40 percent depict tourists in, what Urry calls "tourist ghettos" (Urry, 2011, p. 175). (cf. Ibid., p. 175; Groebner, 2020, p. 44; Miller, 2017) The BD series also portrays this illusion in their transition shots (figure 5.11) with empty, serene shots of WK, contrasting with the reality of a popular, crowded destination. Tourists end up frustrated, often directing their annoyance at other tourists, i.e., themselves. The cognitive dissonance between screen product and destination requires a "suspension of disbelief (Reijnders, 2016, p. 105)" to accept the simulated reality they encounter. STs in the case study had mixed experiences (page 165), with some finding it empty but others were frustrated by crowds, supporting the idea that tourists are irritated by their own presence.

Baudrillard's simulations and hyperreality

Baudrillard's simulation theory filled the void left by collapsed meta-narratives, introducing "hyperreality" (Baudrillard, 2001) as the new *condition of society*. He describes a society since the late 20th century blending fantasy and desire, with dreams like ideal vacations shaping expectations of a hyperreal destinations. (cf. Baudrillard, 2001, p. 2; Groebner, 2020, p. 42 + 43; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 22) The past distinction between object and representation

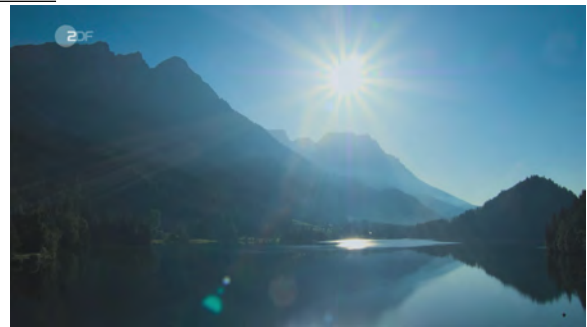


Figure 5.11: Panorama of the Hintersteiner See in the 16th season of the BD show (Source: Still from The Mountain Doctor episode 3 of season 16).

has become meaningless, starting even before the biggest simulation machine yet, the internet, when "soap operas whose daily events are both referent and reality for many viewers (Baudrillard, 2001, p. 6)". Simulations, unlike fiction, present the

⁶¹As seen in a perfect example in the figure on page 213

⁶²Or you can put it the other way around: They are in the destination because they know what it offers.

imaginary as real and undermine the real, creating self-referential so-called hyper-reality. (cf. Ibid., p. 6ff) Cinema and television images are not a copy of reality and do not represent the underlying truth of the supreme reality, but create their own. Hyperrealities are beyond reality because they are realer-than-real and at the same time depthless copies without origin. (cf. Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 23 + 105) Deleuze also noted "With cinema, it is the world which becomes its own image, and not an image which becomes the world (Deleuze, 1986, p. 57)." Influencers and actors, like found in the case study, promote their hyperreal lives on Instagram. Baudrillard's self referential circle can be found with the simulation of life (social media) looking at the simulation of holidays (staged authenticity) and the tourists expect the simulation to be the reality at the destination (promoted image of a place). This removes cultures and landscapes from their contexts, turning them into consumer objects. (cf. Tzanelli, 2007, p. 16) This phenomenon is visible in screen products that enrich places with narratives and sell them to the viewer. Geographical spaces and their history become distorted and finally replaced by the simulation created by all participants with the image building of the DMOs, media representations and staged authenticity on social media.

Dominant simulations fosters nostalgia Baudrillard contends that simulation has become the dominant cultural form, blurring the line between theory and (a dystopian) reality. This shift could mark a historical singularity!⁶³ (cf. Ibid., p. 16; Baudrillard, 2001, p. 10) As the real world changes, nostalgia gains significance, reflected in pop culture's revival of past trends and a longing for a supposedly better past.⁶⁴ (cf. Ibid., p. 174) In tourism, iconic sights remain unchanged for decades like castles, churches or old town districts). The industry upholds the illusion of an authentic experience of the really old. The souvenir shops and routes basically did not change in examples like Salzburg or Luzern. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 42) Given the unreliability of the current truth, people seek solace in 'older versions' of truth, myths and search for a live predating the era of simulation. (cf. Baudrillard, 2001, p. 174) A quest for the "auratic original (Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 125)" like Lukinbeal calls it. As the landscape of the BD show reflects these 'older versions' of truth, and the nostalgia of the STs is probably one key point of the motivation to go to the destination. The exalted Alps, the rural closeness to nature and the family themes of the show represent a simpler truth that makes people nostalgic. But we are probably already too far into the rabbit hole: The simple truth, found at these kind of destinations, is

⁶³Says Baudrillard but also Nora thinks this. (cf. Reijnders, 2016, p. 16)

⁶⁴This is visible in tv shows coming back, 90s revival style, callbacks to old characters and the *everything was better in the past* fraction of social media users and memers.

already a simulation and no truth can be found⁶⁵ at this endpoint of nostalgia. (cf. Baudrillard, 2001, p. 170ff) Because what ST find at the screen locations are the fictional sign that signal them back to the simulation of the BD tv show (figure 5.12).



Figure 5.12: Photo of a sign at the screen location of the Bergdoktor practice signaling to the character Roman Melchinger as mentor of the Bergdoktor in the show (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CDHaaYUHAik).

Nostalgia destorys the heritage Nostalgia is paradoxical: its success can harm old places and landmarks, as seen with UNESCO World Heritage sites that attract damaging tourist influxes. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 51) Tourism aims to preserve nostalgia's feeling but not the objects of nostalgia. This results often in damaging the actual heritage by causing pollution and stress to structures and environments. For two centuries, tourism has broken what it offers to visit. *Nostalmobies* (nostalgia zombies) destroy the future of the desired very old. (cf. Ibid., p. 85) Nostalgia is the simulation of a tourist utopia, while the heritage site is destroyed in the process. The tourism industry maintains authenticity illusions through staged ex-

periences. (cf. Ibid., p. 51 + 85 - 97; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 135) When genuine old sites crumble, simulations fill the gaps and the staged authenticity is accepted by post tourism. STs can create new layers of fictional nostalgia, often stronger than the real nostalgia, which finally buries the history of the space underneath it. This media-induced nostalgia may be more honest, embracing pure fiction over staged authenticity. For instance, the Gruberhof as well as the BD practice refers to its part in the BD narrative, not their own histories as old farmhouses. Nostalgia becomes a powerful layer of signs in Baudrillard's simulation.

Third-order-simulations Disneyland, Instagram filters and ST are third-order simulations. Baudrillard explains this with Disneyland:⁶⁶ "Disneyland is presented as imaginary in order to make us believe that the rest is real, [...]" (Baudrillard, 2001,

⁶⁵or never existed in the first place

⁶⁶Disneyland is not the only example, as the emerging markets of the new Asian middle class (mainly Chinese) are building theme parks of exotic Western things. More on this in Urry's book "The Tourist Gaze 3.0" (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 25; Hendry, 2000).

p. 175)". Screen locations are just smaller and less involved versions of the Disney theme parc experience. The struggles as doctor and lover in the BD TV show are fictional, but the WK region is supposed to be real. - Advertised by the DMO as "even more beautiful in real life". The obvious fake hides that everything behind it is also fake, because it presents itself at the same time as the real fake and says that the normal fake is real⁶⁷. Instagram (face) filters can be like that and hide the inauthenticity of everything else, making social networks generally third-order simulations. ST communication in social media adds a layer to an already simulated space, aligning with Baudrillard's prediction of self-referential signs.⁶⁸ Screen locations and media theme parcs are appealing not because of "the allure of the real [...]" that gives it such predominance but rather the appeal of the absolute fake version (Sadler and Haskins, 2005, p. 213)"

Desires become reality Rediscovering the absolute real is impossible as all reference points are lost in the simulation. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann ask: "What if the copy is better than the original? And what if the original never existed but is a myth? (Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2006, p. 11)". Is an answer to these questions possible at all, is a question I would like to ask? Baudrillard suggests the "real is no longer possible (Baudrillard, 2001, p. 180)". Television and social media show us what we desire, but nothing is real anymore. Media have so penetrated physical spaces that images on screens have become reality (cf. Ibid., p. 180; Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 23 - 24; Best and Kellner, 1997, p. 100ff) Tourist areas are most invaded by this phenomenon. A century of media socialization lets us turn desires into reality, building alternative lives online in MMORPGs⁶⁹, forums or social networks. *Desire* and *reality*, once separate, now merge with the Post Tourist. (cf. Baudrillard, 2001, p. 182)

Perception Layers in tourism

The collective differs between cultures because that is the reference point and romantic gazes can differ across individuals who have seen the BD TV show or not. Tourists experience places differently based on their backgrounds and beliefs. STs perceive additional layers of stories and emotions from screen products, never seen by others. Places are always experienced "in relation to an external presence (van Es et al., 2021, p. 290)". Staged authenticity adds another dimension, and Instagram

⁶⁷Does that make any sense?

⁶⁸Lukinbeal and Zimmerman give an example in the redevelopment of Hollywood Boulevard because it builds on "hollywood-the-cultural-myth" by adopting the simulated world of film (cf. Fletcher et al., 2012, p. 24).

⁶⁹A Massive-Multiplayer-Online-Roleplaying-Games like "World of Warcraft", "Final Fantasy" 14" or "Guild Wars 2".

posts build digital place meanings, creating multiple, intertwined interpretations. You can have a completely different experience encountering the same place physically but also between online and offline. (cf. Ibid., p. 290ff; Chen and Chen, 2017, p. 15) As there are different layers of perception existing, there is always one that dominates as part of a collective gaze. For many STs, the layer of narrative has eclipsed the real history of the destination as seen in the case study in figure 4.14 as well as explained on page 204. Reijnders calls this imaginative heritage and this becomes crucial to local place identity. (cf. Reijnders, 2021, p. 4)

Unveiling multilayered worldviews in social networks These layers create different worldviews coexisting at a screen location, visible when people post vacations on social media. The layers of gaze, perception and meaning are encoded in photos, videos, effects, descriptions, hashtags and geotags. Decoding these posts reveals these phenomena formally hidden for science. The different spatial layers combine with time, intertwining past, present and future in postmodern social spaces. Multiple tourist posts generate a constant stream of layered data, juxtaposing individual views with others. Hochman notes this as "a comparison of the present time experienced by an individual launching the application to all other presences expressed by other individuals in the same feed, all posting images in temporal proximity to each other (Hochman, 2014, p. 3)" (cf. Ibid., p. 3ff; Kratz, 2019, p. 327)

Layers need something to be layered upon If STs can not project their screen-inspired expectations onto the real landscape, they may feel disappointed. The screen location does not need to perfectly match or replicate the on-screen situation but must be similar enough for a rewarding personal experience. The key is triggering a personal connection to the screen content for the simulation to take hold. (cf. Mordue, 2009, p. 341; van Es et al., 2021, p. 290) Postmodern de-differentiation of tourism as well as screen products helps STs blend fiction and reality, projecting fictional meaning onto real-life settings that visually resemble each other. Destinations that move screen locations closer to fiction, for example with a sign for a fictional doctor in front of the BD practice screen location (figure 5.12), help to jumpstart connection to the narrative.

The shifting tourism and media connection

The windows to the real, imagined and the inbetween Tourism transportation methods like cars, trains and airplanes share a commonality with movies: the window.⁷⁰ You maybe saw the destination first through the window of the plane but this is just the beginning of mediated views through windows. At destinations, when you visit

⁷⁰Dispositive similarities of train and cinema are established in chapter 2.2.2 on page 45 and on page 46.

a museum and see the work of art on the other side of a glass case, you see colorful fish under the floor of a glass boat, or you ride in a taxi and look out the window at the picturesque old buildings in the town. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 83 + 84) Even hotel and room choices are influenced by window views, a long-standing tourism tradition tourism. Smart devices offer new windows to information and media.⁷¹. Windows guide our gaze, blending the real, imagined and in-between, with tourism they often occupying this middle ground between every possibility.

Tourists for Bergdoktorland Movie parks like Disneyland and Universal Studios create travel attractions, integrating the media into tourism industries and vacation resorts. These fantasy lands feature characters, landscapes and effects from there own films and series. It began in the 1950s, is part of what Baudrillard calls simulation, and they have been growing and expanding ever since. (cf. Böcher and Pasternak, 2018, p. 37; Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 105) Disneyland acts as a complete destination, while screen locations are fantasy islands within landscapes. The WK mountain range's role in the BD TV show makes it a unified destination, with incorporating spaces like the BD parking lot, Ellmauer stars and the fan festival at the Hexenwasser Alp, making the entire WK become a Mountain-Doctor-Land for fans.

Experience Culture lead to Experience Economy

Disneytization has created the "experience economy" (Pine and Gilmore, 2013), where services must be exciting, surprising and memorable to meet thrill-seeking tourists', whose demands grow with every iteration. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 53) Disneytization turns ordinary experiences extraordinary, what Disney calls "magical". "McDonaldization" (Ibid., p. 54) is about taking a particular culture around the world, homogenizing it, and feeding into the de-differentiation of modernity. This leads to a Fordist experience economy where the consistency of experiences, like a Big Mac, remains the same globally. Disneytization and McDonaldization, reflecting broader societal trends, not only impacting tourism but experiences universally. (cf. Ibid., p. 53ff)

Spaces of experience The experience economy reshapes services and landscapes as well as the screen product and it induced ST. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 80) Experiences like sitting on the spectacular Trolltunga rock (Norway, figure 5.13 (a)), bungee jumping in Whistler (Canada, figure 5.13 (b)), or racing down a summer toboggan run in the Tirol mountains (Austria, figure 5.13 (c)). are embraced and developed to offer new tourist experiences. Major films and successful TV shows use these spaces of the experience economy for "landscape as spectacle" (Lukinbeal, 2005, p. 11ff) as Lukinbeal would call it. STs visiting screen locations get both the

⁷¹This line of thought is further discussed in the paragraphs 5.2 and 5.2.



Figure 5.13: (a) A traveling Instagrammer standing alone on rock Trolltunga in Norway. (b) The actress Natasha Calis bungee jumping in Whistler Canada. (c) Photo from the of the summer toboggan run in Tyrol in Austria. (Source: Instagram screenshots with post ids (a) CfpKmPJK09V, (b) CSaWm0fj-Td and (c) photo from Hotel & Alpin Lodge Der Wastlhof)

thrill of the experience economy and the emotional connection to the BD TV show.

Social media impact on experience 21st-century technologies also impact the destination experience and social media is just one of many: "As social posts start to become a new form of postcards, the reaction of other users to the content uploaded can shape the travel experience of the uploader (Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 123)." This increased visibility and immediate feedback possibilities pushes tourism towards the experience economy, making travel a competition for status and driving destinations to create and market spectacular attractions (figure 5.13 (c)). ST communication thrives on social media for the Destination due to ready-made motives (table 3.2), possibility for subliminal messages (page 5.1), an existing fan base (chapter 4.1) and support beyond traditional DMO marketing budgets (chapter 4.3).

Moving images and digital photography

Everyone is a photographer Images have permeated every aspect of life, accelerated by cinema, television and the Internet. In 2015, an estimated 1.8 billion images were uploaded daily. It seems that everyone is constantly being photographed or filmed. The ubiquity of digital photos, camera phones and social media has transformed photography's visual and political economies. In tourism, Urry and Larson note that photo-making and tourism have become a self-accelerating endless loop. (cf. Kratz, 2019, p. 323; Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 53; Groebner, 2020, p. 61)

A stream of digital images The "vernacularization of photography (Schwarz (2010), quoted in Schreiber, 2020, p. 8)" has broadened what's acceptable to photograph.

Despite backlash posting your fancy dinner plate, photographing food and taking selfies (figure 7.11 (e)) are ubiquitous on social media nowadays. New situations, spaces and emotions are now commonly shared through Web 2.0. Initially driven by affordable large-format cameras (page 19), the stream is now dominated by short-form portrait video content. The presentation ("how") is more important than the content ("what") in visual postmodern communication, whether it's a trendy grandpa on Instagram (Instagram Grandpa with trendy clothes) or a selfie at the Oscars (Ellen's Oscar Selfie 2014). (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 8 + 199).

Capturing time with digital photography "The viewer of a photo in the here and now sees something that happened in the past and was seen in the flesh by the photographer at that time (Translated by deep1.com; Eberle, 2017, p. 27)." Photos are evidence of the past, capturing moments to preserve them. This desire for capturing experiences has existed since Goethe could not capture the beauty of his trip to the Vatican. (cf. Ibid., p. 27; Groebner, 2020, p. 65) Taking photos is the desperate attempt to preserve the experience and uploading them to Social Media is akin to creating a personal history book. However, with advanced editing software like Photoshop, the authenticity of photos, especially on filter-heavy social media, is diminishing ever since. (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 27; Schreiber, 2020, p. 50)

Photograph it or it did not happen Tourist areas are crowded with people and their cameras. Polish author Andrzej Stasiuk sees it this way: "Onlookers from all over the world tripped around and snapped photos everywhere. They took the photos and immediately sent them to all four corners of the world. There was something hopelessly sad about that. Every thing only really began to exist after it had been snapped (Stasiuk, 2008, p. 45)." The sight is experienced through screens and cameras, with photos serving as evidence for others and oneself. The photo often seems more important than the actual experience, as first impressions are made through the lense of the apparatus (figure 7.11 (c)). (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 63 - 64) Without photographic proof, an experience feels incomplete. Instagram posts validate tourist experiences, with interactions on these posts serving as a seal of approval.⁷² Without this validation, the experience feels unreal and so the smartphone (camera) became now a mandatory part of it.

Medialised photo prove *Been there, done that* is a postmodern motivation. Tourists arrive with a medialized gaze, reproducing media representations as evidence of having been there (figure 7.11 (b)). Media images drive tourists to find depicted places and present them as proof of visiting the *real* place. WK STs replicate scenes and stories from the inducing BD screen products, validated by Instagram users

⁷²It was out of the scope of this work to incorporate comment data but it would be very interesting to analyze them under the theories of validation of tourist experiences.



Figure 5.14: Photos from screen tourists that show the screen location of the Bergdoktor practice with the same perspective (Source: Instagram screenshots from corpus post).

identifying screen locations. This validates the tourist utopia that exists absolutely here at the destination for the photographer, and always somewhere else for the viewer. And the positions change when the tourist is back home in his everyday life and other people go on vacation in the endless tourist perpetuum mobile. For STs, the exact place where reality and fiction collide is crucial. Certain perspectives, like the centered photo of the BD practice (figure 5.14), are chosen to stage authentic proof of being there. A staged photo as authentic proves that you were at the exact place. A postmodern paradox that is amplified when these staged photos are also shared and become part of the cycle that produces more fake proofs. (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 179)

Photos to comprehend Valentin Groebner suggests another reason tourists take many photos: to comprehend or imagine something they can not understand. (cf. Groebner, 2020, p. 80) This is relevant for ST, which operates on the border between reality and fiction. When people can not imagine the scene, they take a photo — perhaps with a cardboard cutout of the BD — to immerse themselves (figure 5.5 (c)). The photo aids in a similar way as editing combining the real location with the imagined narratives and the fictional counterparts.

We share more photos than ever before Digitization and the Internet have transformed photo creation and sharing, enabling real-time distribution across vast distances. Sharing photos with colleagues, friends and family is easier than ever, and is

done more frequently. The tourist's gaze is reproduced and redistributed by others, with tourism photos shared widely on social networks. This gaze travels globally at lightning speed, primarily shaped by the hands of tourists' themselves (figure 7.11 (c)). (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 17; Kratz, 2019, p. 326; Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 53; Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 146; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 4 + 185) While screen products take away some of this newfound power when they induce aesthetics, places and motives at the destination, publishing and distribution remain in the hands of the ST, evident in the volume of posts and photos.

Sharing impacts the image production The logic of sharing has influenced image production, with photos often created for specific Web 2.0 platforms. (cf. Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 151) For instance, Instagram stories are shot in portrait mode, while YouTube videos are in landscape. Different platforms also dictate video length (TikTok short vs. Youtube long), timing (live stream on Twitch vs. VoD on Facebook) and content genres (funny videos on TikTok vs. beautiful vacation photos on Instagram). ST communication suits photo-centric platforms like Instagram, aligning with the BD series' aesthetic (page 68ff). Your perceived audience also impacts photo-taking and editing behavior, as photos are crafted to reflect the desired experience. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 208) "What is to be seen by whom, where and how is the constant background question of any practice of sharing and showing photos, [...] (Translated by deep1.com; Ibid., p. 207)."

The feedback of spreadability Sharing photos is just the first step; getting feedback is the second. This feedback influences what you upload and the photos you take. While it is not the primary reason to visit a sight, it affects your choice of motive and the number of photos taken to get the best shot as people strive for good feedback. Sharing and feedback fundamentally change our behavior when taking photos, encouraging the post-tourist process of de-differentiation resulting in difficulties to unique self-expression. (cf. Jansson, 2018, p. 105 - 107)

Distinction and banalization Displaying vacation photos on Instagram feels competitive, pursuing the presented gaze (figure 5.20). Competitive also like a game "that becomes more about 'ticking off the sites' than 'following your nose' (Globetrender, 2020, p. 1)". The "fear of missing out (Kratz, 2019, p. 327)" turns the experience into an achievement hunt. (cf. Ibid., p. 327; Globetrender, 2020, p. 1) Instagram gamifies the tourist experience, making photo-taking part of the behavior in the space. Travelers seek unique photos but often find others had the same ideas (figure 5.14), highlighting the de-differentiation of what every one believes is uniqueness. This was visible in the case study clusters as posts are concentrated in hot spots, not spread out. A view is good as long as it is not already poisoned by the tourist gaze of others, which leads back to the hating of other tourists (page 202). The core

challenge in the post-tourist dilemma is to negotiate between achieving distinction and avoiding banalization. (cf. Jansson, 2018, p. 107)

Screen culture

In their 2008 article "A life more photographic", Rubinstein and Sluis were already clear that "the rise of the camera phone has been part of a shift from print-based to screen-based photography (Rubinstein and Sluis, 2008, p. 13)". You look at the screen to make the photo and you look at the screen to see the photo - and of course you no longer need paper. (cf. Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 149; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 181)

Screens in our world Face-to-face services are declining, replaced by face-to-interface interactions, with screens as the primary interface. Screens, strategically placed in elevators, airports, gyms, shopping malls and of course tourist hot spots, are prevalent in all life situations. (cf. Ibid., p. 57; Andersson and Webb, 2016, p. 143 - 146; Fletchall et al., 2012, p. 16) In mass transportation, screens are ubiquitous, providing information, advertising and entertainment. In long-distance airplanes, in-flight entertainment screens distract passengers and could even induce ST at the current destination⁷³ or for future holidays. This widespread use creates a face-to-screen sociality, argues Urry, impacting human interaction significantly (cf. Ahmad, 2017, p. 1 - 2; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 186)

Deletion through the screen The screen paradoxically leads to deletion. In digital photography, many photos are deleted immediately upon viewing on a camera or smartphone screen (Example situation in figure 7.11 (c)). Few photos survive this initial screening and even fewer are uploaded and shared. Photos must look good instantly or are easily deleted or retaken. (cf. Ibid., p. 184) "This delete-ness represents something radically new (Ibid., p. 184)."

Emphemeral social content A similar phenomenon that has seen new networks like Snapchat emerge and become popular.⁷⁴ Instagram blatantly copied the idea of short-lived content with Stories, and now all the major social networks have established different ways of presenting ephemeral content. BeReal, the latest addition to the social networks, is completely based and built around ephemeral content. So the trend is here to stay as BeReal just found and added a spin with an RNG mechanic of posting times to ephemeral social media content. It is even now moving into other direct messaging as Whatsapp as well as social networks introduce it into their apps.

⁷³An angle for DMOs to market their destination and screen locations to potential new tourists, discussed in Chapter 5.3 on page 231.

⁷⁴They even state on their support page that "Delete is our default (Snapchat Support, 2023, p. 1)" followed by a ghost 👻 emoji.

(Instagram Support, 2024, p. 1; Snapchat Support, 2023, p. 1; BeReal Help Center, na, p. 1; He and Kivetz, 2017).

How (screen) tourism is fostering deletion Deleting photos is a prerequisite for this social media (technology) behavior. The immediate deletion of photos is driven today by stereotypes and quick heuristics. Tourists delete photos that do not match their idealized destination image, often discarding those that do not look convincingly like the original. Photos also serve as proof (page 209), and especially STs imitate screen product perspectives to make their proof watertight leading to more deletion. Screens enable this process by displaying and allowing deletion. Urry says, that part of the production of photos today is erasure, which makes it easier to produce the expected photos for others to see on their screens. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 184) For STs, the screen what defines what is suitable for posting is also the same screen they delete the photos on. The same devices that take photos also display and induce them, leading to the de-differentiation of technology. The compositional corridor first opened up by smart devices and social media is narrowed again by the same technology, leading to more photos being deleted or not taken at all.

Smartphones and technology

By 2018, 40 percent of the world's population had a smartphone, with over 3 billion devices globally, greatly changing the visual landscape.⁷⁵ (cf. Taylor, 2018, p. 1) Smartphones have evolved significantly since 2000, with advanced input and communication capabilities, large touch screens and stable mobile internet access. These features provide powerful "location awareness functions(Wang et al., 2012, p. 371)", crucial for tourists in often unfamiliar destinations. Alongside hardware advancements, millions of apps extend smartphone capabilities, adding social network features, transforming navigation and photo editing. Apps have also changed the representation of the landscape, when you think of Snapchat filters, Photoshop edits or Instagram geotags. (cf. Ibid., p. 371)

Competency of the photographer With improved camera technology, photographic aesthetics now focus on the photographer's skill rather than the equipment. Billions of photos are taken daily and even more deleted (page 212), with aesthetics distinguishing good from bad photos. A distinction that is subjective and cultural. (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 14 + 50 + 117 - 124) Differences in corpus photo quality are evident between STs, Destination and Production groups, and between regular accounts and influencers. The influencer aesthetics is clearly setting apart different competency

⁷⁵How much it has actually changed can be perfectly demonstrated in Alan Taylors great article in The Atlantic 'The Ubiquity of Smartphones, as Captured by Photographers'.

levels, which results in more interaction and reach.

A story of co-presence and un-presence In a 2019 article, Yudhijit Bhattacharjee shares a story of connecting with his 79-year-old father via a Skype call while traveling by train from Denmark to Sweden: "Speaking to him, I held my Phone up against the window, its camera lens facing out. We both took in the view of the Swedish countryside as the train pulled out from Malmo and sped towards Lund. For a brief while, it felt like we were traveling together (Bhattacharjee, 2019, p. 1)." The headline of this article was not so positive but also questioned the cost of such connections, and the article noted the intrusion and diminishing in-person interactions of these technological advancements in form of the smartphone. (cf. Ibid., p. 1) Absence and presence have always been discussed in the context of photography and the frame of the apparatus but showing someone who is not present is a novelty (figure 7.11 (c)). This phenomenon, called "connected presence" (Licoppe, 2004) and "ambient intimacy" (Hjorth et al., 2012), is facilitated by smartphones and the internet, allowing a "shared synchronous gaze" (Villi, 2015) for those on the other end. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 9ff + 210; Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 185) For the not present people in this scenario, the screen product can have the positive effect of making them feel closer in the shared synchronous gaze than they would without the knowledge of screen locations and landscapes because of watching the TV show. Some of the phenomena witnessed with real-time connections are just stronger forms of what can be already seen in Social Media. It accelerated only because the feedback is even more immediate in this form of communication.

Distraction or everyday device Smartphones support many travel activities but can also micromanage tourism processes but are often also seen as procrastination devices and distraction due to their endless possibilities and addictive applications. The average US citizen checks their smartphone 47 times a day (Deloitte (2016); quoted in Ayeh, 2018, p. 2) Its use becomes habitual, replacing many tasks previously tied to desktop PCs and making it an always-on device. (cf. Wang et al., 2012, p. 372; Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 146; Schreiber, 2020, p. 53) Andreas Reckwitz, building on Michel Foucault, calls smartphones a "technology of the self" for their potential to change perception and relevance in everyday situations. In tourism, some embrace the technology to stay connected, while others seek relaxation and disconnection, creating "technological dead zones" (Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 125). Pearce and Gretzel found unplugging challenging for some but rewarding for others who find entertainment in the immediate present landscape. (cf. Ayeh, 2018, p. 1 - 3; Bhattacharjee, 2019, p. 2; Eberle, 2017, p. 44 + 117; Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 125 + 135)

Distraction as a chance? Tourism involves increased information processing which

multipurpose devices that allow simultaneous use of multiple channels and applications can help with but also intensify it. Smart devices are essential for tourists, who typically bring them along. Some destinations leverage this to attract tech-savvy tourists, using smart technology to enhance experiences and provide navigation assistance in unfamiliar spaces. (cf. Ayeh, 2018, p. 1 - 3; Bhattacharjee, 2019, p. 2; Eberle, 2017, p. 44; Wang et al., 2012, p. 385) If Smartphones, drones and wearables can change or distract from our perception of the world is a matter of perspective. As far as politics of the European Union is concerned they introduced new roaming laws to use the mobile internet like you were at home, resulting in more possibilities for EU tourist to stay connected and use the tools available. (cf. Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 46) While some tourists avoid mobile media devices to preserve unique experiences, this approach can be considered as countercultural or even prudent. (cf. Ayeh, 2018, p. 2 + 19)

Digital peer group Mobile devices shape our habits, replacing liminality⁷⁶ with "digital elasticity" (Pearce, 2011, p. 41). Tourists stay connected to their peer group and home world, losing the liminal experience of foreign cultures. High-quality (camera) smartphones, editing software and social media create a new co-present sociality and visuality. (cf. Pearce, 2011, p. 40ff; Ayeh, 2018, p. 4-5; Tanti and Buhalis, 2017, p. 123; Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 145) This private media connection from the tourist to the peers at home is possible via smartphones and distinct from the public sphere created by cinema and television⁷⁷.

Be careful with smart technologies Wang, Park, and Fesenmaier found that smartphones are powerful for reaching potential and existing visitors. The tourism industry, having adapted to the Internet, only 10 years ago now faces smart technologies as the next challenge. (cf. Wang et al., 2012, p. 384 + 385) However, DMOs must implement these carefully, as tourists can be disturbed by fellow tourists' technology use, like for example the infamous selfie sticks (figure 5.15). This creates tension between tech-savvy and purist travel experiences. Smartphones can also disrupt group dynamics, potentially isolating travelers. It can "take away the pleasure of having company (Ayeh, 2018, p. 16)." Although in the near future you will never travel alone (because of your smartphone), but you will be isolated (because your travel companion is using his smartphone) at the destination. (cf. Ayeh, 2018, p. 14 - 20) Understanding smart devices, embedded applications and shared experiences with their impact on tourism is crucial for the DMOs. But luckily scholars can witness and extract an understanding of these new tourism experience through various methods from the smart devices and connected services that helped create it in the first place.

⁷⁶Explanation: the transitional phase between rituals where the person has no fixed social status.

⁷⁷For television this is discussed in paragraph 2.2.3.

(cf. Wang et al., 2012, p. 385)

Visual sociality Smartphone cameras create subjective photos as evidence, meant not only for your memory but to be rather shown to others. "Visual sociality" (Carrier found in Kratz, 2019, p. 326) describes how photos and videos are embedded in social interactions and communication. Mobile photography transforms everyday, religious and artistic practices, as well as of course tourism, creating new media genres and jobs like social media managers for DMOs. The rise of smartphones has further mediated the social sphere and virtualized the presence. (cf. Ibid., p. 326; Eberle, 2017, p. 50)

Live photos as new convergence format Urry suggests we view photographs as corporeal, traveling, aging, timeless, fixed, passive and affective rather than disembodied. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 156) Digital technology, especially in smartphones, facilitates this evolution.

iPhone's Live Photos⁷⁸ and Instagram's Boomerang⁷⁹ expand the frozen time of photos, blending photo and video to capture moments before and after the shot, akin to time travel. (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 26) It is also fascinatingly related to Goffman's thoughts about how the truest expression is only to be found just before or after the tourist's photo has been taken: "[...] the moment when a performer leaves the back region and enters the place where the audience is to be found, or when he returns therefrom, for at these moments one can detect a wonderful putting on and taking off of character' (Goffman quoted in Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 211)." The live photos and boomerangs can give us a glimpse into the inner sanctum of feelings and emotions that a subject would not show in a performative photo.⁸⁰ (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 201 - 211)

Adapting to the digital life "Our use of smartphones has effectively changed the geography of our minds, creating a distracting off-ramp for every thought we might

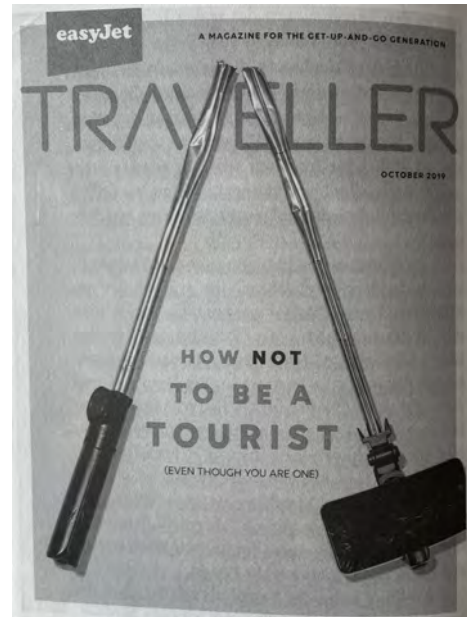


Figure 5.15: Post-tourism irony in the Easy Jet in-flight magazine (Source: Easy Jet Magazine; found in Groebner, 2020, p. 18).

⁷⁸"With Live Photos, iPhone records what happens 1.5 seconds before and after you take a photo (Apple Support, 2024, p. 1)."

⁷⁹A very short video that plays back and forth for a few seconds (Instagram for Business, 2021, p. 1).

⁸⁰These new formats could not be found in the corpus of this case study, but this could be a subject to study how the transitional formats are used in modern tourism communication.

have on our own (Bhattacharjee, 2019, p. 2)," as Bhattacharjee says. This sociological shift moves attention from local to global and digital spaces, losing what's in front of us. (cf. Ibid., p. 2) Internet photos face unpredictable lives, multiple paths and possible harm. The rapid evolution of smartphones, ubiquitous Internet and social networks outpaces society and political regulation, making them integral to our new everyday life as we struggle to adapt. (cf. Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 186; Bhattacharjee, 2019, p. 4; Turner, 2015, p. 111)

The social medias

67 percent of Germans (Statista, 2018) use social media on their phones and are online most of the day. A study predicts increased social media use by travelers in the coming years. (cf. Globetrender, 2020, p. 4) It is "the informational archive of the everyday lives that draws people into the networks (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 59)" and it is this information that is also interesting for science. Since tourism is also closely connected to everyday life - either as an escape from your own life or as subject a tourist's gaze - it has a thematic overlap with social media content. Networked communication has not radically changed sociality but has intensified it, making private behaviors of everyone more noticeable and of some even front an center of their networked presence. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 217)

Visual based communication Much of social media communication is through video or photos. In 2013, 350 million photos were uploaded daily to Facebook and Flickr had 1.6 million photos uploaded, about 19 per second (Eberle, 2017, p. 118). Often, photos are accompanied by descriptions, though some platforms like Instagram require an image or video with optional text⁸¹ (cf. Ibid., p. 118 + 119)

(Screen) tourism and Instagrams visual drive Instagram is a common tool for millions of Western travelers, who document their experiences with photos, videos and stories, documenting their experiences and participating in networked communication. (cf. Globetrender, 2020, p. 1) ST is deeply visual, combining the screen's visual stimulus with tourism's practice of looking. Tourism stakeholders can juxtapose screen product visuals with destination images in social medias like Instagram. Social media and ST are a match made in postmodern heaven.

Dektop and mobile creation and consumption Early networks were desktop-focused, while Instagram emerged during the mobile transition. Newer networks like Snapchat and TikTok are designed for mobile, emphasizing portrait mode. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 56 + 91) These platforms are *mobile first* with key features available only on mobile. Mobile first was driven by content creation, with smartphones making photo and video production accessible and low-cost. As media consumption also moved

⁸¹or just text without an image. But this is not that common, with exceptions in Twitter or Reddit

from homes to everywhere, content adapted: videos became soundless and shortened, and videos as well as photos shifted to a 9:16 aspect ratio. Most photos in the case study are 1:1 (Squared)⁸², Instagram's standard format, reflecting the shift from desktop to mobile-based networks.

Fluid personalities We are constantly compelled to make ourselves the subject in photos and videos, a key part of networked communication. This constant self-expression and always-on mentality reflect the fluidity of knowledge and identity in late modern societies. (cf. Rosa, 2016, p. 240; Schreiber, 2020, p. 10) Techniques like selfies (figure 4.37) are driven by the need to negotiate identity through social media interactions. As tourist we include ourselves with a selfie in the vacation photo (figure 5.16) to partake in the dialectical space of social media. Social media platforms, while offering space to negotiate identity and knowledge, are not neutral. They shape identities and empower users, but also threaten self-expression through social control. (cf. Ibid., p. 55)



Figure 5.16: Selfie of a screen tourist at the screen location of the Hintersteiner lake (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CQbZxDksIbU).

Influencing other gazes Our fluid personalities are shaped by social media and others' reactions, influencing tourism communication online and at destinations. Urry discusses how tourists' gazes discipline each other⁸³, spending time observing and judging others: "[...] [tourists are, D.B.] constantly observing and judging the behavior of other tourists, but it also produces rich opportunities for daydreaming, fantasizing about the lives of the strangers surrounding you. (Urry and Larsen, 2011, p. 201)" (cf. Ibid., p. 201) This is evident in the streamlined photos of ST communication, which often exclude other tourists despite their presence. While tourists of this case study

may not feel influenced by Instagram photos, theoretical research suggests otherwise (Chapters 2.2 and 5.2). Tourists' photos typically depict magically empty scenes, ignoring the crowded reality of places like WK. However, shared fandom in ST can

⁸²Which is a tradeoff between portrait (Higher than wider) and landscape mode (Wider than higher)

⁸³The same thing happens in a cinema audience. Explained on page 45.

foster connections with like-minded people and make you receptive to their gaze. By looking at others and imagining your own life the gazed at also kind of influences what you can dream of. Observing others' idealized holiday versions can fuel personal tourism utopias. We are looking at the actors at the locations in the tv show, but we also see the fellow STs at the same (screen) location in the destination acting within their staged holiday.

Defining context In a Baudrillardian world, simulacra shift focus from content to form, moving away from the material world. (cf. Lukinbeal and Zimmermann, 2008, p. 19) Social media is defined by form rather than content, with context being crucial. The BD actor's influencer-style posts (page 142 and 171), WK's marketing (page 5.1) and induced STs' content mimic what they see on the BD show and Instagram (chapter 4.1). The BD narrative adds an invisible layer to screen locations, which social media can reveal through context. Thus, social media can uncover content by highlighting its form and context.⁸⁴

The origin as original In an environment ranging from photographic plates in the 19th century to Internet photos of today, the question of the original, the real, the very first thing no longer viable. (cf. Benjamin, 1993, p. 18) It need not be the original in the traditional sense (since it can, by definition, be a reproduction of an older work), but it is the origin of a considerable wave of descendants. In today's context, the original's relevance shifts from creation to post-dissemination. An original, not necessarily the first, can spark a wave of copies, becoming the "original" through viral spread. Just as the screen prod-

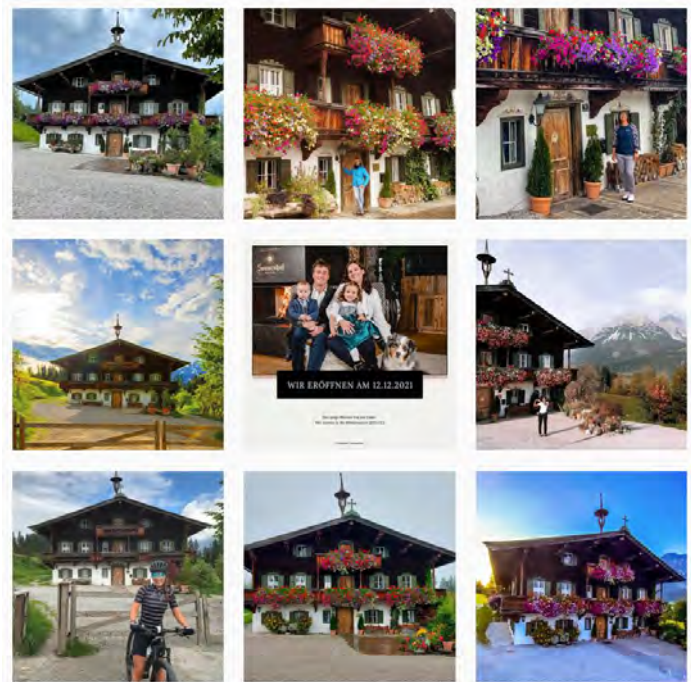


Figure 5.17: The Instagram hashtag #bergdoktorpraxis (source: Instagram screenshot (25.02.2022)).

⁸⁴A principle science can use to identify new phenomenon or find answers to questions hard to answer without this.

and share them in their social media communication (Figure: 5.17).

Narrative vs pictorial content Important factors for social media content creation are hedonism, escapism and entertainment, but not information. There is a preference for visual over narrative content. This goes hand in hand with an already strong connection of tourists to visual media. (cf. Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 53) At the destination, it is the screen location that is associated with its screen product representations, and this in turn is attached to the broader narrative. It is the visual of the WK destination, like the screen locations, and the visual of the BD TV show, like an establishing shot, that connects the narrative to the place. At the destination, the screen location is usually the only thing visible because the narrative is only virtual. In addition, social media acts as a filter (page 217) that promotes visual content first. With the marketing aspect of Destination accounts (page 168), the corpus photos mostly just showed the pictorial gaze on screen locations with subliminal ST communication (page 168). This leads to a dominance of the visual over the narrative, even in narrative-heavy ST contexts. The case study shows a focus on the visuals of the WK mountain range (page 175), with descriptions often highlighting personal stories (A diary: page 153) and the pictorial quality of posts (page 110) rather than the actual narrative.

Daydream filters According to Anthony Turner, today's media use does not allow for downtime or daydreaming. (cf. Turner, 2015, p. 110). However, I argue that social media enabled it: daydreams have moved to screen products like Instagram photos and TikTok clips, integrated with filters, stickers and emoji. Daydreams are now visible on social media, working perfectly with fictional narratives, especially at screen locations like WK. Filters on social apps alter photos to reflect feelings rather than reality, capturing the atmosphere of a place as influenced by personal mood. In ST, fictional atmospheres enhance this effect with the narrative, the characters, your head canon⁸⁵ and STs connection to them. Photos on social media are more about the photographer's perception than the destination itself. So the photos are not authentic of the destination, but more of yourself. All digital features like a filter are built to preserve your situational subjective experience. (cf. Eberle, 2017, p. 14 + 15 + 44 + 127 - 128) Professional photographers and the marketing industry also use these digital tools, as seen in the case study where Destination accounts often used staged photos from professional photographers

The stream of images In the age of the stream, photos, text and numbers blend, creating a new relationship with the outside world. Photos, whether new or old, share the same initial status when uploaded to social media. They become equal-

⁸⁵The concept refers to a fan's personal interpretation, belief, or backstory about characters or events in a fictional universe, which is not explicitly stated or confirmed in the official source material.

ized as they are inserted into the networks with their status as new. Tags like #tbt or #latergram indicate their temporal status. This constant stream of newness old posts reveals the passage of time, forming a contemporary history where past, present and future temporally coexist in social media. (cf. Hochman, 2014, p. 4-5)

The stream fosters the absent presence The stream of images fosters a new way of thinking: not linear, faster, disjointed, and overlapping, transforming the brain into a flow of knowledge continuously taking in and giving out information. This can lead to a state of "absent presence"⁸⁶ (Turner, 2015, p. 111), where divided attention prevents full engagement and in the end this can cause stress even while doing nothing. (cf. Ibid., p. 111)

The photo becomes a meta-image Photos have evolved from being self-contained to including paratexts that provide context, often becoming the main content. Context is added through text, hashtags that connect to similar photos or places it in a web of relationships and patterns. Within a social network, generating a photo's aura is done through being part of a collection (cf. Hochman, 2014, p. 5 - 6) "In short, the 'real' is everything that is going on inside an image (images of particular subjects in the world), while the symbolic is everything that is outside of that image and connected to it via similar fragmented data units (Ibid., p. 6)." In the stream the photograph itself may represent the reality, while the surrounding elements offer a glimpse of potential or speculative scenarios. A "meta-image" (Ibid., p. 6) includes the photo, effects, paratexts, hashtags and interactions like likes and comments. Social media photos' functions, descriptions and connections form their *DNA* (Ibid., p. 6), but they can lose their original context through metadata transformations and tagging into a different collection. (cf. Ibid., p. 5ff; Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 149)

The photo frame Photo frames in tourist spots are pop-up places designed for social media photos. Unlike the new phenomenon of pop-up museum, they are not the objects of the gaze, but try to help find the right subject. DMOs install frames in popular places, recommending the best photo motives, sometimes even imitating iconic screen product shots. These frames continue the tradition of framing views seen in trains, hotel windows (theory on page 2.2.1), square prints of photographs, and movie projection borders. Links to ch 2.2 The display of media within a square is inherent to these types of media, and chapter 2.2 showed that tourism has always been closely linked to them. In one post and the trace interview response, a WK DMO account (page 123) explicitly shows and mentions a photo frame. Links to chapter 4.2 The Hexenwasser Alp does not have its own screen location, so it cannot be the motive, but with the photo frame (figure 4.17) looking towards the popular

⁸⁶More on this feeling of being connected but not present in Yudhijit Bhattacharjee's story about his relationship with his father in page 214.



Figure 5.18: (a) to (f) photo frames in different tourists spots in Europe (France, Luxembourg, Germany and Sweden) (Source: Own photos).

screen location of the BD, it can at least take part in ST as the photographer's position. Links to ch 4.2 The photo frames on beaches, hills and cities are reminiscent of postcard motifs that are still very popular today, literally everywhere you look in tourist destinations. These frames have gained popularity over the last decade, with just a few examples in figure 5.18.

Crossing networks Social media networks, which once promised freedom but now seem chaotic, follow the "small world" property or "six degrees of separation: " [...] the uncanny rapidity with which one can reach any vertex in the network from any other vertex (Levine, 2015, p. 112)." This principle connects each ST digitally to Production accounts and in real life to people at the WK. Networks can also overlap: (cf. Ibid., p. 112-114) Of course, fan communities - online on Instagram or offline at the BD Fan Fest, for example - are networks that include all kinds of people through the shared worship of a screen product (page 15). But also BD actors

and fan accounts intertwined on social media, as well as fictional characters connected with screen locations at the destination. STs aim to change these networks through ST (re-enactment) posts on social media, as they stage themselves to be part of them. This example shows that some networks have the ability to cross other networks. The Internet and social media transcend traditional boundaries such as nations, continents, peer groups, or work. This reflects the idea that "technology is society" (Levine, 2015, p. 114) and that digital networks are pervasive in our lives. (cf. Ibid., p. 117; Reijnders, 2016, p. 108)

Social Media as tourism feedback tool In 2014, 42 percent of Facebook users (Senouci, 2019, p. 1) shared more travel-related content than any other topic, highlighting its relevance for new travel communication trends. Participation in online communities⁸⁷ increases the likelihood of creating, consuming and interacting with social media content. (cf. Senouci, 2019, p. 1 + 2; Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 51 + 52) Social media is ideal for the tourism industry, enabling them to provide relevant and consistent information to the consumer. It is a perfect customer service tool, offering direct tourist feedback at the place the users already are. The use of these communication channels by both sides is also helping destinations with boosting social media KPIs such as reach. Tourism stakeholders can reach tourists anytime, as consumers are always online and seeking information, only the destination can provide at this point.

Screen-inspired indirect word-of-mouth advertising Word-of-mouth is crucial, as consumers trust other tourists more than tourism providers.⁸⁸ All this while users share travel content to communicate sociability and emotion rather than to make vacation decisions. (cf. Senouci, 2019, p. 1 + 2; Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 48 + 49) The case study showed that during the preparation phase (page 104), STs looked at the Destination accounts and their content on Instagram, but denied being influenced by them. Production accounts have more influence during the preparation phase (page 4.1.3), acting as indirect marketers for the destination. The Destination can create indirect marketing value through the screen products, which creates word-of-mouth advertising for the screen locations. Production accounts act as intermediaries, being in a para-social relationship with fans (tourists), but are also not part of the Destination, but a presumably neutral third party. They mostly unintentionally carry the marketing messages of the destination while promoting their own

⁸⁷The number of fan accounts of the BD series and its characters indicates a large social media community that should encourage photo creation among (ST) fans. Only within the ST communication context 21 different fan accounts were identified in the initial data downloaded from crowd Tangle.

⁸⁸It is only sometimes cursed in the form of a shitstorm.

screen product.⁸⁹ This paradox shows that while STs believe that they are not influenced by Destination communication, they still engage in word-of-mouth marketing through screen products that were likely part of the DMO's marketing strategy. Screen-inspired word-of-mouth is advertising by the back door, with advertising that is not visible to the normal tourist (page 125) and not perceived as marketing by the (screen) tourist.

User generated content

user generated content (UGC) has various user motivations, such as fun and entertainment or for example US travelers that are motivated by altruistic and hedonic benefits. Despite the abundance of user-generated text, photos and videos on social media, most users are *lurkers* who watch and occasionally interact without creating content. (cf. Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 48) This follows the 90-9-1 scheme: 90 percent lurking, 9 percent low-level interactions, and 1 percent direct interaction and (confrontational) communication (Ibid., p. 52; Nielsen, 2006, p. 1). UGC can also be a way for users to give back to the community or destination that helped them plan their trip. (cf. Munar and Jacobsen, 2014, p. 48)

Geotag

Locative media help scholars understand everyday movement, environmental perception and development place meaning. Geotags are contextually embedded in photos. In a networked map of geotaged posts, it can show us movement as part of a configuration of place. (cf. Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 150) Mobile media has four affordances: Portability, Availability, Locatability, and Multimediality. Two of the four affordances are directly related to place making mobile media highly place-dependent despite having the world mobile its name. Hashtags but geotags even more effectively provide locatability in social media. (cf. Schreiber, 2020, p. 59) As the geotags were not used (reasons on page 76) but actively discarded we can not connect the findings of the case study to the theory of these few paragraphs. The motive and photographer points still show similar behavior to geotags so some of the findings in chapter 5.1 can be maybe transferred.

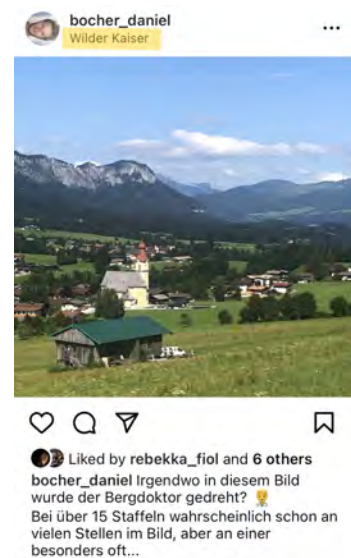


Figure 5.19: A prime place for the geotag on Instagram (source: Instagram screenshot).

⁸⁹More information on page 168.

Geotaging options Many social networks, including Instagram, allow geotaging, a prominent meta-information feature. Geotags place posts on a map, recording more of the original context. (cf. Pink and Hjorth, 2012, p. 150)". A place or space can also be specified in text or visibly in photos. Especially on Instagram the geotag is presented right underneath the account name and above the photo (figure 5.19), so that it cannot be overlooked and making it integral to the post's meaning. Geotags have evolved into various methods, techniques and formats, enhancing the sense of place, photo distribution and its impact on tourism.

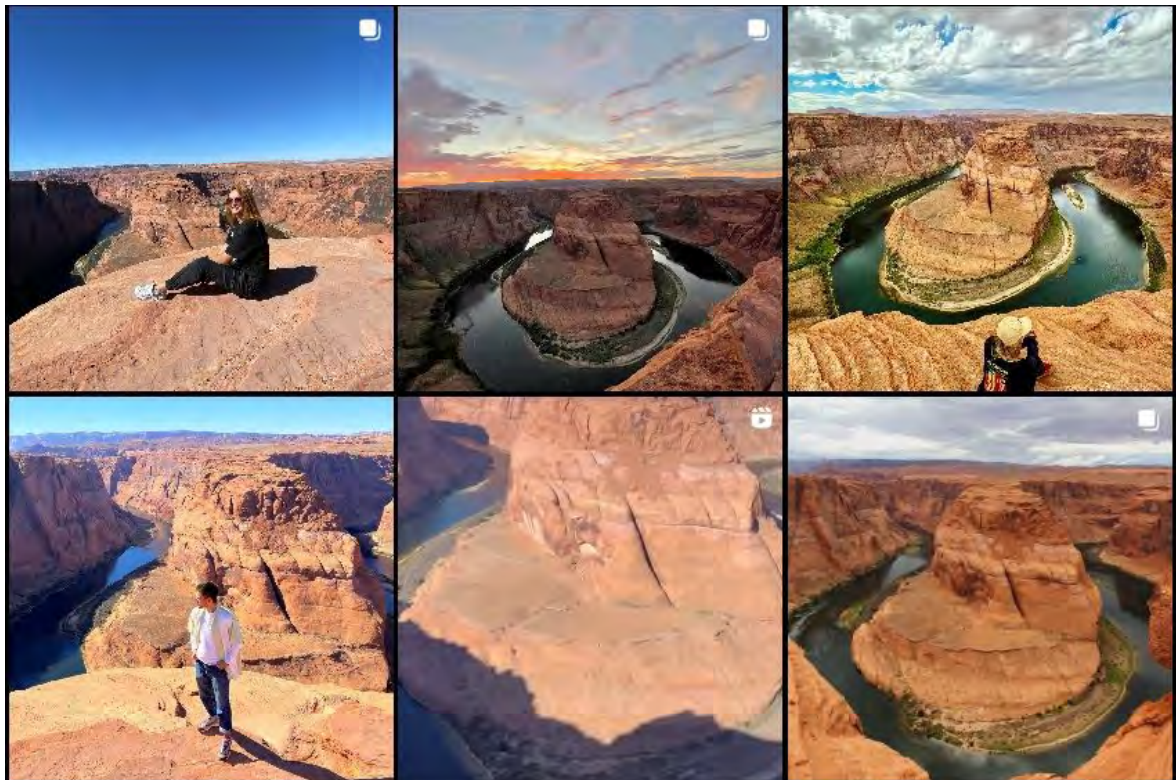


Figure 5.20: The reality of the Horse Shoe Bend on Instagram (Source: Instagram screenshot of the Horse Shoe Bend geotag page).

Place hashtags as sign of post modern globalisation In 2020 the most instagrammed villages were dominated by Europe on the first seven places. Two notable examples are Hallstatt (Austria) in sixth place (817,000 hashtags) and the fictional town Hobbiton (New Zealand) in eighth place (500,000 hashtags). (cf. Globetrender, 2020, p. 7) Hallstatt, with 800 inhabitants, is UNESCO World Heritage Site that sees over 10,000 daily tourists, mainly from Asia. Hobbiton is a small fictional town of the Hobbits, a race from the famous "Lord of the Rings" movies (Jackson, 2003). (cf. Globetrender, 2020, p. 7) Since Hobbiton is clearly a fictional village used as a backdrop for a generation-defining movie, the residents of Hallstatt feel much the same way: "It's a catastrophe. Many visitors seriously think this is a theme park. (The

Washington Post, 2019, p. 1)" Hallstatt's fame in Asia likely stems from the 2006 South Korean TV show "Spring Waltz" (Yun, 2006) and a replica town in China's Guangdong province and not the fact that it is a UNESCO sight. (cf. Ibid., p. 1ff) A mediated Korean view inspires a simulated city in China and induces Asian people to have a ST vacation in the original city in Austria - a postmodern story about globalization and de-differentiation tendencies (also in non-western cultures).

Overtourism through Instagram geotags Geotagging can lead in some scenarios to overtourism, as seen in places like Horseshoe Bend (USA) with an repetitive cycle of the same photo in figure 7.11 (e). The geotag is the bridge from the digital world to real places, showing how the masses of social media can overwhelm local destinations. The destination loses control over the influx of tourist because they can not influence the communication as the tourist themselves take over and choose the geotag for their posts. "It's tricky to predict viral posts, but the speed at which geotags can accelerate existing tourism, compared to guidebooks, is something communities now have to anticipate (Djossa, 2019, p. 2)." This digital culture of sharing and tagging impacts real places, often harming the environment as tourists seek to recreate popular Instagram photos which is very visible in figure 5.20. By tagging the photo themselves, tourists feed the perpetual cycle of posts, tourists, more photos and again more tourists. (cf. Djossa, 2019, p. 1ff)

5.3 The use and learnings of Screen Tourism for the Production and Broadcaster

The ordering of this chapter for the Production starts with more foundational and context-setting arguments, moving towards the more impactful and strategic points, culminating in the strong argument of transmedia storytelling which ties everything together by showing the broad and innovative potential of ST and media convergence.

Changing generation and trends

Chapter 2.2 (page 62) emphasizes Generation Z's impact on society, urging media and tourism to adapt. Gen Z tourists seek unique experiences inspired by visually-driven social networks. ST caters well to this by offering otherworldly experiences tied to favorite screen products. The ZDF should market BD and its screen locations as must-visit spots⁹⁰, promoting them through social media⁹¹ to engage Gen Z. Some fan events at WK already align with this, though they are not ZDF-organized but the WK DMO. The ZDF should enhance its social media strategy with shareable content, influencer marketing and interactive online experiences, but first of all reclaim the official BD Instagram account, that is not even managed by the ZDF (page 232).

Destination screening

Since the BD screen product prompted the journey to WK, the process could be reversed once STs reach the screen location. After exploring BD screen locations, STs may want to watch the show again. Therefore, content should always be available online, accessible for example via QR codes at screen locations or information near the TV in accommodations.⁹² This potential would be lost if the show relied only on one entry point in the form of a two month season on TV every year. BD's early success on ZDF's VOD platform proves the value of online availability (cf. Böcher, 2018a).⁹³ As tourism and TV viewing became mediatized, viewers began demanding free and easy access to content (page 216). Both Destinations and Productions

⁹⁰Travel shows like described on page 234 can support the standing of the show.

⁹¹The screen production should have no problem with a mobile-first strategy and a social media presence as it should be their daily business.

⁹²Connected to that is the argument of showing it in the in flight entertainment systems on page 231

⁹³. A little BD history to support this argument: Since the BD episodes were accidentally released on ZDF's vod platform (called "ZDF Mediathek") a week before the TV screenings, it was an instant success to this day. Thus, the BD was one of ZDF's pioneers to be released online first and established a strong precedent for VOD productions within the channel. (More info on page 85)

must adapt to these changing habits, driven by the new generation of fans, Gen Z (page 227). Although not the main target now, they will be the future audience and tourists.

Photos can not spoil a lot

The screen production's approach to social media posting is characterized by a relaxed attitude (page 142), likely influenced by being a German public service broadcaster rather than a secretive Hollywood production. The consistent nature of the show's locations over 15 years⁹⁴ and the case-of-the-week structure reduces the risk of spoilers. The relaxed rules of the production, have an effect, not by what they forbid, but by the freedom they allow. The established freedom in posting contributes to the authenticity of the ST communication from the Destination and Production accounts, organically promoting both the BD TV show and the WK destination. The omission of strict rules should be kept in the future.

Connecting the ZDF to the WK

The Production uses the ZDF token a lot, but this does not translate to the STs (page 154). Destination accounts could use this strategy, as seen in posts BsZ-kFonPLd and BsIQsIZnv5c.⁹⁵ They can mention BD episodes promoting specific screen locations at the WK, supported by the broadcast channel that can connect the broadcaster more to ST communication. Production could provide movie stills, promotional material and episode information, possibly inviting the DMO to their press area (presseportal.zdf.de) to see episodes before anyone else. Destination accounts could use this material in their strategy to natively promote their destination with BD themes. Attractions, hotels and the DMO could promote episodes featuring them as screen location. This strategy can help both sides because it promotes specific episodes in the ZDF as well as the featured locations in the destination. This could also be expanded upon as to incorporate STs, who are probably eager to use all the materials available to them.

Using the social media network features

Instagram is a valuable tool for the broadcaster: Following Destination accounts, linking posts and geotagging local attractions can connect the online and offline

⁹⁴At this point in the development it almost becomes a spoiler if its absent rather than visible.

⁹⁵These posts seem strange because they are in English. First of all, the account posts primarily in German, and it seems unlikely that information about dates of German TV show airing on German TV is relevant to international, English-speaking tourists. The answer from the DMO account as to why they published them was just that "it was inconsistent and probably an unintentional mistake. (Krösslhuber, 2023b)".

worlds, allowing fans and STs to navigate between them. Using networking features like sharing, mentioning, hash- and geotags can not only enhance the reach but metaphysically embed the BD and its narrative in our world. Geotags especially act as tools of transcendence, placing fictional scenes on real maps - a post modern act ST communication works best when social media features are used to spread the message and encourage UGC and UGC and word-of-mouth marketing (page 223).



Figure 5.21: (a) Hans Gruber is always working at the Gruberhof. (b) Dr. Alexander Kahnweiler is usually the only available doctor at the hospital. (c) The doctor's nurse (different characters over the years) rules over her kingdom in the mountain doctor's practice. (d) Susanne Dreiseitl owns the guesthouse Wilder Kaiser, so this is her designated building. (Source: Stills from the episodes (a), (b) "Was bleibt (1)", (c) "Fremdes Herz (1)" and (d) "Im Netz")

Is there a perfect screen location?

Farsighted screen locations Ideal screen locations for tourism are tall, isolated, offer panoramic views, and serve as visible landmarks. These iconic spots frequently appear in both screen and tourist footage. While their fame may be recognized, their significance in a screen production is often discovered serendipitously by tourists. Large sites increase visibility, while smaller or indoor sites have obstructed views and face cost barriers. For example, the WK mountain range (figure 4.40, section

3) prominently looms over the WK valley (map 3.9). Similar examples can be also found in other screen products, such as the medieval city walls of Dubrovnik in "Game of Thrones" (Creators: Benioff and Weiss, 2019). (cf. Böcher, 2018b)

Concentrating on screen locations and characters To induce ST, screen productions must follow specific rules. One rule, evident in corpus data, is focusing on a few key locations (page 173). The BD is also consequent with the narrative radius of most of its characters: characters are predominantly associated with individual locations (see figure 5.21 for examples) and from this follows the emotions from a fan towards the fictional characters or in the narrative get affixed upon the designated screen location. These main locations, used repeatedly over a decade now, link characters and narratives to specific spots. This focus enhances fans' mental maps and desire to visit, more effectively than using many locations and mobile characters.

Talk about the location Focusing on a few screen locations allows for more discussion about them. Space-related tokens perform exceptionally well but are underused by Production accounts. These tokens generate high interaction (page 156). The Production should post more about these screen locations to boost interaction. By talking about the space with tokens like "Wilder Kaiser", "Ellmau" or "Gruberhof" in the descriptions the Production accounts can offer something beyond the narrative they normally deliver. With that they can potentially optimize their reach in ST communication.

Advertising screen tourism

Boundries of advertising for the mountain doctor A destination can become as strongly associated with the screen product as New Zealand is with Middle Earth ("Lord of the Rings"; Jackson, 2003) or Dubrovnik (Croatia) is with the Iron Throne ("Game of Thrones"; Creators: Benioff and Weiss, 2019). Dubrovnik and New Zealand are extreme examples of successful ST, even leaning towards overtourism, serving as both guidelines and warnings. Compared to these examples the mountain doctor franchise has not reached their maximum potential. As the BD is part of a public service broadcaster, they will never go as far as the mentioned examples or even the DMO of WK wants them to go. A few ST strategies can therefore never be realized for good reason.

Screen tourism itself can be advertising The BD screen locations drive desirable word-of-mouth advertising (page 223), generating UGC about the BD series. This is providing content leverage for the DMO, Production and broadcaster. Screen locations trigger most ST communication of STs (chapter 4.1), focusing more on the destination than the production. UGC offers free advertising that the Production can incorporate into their (paid advertising) posts. When reposting UGC they can adjust

the framing to promote the show more or leave it to avoid giving the impression of being promotional. This scenario engages and highlights the fandom, provides also free marketing for the destination and lets the Production promote without feeling intrusive. Reposting ST communications to Production accounts goes some way to regaining control over the perceptions created by UGC content (page 167).

Using the onboard entertainment systems On long-distance flights, passengers usually have screens for entertainment, that provide distraction from flights, which is ironic as traveling should be the distraction from everyday life but is on par with post modernism. Movies watched during flights can inspire ST to the current or future holiday destinations. (cf. Ahmad, 2017, p. 1 + 2) This allows DMOs to market their destinations and screen locations directly to incoming tourists. For Productions, it is additional exposure to a willing audience. Visiting screen locations can convert viewers into fans because it is an act of fandom. Informed tourists can create intentional ST, enhancing the experience, encouraging alternative sightseeing to screen locations and promoting merchandise purchases in a receptive environment. This tactic can help⁹⁶ transfer the movie's created image onto the destination, because tourists are already in open state of mind. The "suspension of disbelief" (page 184) timely exactly before arrival could facilitate the acceptance of staged authenticity in other attractions of the destination. The Productions must cooperate with airlines, other tourism transportation segments for licensing the screen product as well as thinking about to expand to other screen providers at tourist destinations in a world where the screen is ubiquitous (page 212).

The power of going to places

Naturally the Production accounts focus more on the screen production (figure 4.4) and STs (chapter 4.1) as well as the Destination (chapter 4.2) focus on the destination first. STs and Destination accounts mention the BD show secondarily, emphasizing being at the real place rather than in front of the TV. This is actually not bad for the screen production as the connection between screen locations and stories strengthens fans' bond with the narrative. But it also demonstrates that despite medialisation, live experiences remain powerful (page 178). Screen productions must be aware that there is always (or at least in the foreseeable future) something stronger than what they can offer in pop culture, memes and media fandoms: Screen productions should recognize that live events with bodily experiences at certain places are

⁹⁶For this tactic to work, the journey must be long enough. WK's main tourists are neighboring states traveling by car or train, not long-distance flyers (table 7.48). However, there is a rise in Indian tourists due to Bollywood movies produced in Tyrol (cf. Cine Tirol Film Commission, 2017), dubbed "Tirollywood" (Tirol Werbung, na).

inherently human. The paradox is that they would not be so powerful without the screen coverage with memes, pop culture and media fandoms. Which again should not prevent embracing screen locations as part of content, distribution and marketing strategies.



Figure 5.22: A post from @andreagerhard_tall_area promoting the TV screening of a new episode (source: Instagram screenshot with post id B8d8wxhI9iO).

The channels need to keep up

ST communication is a powerful promotional tool, but broadcasters may not fully exploit its potential. Actors have an advantage in ST communication due to their integral role in the diegetic narrative. ZDF is visible with its logo but plays an extradiegetic role. Actors also benefit from personal social media accounts which can utilize influencer tactics (page 148). These disadvantages are hard to compensate but to maximize benefits, ZDF and ORF should encourage actors to post about the show as well as air dates (e.g. figure 5.22) and mention the broadcaster (page 154). ZDF could reclaim control of the BD official Instagram channel, which is currently managed by the production company⁹⁷, for better ST communication exposure. Broadcasters like in public-law are often slow to adapt to new platforms and digitization

⁹⁷And it is an open secret that BD actor Hans Sigl himself is behind most, if not all, of the account's posts.

trends, often focusing too much on their traditional media delivery channel. This means for the ZDF that marketing strategies are sometimes still too linear and TV focused, e.g. actors often appear as guests in TV magazines at the premieres of the new season (e.g. Milert, 2019 or), often neglecting the web and social media. Web and social media should be considered viable distribution options.

Influence on a region with screen tourism

Supporting economically underdeveloped regions As a public-law broadcaster, ZDF is expected contribute to social improvement beyond private competition. With its historical context and responsibility, ZDF can drive positive local change purposefully through medialisation. ST can help by addressing the historical neglect of East Germany, improving its image, promoting tourism and strengthening the local economy. ZDF is already doing this with "Dr. Ballouz" (X-Filme Creative Pool, 2024), set in the Uckermark in eastern Germany. Overall this commitment could be expanded. Choosing diverse locations for productions is possible and can enhance ZDF's reputation in these spaces, fulfilling society's need for tangible experiences and creating appreciated and gratifying landmarks.. With criticism always close at hand, ZDF should work openly with regional DMOs to support these regions.

Critique on media and destination connection Where there are opportunities, there is also criticism and especially public-law broadcasters must be aware of these social developments. ZDF is already aware as there are ongoing internal discussions about BD merchandising and tourist services costing money. Since Germans have already paid a fee for BD production, some question why they should pay more? The controversy stems from mandatory fees that fund public-law TV in Germany. Paying for optional merchandise is seen by some as unreasonable. Criticism also targets ST and medialisation, with accusations that e.g. documentaries serve as advertisements for regions like Tyrol: "The fact that the documentary [page 95, D.B.] is now being broadcasted at the very time [2021, D.B.] when Austria is reopening to its neighbors and Bavaria is allowing small-scale border traffic: A rogue who sees connections here. (Translated with deepl; Focus Online, 2021, p 1ff)" The Journalist argues that homeland series like the BD can be escapist, but journalistic documentaries in the ZDF should carefully depict reality. (cf. Focus Online, 2021, p 1ff)" For the Journalist the documentary felt like it was more an advertising for the WK destination than about the background of the BD TV show. As this might be just an opinion it is clear that the BD screen product was just used as a prominent lead (page 234) into more mundane subjects depicted in the documentation. There is a delicate balance to be struck: Landscapes as innocent backdrop or already "location placement" (page 95)?

Transmedia storytelling

Henry Jenkins' concept of "transmedia storytelling" becomes relevant when considering the potential of the BD show with its established fan base, WK ST and social media engagement. Transmedia storytelling could extend the BD TV show into other media forms and new screen products and ST itself could be an entry point into the BD narrative. Screen locations at the WK can serve as unique media for storytelling, generating new ideas and serving as starting points for different formats and themes. (cf. Jenkins, 2007)

Screen locations as entry points for journalism As a public broadcaster, ZDF has a mandate to inform the public, using journalism across platforms. The established narrative, spanning 16 seasons, provides tangible subject matter for journalism. BD screen locations serve as popular entry points for journalistic exploration of regional stories and issues. ZDF has already produced a short documentary, "At home with the Bergdoktor - On the road at the Wilder Kaiser,"⁹⁸, exploring real places and meeting the people who live there, including the "real" mountain doctor Lorenz Steinwender. While not in-depth, such journalism uses the popularity of the BD to engage a more niche audience in journalistic contexts. Since the BD is not a philosophical show debating the pros and cons of the exalted mountain motive, the offshoots only get as far as catering to the same audience, so they remain superficial.

Screen tourism travel show Journalism is an obvious choice, but entertainment shows closer to the BD TV show fit well in a transmedia universe. Special editions of shows like "ZDF Fernsehgarten" at the WK destination connect to the BD. This connection was evident when BD star Hans Sigl appeared on the show.⁹⁹ (cf. Wilder Kaiser Tourismusverband, 2014; Milert, 2019, p. 1) One significant change in television viewing habits due to the shift in tourism and medialisation is the rise of destination-inspired content and travel-related programming. Shows like "Dark Tourist" (Rothbart et al., 2018) and "James May: Our Man In India" (Whitter et al., 2024) gaining popularity spiking the viewers interested in exploring different cultures and destinations featured in these programs. Reality TV shows centered on adventure and exploration like "The Amazing Race" (Creators: Doganieri and van Munster, 2024) and "Survivor" (Creator Parsons, 2024) are also popular. ZDF could explore this trend with shows use the sets of its own shows. And the BD is just a start as others like "ZDF Traumschiff" (Polyphon Film-und Fernsehgesellschaft and

⁹⁸this was already discussed on page 95.

⁹⁹And it is interesting how other media report on this fact, like the headline "ZDF-Fernsehgarten: "Mountain Doctor star Hans Sigl dawdles at Whitsun (Milert, 2019, p. 1)". The actor's background is strongly emphasized in the headline as well as in the text. This is exactly the kind of promotion that is useful for the show and creates a connection to the viewer and fans.

Zweites Deutsches Fernsehen Österreichischer Rundfunk, 2024) and "ARD Tatort" (Griesmayr et al., 2024) can provide screen locations for decades. This shift aligns with viewers' growing interest in travel and adventure, as well as making ST communication more closely tied to the ZDF brand and its programming mandate.

The mountain doctor cinematic universe "Media in the 21st century is so easily accessible, so ubiquitous beyond the silver screen, that it's seen as faulty logic to constrain people to experiencing a story in only one medium (Clark, 2023, p. 5)." With a TV show and book series, there is potential to expand BD's narrative across more media types. An obvious suggestion: The winter special could be upgraded to a theatrical event with a bigger budget and bigger story threats. A crossover with the "Bergretter" series - that is partially filmed in neighboring valleys - could attract fans of both shows and broaden the perspective on Tyrol.¹⁰⁰ Spin-offs, companion shows and documentaries could create a "Mountain Doctor Cinematic Universe" with movies, series, comics, games, user-generated content and global stories with spectacular cases. This would expand BD's narrative into new realms and locations, while journalism and on-screen locations ground this universe in reality for fans. I know this seems a little far fetched but we live in a time where this would be a possibility.

¹⁰⁰This has happened before, but fans want it again (von Parseval, 2023).

Chapter 6

Final thoughts on screen tourism

This dissertation explored the complex relationship between media and tourism, with a special focus on screen tourism (ST). Through a detailed case study of "Der Bergdoktor" (BD, engl. "The Mountain Doctor") and its screen locations in the Wilder Kaiser (WK) destination, the research has demonstrated how screen productions can significantly influence tourism dynamics and social media patterns. It contributes to the academic understanding of screen tourism by extending existing theories and situating the phenomenon in the interplay between media and travel.

Thick data and method mesh The screen product was analyzed using quantitative market share data (figure 3.13) together with a content analysis of Bergdoktor TV show locations (page 87). These insights were connected with a thick data analysis from Instagram follow-up communication: Quantitative social media data and qualitative trace interviews provided comprehensive insights. The combined methods - social media everyday posts, quantitative and qualitative data, content analysis from BD screen product and additional insight from ZDF and Wilder Kaiser tourism management - offered a comprehensive examination of screen tourism: Thick data and the method mesh allowed for theoretical ground work, drew a path for the development of media & tourism as well as having practical recommendations.

Weaknesses By focusing on "Der Bergdoktor" (ZDF, 2024) and the Wilder Kaiser region, this research only adds to the growing body of literature on how specific media products can promote tourism. The primary limitation of the case study is that it is geographically concentrated in the Wilder Kaiser region, which limits the generalizability of the findings.¹ In addition, the reliance on self-reported data from tourists through the trace interview method introduces potential biases related to the demographic and behavioral characteristics of social media users. These may include social desirability bias and recall bias, which seems very relevant when looking at the

¹What this work tries to counterbalance with the intertwining of the historical development of media and tourism into the case study findings to generalize them.

single respondent for the Production accounts.

What science could do Despite addressing weaknesses, future research should conduct longitudinal studies to understand the long-term development of screen tourism. Other studies could trace in detail the evolution from film tourism to screen tourism (expand on page 9) and explore possible future forms. Researchers could examine the role of emerging technologies, like virtual and augmented reality, in enhancing (screen) tourism experiences or inducing tourism from home. It would be interesting to see if these technologies can induce tourism similarly or how the paradox of traveling to a real-world destination for a virtual experience might play out.

Knowledge about the everyday and extraordinary Social media is a ubiquitous tool used for everything, including daily life (page 217). It offers a way to gather data on specific everyday habits, attitudes or emotions, often overlooked and hard to obtain. Results show that social media captures both the extraordinary and the everyday, niche habits and zeitgeist developments. Seeing Bergdoktor actor Hans Sigl at Fan Fest is extraordinary (figure 4.34), while parking in the Bergdoktor lot is ordinary (figure 5.7). Social media's omnipresence includes all agent groups, providing diverse perspectives on screen tourism communication and enriching the final data. The study showed that everyday knowledge in the destination is disrupted because all stakeholders frame the screen locations as places of fiction where local reality plays a diminishing role. The screen productions have not only completely taken over some of the spaces, transformed others and influenced the surrounding areas, but the combined social media posts of all stakeholders have also created a simulated knowledge. The dissemination of the posts produces a media reality that may end up cementing these changes in the destination for the future. (page 58).

New insights about the Production Studies have examined individual stakeholders of Screen Tourists, Destination and Production, but this work viewed them as interconnected aspects of the same phenomenon. They interact on different levels - user generated content, inducing traveling, reposts or simply interactions - but on social media they have a supposedly almost equal playing field. Results showed all groups focus on the three main screen locations (Gruberhof, Bergdoktor practice and town square) and the motive Wilder Kaiser mountain range, with slight differences. Production and some Screen Tourists used an influencer aesthetic putting themselves into the photo, which the Destination never did, because it was more focused on landscapes and main screen locations, rarely showing tourists present at these sights.² This is an example of that comparing the different groups, is revealing

²This hints at the urban-rural divide explained on page 32.

insights that would otherwise be impossible to identify. This work explored post-production communication on social networks, generating new knowledge about the ongoing influence of the Production and other stakeholders. Actors dominate the Production's screen tourism communication. They are presenting their work as a vacation (page 171) and creating a tourist utopia for fans.³

The screen, tourism and social media is the future We live in an age dominated by screens, prophesied soon to become invisible with augmented reality in wearable tech. Generation Z (page 62) extensively uses screen devices in tourism, preferring destinations popularized by visual media and sharing experiences on social media. The traditional cinema dispositive is fading, with screens now transcending traditional space and time limits. The proliferation of digital media has expanded screen tourism scope to include various forms of screen media, such as TV series or social media. This shift changes how audiences interact with media and tourists perceive destinations via smart devices. In the pre-travel phase (page 104), they interact with the inducing screen product and social media photos and at the destination through the smartphone device (page 213) and follow-up social media communication. Screen tourism describes the evolving relationship between media and tourism due to the digital revolution. It is not a definition, but a description of what we find when we analyze the interplay between media and tourism.

The power of visual media Visual media's power is evident in its ubiquity (page 208): With screens, the Internet and media all contributing to its dominant form. For the first time the smartphone combines them all with visual in- and output at its core (page 213). Shows like "Mountain Doctor" create fandoms and induce tourism to destinations like Wilder Kaiser. Visual media influences fans' lives, destination realities and social media communication. Instagram exemplifies how visual media distracts (page 214), creates co-presence (page 214), alters personalities (page 218) and serves as tourism evidence (page 209). Social media's structure aligns with screen tourism, extending the screen product and allowing tourists to join the narrative (page 209) and connect with peers (page 215) through photos and videos. The visual induced by the media, transformed by the screen and distributed by the internet changes the experience in the destination, all while impacting other spaces.

From inspiration to preparation The study showed that social media accounts of the Production influenced tourists' initial destination choices, while planning relied on Destination accounts and other (screen) tourists (page 164). In the pre-travel phase, potential screen tourists know who initiated their trip but also where to find the best travel information. Therefore, Destination accounts should focus

³Similar to what happened in old Hollywood with the production of Western (page 38).

on providing relevant information for the screen location experience, while productions should focus on the fictional story, emotions and characters to motivate screen tourism.

Diverse photo compositions Screen Tourists, Destinations and Production accounts on social media differ in photo compositions (page 177). Production accounts but mostly actors focus on self-promotion, centering on themselves (page 171). Destination accounts highlight the region, landscape and attractions with professional looking photos (page 174). Regular Screen Tourists, apart from influencers (who act like most Production accounts), showcase beautiful landscapes (page 166) while integrating themselves into the TV show's fictional world, blending Destination and Production styles. These compositions kind of reflect their roles in society and social media but all of these composition can be seen in still of the mountain doctor TV show.

Similar post content The corpus showed three common aspects among different stakeholders. First, the focus is on a few screen locations like Gruberhof, the mountain doctor practice and Going's town square (including the church, Wilder Kaiser guesthouse, pharmacy and the square itself; page 173). Second, most photos were taken outdoors (page 164), highlighting the destination landscape, especially in summer (page 173). The winter ski season is less featured (page 146). Lastly, many photos have the Wilder Kaiser mountain range in the background (page 175). These trends originate from the TV show's narrative, which uses few screen locations (page 87), relies on outdoor summer shots (page 87) and emphasizes the mountain range (page 160) in the character scenes as well as transition shots. As the similarities are defined by the screen product, the differences (page 239) arise from stakeholders' roles and use of social media. So screen tourism communication is partially influenced by either the screen product and social media but always by media and the screen.

Influencer accounts The analysis quickly revealed (page 99) a major difference between two types of accounts among stakeholders: some screen tourists and actors behaved like influencers. This divided these groups into subgroups or a new cross sectional influencer group. While the difference between influencer/actor and regular screen tourists/production crew is intriguing for future research, it was not the focus of this work. These Influencer accounts were promoting themselves as the Destination was promoting itself (page 171), making successful screen tourism posts predominantly feel like advertisements. This led to staged authenticity and hyperreal posts (page 157), further blurring reality and accelerating the shift into simulation.

The prime example for screen tourism success The Mountain Doctor TV series ex-

emplifies a screen product with high screen tourism potential. Its genre evokes an emotional desire for belonging and nature (page 85), set against the background of exalted Alps. With the mountains as one of the archetypes of landscapes (page 17), they have a recognizable feature that almost everyone can relate to. The transition shots (table 3.2) between scenes use panoramic and drone shots of the Wilder Kaiser region. They transfer the metaphor of the landscape to the narrative, as it becomes an actor in its own right, worthy of worship as much as the main characters. The show focuses on exterior shots (page 87) with the Wilder Kaiser mountain range mostly in the background, its most valuable asset. Also certain actors are anchored to certain locations (page 88) transferring their stories and characters traits onto the screen location which increases the possible appeal for screen tourists. Picturesque sceneries, recurring on-screen locations and resonant narratives about family, love and belonging turn viewers easily into tourists. This success of mountain doctor screen tourism, both online and on TV, has sustained for over 17 years, with no end in sight.

Strong influence on Instagram photos The power of the inducing screen product became evident through the method of the photographer-subject triangle analysis. Three main screen locations and the famous Wilder Kaiser mountain range emerged as dominant photo spots (page 173). The main screen locations of the gruberhof, Bergdoktor practice and town square had a lot of different photographer and motive points as the fourth hot spot above the Wilder Kaiser mountain range just had motive points. This methodical separation presented the difference between the photos and highlighted their function. With the screen locations frequently in the foreground and the mountain range in the background of Instagram posts (e.g. figure 6.1), they were mirroring the TV show. Key story locations of the narrative are the most photographed on Instagram. The show's outdoor emphasis turns the landscape into another character, attracting tourists to these natural sites visible on Instagram (page 164). The visual worlds of the TV show start the journey (figure 6.1 (a)), continuing through with the tourist gaze and ending up in social media posts (figure 6.1 (b)). In the End they are all connected by signs and symbols, creating a higher-order simulacra.

The late stage of modernity Chapter 2.2 explores the origins of the media-tourism nexus, showing their paralleled evolution together since the 19th century. Kirby described how the train and cinema developed alongside each other even before cinema arrived in the protocinema phase. First it was mostly traveling, the railway and the newly won freedoms that influenced the development of cinema and movies but this relation changes when continuing the path from the 19th to the 21st century. Screen tourism and surrounding theories, discussed in chapter 5.2, exemplifies the postmodern shift. It is not a parallel developing anymore but a merging media and



(a)

(b)

Figure 6.1: (a) Scene at the mountain doctor's practice with mountain scenery (source: screenshot from season 4 episode 4). (b) Photo of a screen tourist in front of the same screen location (source: Instagram with post id CGNnFd7DbIJ).

tourism in a new era. Media, smartphones and social media mediatize our (tourist) gaze (page 216) and mediatize (tourist) experience (page 209). Despite this digital shift, live events remain powerful (page 178). But screen tourists seek not just the real screen location anymore but also the narrative and personal emotions tied to it. This development, with its staged authenticity and fiction overwriting fact, reflects a broader societal shift. The rebellious postmodernism with its broad skepticism, subjectivism and relativism was only the beginning of the road to post-truth (page 198).

The post truth of screen tourism The study and theory shows that screen tourism contributes to a post-truth society, where visual media significantly influences reality perception. It motivates visits and alters how destinations are perceived, both physically and virtually. This mirrors a societal trend where media shape and distort public understanding. The Internet and especially social media amplifies this by reshaping narratives and creating feedback loops, where fictional screen representations are reinforced or de-differentiated (page 190). This entrenches post-truth dynamics, where media representation trumps objective reality. This is so powerful because the narratives and images of screen products are largely more wide spread up to global pop culture icons that overshadow foreign history, local cultures and subordinate spaces (pages 176 and 58). Post tourists are characterized by enjoying and acknowledging the staged nature of their experiences, which are heavily influ-

enced by the media. Post tourists love screen tourism, where the line between reality and fiction is increasingly thin. When the polar opposites of (fictional) media and tourism (reality) come together in screen tourism they are taking post tourism to its possible end: As it is not just pretending to be something else, but becoming something else entirely.

Screen tourism as a sign of change From fiction overwriting fact to the power of visual media in our everyday lives, these phenomena witnessed in the case study of the Mountain Doctor and screen tourism in general are part of a larger societal shift towards *post-truth*. A shift that began with the emerging dominance of visual media and has culminated in a digital hyperreal late modernity. Is post-truth the cultural shift needed to accept that Baudrillard's *simulation* is already upon us? Again, a scenario that was a movie in the 1999 instant classic, *The Matrix* (Wachowski and Wachowski, 1999). The film delves into philosophical questions about perception and illusion, suggesting that what we perceive as real may be a construct. Whatever words you use - post-truth, simulation, the Matrix - it is clear that society is changing, and screen tourism and social media are just a tiny fraction of where it is becoming clearly visible.

Chapter 7

Appendix

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7.3 Trace interview

7.3.1 Trace interview questionnaire

The question in this section are left in their original form as they were asked in the trace interview in German. This is done to show how the questions were originally asked to the respondents. Later when it gets to the answers they are translated to understand the question and answer items. The complete design of the survey on SoSciSurvey can be found in the repo under this link: https://git.zdf-digital.com/boecher.d/bergdoktorarbeit/-/tree/master/scripts/SociSurvey_Traceinterview_Code?ref_type=heads

Table 7.1: Trace interview questions for screen tourists

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Wie viele Folgen der Serie „Der Bergdoktor“ haben Sie gesehen?		Nominal	Selection
Welche Staffeln der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" haben sie gesehen?	Staffel 1, Staffel 2, [...], Staffel 15, Keine Staffel	Metric	System
Sind Sie ein Fan der Serie?		Metric	Scale
Beschäftigen Sie sich auch über das wöchentlichen Schauen der neusten Folgen der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" hinaus mit der Serie oder ihren Charakteren?		Ordinal	Scale
Wie viel Zeit verbringen Sie durchschnittlich am Tag auf Instagram?		Nominal	Selection
Welche Themen interessieren Sie normalerweise am meisten auf Instagram?	"Reisen & Destination", "Mode & Beauty", "Sport & gesundes Leben", "Kunst & Kultur", "Stars & Sternchen", "Kochen & Backen", "Neuigkeiten & News", "Freunde & Verwandte", "Comedy & Memes", "Heimwerken & Basteln"	Ordinal	Scale
Wie sehr haben Sie Instagram in der Vorbereitung auf den Urlaub am Wilden Kaiser genutzt?	"Ich habe vor dem Urlaub bei Instagram über den Wilden Kaiser recherchiert.", "Ich habe vor oder während meines Urlaubs andere Tourismusbeiträge vom Wilden Kaiser auf Instagram wahrgenommen.", "Ich habe mir Beiträge von Accounts der Destination angesehen (Bsp.: Visit Tirol).", "Ich folge den offiziellen Tourismussaccounts der Destination auf Instagram (Bsp.: Wilder Kaiser, Love Austria oder andere).", "Ich habe mir Beiträge von Schauspieler:innen und der Filmcrew am Wilden Kaiser angesehen.", "Ich habe Instagram nicht genutzt, um mich über den Wilden Kaiser zu informieren."	Ordinal	Scale
Haben Sie die Beiträge der anderen Akteure in Ihrer Entscheidung, an den Wilden Kaiser zu fahren, beeinflusst?	"Beiträge von anderen Touristen im Urlaub am Wilden Kaiser", "Beiträge von Schauspieler:innen und der Filmcrew am Wilden Kaiser", "Beiträge der lokalen Tourismussaccounts (Bsp.: Visit Tirol)"	Ordinal	Scale
Wie stellt sich der Wilde Kaiser dar?	"Der Wilde Kaiser erschien mir vor Ort so, wie ich das auf Instagram wahrgenommen habe.", "Es war vor Ort am Wilden Kaiser schöner als die Instagram-Bilder es zeigen konnten.", "Meine Erwartungen durch die Instagram-Beiträge konnte der Wilde Kaiser vor Ort nicht erfüllen.", "Ich habe mir vor dem Urlaub keine Instagram-Beiträge vom Wilden Kaiser angesehen."	Ordinal	Scale

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Waren Sie schon mal auf einem Bergdoktor-Fantag am Wilden Kaiser?		Nominal	Selection
In welchem Zeitraum fand der Urlaub am Wilden Kaiser statt, von dem die auf Instagram geposteten Fotos stammen?		Date	Open
Was hat Sie zu dieser Reise motiviert?		Text	Open
Welche Rolle hat die Serie "Der Bergdoktor" gespielt?		Nominal	Selection
Was waren Ihre Gründe, die Drehorte des Bergdoktors am Wilden Kaiser zu besuchen?	"Ich wollte in die Fußstapfen meiner Lieblingsschauspieler:innen treten.", "Ich wollte selbst einmal an dem Drehort der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" stehen.", "Mich interessiert der reale Ort; nicht die Relevanz des Ortes als Drehort in der Serie "Der Bergdoktor".", "Ich bin ein loyaler Fan und wollte das zum Ausdruck bringen.", "Ich finde die Landschaft einfach beeindruckend und wollte sie selbst sehen.", "Ich habe das Gefühl durch die Serie den Wilden Kaiser zu kennen.", "Ich wollte einfach Spaß haben und mich entertainen lassen.", "Ich wollte etwas Besonderes machen in meinem Urlaub.", "Ich wollte etwas Neues und Ungewöhnliches wagen.", "Ich war auf der Suche nach einer einzigartigen Erfahrung.", "Es war nicht meine Idee, sondern die meiner Reisebegleitung."	Ordinal	Scale
Wie haben Sie die Drehorte entdeckt bzw. davon erfahren?		Nominal	Selection
Welche Drehorte haben Sie am Wilden Kaiser besucht?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Ordinal	Ranking
An welchen Drehorten waren Sie ihrem Gefühl nach der fiktionalen Welt der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" und ihrer Charaktere besonders nahe?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Metric	Scale
Wie oft waren Sie schon am Wilden Kaiser?		Nominal	Selection
Waren Sie schon mal bewusst an anderen Film-tourismus Orten?		Nominal	Selection
Ich habe mir den Instagram-Beitrag hinter dem Link angesehen?		Ordinal	Scale
Ist das Ihr Beitrag zum Thema "Filmtourismus am Wilden Kaiser"?		Nominal	Selection
Ort des Fotomotiv?		Metric	System
Standort der Fotograf:in?		Metric	System

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Ist der Beitrag ein "repost" eines anderen Beitrags?		Nominal	Selection
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesen Hashtags veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesen Mentions veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesem Text veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie sich bei diesem Instagram-Beitrag für dieses Foto (bzw. Albumfotos) entschieden?		Text	Open
Wie war die Situation vor Ort, als das Foto entstanden ist?		Text	Open
Welchen fiktionalen Ort aus der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" zeigt das Foto aus Ihrem Beitrag?		Nominal	Selection
Wann ist das Foto/Bild entstanden?		Date	Open
Wurde der Beitrag gepostet, direkt nachdem das Foto/Bild im Urlaub am Wilden Kaiser entstanden ist?		Nominal	Selection
Wo wohnen Sie?		Text	Open
In welcher Art von Gemeinschaft leben Sie?		Nominal	Selection
Was ist Ihr Geburtsjahr?		Metric	Open
Was ist Ihr höchster Bildungsabschluss?		Nominal	Selection
Welchen Familienstand haben Sie zurzeit?		Nominal	Selection
In welcher Berufsgruppe sind Sie tätig?		Nominal	Selection
Welche Serien schauen Sie neben dem Bergdoktor im Fernsehen?		Text	Open
Was ist Ihre Lieblingsrubrik im Fernsehen gemessen an der Zeit, die sie damit verbringen?	"Dokumentation", "Sport", "Serien", "Filme", "Spielshows", "Magazine", "Nachrichten", "Live-Events"	Ordinal	Ranking
Möchten Sie noch etwas sagen?		Text	Open

Table 7.2: Trace interview questions for the destination

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Haben die Mitarbeiter:innen, zuständig für Filmtourismusbeiträge, auf Instagram die Serie "Der Bergdoktor" gesehen?		Nominal	Selection
Wie tritt Ihr Account auf Instagram insgesamt auf?	"Aktiv", "Interessant", "Bescheiden", "Locker", "Formell", "Ehrlich"	Ordinal	Scale
Was kam zuerst?	"Die Bergdoktor-Filmtouristen an den Wilden Kaiser.", "Die Vermarktung des Wilden Kaiser als Bergdoktor-Drehstandort.", "Vermarktung und Filmtouristen kamen ungefähr zur gleichen Zeit."	Nominal	Selection
Ist Filmtourismus Teil der Social-Media-Strategie Ihres Accounts?		Nominal	Selection
Gibt es bestimmte Vorgaben speziell für Filmtourismus-Beiträge durch Verantwortliche in der Destination?		Text	Open
Versucht Ihr Account sich bei Filmtourismus-Beiträgen einem bestimmten Stil anderer Akteure auf Instagram anzunähern?	"Screentouristen", "Allgemeine Touristen", "TV-Produktion", "Eigener allgemeiner Social Media-Stil", "Aktuellen Trends", "Anderes"	Metric	Scale
In welcher Jahreszeit findet Filmtourismus am Wilden Kaiser eher statt?	"Frühling", "Sommer", "Herbst", "Winter"	Metric	System
Ermutigen Sie Ihre Touristen dazu Fotos bzw. Beiträge von den Drehorten der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" zu machen und sie auf Instagram zu veröffentlichen?		Ordinal	Scale
Ermutigen Sie die Film-Produktion und ihre Mitarbeiter:innen dazu Fotos bzw. Beiträge von den Drehorten der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" zu machen und sie auf Instagram zu veröffentlichen?		Ordinal	Scale
Hat sich das Image des Wilden Kaisers aufgrund der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" verändert?		Metric	Scale
Was sind laut Ihrer Meinung und Einsicht die beliebtesten Filmtourismusorte der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" am Wilden Kaiser?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Ordinal	Ranking
Was sind laut Ihrer Meinung und Einsicht die beliebtesten Drehorte der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" in den sozialen Medien?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Ordinal	Ranking
Wie schätzen Sie die Bergdoktor-Fantage am Wilden Kaiser ein?		Text	Open
Ich habe mir den Instagram-Beitrag hinter dem Link angesehen?		Ordinal	Scale
Ist das Ihr Beitrag zum Thema "Filmtourismus am Wilden Kaiser"?		Nominal	Selection

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Gab oder gibt es Überlegungen Virtual Reality (VR) bzw. Augmented Reality (AR) oder verwandte Technologien beim Filmtourismus am Wilder Kaiser einzusetzen?	"Es gab Überlegungen in der Vergangenheit", "Es gibt aktuell aktive Projekte", "Es gibt Pläne für die Zukunft", "Darüber haben wir uns keinerlei Gedanken gemacht."	Ordinal	Scale
Ist der Beitrag ein "Repost" eines anderen Beitrags?		Nominal	Selection
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesen "Hashtags" veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesen "Mentions" veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesem Text veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie sich bei Ihrem Instagram-Beitrag für dieses Foto (bzw. Albumfotos) entschieden?		Text	Open
Handelt es sich im Beitrag um ein kommerzielles Foto?		Nominal	Selection
Ort des Fotomotiv?		Metric	System
Standort der Fotograf:in?		Metric	System
Welchen fiktionalen Ort aus der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" zeigt das Foto aus Ihrem Beitrag?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Nominal	Selection
Welchen fiktionalen Ort aus der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" zeigt das Foto aus Ihrem Beitrag?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Text	Open
Wann ist das Foto/Bild entstanden?		Date	Open
Haben Sie für oder im Foto etwas verändert? Haben Sie den Drehort so fotografiert wie Sie ihn vor Ort vorgefunden haben?		Metric	Scale
Gibt es belastbare Zahlen zum durchschnittlichen Alter von Fans der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" am Wilden Kaiser?		Text	Open
Welche Art von Urlauber:innen entscheiden sich, motiviert durch die Serie "Der Bergdoktor", für Filmtourismus am Wilden Kaiser?	"Kulturtouristen", "Bildungstouristen", "Naturtouristen", "Sporttouristen", "Gesundheitstouristen", "Erholungstouristen", "Wellnestouristen", "Rucksacktouristen", "Andere, bitte spezifizieren"	Metric	System
In welcher Form reisen Filmtouristen der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" vorrangig an den Wilden Kaiser?	"Individualreisen/Veranstalterreisen", "Exklusivtourismus/Massentourismus", "Fremdenverkehr/Binnentourismus"	Ordinal	Scale

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Mit welchem Verkehrsmittel reisen die Filmtouristen der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" an den Wilden Kaiser?	"Auto", "Wohnwagen", "Bus", "Bahn", "Flugzeug", "Schiff/Boot", "zu Fuß", "Anderes, bitte spezifizieren"	Metric	System
Wie lange bleiben die Filmtouristen der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" durchschnittlich am Wilden Kaiser?		Nominal	Selection
Welche anderen Medienproduktionen locken Filmtouristen an den Wilden Kaiser?		Text	Open
Möchten Sie noch etwas sagen?		Text	Open

Table 7.3: Trace interview questions for the production

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Wie viel Zeit verbringen Sie durchschnittlich am Tag mit Instagram?		Nominal	Selection
Wie tritt Ihr Account auf Instagram insgesamt auf?	"Aktiv", "Interessant", "Bescheiden", "Locker", "Formell", "Ehrlich"	Ordinal	Scale
Gibt es bestimmte Vorgaben speziell für Filmtourismus-Beiträge durch Verantwortliche in der Destination?		Text	Open
Gibt es bestimmte Vorgaben durch die Produktion (ZDF, ORF, NDF, etc.) wie die Serie "Der Bergdoktor" dargestellt werden soll auf Instagram?		Text	Open
Was sind laut Ihrer Meinung und Einsicht die von Touristen meist besuchten Drehorte der Serie "Der Bergdoktor"?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Ordinal	Ranking
Wie schätzen Sie die Bergdoktor-Fantage am Wilden Kaiser ein?		Text	Open
War der Ort der Produktion am Wilden Kaiser einer der Gründe bei der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" mitzuwirken?		Metric	Scale
Was sind laut Ihrer Meinung und Einsicht die meist genutzten Drehorte der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" am Wilden Kaiser?	"Gruberhof (Elternhaus/Bauernhof)", "Praxis des Bergdoktors", "Gasthof zum Wilden Kaiser", "Krankenhaus", "Dorfplatz und Kirche", "Apotheke", "Hintersteiner See"	Ordinal	Ranking
Ist der Beitrag ein "repost" eines anderen Beitrags?		Nominal	Selection
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesen "Hashtags" veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesen "Mentions" veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie diesen Beitrag auf Instagram mit diesem Text veröffentlicht?		Text	Open
Warum haben Sie sich bei diesem Instagram-Beitrag für dieses Foto (bzw. Albumfotos) entschieden?		Text	Open
Handelt es sich bei dem Foto im Beitrag um ein kommerzielles Foto?		Nominal	Selection
Wie war die Situation vor Ort, als das Foto entstanden ist?		Text	Open
Welchen fiktionalen Ort aus der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" zeigt das Foto aus Ihrem Beitrag?		Nominal	Selection
Wann ist das Foto/Bild entstanden?		Date	Open

Question	Answers	Type	Input
Wurde der Beitrag gepostet, direkt nachdem das Foto/Bild beim Dreh am Wilden Kaiser entstanden ist?		Nominal	Selection
Haben Sie den Drehort so fotografiert wie Sie ihn vor Ort vorgefunden haben? Haben Sie für oder im Foto etwas verändert?		Metric	Scale
Wie viele Jahre bzw. Staffeln sind Sie bereits Teil der "Der Bergdoktor" Produktion?		Metric	Open
Welche Rolle haben Sie bei der Produktion der Serie "Der Bergdoktor"?		Nominal	Selection
Bei welchen anderen Produktionen sind Sie neben der Serie "Der Bergdoktor" noch aktiv?		Text	Open
Möchten Sie noch etwas sagen?		Text	Open

7.3.2 Trace interview answers

The trace interview questions in this section were in their original form in german. They were now translated with the help of deepl.com and ChatGPT. The order of questions are like in the original trace interview questionnaire on SoSciSurvey. The answers and data of the production questionnaire were not included into this chapter because the number of cases (N) were not sufficient to add a value on an aggregated level. The answers to open text questions are not included because they do not produce quantitative results but rather are analyzed more qualitatively and individually.

Screen tourism trace interview answers

Some questions and answers of ST respondents are left out because they include personal information. Most of the trace interview questions have 21 cases which puts it right between quantitative and qualitative data making it a good amount to enrich the data gathered in bulk on social media.

Table 7.4: Which seasons of the series "The Mountain Doctor" have you seen? Dichotomous checkboxes with the seasons available to watch on tv by the time of the interview (Season 1 to 15).

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
EI01		19	1	15	14	9	4,91

Table 7.5: How many episodes of the series "The Mountain Doctor" have you watched?

Selection between 7 different buckets of viewed episodes.

Index	Item	N
EI06	No episode	-
EI06	One episode	-
EI06	Two to five episodes	-
EI06	Six to ten episodes	1
EI06	Ten to 20 episodes	-
EI06	21 to 50 episodes	6
EI06	More than 50 episodes	14

Table 7.6: Are you a fan of the series?

Metric scale 1 to 101 where 1 is "not a fan at all" and 101 is "big fan"

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
EI02		21	42	101	59	100	19.09

Table 7.7: Do you engage with the series "The Mountain Doctor" or its characters beyond just watching the newest episodes weekly?

Boolean options between "yes" and "no".

Index	Item	N
EI03	Yes	11
EI03	No	10

Table 7.8: How much time do you spend on average per day on Instagram?

Selection between 6 different time buckets.

Index	Item	N
EI04	Not at all	-
EI04	1/2 hour	4
EI04	One hour	10
EI04	Two hours	6
EI04	Three hours	1
EI04	More than three hours	-

Table 7.9: Which topics are you usually most interested in on Instagram?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 5 where 1 is "not at all" and 5 is "very much".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
EI05_01	Travel & Destination	21	2	5	3	4	0.89
EI05_02	Fashion & Beauty	20	1	5	4	2.5	1.27
EI05_03	Sports & Healthy Living	21	1	5	4	3	1.45
EI05_04	Arts & Culture	21	1	5	4	3	1.23
EI05_05	Celebrities & stars	20	1	5	4	2	1.30
EI05_06	Cooking & Baking	20	1	5	4	3	1.35
EI05_07	News & current stories	21	1	5	4	3	1.34
EI05_08	Friends & Family	21	1	5	4	4	1.12
EI05_09	Comedy & Memes	21	1	4	3	2	0.95
EI05_10	DIY & Crafts	21	1	5	4	3	1.20

Table 7.10: How much did you use Instagram in preparation for your vacation at the Wilder Kaiser?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 5 where 1 is "does not apply" and 5 is "fully applies".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT01_01	I researched the Wilder Kaiser on Instagram before the vacation.	21	1	5	4	3	1.49
IT01_02	I noticed other tourism posts about the Wilder Kaiser on Instagram before or during my vacation.	21	1	5	4	3	1.51
IT01_03	I looked at posts from destination accounts (e.g., Visit Tirol).	21	1	5	4	3	1.56
IT01_04	I follow the official tourism accounts of the destination on Instagram (e.g., Wilder Kaiser, Love Austria, or others)	21	1	5	4	2	1.59
IT01_05	I looked at posts from actors and the film crew at the Wilder Kaiser.	21	1	5	4	3	1.46
IT01_06	I did not use Instagram to inform myself about the Wilder Kaiser.	20	1	5	4	3	1.76

Table 7.11: Were you influenced by the posts of other actors in your decision to travel to the Wilder Kaiser?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 5 where 1 is "not influenced" and 5 is "strongly influenced".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT02_01	Posts from other tourists on vacation at the Wilder Kaiser	21	1	3	2	1	0.94
IT02_02	Posts from actors and the film crew at the Wilder Kaiser	21	1	5	4	2	1.50
IT02_03	Posts from local tourism accounts (e.g., Visit Tirol)	21	1	4	3	1	1.12

Table 7.12: How often have you been to the Wilder Kaiser?

Selection from 1 to 6 where 1 is "never" and 6 is "More than 4 times".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT13		21	2	5	3	3	

Table 7.13: What was the situation on site: How does the Wilder Kaiser present itself?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 5 where 1 is "does not apply" and 5 is "fully applies".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT03_01	The Wilder Kaiser appeared to me on site just as I perceived it on Instagram.	21	1	5	4	4	0.97
IT03_02	It was more beautiful on site at the Wilder Kaiser than the Instagram pictures could show.	21	1	5	4	5	1.34
IT03_03	My expectations from the Instagram posts were not met by the Wilder Kaiser on site.	21	1	4	3	1	1.03
IT03_04	I did not look at any Instagram posts of the Wilder Kaiser before the vacation.	21	1	5	4	2	1.41

Table 7.14: Have you ever attended a Mountain Doctor Fan Day at the Wilder Kaiser?
Selection from 1 to 5 where 1 is "never" and 5 is "More than 3 Fan Days".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT04		21	1	2	1	1	

Table 7.15: What role did the series "The Mountain Doctor" play?
Selection from 1 to 3 where 1 is "no reason" and 3 is "the main reason".

Index	Item	N
IT07	The series "The Mountain Doctor" was not a reason to travel to the Wilder Kaiser.	7
IT07	The series "The Mountain Doctor" was one of many reasons to travel to the Wilder Kaiser.	9
IT07	The series "The Mountain Doctor" was the main reason to travel to the Wilder Kaiser.	5

Table 7.16: What were your reasons for visiting the filming locations of "The Mountain Doctor" at Wilder Kaiser?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 5 where 1 is "does not apply" and 5 is "fully applies".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT08_01	I wanted to walk in the footsteps of my favorite actors.	21	1	4	3	2	1.30
IT08_02	I wanted to stand at the filming location of the series "The Mountain Doctor" myself.	21	1	5	4	3	1.42
IT08_03	I am interested in the real place; not its relevance as a filming location in the series "The Mountain Doctor".	21	1	5	4	3	1.47
IT08_04	I am a loyal fan and wanted to express that.	21	1	4	3	2	1.09
IT08_05	I find the landscape simply impressive and wanted to see it for myself.	21	4	5	1	5	0.44
IT08_06	I feel like I know the Wilder Kaiser through the series.	21	1	5	4	4	1.29
IT08_07	I just wanted to have fun and be entertained.	21	1	5	4	3	1.33
IT08_08	I wanted to do something special on my vacation.	21	1	5	4	4	1.33
IT08_09	I wanted to try something new and unusual.	21	1	5	4	2	1.54
IT08_10	I was looking for a unique experience.	21	1	5	4	2	1.36
IT08_11	It was not my idea, but that of my travel companion.	21	1	5	4	1	1.37

Table 7.17: How did you discover or learn about the filming locations?

Selection between 6 different answers.

Index	Item	N
IT09	I only realized afterwards that it was a filming location.	-
IT09	I came across it by chance.	1
IT09	I specifically searched for it.	14
IT09	It was part of a guided tour.	2
IT09	My travel companion took me there.	3
IT09	Another reason: "Viewed from a distance, I had already been there several times."	1

Table 7.18: Which filming locations have you visited at the Wilder Kaiser?

Ordinal scale from rank 1 to rank 7, where 1 is the "most visited" and 7 is the "least visited"

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT10_01	Gruberhof	16	1	7	6	4	1.93
IT10_02	Bergdokter Practice	21	1	7	6	3	1.80
IT10_03	Wilder Kaiser Guesthouse	17	1	6	5	3	1.33
IT10_04	Hospital	8	5	7	2	6.5	0.89
IT10_05	Village Square & Church	18	1	7	6	2	1.58
IT10_06	Pharmacy	17	2	6	4	5	1.19
IT10_07	Lake Hintersteiner	17	1	7	6	3	1.74

Table 7.19: Have you ever intentionally visited other film tourism locations?

Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IT14	True	5
IT14	False	16

Table 7.20: At which filming locations did you feel particularly close to the fictional world of the series "The Mountain Doctor" and its characters?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 101 where 1 is "no closeness" and 101 "very close".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT15_01	Gruberhof	16	5	101	96	101	31.03
IT15_02	Bergdokter Practice	21	21	101	80	97	26.34
IT15_03	Wilder Kaiser Guesthouse	17	8	101	93	51	30.11
IT15_04	Hospital	8	1	49	48	13	15.42
IT15_05	Village Square & Church	18	11	101	90	81.5	31.65
IT15_06	Pharmacy	17	5	101	96	16	24.32
IT15_07	Lake Hintersteiner	17	10	101	91	34	30.30

Table 7.21: When was the photo/picture taken?

Open date question with the format DD.MM.YYYY requested. Truncated to months for analysis.

Index	Item	N
IP12	2016-01	1
IP12	2016-10	1
IP12	2018-08	1
IP12	2018-10	1
IP12	2019-08	1
IP12	2019-09	1
IP12	2020-03	1
IP12	2020-06	2
IP12	2020-08	3
IP12	2020-09	2
IP12	2020-10	1
IP12	2020-11	1
IP12	2021-09	1

Table 7.22: Is the post a "repost" of another post?

Nominal selection between "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IP01	True	1
IP01	False	17

Table 7.23: Was the post posted directly after the photo/picture was taken on holiday at the Wilder Kaiser?

Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IP13	True	12
IP13	False	6

Table 7.24: Which fictional location from the series "The Mountain Doctor" does the photo in your post show?

Selection between 9 different answers with all the screen locations and "Other filming location" option as well as "It is not a filming location"

Index	Item	N
IP11	Gruberhof	3
IP11	Bergdokter Practice	8
IP11	Wilder Kaiser Guesthouse	1
IP11	Hospital	-
IP11	Village Square & Church	1
IP11	Pharmacy	-
IP11	Lake Hintersteiner	2
IP11	Other filming location	2
IP11	It is not a filming location	1

Table 7.25: What is your favorite TV category based on the time you spend watching it?

Ordinal ranking from rank 1 to 8 where 1 is "most time spent" and 8 is "least time spent".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
DE03_01	Documentary	14	2	7	5	3.5	1.77
DE03_02	Sports	9	1	8	7	6	2.12
DE03_03	Series	15	1	6	5	2	1.64
DE03_04	Movies	14	1	5	4	2	1.20
DE03_05	Game shows	10	2	8	6	5	2.10
DE03_06	Magazines	11	3	8	5	5	1.83
DE03_07	News	13	1	7	6	4	2.10
DE03_08	Live Events 5	9	3	8	5	6	1.74

Table 7.26: What is the year you are?

Open metric question with the date of birth format YYYY requested.

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
DE07		15	1958	1994	36	1976	11,43

Table 7.27: What is your highest educational qualification?

Selection question with 6 different options from 1 "Middle school" to 6 "Doctorate".

Index	Item	N
DE06	Middle school	4
DE06	High school diploma	2
DE06	Vocational training	5
DE06	Bachelor's degree	2
DE06	Master's degree	1
DE06	Doctorate	1

Table 7.28: What type of community do you live in?

Selection question with 6 different options ranging from rural 1 "Standalone building with no connection" to urban 6 "Metropolis".

Index	Item	N
DE05	Standalone building with no connection	1
DE05	Rural community	6
DE05	Suburban community	2
DE05	Town or city community	3
DE05	City	2
DE05	Metropolis	1
DE05	Other	-

Table 7.29: What is your current marital status?

Selection question with 6 different answer options.

Index	Item	N
DE08	single	2
DE08	in a relationship	5
DE08	married	8
DE08	widowed	-
DE08	divorced	-
DE08	registered civil partnership	-

Destination trace interview answers

Only 6 trace interviews of the destination were left to analyse after cleaning and filtering, so the answers should be seen as qualitative.

Table 7.30: What came first? Selection of 3 different answers.

Index	Item	N
IT16	The Mountain Doctor film tourists at the Wilder Kaiser.	1
IT16	The marketing of Wilder Kaiser as a Mountain Doctor filming location.	3
IT16	Marketing and film tourists came about at the same time.	2

Table 7.31: In which season does film tourism at the Wilder Kaiser predominantly occur?

Dichotomous checkbox for all four seasonal options: Spring (1), Summer (2), Autumn (3), and Winter (4).

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT20	Spring, Summer, Autumn, Winter	6	2	3	1	3	0.52

Table 7.32: Have the staff responsible for film tourism posts on Instagram watched the series "The Mountain Doctor"?

Selection from 7 different episode buckets from 1 "No episode" to 7 "More than 50 episodes".

Index	Item	N
EI07	No episode	-
EI07	One episode	-
EI07	2 to 5 episodes	1
EI07	6 to 10 episodes	1
EI07	10 to 20 episodes	-
EI07	21 to 50 episodes	1
EI07	More than 50 episodes	3

Table 7.33: How does the account overall present itself on Instagram?

An ordinal scale from 1 to 5, where 1 is "not at all" and 5 "very much".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
EI08_01	Active	5	2	5	3	4	1.14
EI08_02	Interesting	5	3	5	2	4	0.84
EI08_03	Modest	5	2	3	1	3	0.55
EI08_04	Casual	5	3	4	1	4	0.55
EI08_05	Formal	5	2	4	2	2	0.89
EI08_06	Honest	5	1	5	4	4	1.64

Table 7.34: Is film tourism part of your account's social media strategy?

Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IT17	True	4
IT17	False	2

Table 7.35: Does your account try to emulate the style of other actors on Instagram in film tourism posts?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 101 where 1 is "no emulation" and 101 "strong emulation".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT19_01	Screen tourists	4	35	72	37	51	15.17
IT19_02	General tourists	4	2	101	99	81	46.80
IT19_03	TV production	2	4	27	23	15.5	16.26
IT19_04	Own general social media style	4	1	101	100	59.5	41.70
IT19_05	Current trends	4	1	101	100	56	41.13
IT19_06	Other	1	72	72	0	72	-

Table 7.36: Do you encourage users? Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IT21	Do you encourage your tourists to take photos or make posts of the filming locations from "The Mountain Doctor" series and publish them on Instagram?	1
IT21	Do you encourage the film production and its staff to take photos or make posts of the filming locations from "The Mountain Doctor" series and publish them on Instagram?	-

Table 7.37: Has the image of the Wilder Kaiser changed due to the series "The Mountain Doctor"?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 101 where 1 is "not at all" and 101 "very much".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT22		6	51	101	50	81	18.38

Table 7.38: Have there been considerations to use Virtual Reality (VR), Augmented Reality (AR), or related technologies in film tourism at the Wilder Kaiser?

Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IT27	There were considerations in the past.	1
IT27	There are currently active projects.	-
IT27	There are plans for the future.	1
IT27	We have not given this any thought.	3

Table 7.39: What are, in your opinion and insight, the most popular film tourism locations of the series "The Mountain Doctor" at Wilder Kaiser?

Scale from rank 1 to rank 7, where 1 is the "most popular" and 7 is the "least popular".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT24_01	Grubertshof	6	1	3	2	2	0.75
IT24_02	Bergdokter Practice	6	1	2	1	1.5	0.55
IT24_03	Wilder Kaiser Guesthouse	6	3	5	2	4	0.89
IT24_04	Hospital	5	6	7	1	7	0.55
IT24_05	Village Square & Church	6	1	5	4	3.5	1.37
IT24_06	Pharmacy	5	4	7	3	6	1.10
IT24_07	Lake Hintersteiner	6	3	7	4	5	1.33

Table 7.40: What are, in your opinion and insight, the most popular filming locations of the series "The Mountain Doctor" on social media?

Scale from rank 1 to rank 7, where 1 is the "most popular" and 7 is the "least popular".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IT25_01	Gruberhof	4	2	6	4	2.5	1.89
IT25_02	Bergdokter Practice	5	1	2	1	1	0.55
IT25_03	Wilder Kaiser Guesthouse	5	2	6	4	3	1.64
IT25_04	Hospital	4	7	7	0	7	0.00
IT25_05	Village Square & Church	4	1	5	4	3.5	1.71
IT25_06	Pharmacy	4	3	6	3	5	1.50
IT25_07	Lake Hintersteiner	4	4	5	1	4.5	0.58

Table 7.41: Is the post a "repost" of another post?

Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IP21	True	0
IP21	False	0

Table 7.42: Is the article a commercial photo?Nominal scale with "True" and "False".

Index	Item	N
IP27	True	1
IP27	False	-

Table 7.43: When was the photo/picture taken?

Open date question with the format DD.MM.YYYY requested. Truncated to months for analysis.

Index	Item	N
IP31	10.2017	1
IP31	08.2019	1
IP31	04.2020	1
IP31	06.2020	1
IP31	09.2020	1

Table 7.44: Did you photograph the filming location as you found it on site?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 101 where 1 is "as found" and 101 "greatly altered".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
IP32		6	1	18	17	1.5	6.74

Table 7.45: Are there reliable figures on the average age of fans of the series "Der Bergdoktor" on the Wilder Kaiser?

Open Text question that asked for an age bucket.

Index	Item	N
DE13	40 - 60	1
50 DE13	18 - 70	1
44 DE13	20 - 70	1
45 DE13	16 - 80	1
48 DE13	25 - 75	1
50 DE13	+ - 50	1
50		

Table 7.46: What type of tourists, motivated by the series "The Mountain Doctor", opt for film tourism at the Wilder Kaiser?

Dichotomous checkbox answer out of 9 options with more than one possible answer.

Index	Item	N
DE14	Cultural tourists	1
DE14	Educational tourists	-
DE14	Nature tourists	4
DE14	Sports tourists	3
DE14	Health tourists	-
DE14	Recreational tourists	5
DE14	Wellness tourists	1
DE14	Backpackers	-
DE14	Other	1

Table 7.47: In what form do film tourists of the series "The Mountain Doctor" primarily travel to the Wilder Kaiser?

Ordinal scale from 1 to 101 where for DE15_01 1 is "Individual travel" and 101 "Package tours", for DE15_02 1 is "Exclusive tourism" and 101 "Mass tourism", and for DE15_03 1 is "International Tourism" and 101 "Domestic tourism".

Index	Item	N	Min	Max	Range	Median	SD
DE15_01	Individual travel/ Package tours	6	1	49	48	23	20.13
DE15_02	Exclusive tourism/ Mass tourism	6	32	85	53	58.5	19.87
DE15_03	International Tourism/ Domestic tourism	4	11	101	90	42.5	38.71

Table 7.48: What means of transportation do film tourists of the series "The Mountain Doctor" use to travel to the Wilder Kaiser?

Dichotomous checkbox answer with 8 options with more than one possible answer.

Index	Item	N
DE16	Car	6
DE16	Caravan	3
DE16	Bus	4
DE16	Train	4
DE16	Airplane	-
DE16	Ship/Boat	-
DE16	On foot	1
DE16	Other	1

Table 7.49: How long do film tourists of the series "The Mountain Doctor" typically stay at the Wilder Kaiser?

Selection out of 5 different time boxes ranging from 1 "1 day (day tourists)" to 5 "Longer than 14 days".

Index	Item	N
DE17	1 day (day tourists)	-
DE17	2 to 3 days	1
DE17	Up to 7 days	3
DE17	Up to 14 days	-
DE17	Longer than 14 days	-
DE17	I cannot answer this	-

7.4 Vector calculations for Photo-Motive-Triangle

Calculations and the corresponding letters are found in figure 7.1 on page 303.

The distance or height (h) of the triangle was calculated between the coordinates of the photographer (x_p, y_p) as vector $\vec{p}$ and the motive (x_m, y_m) as vector $\vec{m}$:

$$h = \sqrt{(x_m - x_p)^2 + (y_m - y_p)^2}$$

A constant factor (f) for the camera angle between the opposite (a_1) and adjacent (a_2) was determined by the researchers smartphone as 1.3076.¹ The calculation for the hypotenuse (b) was now the height (h) divided by two times the factor (f):

$$b = \frac{h}{2 * f}$$

With the length of the hypotenuse (b) the calculation of the two corner xy-coordinates (x_{c_1}, y_{c_1}) and (x_{c_2}, y_{c_2}) was possible.

Determine the (x_h, y_h) as vector $\vec{h}$ that points from the photo coordinate $\vec{p}$ to the motive coordinate $\vec{m}$:

$$\vec{h} = \begin{pmatrix} x_m - x_p \\ y_m - y_p \end{pmatrix}$$

Rotate the vector $\vec{h}$ 90 degrees clockwise:

$$\vec{h}_r = \begin{pmatrix} -y_h \\ x_h \end{pmatrix}$$

Scale the vector $\vec{h}_r$ to the length of the hypotenuse (b):

$$\vec{h}_s = \frac{\vec{h}_r}{\sqrt{\sum(\vec{h}_r^2)}} \times b$$

Calculate the coordinates of the two corners points (x_{c_1}, y_{c_1}) as vector $\vec{c}_1$ and (x_{c_2}, y_{c_2}) as vector $\vec{c}_2$ on each side of the hypotenuse (b) from the motive vector $\vec{m}$:

$$\vec{c}_1 = \vec{m} + \vec{h}_s$$

$$\vec{c}_2 = \vec{m} - \vec{h}_s$$

The vectors of $\vec{c}_1$ and $\vec{c}_2$ are finally rounded to the same level as the input values for $\vec{m}$ and $\vec{p}$ to ensure the placement with the same accuracy on the map as the connected triangle coordinates.

¹The tests and calculations were specific to the researcher's smartphone model, so they may not represent the angle of every smartphone lens. However, since the iPhone is widely used, it should cover most standard cases, and most tourism photography on Instagram is done with similar smartphones.

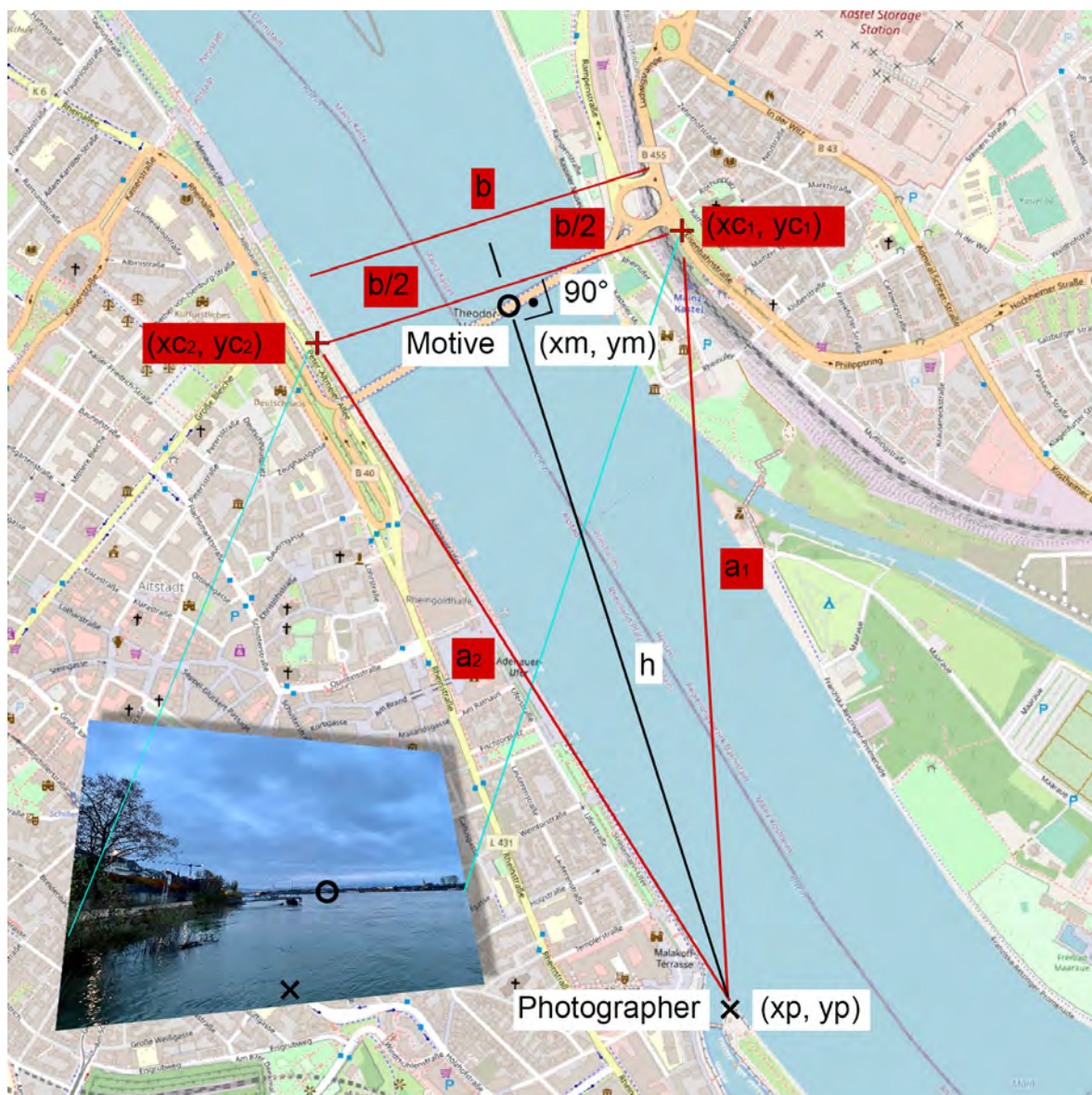


Figure 7.1: Example of the viewpoint triangle (red lines) between the position of the photographer (x_p, y_p) and the motive (x_m, y_m) in the city of Mainz (source: own photo and figure with underlying OSM standard map).

7.5 Additional supporting figures, tables and maps

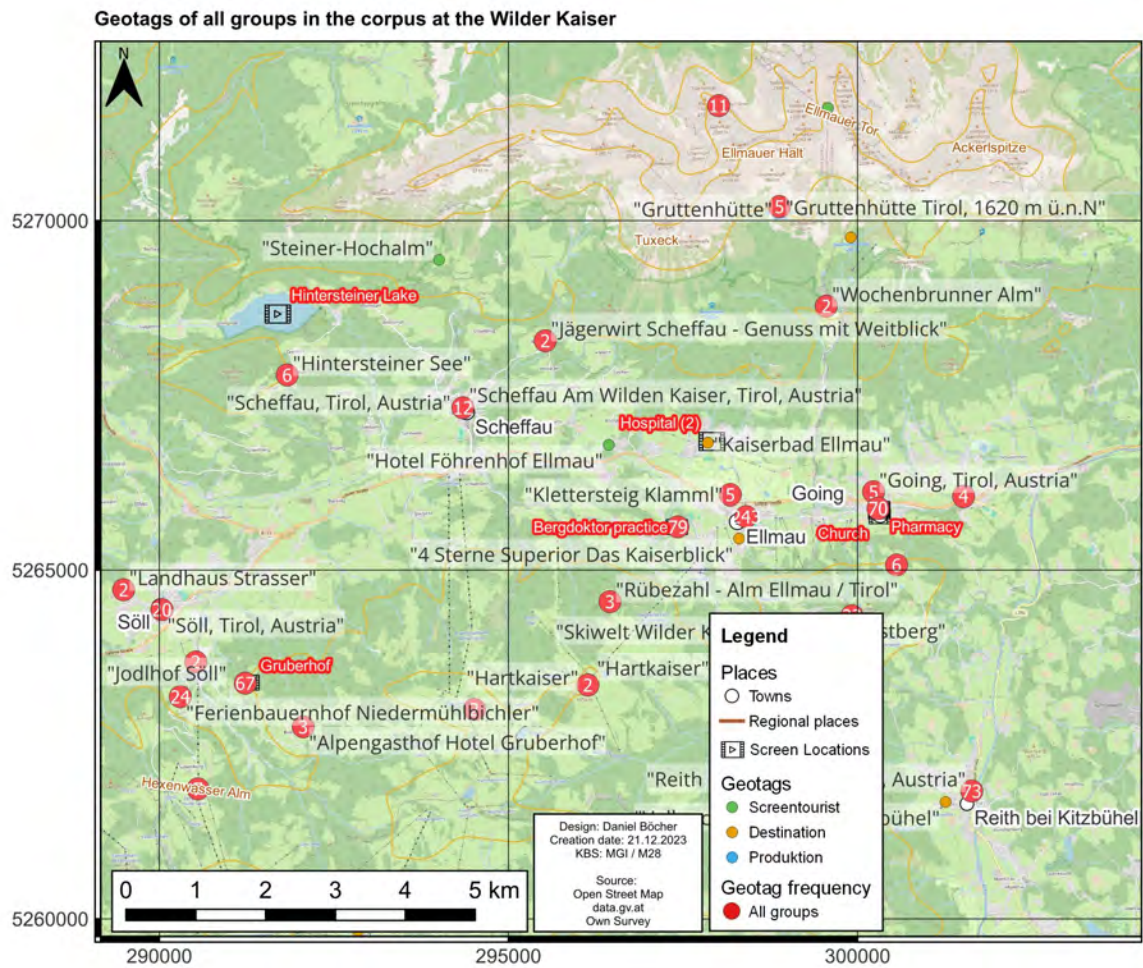


Figure 7.2: Geotags of all corpus posts in the Wilder Kaiser region (source: own data).

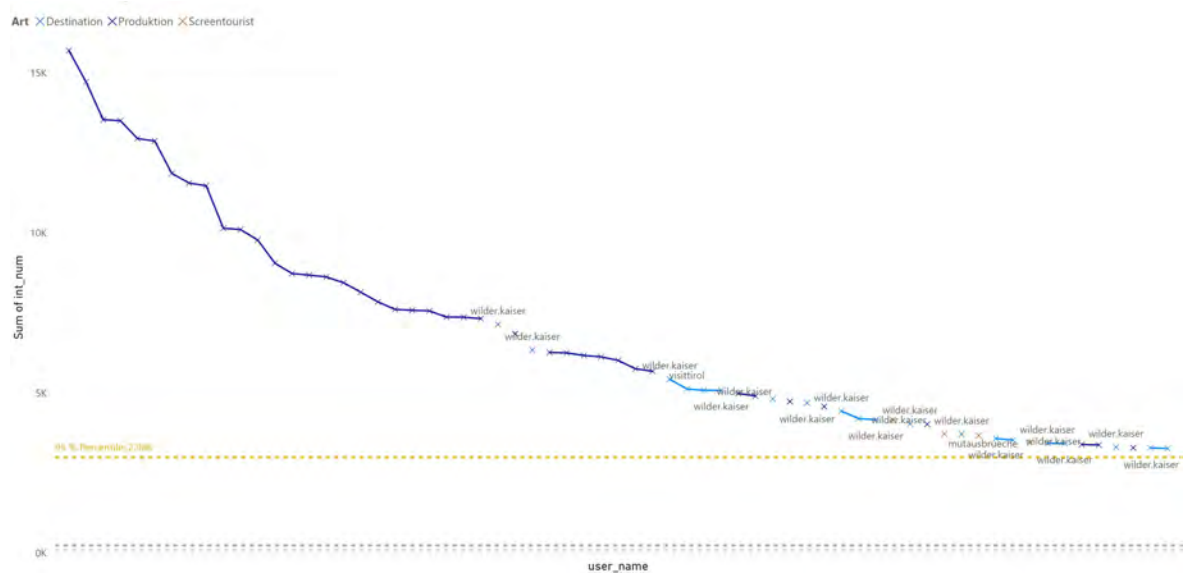


Figure 7.3: Posts of the 95 percentile of all posts in the corpus.



Figure 7.4: A photo in the direction of the Ellmauer Tor in the center (Source: Instagram screenshot with post id CJtdgPn-JHmw).

Artikel	Anzahl
Bergdoktorposter	423
Bergdoktortasse	5,288
Bergdoktor Postkartenheft	494
Bergdoktor Kühlschrankschrankmagnet div.	4,706
Bergdoktor Pflasterbox	1,575
Bergdoktor Schlüsselanhänger	988
Bergdoktor Jausenbox	779
Bergdoktor Fächer	833
	15,086

Table 7.50: The amount of BD merchandise sold in 2023 by the DMO as the net proceeds will be donated (source: Krösslhuber (2024b)).

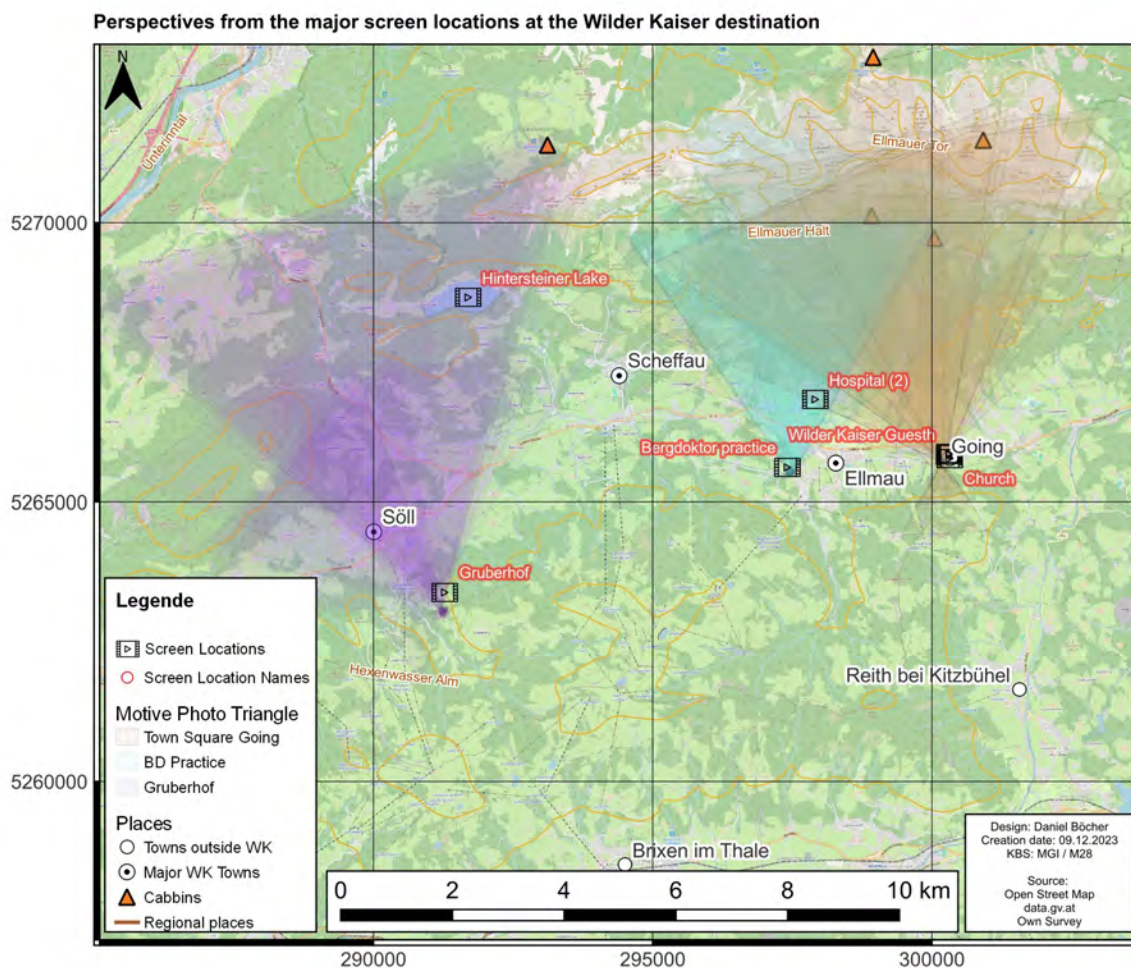


Figure 7.6: The screen tourist perspective of every photographer at the three major screen locations of the (f.l.t.r) Gruberhof, Bergdoktor Practice and the Town Square in Going (Source: Own Map).

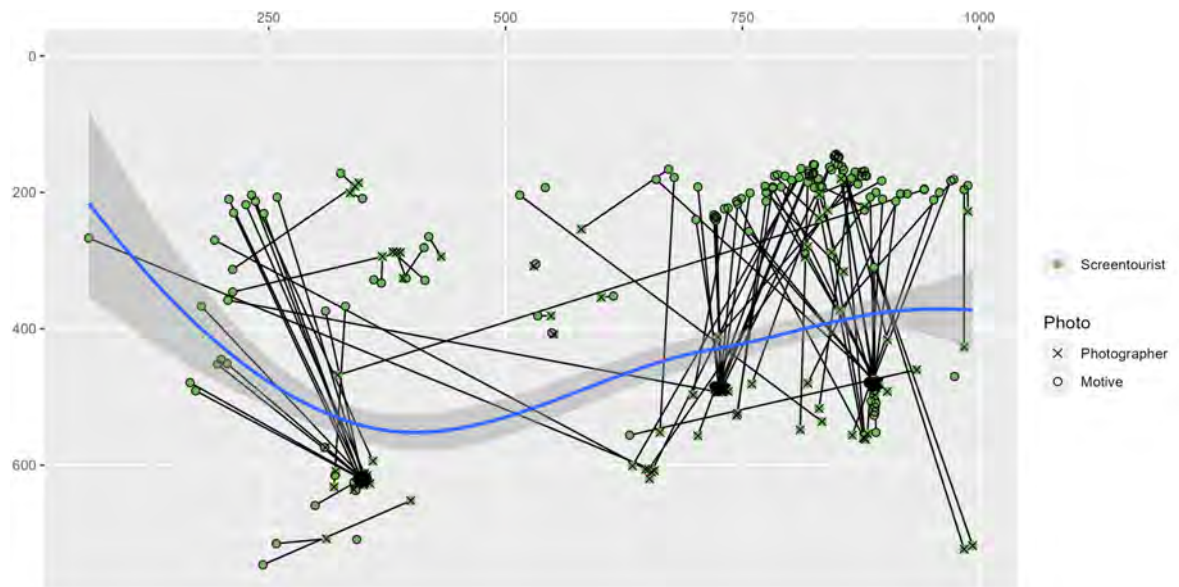


Figure 7.7: Connection between screen tourism motives and photographer positions on a X-Y-axis. The blue line is the regression line with the confidence interval in grey (source: own data).

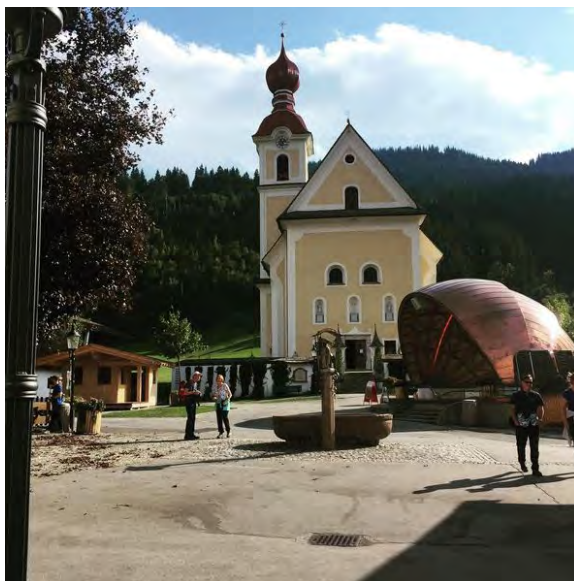


Figure 7.5: Photo from the screen location town square and the church with the ski hills in the background (Source: Instagram screenshot with Post id CF-06iuJF1a).

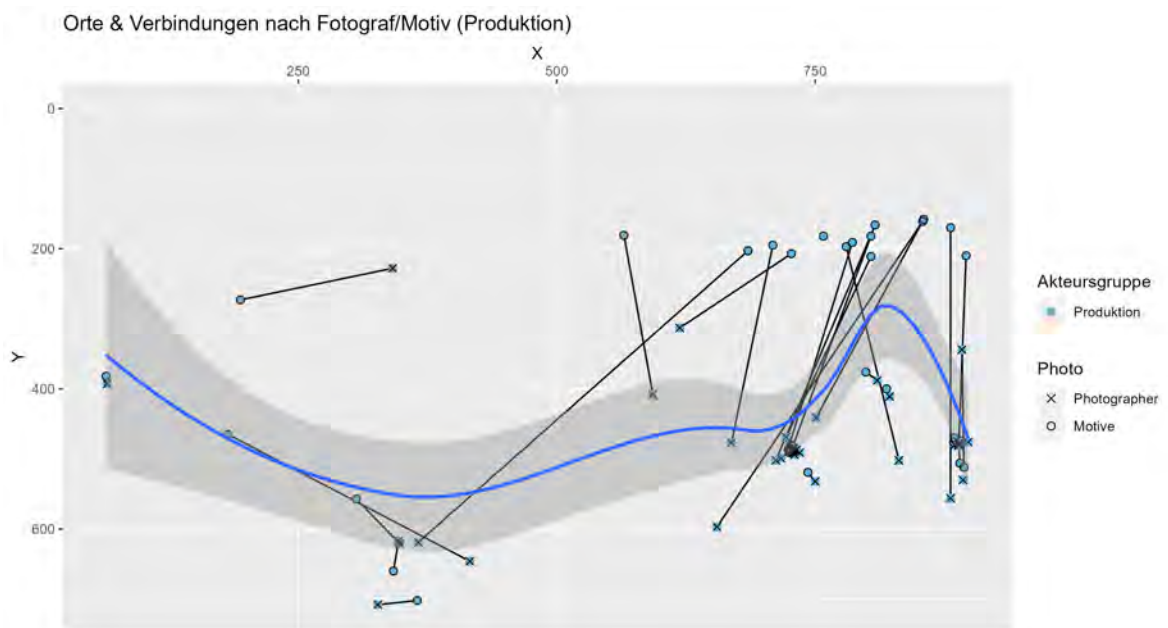


Figure 7.9: Connections of Production photos between photographer and motive points (source: own data). The blue line is the regression line with the confidence interval in gray.

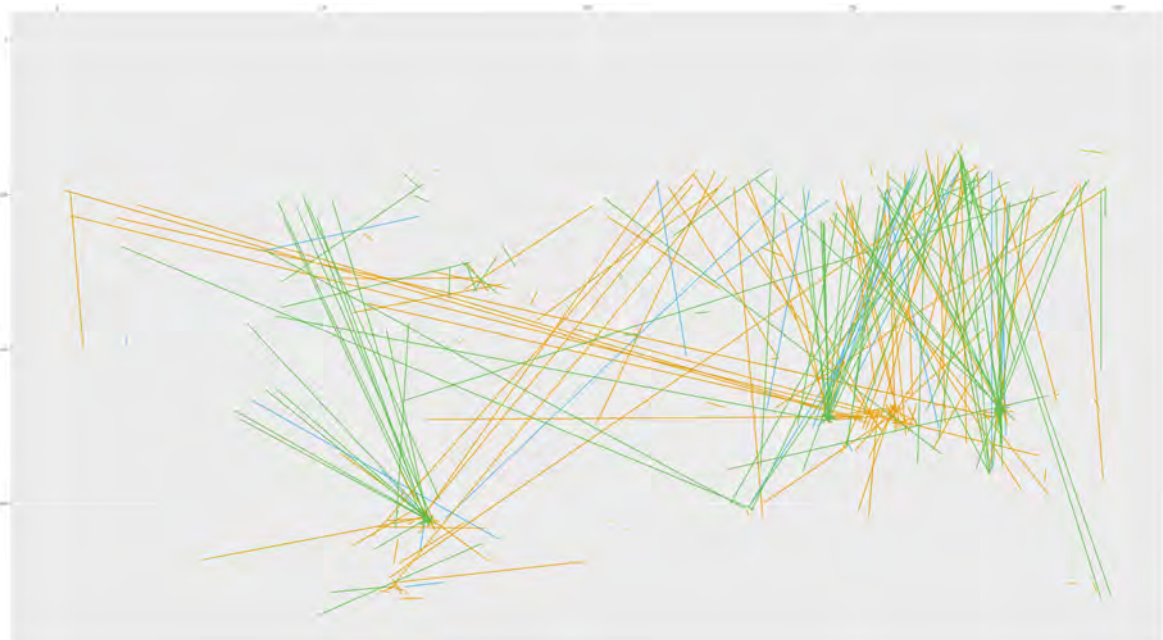


Figure 7.10: Connection between photographer and motive points for the corpus data (source: own data). Screen tourist in green, Destination in yellow, and Production in blue.

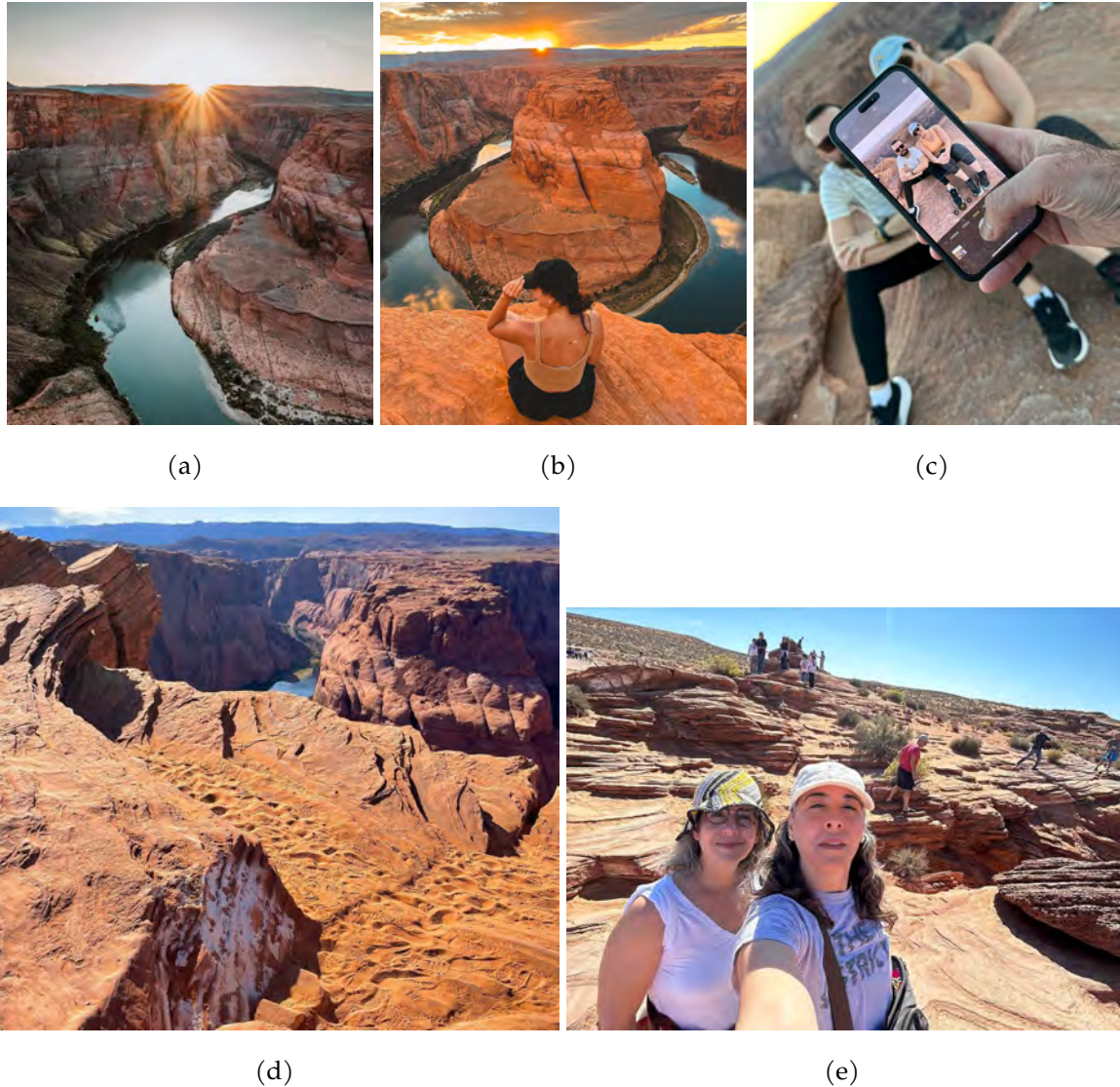


Figure 7.11: (a) What we dream of seeing at the attraction. (b) How we present ourselves as (lonely) tourists. (c) Through the eyes of the apparatus. (d) Hidden but still there: Footprints of tourist activity. (e) The tourist reality at the attraction. (source: Instagram screenshots with post ids (a) CySOX0Tu-rv, (b) CyA1RZ0IYzm, (c) CycLkFqJQYX, (d) CybzYzruNh8 and (e) CyJbH8JOrGK)

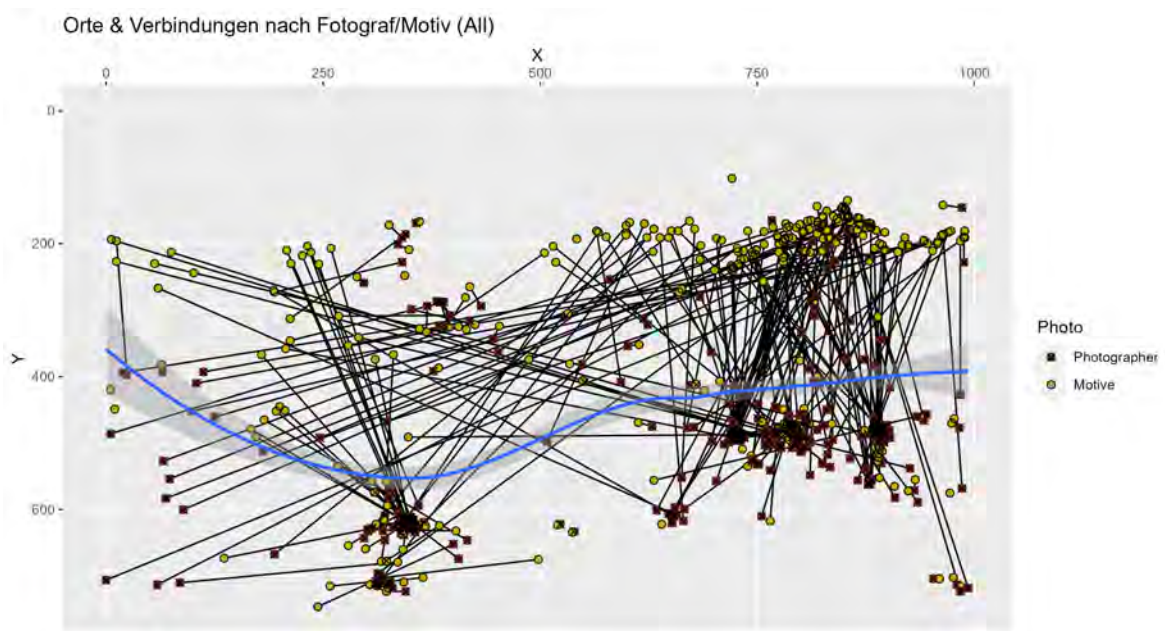


Figure 7.12: The connection of all photographer to motive points (source: own data).

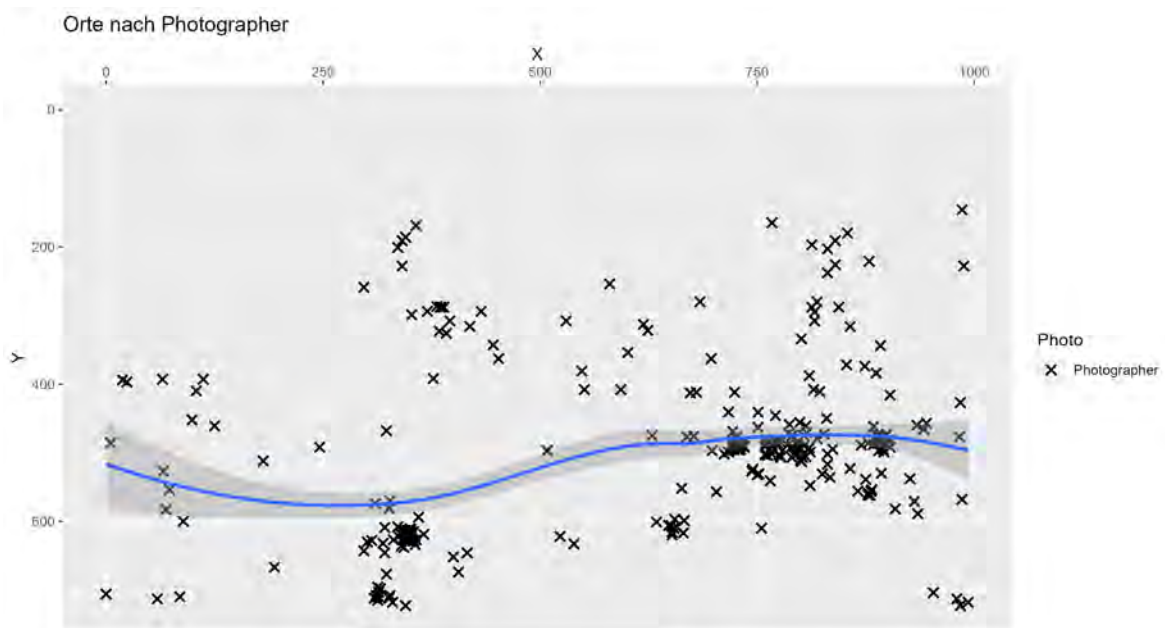


Figure 7.13: The photographer points of all posts (source: own data).

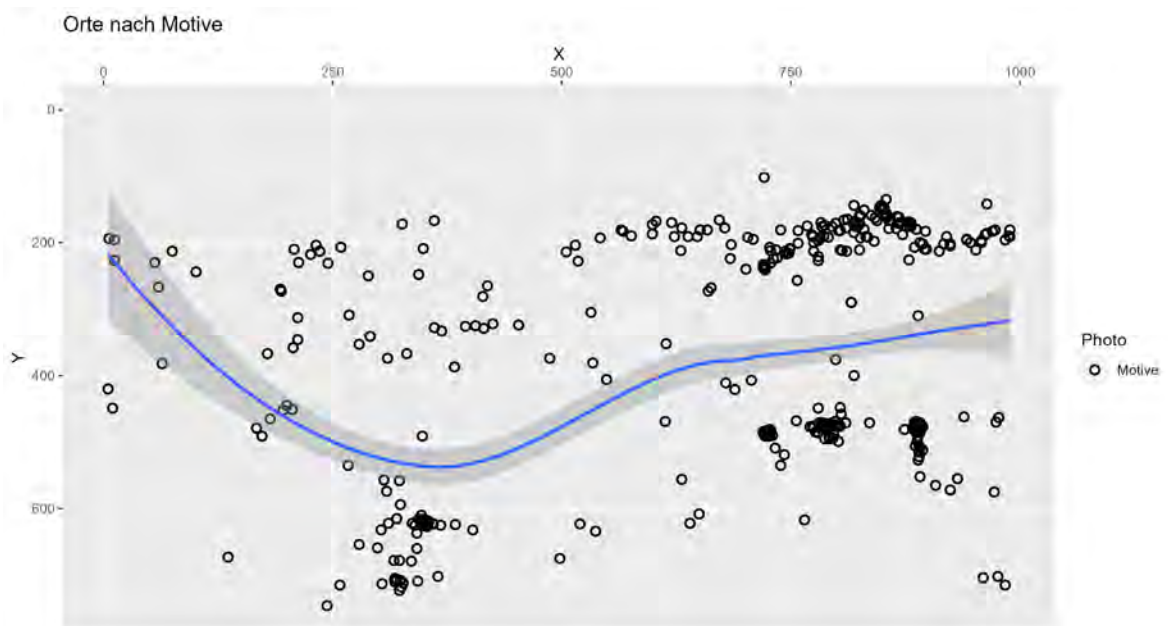


Figure 7.14: The motive points of all posts (source: own data).

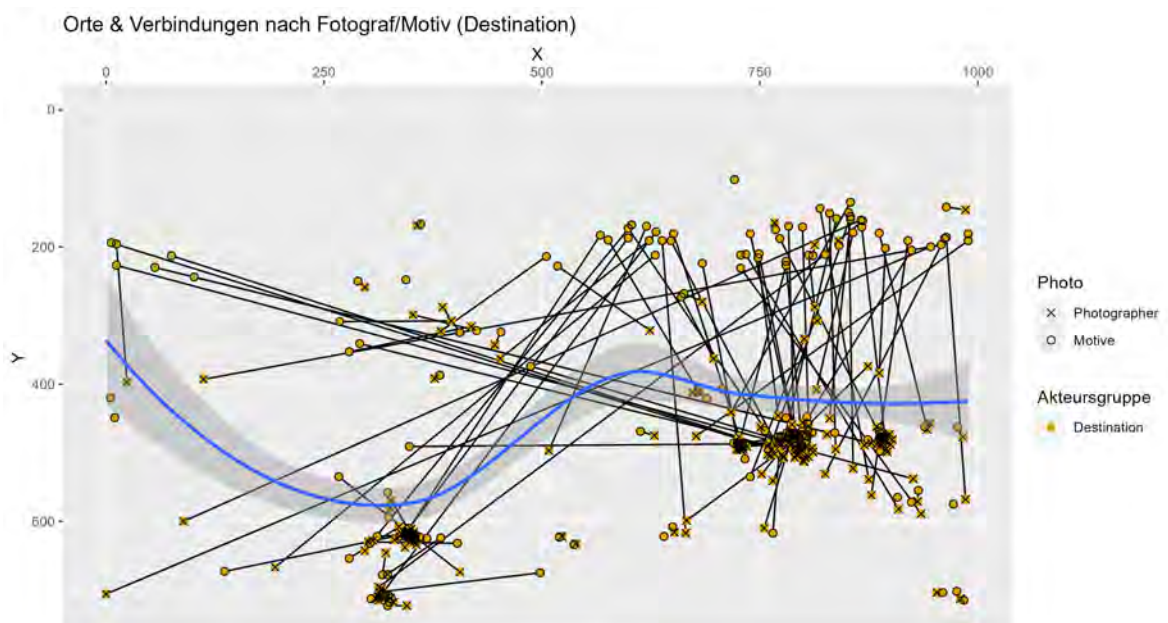


Figure 7.15: Photographer and motive points and connections of Destination photos (source: own data).

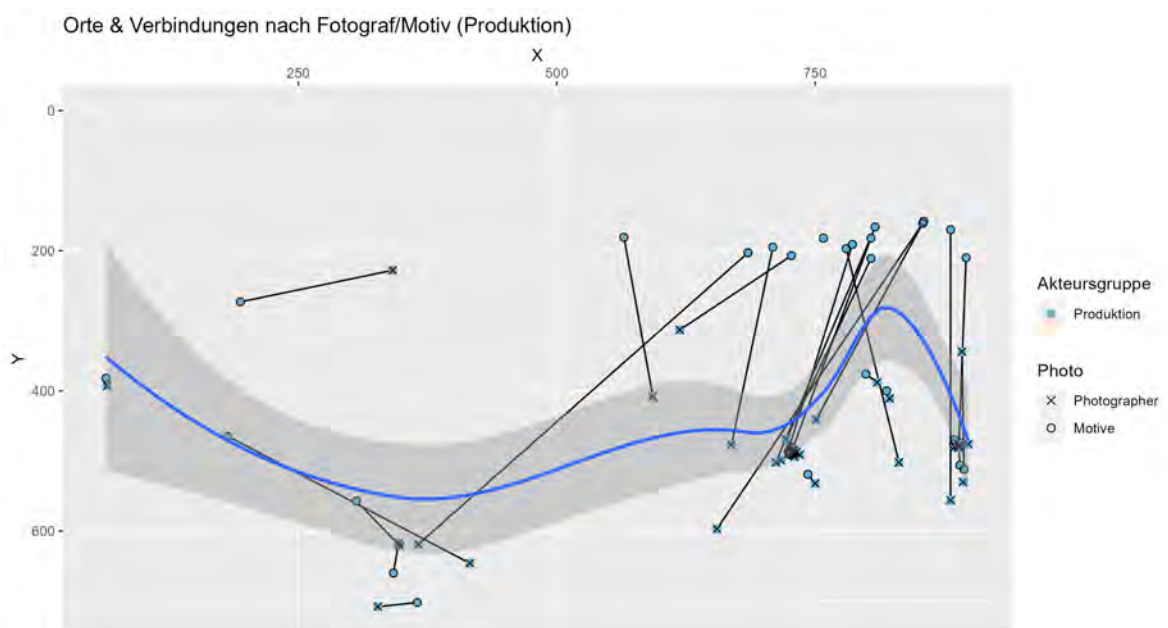


Figure 7.16: Photographer and motive points and connections of Production photos (source: own data).

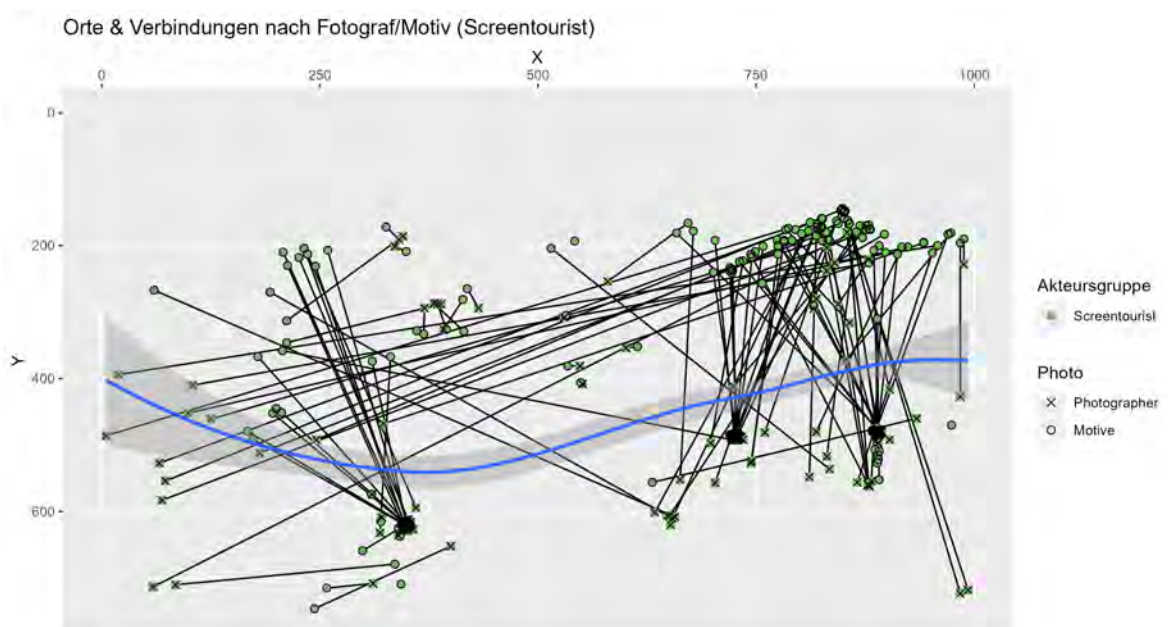


Figure 7.17: Photographer and motive points and connections of Screentourist photos (source: own data).

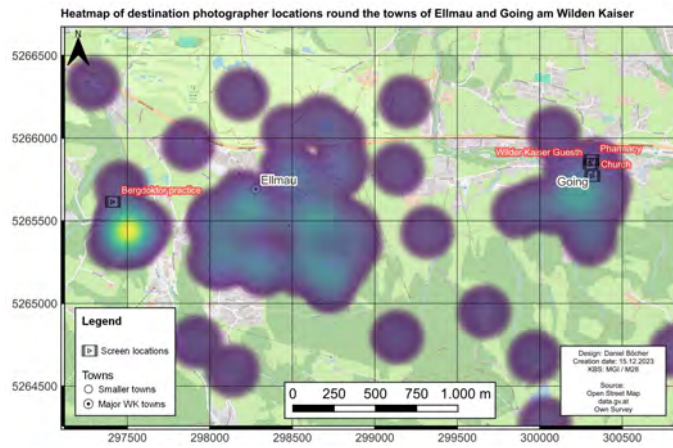


Figure 7.8: A heatmap of the destination photos with photographer locations near Ellmau (Source: Own map).

7.6 Declaration of independence

This is a declaration that the dissertation has been prepared independently, without outside help and with no aids other than those specified therein, that the passages, drawings, sketches, pictorial representations and the like taken verbatim or in terms of content from other works are clearly identified as such and that the regulations on safeguarding good scientific practice in research and teaching and on the procedure for dealing with scientific misconduct have been taken note of. No help from commercial doctoral advisors has been used.

Mainz, den

Unterschrift:

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